

تدبر سورة يوسف

TADDABUR SURAH YUSUF

These notes are based on a previous course. Anything good is from Allah and any mistakes are from ourselves and the shaitan. May Allah forgive us.

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لا حول ولا قوة إلا بالله

تدبر سورة يوسف

TADDABUR SURAH YUSUF

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Miracle of the Qur'an (اعجاز القرآن) – Ayat 1 -3

1. Miracle of the Qur'an (اعجاز القرآن) – Ayat 1 - 3

- Alif Lam Ra'a – the severed letters (one of the miracles of the Qur'an) (الرّاء)
- These are the verses (تِلْكَ آيَاتُ)
 - Of the Book (الْكِتَابِ)
 - Clear (الْمُبِينِ)
- We sent it (إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ)
 - Qur'an (which means always repeated) (قُرْءَانًا)
 - Arabic (which means to clarify) (عَرَبِيًّا) → Why?
 - So that you may understand (لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ)
- We narrate upon you (Prophet (صلى الله عليه وسلم)) (نَحْنُ نَقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ)
 - The best of stories (أَحْسَنَ الْقَصَصِ)
 - With what We inspired to you (بِمَا أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ)
 - This Qur'an (هَذَا الْقُرْءَانِ)
 - And verily before it (وَإِنْ كُنْتَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِ)
 - You were of the heedless (لَمِنَ الْغَافِلِينَ)

Vision of Yusuf (عليه السلام) – Ayat 4-6

1. Vision of Yusuf (عليه السلام) – Ayat 4-6

- Yusuf (عليه السلام) said to his father (إِذْ قَالَ يُوسُفُ لِأَبِيهِ)
 - O my father (يَا أَبَتِ)
 - Verily I saw a vision (إِنِّي رَأَيْتُ)
 - Eleven stars (أَحَدَ عَشَرَ كَوْكَبًا)
 - And the sun and the moon (وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ)
 - I saw them (رَأَيْتُهُمْ)
 - i. To me (لِي)
 - ii. Prostrating (سَاجِدِينَ)
- He (the father) said, O my son (قَالَ يَبْنَىٰ)
 - Do not narrate your vision to your brothers (لَا تَقْصُصْ)
 - ↳ Why? (رُءْيَاكَ عَلَىٰ إِخْوَتِكَ)
 - Then they will plot against you a great plot (فَيَكِيدُوا)
 - (لَكَ كَيْدًا)
 - Verily the shaitan is to the human a clear enemy (إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ لِلْإِنْسَنِ عَدُوٌّ مُّبِينٌ)
- Allah's actions (أفعال الله)

○ And thus your Lord chooses you (وَكَذَٰلِكَ يَجْتَبِيكَ رَبُّكَ)

○ And He teaches you the interpretation of dreams (وَيُعَلِّمُكَ مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ)

○ And He completes His favor (وَيُتِمُّ نِعْمَتَهُ)

- Upon you (عَلَيْكَ)

- And upon the family of Yaqoub (وَعَلَىٰ ءَالِ) (عليه السلام) (يَعْقُوبَ)

○ Just as He completed it upon your forefathers (كَمَّا أَتَمَّهَا عَلَىٰ أَبَوَيْكَ مِنْ قَبْلُ)

- i. Ibrahim (إِبْرَاهِيمَ) (عليه السلام)

- ii. And Issac (وِإِسْحَاقَ) (عليه السلام)

○ Verily (إِنَّ)

- i. Your Lord (رَبِّكَ)

- ii. Is the All-Knower (عَلِيمٌ)

- iii. All-Wise (حَكِيمٌ)

Plotting of Yusuf (عليه السلام) brothers (تأمر أخوة يوسف عليه السلام) – Ayat 7-18

- When we look at the overall conversation above, we see that the brothers are speaking more – 3 ayat amongst each other, 3 ayat

with the father, the father speaks in one ayah, and Yusuf (عليه السلام) does not speak at all.

1. Introduction – Ayah 7

- **Verily there were** (لَقَدْ كَانَ)

- In Yusuf (فِي يُوسُفَ)

- And his brothers (وَإِخْوَتِهِ)

- **Signs for those who ask** (ءَايَاتٍ لِّلَّسَّالِينَ) → it shows what is in their hearts and the nurturing that takes place. If you have doubts, you need to clear your doubts. You need to ask questions.

2. Talk of the Brothers among themselves (كَلَامُ إِخْوَةِ يُوسُفَ فِيمَا بَيْنَهُمْ) –

Ayat 8-10

- **They said** (إِذْ قَالُوا) → whenever there is something being said, that means there is something in the heart.

- **That Yusuf and his brother is more beloved to our father than us** (إِذْ قَالُوا لَيُوسُفُ وَأَخُوهُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْنَا مِنَّا) → do not make

comparisons, and this shows there is jealousy and displeasure, and it shows you that love is in Allah's hands. And that jealousy came means there is something wrong with their belief in Allah.

- **And we are a strong group** (وَنَحْنُ عُصْبَةٌ) → you can see they are praising themselves.

- **Verily our father in a clear misguidance** (**إِنَّ أَبَانَا لَفِي**)

(**ضَلَّلَ مُبِينٍ**) → and how jealous they are

- **Kill Yusuf** (**أَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ**) → there is even no mention of 'said' which shows how determined and how strong they feel .

- **Or cast him in a land** (**أَوْ أَطْرَحُوهُ أَرْضًا**)

- **So that the face of your father will be for you alone**

(**يَخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهُ أَبِيكُمْ**) → see how people will go far for love.

- **And we will be after him a righteous group** (**وَتَكُونُوا**)

(**مِنْ بَعْدِهِ قَوْمًا صَالِحِينَ**) → they are thinking that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is making all of the evil thoughts come as a result of him, so they need to get rid of him in order to be righteous, so it shows they were not righteous to begin with, subhan Allah.

- **Said one among them** (**قَالَ قَائِلٌ مِّنْهُمْ**) → so only one brother is speaking now and he is giving a condition. He lays out the scenario and it happens exactly that way.

- **Do not kill Yusuf** (**لَا تَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ**)

- **And throw him in the bottom of a dry well** (**وَالْقُوْهُ فِي غَيَابَتٍ**)

(**الْجُبِّ**) → even though he did not even know that well

will be there. When a person wants to sin, the means become approachable.

- He will be picked up by a caravan of travelers (يَلْتَقِطُهُ بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ) → how does he even know this will happen, and it shows you it is the ability of Allah who is making him speak like this.
- If that's what you want to do (إِنْ كُنْتُمْ فَعَلِينَ)

3. Talk of the Brothers with the father (كلام الاخوة مع ابيه) – Ayat 11 -12

- They said (قَالُوا) → before they didn't have a plan and the father wouldn't send Yusuf (عليه السلام) with them, but the time they have a plan, the father ends up letting Yusuf (عليه السلام) go with him.
 - Oh our father (يَا أَبَانَا) → notice that the mother is not mentioned because the test is for Yaqoub (عليه السلام) and his relationship with Yusuf (عليه السلام)
 - Why do you not trust us with Yusuf (مَا لَكَ لَا تَأْمَنَّا عَلَىٰ) (يُوسُفَ) → look at how they immediately jumped to talking about trust, rather than just saying we would like to take Yusuf (عليه السلام)
 - And verily we are to him counselors (وَإِنَّا لَهُ ,) (لَنَنْصِحُونَ) → we will take care of him because we are his older brothers. They

know that their father is a messenger so they try to speak in a way of talking about trust, and counseling, that they are caring and guiding.

- Send him with us tomorrow so that we to enjoy and play (أَرْسَلَهُ مَعَنَا غَدًا يَرْتَع وَيَلْعَبُ) → notice they were not planning to take Benjamin, but rather only Yusuf (عليه السلام)
 - And verily we will protect him (وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ)

4. Talk of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) (كلام يعقوب عليه السلام) – Ayah 13

- He said (قَالَ)

○ It will sadden me that you go out with him (إِنِّي لَيَحْزُنُنِي أَنْ)

(تَذْهَبُوا بِهِ) → notice that he talked about his emotions

first, he is very direct with his feelings, and it shows how much love he has for Yusuf (عليه السلام), thus the great test. Subhan Allah. And they only asked him to go out, not to travel with him, and he feel so sad to even be separated from him for a few hours. Subhan Allah.

○ And I fear that the wolf will eat him (وَأَخَافُ أَنْ يَأْكُلَهُ الذِّئْبُ)

→ he gave an idea for the brothers and they took it. So don't say what you fear out loud to others. And again he shows his feeling of fear.

○ And while you are heedless (وَأَنْتُمْ عَنْهُ غَافِلُونَ)

5. Reply of the brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام) (رد اخوة يوسف عليه السلام) –

Ayah 14

- They said (قَالُوا) → they took something from their father's speech and based it as their argument.
 - If a wolf eats him and we are a strong group (لَنْ أَكَلَهُ) → it shows their arrogance, they are so tough.
 - Verily then we are losers (إِنَّا إِذَا لَخْسِرُونَ) → notice they are boasting about themselves to their father in order to convince him, they said we are 'counselors, guardians, a big group, we don't want to be losers'

Plotting of Yusuf (عليه السلام) brothers (تآمر أخوة يوسف عليه السلام) – Ayat 15-18

(first half)

2. **So when they took him away (فَلَمَّا ذَهَبُوا بِهِ)**
 - **And all agreed to throw him in a hidden well (وَأَجْمَعُوا أَنْ يَجْعَلُوهُ فِي غِيَابَتِ الْجُبِّ)** → Here we see the brothers plotting, but Allah plans and Allah is the best of planners.
3. **And We inspired to him (Yusuf (عليه السلام)) (وَأَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْهِ)** → Here we see the action of Allah
 - **Indeed you will inform them of this matter (لَتُنَبِّئَنَّهُمْ بِأَمْرِهِمْ هَذَا)** → After some years, we see the fulfillment of Allah's promise.

- While they do not perceive (وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ)

4. **And they came** (وَجَاءُوا) → To whom?

- Their father (أَبَاهُمْ) → When?
- Evening (عِشَاءً) → Doing what?
- Crying (يَبْكُونَ)

5. **They said** (قَالُوا) → When people are plotting, they all try to say the same thing

- **Our father** (يَا أَبَانَا) → Telling their made up story to their father

○ **We went to race** (إِنَّا ذَهَبْنَا نَسْتَبِقُ)

○ **And we left Yusuf with our belongings** (وَتَرَكْنَا يُوسُفَ عِنْدَ مَتَاعِنَا)

○ **And the wolf devoured him** (فَأَكَلَهُ الذِّئْبُ)

○ **And you will not believe us** (وَمَا أَنْتَ بِمُؤْمِنٍ لَّنَا)

○ **Even if we were truthful** (وَلَوْ كُنَّا صَادِقِينَ) → This shows they are liars because if you are truthful you do not need to make a statement like this.

6. **And they came** (وَجَاءُوا) → All of the brothers, so we really see how they are all in this, not single one of the ten brothers is out of sync.

- **On his shirt** (عَلَى قَمِيصِهِ) → This shows they are liars because the blood is on the shirt, and it is not torn through
 - **With fake blood** (بِدَمٍ كَذِبٍ)

Reply of father – Yaqoub (عليه السلام) (رد ابيهم يعقوب عليه السلام)– Ayah 18
(second half of ayah)

1. He said (قَالَ)

- **Not (بَلَّ)** → This negates what was previously said, so what his sons said
 - **Your nafs made it easy for you to obey it and do this matter** (سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا) → This shows a gentle reforming from the father, he could have easily have said to his sons 'you are liars', but he is talking to them according to what they understand.
- **A beautiful patience (فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ)** → Yaqoub (عليه السلام) consoles himself by turning to Allah. It is not easy to lose a child. Because how much can he do after that, so the faith comforts him. He did not say I am patience. Rather, it's a type of patience without hard feelings, no pain, unlike other patience that can be painful.
 - **And Allah Whose help can be sought for what you describe** (وَاللَّهُ الْمُسْتَعَانُ عَلَى مَا تَصِفُونَ) → he is telling us that he can't take being like this, but Allah will be the One

who help him. When you hear something you do not like, seek the help of Allah.

What happened to Yusuf (عليه السلام) – Ayat 19-20

1. And a caravan came (وَجَاءَتْ سَيَّارَةٌ)

- So they sent their water-drawer (فَأَرْسَلُوا وَارِدَهُمْ)

○ And he let down his bucket (فَأَذَلَّى دَلْوَهُ)

- He said (قَالَ)

○ Oh good news! (يُبَشِّرِي)

○ Here is a boy! (هَذَا غُلَامٌ) → So what did they do with Yusuf (عليه السلام)?

- And they hid him as merchandise (وَأَسْرَوْهُ بِضْعَةً)

- And Allah is All-Knowing of what they did (وَاللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ بِمَا يَعْمَلُونَ)

→ They can hide him, but Allah is All-Knowing. What happened to Yusuf (عليه السلام)?

2. And they sold him (وَشَرَوْهُ)

- For a measly price (بِثَمَنٍ بَخْسٍ)

- Dirhams that can be counted (دَرَاهِمَ مَعْدُودَةٍ)

- And they were of those who saw him as insignificant (وَكَانُوا)

(فِيهِ مِنَ الْزَاهِدِينَ) → Though Yusuf (عليه السلام) is worth more than all of them. And this tells us do not judge someone by their cover,

because you do not know what is their value with Allah. And vice versa, some people might have value with the people, but not with Allah. Subhan Allah.

وَقَالَ الَّذِي اشْتَرَاهُ مِنْ مِصْرَ لِمَرْأَتِهِ أَكْرِمِي مَثْوَاهُ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَنْفَعَنَا أَوْ نَتَّخِذَهُ وَلَدًا ۚ وَكَذَٰلِكَ مَكَّنَّا لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَلِنُعَلِّمَهُ مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ ۚ وَاللَّهُ غَالِبٌ عَلَىٰ أَمْرِهِ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ {21}

(21) The man in Egypt who bought him, said to his wife: "Make his stay (among us) honourable: may be he will bring us much good, or we shall adopt him as a son." Thus did We establish Joseph in the land, that We might teach him the interpretation of stories (and events). And Allah hath full power and control over His affairs; but most among mankind know it not. (Yusuf)

Surah Yusuf: 21 From 'Thus' (وَكَذَٰلِكَ)

- Look at the decree of Allah, of all the people that could have bought Yusuf as a slave, Allah decree that a man of position would take him and treat him with honor. A scholar was asked, 'How do you know Allah?' He said from how quick the intention of a heart can change. Need to always think good of Allah, because your provision will be better than expected.
- (وَكَذَٰلِكَ) is referring to all of the incidents that took place from the time of the well, to being traded, and then being taken to Egypt.
- (مَكَّنَّا) means to grab something and stay firm on it, like grabbing an opportunity, so now we know that Yusuf will be established in Egypt

(مَكَّنَّا لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ). Before, his family was living as nomads, but look at the decree of Allah that from Banu Israel, Yusuf will be the first to be established. Israel refers to his father, Yaqoub. Banu are the sons, who later became tribes. Look at the wisdom of the decree of Allah. It began with a plot, but look at the result. This should remind you that in life, you can reach success with tawakul from Allah, don't blame your circumstances. Your circumstances could be the very drivers to improve you, if you seek the help of Allah.

- (وَلِنُعَلِّمَهُ مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ) In order for Yusuf to reach his position that Allah has decreed for him, Allah will now train and prepare him. First is عَلَّمَ, knowledge. So who will teach him? Allah will teach him through different means. Who was the first to learn? Adam (And He taught Adam the names of all things 2:31) (وَعَلَّمَ آدَمَ الْأَسْمَاءَ كُلَّهَا). So whatever you learn, you must attribute it to Allah. When you acquire knowledge, don't say 'that person will teach me better', they are only human, ask Allah to help you learn, and He will bring the means.
- **There are two ways of having knowledge:** 1. Knowledge that you learn from somebody 2. Not being taught, and you already have a talent, this is from Allah. So Allah taught Yusuf (gave him the talent) to be able to interpret الْأَحَادِيثِ. This can mean 'narration' and 'dream', but very specific dreams, those that you see properly and have symbols. Allah also gave this ability to his father, Yaqoub, and to the Prophet Mohammed (peace be upon them all). The interpretation of dreams

was the miracle for Yusuf. Also, Allah gave him the talent to speak with wisdom and be able to deal with different matters in life.

- **(وَاللَّهُ غَالِبٌ عَلَى أَمْرِهِ)** means to defeat, dominate. So Allah commands what is to happen, and no one can avoid it or prevent it. So if you are attached to Allah, you will not worry about what is decreed for you because you do not know what the result will be. Even with the plot, Yaqoub continued to only love Yusuf more and the other brothers less for what they did. So Allah took care of Yusuf's affairs. If society and people knew this and actually accepted that Allah dominates your affairs, everybody would be more at ease, but the majority do not know this **(وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ)**
- **يَعْلَمُونَ** comes from **عَلِمَ** this is referring to 'beneficial knowledge' (**علم**), for example knowing about the hereafter. Ex: Sometimes parents treat their child's exams like it's the end of the world. They will not even wake them up for fajr prayer since they were studying, or skip reading their Qur'an. So in order to get a good grade, certificate, get a job, etc But where is the certificate for preparing for the hereafter? The message is to prioritize the knowledge you seek. When you know Allah first and then learn other things, this of itself will be a charity because you are now doing it for the sake of Allah. Now, people are fighting for the duniya.
- When decrees are happening to you, even if it's being treated badly by others, it is a test for you to see, 'do you know Allah? Are you going to seek the help of Allah from the start?' The prophet Mohammed

((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) was being tortured by the disbelievers of his community, and he said, 'Oh Allah forgive them, for they are a people who do not know.' (اللهم اغفر لهم انهم قوم لا يعلمون)

Surah Yusuf: 22 Upto 'Knowledge' (عِلْمًا)

وَلَمَّا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ آتَيْنَاهُ حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا ۚ وَكَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي الْمُحْسِنِينَ {22}

(22) When Joseph attained His full manhood, We gave him power and knowledge: thus do We reward those who do right. (Yusuf)

- (وَلَمَّا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ) Here we know that Yusuf came young and know has reached maturity. (بَلَغَ) means to reach its fullest, (أَشُدَّهُ) means that he has reached the best of his strength.
- **What kind of strength?:** 1. Physical strength 2. Mental strength. This means that at this stage, he has now been nurtured and ready to receive the message from Allah. Now he can take on the prophethood because he can bear the burden. So Allah has granted him a special provision (رزق خاص)
- Sometimes in the Qur'an, we see that Allah is speaking in the 'We' form. This is referring to the majestic, exalted 'We'. Also it is referring that this is coming from Allah through different means, ie: through angels, Jibreel, etc.
- **What are the provisions?:** 1. Judgement (حُكْمًا) and this is referring to (a) Accurate insight (الرؤية الصحيحة), so he can make good judgement

(b) Wisdom (الحكمة) (c) Intellect (العقل). So all of these are means to establishing Yusuf as explained in the last verse.

- Look at the order in which Allah granted the provisions, judgement and then knowledge (حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا). Some people have knowledge but make wrong decisions, do not have wisdom or insight. So in the case of Yusuf, knowledge (عِلْمٌ) is referring to 1. Knowledge of Allah 2. Knowledge of the commands of Allah 3. Knowledge about life. All in all, ready for prophethood.

وَلَمَّا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ آتَيْنَاهُ حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا ۖ وَكَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي الْمُحْسِنِينَ {22}

(22) When Joseph attained His full manhood, We gave him power and knowledge: thus do We reward those who do right. (Yusuf)

- There is a lesson in all of the stories Allah narrates, and the more you know about it, the more you start to grasp and realize it is an Arabic Qur'an (قرآن عربيًا) with the best of the stories (أحسن القصص).
- To be established on the earth, it is not only the outer, but it the inner as well, which is (حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا) judgement and wisdom.
- (حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا) judgement and wisdom are blessings from Allah, and you can ask Allah to be bestowed with knowledge (to comprehend religion) and wisdom (to understand the consequences) but Allah gives this to the (محسنين). When a person starts to have (إحسان) which means doing everything in life in the best way. So Islam is teaching us

this principle. Allah loves the (محسنين), those who do things in the best way, and will recompense them.

- Al Muhsineen when it comes in the noun form is different from the verb form. In the noun form, it means you are in a constant phase of 'ihsan', ie: being a mother, driving, walking, etc.
- So Allah chooses the real 'muhsineen' because He knows they are not doing it for the sake of the people, but they are doing it for the sake of Allah. In the hadith (قَالَ مَا الْإِحْسَانُ قَالَ " أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّكَ تَرَاهُ، فَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ تَرَاهُ فَإِنَّهُ) ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) Gabriel asked the Prophet (يَرَاكَ) "What is Ihsan (perfection)?" Allah's Apostle replied, "To worship Allah as if you see Him, and if you cannot achieve this state of devotion then you must consider that He is looking at you."
- And when you become of the 'muhsineen' you will see that Allah honors you with knowledge and wisdom. So Yusuf was truly among the 'muhsineen', doing everything perfect. Even though this story is about Yusuf, but it is glad tidings for Prophet Muhammad ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) and for his ummah.
- Allah can give you the provision, be and it is (رزق كن فيكون) , but Allah gives it to you until you go through different trials. And more trials and struggles will make you turn towards ihsan. People say they want something and they prayed but nothing happened, don't think bad about Allah. Allah will give it to you when you are prepared so that you appreciate it when you have it.

Surat Yusuf: 23

وَرَاوَدَتْهُ الَّتِي هُوَ فِي بَيْتِهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ وَغَلَّقَتِ الْأَبْوَابَ وَقَالَتْ هَيْتَ لَكَ قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ رَبِّي أَحْسَنَ مَثْوَايَ إِنَّهُ لَا يُفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ

(23) But she in whose house he was, sought to seduce him from his (true) self: she fastened the doors, and said: "Now come, thou (dear one)!" He said: "Allah forbid! truly (thy husband) is my lord! he made my sojourn agreeable! truly to no good come those who do wrong!"

- Yusuf was now in the house of the Aziz, and he was a servant as a young boy, but he started to grow in the eyes of the wife of the Aziz, and according to the hadith, "when a man and woman are alone, the third is the shaitan". And the devil does not know nationality or background, he beautifies each other in the eyes of the other. Even in the workplace, people think that things will not happen, but it is best to separate men from the women.
- She couldn't control her desires since she is seeing him everyday and she became attracted both to his outer and inner beauty. So what do you need in such a situation, flee to Allah.
- (رَاوَدَتْهُ) means to do something so that he can be inclined to her. She was gently trying to get him into her trap. (الَّتِي هُوَ فِي بَيْتِهَا) so it was in her house, so it puts Yusuf in a difficult situation. So this trial that he is going through is more severe than the trial he went through with the brothers. Because with the brothers he was cast away and had to wait and be

patient, but now he has to react, and he has to be patient from committing a sin.

- (الْأَبْوَابُ) are doors so this is plural, she locked all of the doors, and the place was free and empty from other servants. So if the husband comes, she will know if he is coming. When she was approaching Yusuf and saw that he was not interested, she said it directly to him, (هَيْتَ لَكَ), unlike (رَأَوْدَتْهُ) which was unclear. So (هَيْتَ) means come, I am prepared for you. It was not easy for her to say this. Subhan Allah, even when a child is reading this, they will not understand the hidden undertone.
- There are different types of love, hers is like (الصَّبَابَةُ) her love was overflowing that she couldn't control herself. Subhan Allah a person can either honor or dishonor himself through his actions, and this seduction was a complete dishonor for her.
- She was beautiful and young and had a high position. Yusuf was young and beautiful and single and it was his first time, and he was a stranger. For example: some people won't do something in their country because people know each other, but outside they do what they want. So one of the ones who will be shaded under the shade of Allah on the Day of Judgement will be the ones when an attractive women calls on them, and the man says I fear Allah.
- When someone is going through so much temptation and cannot control themselves, you can only turn to Allah. So Yusuf said, (مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ), I seek refuge of Allah. And he did not say أَعُوذُ, he said (مَعَاذَ) which is a

noun to give him a place of refuge. So Allah kept him firm. Yusuf was able to see that this sin was very severe and Allah made him hate it, and this is from Allah.

- If a person feels secure from committing a sin, he will fall into that sin. You need to always ask Allah to protect you. Morning / evening supplication (يا حي يا قيوم برحمتك أستغيث أصلح لي شأني كله ولا تكلني إلى نفسي طرفة عين) Oh Living, Oh Everlasting One, with Your mercy I seek, make good all of my affairs, and do not leave me to myself even for a blink of an eye.
- So this situation happened to Yusuf, so do not think others will not fall into that situation? So you need to seek refuge from Allah from the start. Yusuf also told her, (إِنَّهُ رَبِّي أَحْسَنَ مَثْوَايَ). Verily, my master (which can mean Allah or can mean her husband who took him in) took care of my food, clothing, and told you to take care of me. So he did not exceed his limit with his reply even though she exceeded her limit. So he indirectly wanted to make her feel guilty by talking about himself. He never said anything negative like, 'I'm a servant, stranger, alone'.
- Others in such a situation, might have screamed, or hit her, run away, or commit the sin. But he spoke in such a manner that it made her think about Allah (indirectly it is a dawah also). His response was very gentle. No one can protect like this except Allah, so always ask (يا مقلب القلوب،) (ثبت قلبي على دينك) Oh Changer of the hearts, keep my heart firm on Your religion.
- Allah only gives a trial when He knows you can handle it, but then it depends if you fail or pass it. So Yusuf would not have been able to handle it if younger.

- (إِنَّهُ لَا يُفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ): Allah does not make successful the ones who are unjust. So he did not say it directly to her that you are unjust or committed sin. So according to this ayah committing a sin will create imbalance in your system. You are in balance and being just to yourself when you are not committing sin. Ex: if you want to lie, don't you feel uncomfortable.

Surat Yusuf: 24

وَلَقَدْ هَمَّتْ بِهِ ۖ وَهَمَّ بِهَا لَوْلَا أَنْ رَأَىٰ بُرْهَانَ رَبِّهِ ۚ كَذَٰلِكَ لِنَصْرِفَ عَنْهُ السُّوءَ وَالْفَحْشَاءَ ۚ إِنَّهُ
(مِنْ عِبَادِنَا الْمُخْلَصِينَ ٢٤)

She verily desired him, and he would have desired her if it had not been that he saw the argument of his Lord. Thus it was, that We might ward off from him evil and lewdness. Lo! he was of Our chosen slaves. (24)

- Surah Yusuf is the only surah that is about the messenger's life from the beginning to the end. And his stories are all about him being innocent, and others plotting against him. Ex: plot of the brothers, plot of the lady. So this shows it's not just women who plot, or men. It is anyone who listens to the whispers of the shaitain.
- The sequence started with plotting, then talking to him, and now she is taking action.
- (وَلَقَدْ هَمَّتْ بِهِ ۖ): so she desired him (هَمَّ) is thought, (وَهَمَّ بِهَا لَوْلَا أَنْ رَأَىٰ بُرْهَانَ رَبِّهِ ۚ): he would have been inclined to her but Allah is protecting him. So

this does not mean that he has a sickness of having no desire. But his desired was removed from Allah. Had he not seen the clear evidence from his Lord. What is this 'burhan'?

- **What is the clear evidence of his Lord? (بُرْهَانٌ رَبِّهِ):** Yusuf saw from his Lord the faith and knowledge that Allah bestowed upon him in his heart – that is the clear evidence. Sometimes you think you are learning and learning, but when will it be of use. It will come in best use during times of affliction. Always pray, (اللهم زدني علما) “Oh Allah increase me in beneficial knowledge” It is only Allah that can also make you remember when to stop or what to say from committing a sin.
- Don't ever think that you will not fall into sin, or that you trust this person or yourself. We think we have confidence, but it's not the case. We can only have trust in Allah.
- Sins are haram for everyone, but the higher in knowledge, the worse the sin is. Ex: an old man committing adultery is worse than a young man committing adultery. The wives of the Prophet, if they commit sin it would count twice against them.
- (كَذَلِكَ لِنَصْرِفَ عَنْهُ السُّوءَ وَالْفَحْشَاءَ): Allah wanted to get rid of the sin of the desire in Yusuf's heart, and he wanted to eliminate any of the 'after-effects' of such a sin, especially emotional. For example: when going through a bad situation similar to this, someone might say I don't want to go out, becomes panicked, depressed, etc. So Allah is protecting Yusuf from the (السُّوءَ). Allah is also protecting Yusuf from (وَالْفَحْشَاءَ), the indecency / physicality of the sin.

- **Don't you want to be protected?** Not all temptations are the same for each person, everyone has a certain weakness, and that temptation will come according to your weakness. (إِنَّهُ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا الْمُخْلَصِينَ) He was of Our sincere servants.
- **Characteristics of those whom Allah will protect:**

1. Special servant of Allah (عِبَادِنَا): there are special servants and general servants of Allah, don't you want to be a special servant of Allah? Everyone is a slave of Allah, but to be a special slave, they are the ones who chose to become a slave of Allah. How do you choose to become a slave of Allah? Your heart should be humble to Allah, attached to Allah, surrendering to Allah, wanting to please only Allah, and cannot do anything without Allah. You don't look like a poor slave, your heart is a slave to Allah. We ask Allah to make us of His special servants. Ameen. The more we know about Allah and Qur'an, the more the chains are being lifted and freeing our hearts to become attached to Allah and not to our desires or other people's desires. Don't you think people are doing strange things when they are a slave to their desires? So when you become a slave to Allah, Allah will honor you and protect you.
2. Sincere (الْمُخْلَصِينَ): They are sincerely, exclusively slaves to Allah. No slave to another person, to their desires, etc. So when you put these two characteristics together this equals

(لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ). Being a slave of Allah is not enough, you must be sincere and exclusive to Allah only.

- So if you want your children to be protected, you can give them advice not to go there, or do this etc but the most important thing is to be obedient to Allah. You don't know if they will listen to you. Don't make them your servants, make them an obedient, sincere, slave of Allah. How will do you this? Ask Allah for help, let them see you acting properly, set an example for them. You might think how could this child be like me, but they are all like you, they pick up on your habits.

Surat Yusuf: 25

وَأَسْتَبَقَا الْبَابَ وَقَدَّتْ قَمِيصَهُ مِنْ دُبُرٍ وَأَلْفَيَا سَيِّدَهَا لَدَا الْبَابِ قَالَتْ مَا جَزَاءُ مَنْ أَرَادَ بِأَهْلِكَ
(سُوءًا إِلَّا أَنْ يُسْجَنَ أَوْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ ٢٥)

And they raced with one another to the door, and she tore his shirt from behind, and they met her lord and master at the door. She said: What shall be his reward, who wisheth evil to thy folk, save prison or a painful doom? (25)

- Do not say "Qadr Allah, now I have to stay" if you are in a trial. Now you must flee from such a situation. So he ran away, and she started to follow him, and he had to go through so many doors, and she still ran after him and tore his shirt from the back. So look when someone has no guidance, no faith, a person will really be like an animal and

lose control. There were no etiquettes or protocols, considering she was the wife of Aziz.

- If you are in a fitnah, you need to run away from it, escape, don't engage in it.
- (وَقَدَّتْ) means to get hold of something by force, she tore it by force.

(دُبِرَ) is from the back. And look at Qadr Allah, Allah is protecting Yusuf by making sure the husband enters at that very moment. (وَالْفَيَّا) means they both saw him. (سَيِّدَهَا): this is her master, Allah specifically mentioned this instead of husband, to show that she should feel guilty for what she has done.

- Look at how it is when someone is following the footsteps of the devil, she immediately wanted to defend herself and accuse him. She's a liar. (مَا جَزَاءُ مَنْ أَرَادَ بِأَهْلِكَ سُوءًا) What is the recompense for someone who wants to do bad to your household? She is trying to make her husband jealous, because a man is very possessive about his household. She went so far to even suggest what should be done to Yusuf, (إِلَّا أَنْ يُسَجَّنَ) either to be placed in prison or a painful torment.
- What happened to the women who was crazy, running after Yusuf? Look at the difference between pure love and desire. Pure love you would sacrifice, and she would have said it was me, but she accused him, so you can see the evil in her desire.
- Whoever is a sincere slave of Allah, Allah will protect him, and Allah is the best of the Protectors.

Surat Yusuf: 26

قَالَ هِيَ رَأَوْدَتْنِي عَنْ نَفْسِي وَشَهِدَ شَاهِدٌ مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا إِن كَانَ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ قُبُلٍ فَصَدَقَتْ وَهُوَ
(مِنَ الْكَذِبِينَ ٢٦)

He [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "It was she that sought to seduce me," - and a witness of her household bore witness (saying): "If it be that his shirt is torn from the front, then her tale is true and he is a liar! (26)

- At this point Yusuf spoke to defend himself, even though he is innocent. So this is a lesson for us that when we are accused (and we are innocent) we should speak and defend ourselves.
- (قَالَ هِيَ رَأَوْدَتْنِي عَنْ نَفْسِي): "It was she that sought to seduce me." Look at how short his defense was (so it was not exaggerated) and it was said with manners. How do we know this? By the mentioning of (هِيَ) "she" instead of saying "you" or (أَنْتِ). Considering this is an accusation about someone's chastity. So you should defend yourself, but you should control your anger, and just mention the incident as it is and be to the point. Don't add lies. So defend yourself, but don't accuse.
- (رَأَوْدَتْنِي): to seduce me, the wife went through three stages of seduction (from outside, then calling him, then chasing him), So look at the respect that Yusuf has, that he did not mention the details, it is embarrassing, and it shows haya. It is not necessary to announce it, if you must give details, give it to the person who has the authority.

- If Allah wants to defend someone and this person is attached to Allah, then Allah will bring the means. In this case, a witness came from her household (وَشَهِدَ شَاهِدٌ مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا). No one planned to have a witness, this is truly how Allah can bring the means in a way you can't imagine. This witness, despite coming from the side of the wife, was inspired to make a rule based on the shirt. (In the story of Yusuf, the shirt is important, first in the plot with the brothers and now here)
- (وَإِنْ كَانَ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ قُبُلٍ): if the shirt is torn from the front. In Arabic, you would normally use the word (شَقَّ) which means to tear, but (قُدَّ) means torn vertically. So in general, you would need to have a rule before the evidence, and not the other way around.
- (فَصَدَقَتْ وَهُوَ مِنَ الْكَذِبِينَ): so if it is torn from the front, then she told the truth, and he is a liar.

Surat Yusuf: 27

(وَإِنْ كَانَ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ دُبُرٍ فَكَذَبَتْ وَهُوَ مِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ ٢٧)

"But if it be that his shirt is torn from the back, then she has told a lie and he is speaking the truth!"

- ((وَإِنْ كَانَ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ دُبُرٍ فَكَذَّبَتْ وَهُوَ مِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ)) and if it is torn from the back, then he has told the truth, and she is a liar. So there is never a perfect crime, there will always be some traces left behind.

Surat Yusuf: 28

(فَلَمَّا رَأَى قَمِيصَهُ قُدَّ مِنْ دُبُرٍ قَالَ إِنَّهُ مِنْ كَيْدِكُنَّ إِنَّ كَيْدَكُنَّ عَظِيمٌ ۚ ۲۸)

So when he (her husband) saw his [(Yûsuf's (Joseph))] shirt torn at the back; (her husband) said: "Surely, it is a plot of you women! Certainly mighty is your plot!

- ((فَلَمَّا رَأَى قَمِيصَهُ قُدَّ مِنْ دُبُرٍ)) so now the husband found that the shirt was torn from the **back**, and that his wife lied. It was said that the husband's reaction was not very strong, it was very average (he does not have jealousy) (غيرة). For example, a husband should not introduce his wife to other men and tell them to sit down with her, etc.
- (قَالَ إِنَّهُ مِنْ كَيْدِكُنَّ إِنَّ كَيْدَكُنَّ عَظِيمٌ): the husband did not accuse his wife, he just said that women are like this, they plot, and their plot is great. He just thought that I must have one of these women as a wife.
- On a side note, look at the divine laws of Allah which are there to protect us. Those who have illegal relationships before marriage say it's better to enjoy, because during marriage there will be no fun. This is how the shaitan beautifies the sin. But then imagine the few moments of desire, lead to a periods of guilt far greater than those moments of desire, so Allah brought down the divine laws to protect

us, because He created us and knows us best and what is best for us. For example, Allah commanded us to lower the gaze. We have to lower the gaze, for example: adultery begins with the eyes. Also when women are talking, don't talk softly to men, talk softly to your children or husband. The women's voice can be attractive, do you see women leading a congregation prayer? Then no one would concentrate.

- A woman has been honored by Allah, so we should not fall into the trap of the shaitan of being objectified.

- (قَالَ إِنَّهُ مِنْ كَيْدِكُنَّ إِنَّ كَيْدَكُنَّ عَظِيمٌ): the husband did not accuse his wife, he just said that women are like this, they plot, and their plot is great. He just thought that I must have one of these women as a wife.
- When a lady plots, it is different from when a man plots. The brothers planned their plot. The wife plotted because in general she is a strong person, but her temptation was her weakness. For that reason, the husband did not even accuse his wife directly because he knows she is a strong woman. So instead, he accused that women are like this in general, and this is wrong. You cannot assume that if one type (family, nationality) commits a sin, then all are the same.

Surat Yusuf: 29

(يُوسُفُ أَعْرِضْ عَنْ هَذَا وَاسْتَغْفِرِي لِذَنْبِكِ إِنَّكِ كُنْتِ مِنَ الْخَاطِئِينَ ٢٩)

Yusuf! turn away therefrom; and, thou woman! ask forgiveness for thy sin; verily thou hast been of the guilty.

- Aziz called Yusuf directly by his name, he did not even say (يَا). Because when you say (يَا), it is like an announcement, but the scholars say Aziz did not say 'Oh Yusuf' because he wanted to conceal what just happened in his house. Also, he mentioned his name Yusuf (and not boy) because he really loves Yusuf and knows that he is innocent.
- Aziz doesn't want this matter to go outside the house, so he tells Yusuf to just ignore it, reject it (أَعْرِضْ). It is more than just saying 'don't say anything'. Why? Aziz only wants this matter to be ignored because he is worried about his position. He did not even send Yusuf away in order not to make any questions arise – in order to pretend as if nothing happened.
- Then he speaks to his wife directly in command form. He did not even mention her name or say 'oh woman'. He told her (وَأَسْتَغْفِرِي لِدُنْكَ) , 'ask for forgiveness' but it doesn't say to whom. Some scholars said it could be asking forgiveness from him, or their idols. So in general, regardless of religion, people ask for forgiveness because they do have a sense of when a wrong is committed.
- He said (وَأَسْتَغْفِرِي), ask for forgiveness, he did not say to to repent. Because repenting means you have to change yourself, and this would be noticed by others. So he just wants her to cover her sins and not talk about it to others or friends.
- (ذَنْب) means sins and comes from the word tail. So when you sin, this tail is like something attached to you. Since she committed a major sin,

it is like it will always be attached to her. The “lam” in (لِذَنْبِكَ) is called the ‘attached lam’ so this emphasizes the sin being attached to her.

- (إِنَّكَ كُنْتَ مِنَ الْخَاطِئِينَ) : Verily you are of the ones who have made an intentional sin. (خَاطِئٌ) means intentional mistake. So she intentionally made that sin because you have to do a lot to seduce, to chase after, etc . It all begins with the eyes, then talking, then it goes further. She had a period to stop herself, it was not something sudden. When a mistake is done intentionally it is hard to conceal it, it will be exposed somehow. News about her, somehow, spread to ladies in the city who are in competition with her.

Surat Yusuf: 30

وَقَالَ نِسْوَةٌ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ امْرَأَتُ الْعَزِيزِ تُرَاوِدُ فَتْلَهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ طَغَتْ شَغَفَهَا حُبًّا إِنَّا لَنَرَاهَا فِي ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ (٣٠)

And women in the city said; the wife of the Aziz hath solicited her page against himself; he hath inflamed her with love; verily we behold her in error manifest.

- (وَقَالَ نِسْوَةٌ): some women said. The singular of (نِسْوَةٌ) is (إِمْرَأَةٌ) and it can have another plural, which is (نِسَاءٌ). So has an irregular plural, it is not imraat. So you can say (نِسَاءٌ) or (نِسْوَةٌ) for ladies. When you use (نِسَاءٌ) that means a large group of ladies like 30 or 40. (نِسْوَةٌ) is a smaller amount, like 10 or 8. So in this case there were fewer ladies.

- And it says (وَقَالَ) which is masculine and not (قَالَتْ) which is feminine, because when you have an irregular plural noun, you can use the masculine or feminine verb.
- Also, they were in (الْمَدِينَةِ) city, they are not from a village. So these ladies are like 'city ladies' they are of a higher position, and all of their husbands have high ranks.
- They said: (أَمْرَأْتُ الْعَزِيزِ تُرَاوِدُ فَتْلَهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ) They called her (أَمْرَأْتُ الْعَزِيزِ), the lady of Aziz, they did not say her name. This is to show their feelings because the words being used are (كَلَامُ اللَّهِ), words of Allah. Because they do not mention her name, it shows that they don't care about her, they care more that she is the wife of Aziz. So Aziz is in a high position. Also, they did not mention (زَوْجَةً), which is more like partner, they mentioned (إِمْرَأَةً) which means there is something incomplete, whether its lack of kids or her lack of character for having committed the intentional sin.
- So the ladies begin to say amongst each other, not in the presence of the wife of Aziz: (تُرَاوِدُ فَتْلَهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ): (تُرَاوِدُ) is to seduce, (فَتْلَهَا) a young boy who is her servant, and (عَنْ نَفْسِهِ) he did not want her on top of that; against himself.
- So they said she must have tried to seduce the boy because of (قَدْ) (شَغَفَهَا حُبًّا). It means that 'indeed' (شَغَفَهَا) means it is the last stage before love, it means that the love is so ingrained that it is even skin deep. Ibn Qayyim said there are 60 stages of love, and (شَغَفَ) is before the last, so #59. The final stage is worship.

- **Stages of Love (منازل الحب):** not all will be mentioned. So you must lower your gaze and protect yourself, if this doesn't happen, then we enter the first stage. So you can see these are the stages when the love is wrong (the shaitan leads in this manner):
 1. Desire (الهوى)
 2. Attachment (العلاقة)
 3. Love has occupied the heart (الكلف): thinking all the time
 4. Extreme love (العشق): can't sleep or eat
 5. Mind is lost (التدلية)
 6. Totally lost – no focus (هيام)
 7. Ingrained in heart (شغف): that's why you can see from her actions that she didn't what she was doing anymore
- She never loved Yusuf, she just had a desire. But the love of Allah is without conditions, a person can sacrifice himself for the love of Allah.
- If you love, you will do. That's why in order to worship, you must love Allah. Allah did not create your heart for the stages above, He created your heart to fill it with the love of Allah. It cannot be to have the love of Allah and someone else in the same heart.
- She put the wrong love in her heart and the result was that she lost herself. Praised love is to love Allah, love what Allah loves, and love people for the sake of Allah. Nobody deserves to be loved for his sake.

If you love a person because of their qualities, their qualities came from Allah in the first place. So love the Creator.

- To have this true love of Allah, it will give you a high position.
- (إِنَّا نَنزِلُهَا فِي ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ): “We see her in clear misguidance”, so even the ladies understood that what she did was wrong and it was not pure love. She is drowning in clear, plain misguidance. She really went astray. But they were not saying this for the sake of being truthful, they were saying it to make her feel bad. For example, if your husband is inviting guests all the time, then you might say (ان الله لا يحب المرففين) , ‘verily Allah does not love those who spend excessively.” So you are using a Qur’anic verse for your own benefit, not to be truthful.
- The ladies were saying this because they want to put her down and because they are jealous of her and they want to ruin her reputation. They are from the city, and rank and position is very important for them. And indirectly, they want to see Yusuf. Who is that made the Aziz’s wife want to seduce her servant? They were plotting for their own benefit. So they were saying the truth, but their intention was wrong, and Allah knows what’s in the hearts.

Surat Yusuf: 31

فَلَمَّا سَمِعَتْ بِمَكْرِهِنَّ أَرْسَلَتْ إِلَيْهِنَّ وَأَعْتَدَتْ لَهُنَّ مُتَّكًا وَءَاتَتْ كُلَّ وَاحِدَةٍ مِّنْهُنَّ سِكِّينًا وَقَالَتِ
 أَخْرِجْ عَلَيْنَ فَلَمَّا رَأَيْنَهُ أَكْبَرْنَهُ وَقَطَّعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ وَقُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا مَلَكٌ
 كَرِيمٌ (٣١)

And when she heard of their sly talk, she sent to them and prepared for them a cushioned couch (to lie on at the feast) and gave to every one of them a knife and said (to Joseph): Come out unto them! And when they saw him they exalted him and cut their hands, exclaiming: Allah Blameless! This is no human being. This is not other than some gracious angel.

- (فَلَمَّا سَمِعَتْ بِمَكْرِهِنَّ): so Aziz's wife heard about their (مكر), their plot, and since there is a (ب) before it, then it is attached to them. Plotting is always to bring someone down, similar to that of the brothers. No one likes anyone to talk against them, and as soon as the wife heard this, without any thinking, (أَرْسَلَتْ إِلَيْهِنَّ) she sent for them (she sent an invitation to the ladies). In the verse, you can see there are no connectors like 'and' or 'then', so it was an immediate reaction. So you can see she didn't decide to talk to them, instead she wanted to make it seem casual and invite them to her house.
- (وَأَعْتَدَتْ لَهُنَّ مُتَّكًا): She prepared for them (وَأَعْتَدَتْ) and it was exclusive (لَهُنَّ), just for them. So it was a personal invitation. And she prepared (مُتَّكًا), a very refined setting, so seats, banquet, food, everything was prepared exclusively for them. Why did she want to make it so comfortable? It was another plot so that they would be relaxed enough so that they would talk without restraint, to disclose what's in

them. Also, she made it so comfortable so that they would stay for a long time.

- She placed fruits on the table that need cutting, ie: apples, orange. (وَأَتَتْ كُلَّ وَاحِدَةٍ مِّنْهُنَّ سِكِّينًا) So she gave each one of them a knife (what an advanced plot!). Difference between (أتى) and (أعطى) is 'ata' is to give something and have it returned. 'a'ata' is to give something (like a gift) and it's not returned.
- So the moment the ladies were busy cutting the fruits, Yusuf was still in the house.
- (وَقَالَتْ أَخْرِجْ عَلَيْنَ): She told Yusuf (أَخْرِجْ), which is 'come out', unlike 'come in'. We usually say 'come in' and it is said (عَلَيْنَ) and not (الِيهِنَّ), so it shows that he doesn't want to see even more ladies, so it was by force to come out, it was an order from her. (Side note: they say Yusuf was so beautiful that he used to cover his face so that there is no fitna with other ladies, subhan Allah) She wanted to prove to them that this is how beautiful Yusuf is, so don't blame me.
- So everyone has an idea in their mind, but what they saw was beyond their imagination, and when Yusuf (half of the worldly beauty including humans, nature, etc is in Yusuf) came out, they (أَكْبَرْنَهُ), they exalted him, stunned. And when a person reaches this level, then it is as if the person is numb, and scientists say this reaction is a 'natural anesthesia'. For that reason (وَقَطَّعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ), they cut their hands. Since they were in that numb state, they did not feel that they were cutting their hands.

(أَيْدِيَهُنَّ) is not just fingers, it was the hand, and since there is a shedha on (وَقَطَّعْنَ), to cut, it was continuous, so they went back and forth with the knife. They did not feel the pain at all.

- Desire is something natural in a human, you cannot remove it, but you can control it with the help of Allah. That is why there is halal and haram in Islam, to make sure the person doesn't go in the wrong direction, that is why 'lowering the gaze' can lead to greater trials, and can lead to more desire. And now it's not just about not looking at a person, it is so rampant now in books, magazines, music. Even reading things that are so explicit, there is no modesty. Before people used to do these things but discreetly, now it is so open. Also, the bad companions can lead to these desires, so it is best to fill your time doing good, things that make Allah happy. We ask that Allah protects our children, family, societies, and Ummah. Ameen.
- (وَقُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ): it is like saying 'Subhan Allah', it is unimaginable how a man can look like this.
- (مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا مَلَكٌ كَرِيمٌ): He is not a human is what they said. His beauty made them like this, but imagine seeing Allah (His beauty is nothing compared to worldly beauty). That is why the greatest delight is to see Allah. The ladies said that he must be a noble angel. They have not seen angels, but people naturally allude to angels as being light, pure, beautiful, a different creation.

Surat Yusuf: 32

قَالَتْ فَذَايَكُنَّ الَّذِي لُمْتُنْنِي فِيهِ وَلَقَدْ رَاودْتُهُ ۖ عَنْ نَفْسِهِ ۖ فَاسْتَعْصَمَ وَلَئِن لَّمْ يَفْعَلْ مَا ءَامَرُهُ ۖ لَيُجَنَّبَنَّ وَيَكُونَا
(مِّنَ الصَّاغِرِينَ ٣٢)

She said: This is he on whose account ye blamed me. I asked of him an evil act, but he proved continent, but if he do not my behest he verily shall be imprisoned, and verily shall be of those brought low.

- This verse is now talking about the inner beauty of Yusuf, it is not just outer beauty. And inner beauty is better than outer beauty. If the inner beauty is bad, it will reflect in the outside as well. So this made the ladies desire him even more. The wife really wants to show them that their desire is so great, but they can't do anything about it. She is tempting them.
- Before she didn't want others to know what happened, that she chased after Yusuf. But now, since all the ladies saw him, she doesn't mind talking about it – they are all in the same boat now.
- (قَالَتْ فَذَايَكُنَّ الَّذِي لُمْتُنْنِي فِيهِ): She is saying don't blame me, you who cut your hands. Don't blame me, I have to see him day and night. So she is giving an excuse.
- (وَلَقَدْ رَاودْتُهُ ۖ عَنْ نَفْسِهِ): there affirmations, the wow, lam, and qad. She has now confessed, it's in the open, that she wanted to seduce him and he didn't have the desire. When you think about why she would want to say this? It is just her ego.
- Before she didn't want others to know what happened, that she chased after Yusuf. But now, since all the ladies saw him, she doesn't mind talking about it. It shows that she has no modesty, or faith, because someone who is shy about something, will remain shy about it, but not in her case – she exposed herself.

- (أَسْتِ): the fa'a shows that it was a quick response from Yusuf. (فَأَسْتَعِصِمَ) is to seek (عِصْمَ) is refuge/protection, so Yusuf is seeking refuge with Allah. This doesn't mean that Yusuf has a sickness or no desire, the usage of the word shows that he is seeking protection to not fall into sin. We are in a journey and as we progress, our heart needs to get closer to Allah, and we need not just istiqama to remain upright, we also need l'itisam, we need Allah to protect us from the sins. This negates self-confidence, don't think you won't fall into sin, you need to seek refuge from Allah all the time. So never think, oh my children would not fall into this, etc.
- So l'itisam is part of belief. Sometimes people get offended if you say something, and they say I'm married, no need to tell me this. But the shaitan does not care if married or not, young or old, nationality, rank, etc, he knows that humans have desires, point. So we need to seek protection from Allah, whether married or not, young or old, etc.
- (وَلَيْنَ لَّمْ يَفْعَلْ مَا ءَامُرُهُ): Now she wants to command him, so she went from tempting to now commanding him, since he is a servant in her house. She is commanding him to sin.
- (لَيَسْجَنَنَّ): she will imprison him, since he did not obey her. The first and last letters, lam and noon, are letters of affirmation, that surely he will be imprisoned. So now, you can see that already plotting is taking place to imprison Yusuf. It is not mentioned how, but we know that plotting is taking place.
- (وَلَيَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الصَّغِيرِينَ): he will be among those who will be belittled, disgraced. So at the house of Aziz he was honored, and now she wants to debase him. Yusuf did not say anything the whole time. The wife

never mentioned to kill him (he's too nice to be killed), to jail him instead, so that he is still preserved. And as a result, he can become disgraced. She is still trying to play with his feelings. Yusuf can still hear what she is saying.

Surat Yusuf: 33

قَالَ رَبِّ آلَسِجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ وَإِلَّا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ وَأَكُن مِّنَ
(الْجَاهِلِينَ ٣٣)

He said:"O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one (of those who commit sin and deserve blame or those who do deeds) of the ignorant."

- He did not complain or go and talk to her. Yusuf doesn't have any father or mother to talk to, look at the patience he has. Instead Yusuf complained and prayed to Allah. We can learn so much from this manner of handling such a situation.
- Let's shift the attention to the ladies that are sitting and listening to all of this. They are not thinking about anyone but themselves, thinking how they can seduce Yusuf. Each one tries to plot, whether through smell, body language (flipping hair), soft voice, some with walk, and some with eyes (worst is eyes, because eyes can speak). Hijab is prescribed on women because of the greater temptations that emerge from women. Even when the woman leaves the house, the shaitan will beautify her in the eyes of the men outside (this is a hadith).

We ask Allah to protect us. Ameen. The worse fitna (trial) for men is ladies, because they can take control of his mind. Women are the base of society because if a woman is righteous she can reform a society through the upbringing of children.

- In this situation, it becomes even more difficult for Yusuf because more women are involved. So Yusuf sought protection from Allah (اعتصام: دعاء عقيدة، عمل، prayer). (l'itisam: belief, action, prayer).
- Yusuf preferred to seek prison instead of being amongst the ladies and commit sin.
- Here is his prayer (قَالَ رَبِّ السِّجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ): He said, "Rabb" (he used Rabb, which means My Reformer, My Nurturer). It is as if invoking Allah through all of His actions. So he is invoking Allah through His Lordship. (السِّجْنُ) the prison, he said this immediately. It's as if he is going from 'prison' to 'prison' (well, house of Aziz, now actual prison). Subhan Allah, these difficulties are all ways of elevation. If Allah wants a position for you, you will be inflicted with difficulties so that Allah may elevate you.
- (أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ) more beloved, so the prison is more beloved to Yusuf than to be around those ladies. (مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ): what they are inviting me to do. So we know here that all women were involved, and not just the wife. They were inviting him to sin, indecency, adultery. He prefers the obedience to Allah than committing a sin of temporary pleasure followed by permanent torture. People think it's just a short period, and

then they can correct themselves, but you never know if you die in sin. Story of a lady who was asked to wash the dead and she was shaken when she found out the lady she had to wash actually died while committing adultery. We ask Allah to protect us. Ameen. Sometimes people come up to an imam and ask him make du'a for me so that I quit this sin. The imam tells them you can't just jump to du'a. You need (اعتصام: عقيدة، عمل، دعاء), you need to strengthen your belief, then act and change for the better, then pray. You need to strengthen your belief, to love Allah, fear Allah, hope from Allah so that you are convinced to change your misdeeds to good deeds.

- With this du'a we see that Yusuf is in need of Allah, so when you make a du'a, don't make it as if you are self-sufficient. One of the conditions for making du'a is that you are needy, you are weak, broken and need Allah to help you. Look this is a Messenger, son of a Messenger, he wasn't proud or thinking he will be ok, he was in need of Allah. When you see people committing a sin, never think 'I would never do such a thing', this is arrogance, don't look down on people thinking you would never do such a thing. This shows as if you are self-sufficient and do not need Allah, and you will find that you will fall into that situation. Some people know all of the forbidden acts, and still fall into it. Some people don't know all of the sins, but they are being protected because they are seeking Allah to protect them.
- (يَا أَيُّهَا الْمَلَأُ الْأَعْيُنَ وَالْأَلْأَلُ لَا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ): Yusuf's dua reaches its peak, if (Allah) you do not avert their plot, then I will fall into it. You see how needy he is.

- Another story: there is a town in Sham called 'Miski' (musk). It was a story about a man who was being seduced by a woman and she trapped him inside her house. He didn't know what to do, so he told her I need to use the toilet first. So back then the bathrooms were not like now, so he took whatever 'dirt, stool' was there and put it on his body. When he came out, the woman told him to get out. And subhan Allah after that, Allah made his body to smell of musk until he died, Subhan Allah.

Surat Yusuf: 33

قَالَ رَبِّ آلَسْجَنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ وَإِلَّا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ وَأَكُن مِّنَ
(الْجَاهِلِينَ ٣٣)

He said:"O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one (of those who commit sin and deserve blame or those who do deeds) of the ignorant."

- (يَا أَيُّهَا اللَّهُ): Yusuf's dua'a reaches its peak, if (Allah) you do not avert their plot, then I will fall into it. You see how needy he is. (تَصْرِفُ) is to avert, (عَنِّي) is called (عن المجاوزة), (المجاوزة) means to jump over an obstacle. So Yusuf is asking that the plots of the women jump over him and pass him with as little damage. He could have screamed at them, but Yusuf trusted Allah to take care of them in a way that would create the least amount of harm. Yusuf knew that physically he

would not commit the sin, but he was scared for his heart. He did not want his heart to be attached to something besides Allah.

- (أَصْبُ إِلَهَيْنَ): comes from the root word (صبا), which means youth, and someone inclined to entertainment without thinking of the consequence, and it means longing for something, and it means to pour. So Yusuf is showing his neediness to Allah, that he will not be able to control his feelings, as if it's pouring out, maybe he will be inclined to them. He doesn't want his heart to be attached other than Allah, then his heart would be occupied with thinking about this, in his prayers, etc.
- (وَأَكُنَّ مِنَ الْجَاهِلِينَ): it takes a long time to change our outer, but the heart can quickly change. (الْجَاهِلِينَ) is ignorance and not realizing the consequence of something. People think that if they don't know, then it's better. But we have to learn, and trust Allah to keep us firm on the Straight Path. The more you learn, the more you will be able to see things clearly. When you know more about Allah, you will deal with Allah in a real way, not abstract. (الْجَاهِلِينَ) without realizing the consequence, for example, someone just pours out their anger, or pours out their love without thinking. Allah gave us intellect and heart to be used, but you need divine laws in order to control both of these two things.

Surat Yusuf: 34

(فَاسْتَجَابَ لَهُ رَبُّهُ، فَصَرَفَ عَنْهُ كَيْدَهُنَّ إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ (٣٤))

So his Lord answered his invocation and turned away from him their plot. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.

- **(فَاسْتَجَابَ لَهُ رَبُّهُ)**: as long as you remember Allah, Allah will remember you. The start has to begin from you, and Allah will complete it. But you have to make the first move. Do you want to know how much Allah remembers you, you have to think how much do you remember Allah? And of course Allah's remembrance is better than yours. You have to think where is your standing with Allah. Allah put you in prayer, in acquiring knowledge, you have to thank Allah. Don't just make a dua'a when in need, remember Allah all the time. Sometimes Allah will put you in a situation just because Allah wants you to invoke Him. Subhan Allah. **(فَاسْتَجَابَ)**: Allah responded to Yusuf's dua'a. To abstain from sins and to do good deeds, you need Allah's help. You need dua'a. **(رَبُّهُ)**: His Reformer, you noticed that **(رَبُّ)** is mentioned many times throughout Surah Yusuf.
- People's hearts and actions are all in Allah's hands, so if a person is sincere about his dua'a, Allah will respond. **(فَصَرَفَ عَنْهُ كَيْدَهُنَّ)** so Allah averted their plot.
- **(إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ)**: **(السَّمِيعُ)** All-Hearing, Allah hears everything, but because it is occurring with a dua'a preceding it, it is a special kind of hearing, which means that Allah responds to the supplication. Which is why when we pray, while rising from ruku, we say 'sam'a Allah liman hamida', it does not mean Allah hears, it means that Allah responds

to the supplication. When people make dua'a they make their concern how Allah will respond to them. The concern should be to focus on the supplication because anyways the response comes with it. Responds means that Allah will accept the supplication from you, it doesn't mean you get it straight away, you get it when it is best for you. But what's more important is to have an accepted supplication. (الْعَلِيمُ) All-Knowing, Allah responds according to what you want in your heart. Some people might pray something, but don't really want it in their heart. Like a guy might say what are all of these girls coming after me, but inside he might like it.

Surat Yusuf: 35

(ثُمَّ بَدَا لَهُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا رَأَوْا الْآيَاتِ لَيْسَ جُنُنَهُ حَتَّىٰ حِينَ ۝٣٥)

Then it occurred to them, after they had seen the proofs (of his innocence) to imprison him for a time

- The incident of the women cutting their hands spread to others, it reached to their husbands and to Aziz as well. That is why when a sin is not stopped from the beginning, it starts to spread. Ex: when a person says its ok if my son studies with another girl at home, alone. And each parent says they trust their child, you have to say you cannot trust the shaitan and don't allow it to happen. Point.
- (ثُمَّ بَدَا لَهُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا رَأَوْا الْآيَاتِ): (بدا) means apparent. It became very clear that all the evidence points to Yusuf being innocent. (لهم) this is

inclusive of not just the women, but their husbands, and others are involved now.

- (رَأَوْا): they saw (الآيَات): clear evidence, proof, that Yusuf is innocent and the women were plotting. For Aziz, it became very clear to him that the one behind everything was his wife, and that she was insisting on the sin. She was shameless and was not embarrassed about exposing herself. When a person commits a sin, at first there is shyness, fear. This is an ingredient for repentance. But when a person continues committing the sin, and there is no shame or fear, then they don't care if others know about it. And this leads to committing even more sin and different types of sin.
- There were three proofs: the shirt, the witness, and the cutting of the hands. You would think that this would be a happy ending now, but they cannot put the wife in jail. The men in the city were flustered as to what to do. They can't kill Yusuf because he is innocent. So they decided to put Yusuf in jail for a period of time. He didn't do anything, but it caused a lot of commotion in the society, so they decided to just put Yusuf away in jail. But subhan Allah, there is wisdom behind it, because Yusuf wanted this for himself. Allah inspired Yusuf to make that previous supplication. Subhan Allah. Also the men did not trust the ladies, so putting Yusuf in prison was also a means of protecting him from the ladies. Aziz actually cared for Yusuf and he wanted him to be safe, and ironically enough, the prison became the 'safe house' for Yusuf. Putting Yusuf in the prison was also a means for the society to forget about the incident.

- (لَيَسْجُنَنَّهٗ حَتَّىٰ حِينٍ): in verse 32 (لَيُسْجَنَنَّ) it is in the passive form, but here, it is with certainty that he will be placed in jail in order to protect society from what happened. (سَجَنَ) is to be in prison. They placed him in prison because of their desires. But subhan Allah, there were benefits for Yusuf being in prison.

Surat Yusuf: 36

وَدَخَلَ مَعَهُ السَّجْنَ فَتَيَانٍ قَالَ أَحَدُهُمَا إِنِّي أَرِنِي أَخَصِرُ خَمْرًا وَقَالَ الْآخَرُ إِنِّي أَرِنِي أَحْمِلُ فَوْقَ رَأْسِي خُبْرًا تَأْكُلُ الطَّيْرُ مِنْهُ نَبِّئْنَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ إِنَّا نَرَاكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ (٣٦)

And there entered with him two young men in the prison. One of them said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) pressing wine." The other said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) carrying bread on my head and birds were eating thereof." (They said): "Inform us of the interpretation of this. Verily, we think you are one of the Muhsinûn (doers of good)."

- (وَدَخَلَ مَعَهُ السَّجْنَ فَتَيَانٍ): (وَدَخَلَ) is enter and (مَعَهُ) is with, which comes from (مَعِيهِ) meaning companion. (السَّجْنَ) is prison (فَتَيَانٍ) is two young males. There is even a reason why Allah decreed that these two people had to be in the jail with Yusuf. It is said that they are servants of the king, one who serves drinks to the king and the other is a baker for the king. Subhan Allah, you can see that they both have connections to the king, this is the decree of Allah. Allah gave knowledge of the interpretation of dreams to Jacob, Yusuf and Mohammed (peace upon them all). Interpretation of dreams is not

something that can be learned, it is an inspiration from Allah. Why are dreams being mentioned in the jail? Because in jail you are secluded and alone, so a dream is a window to freedom, and the dream is an indication of the future. Subhan Allah. The two young boys were talking to Yusuf and he told them that that he knows how to interpret dreams.

- (قَالَ أَحَدُهُمَا إِنِّي أَرَيْتُ أُعْصِرُ خَمْرًا): This is dream #1, one of them (إِنِّي), verily me, (أَرَيْتُ), saw myself. There are different types of dreams, a vision, one that is so clear and cannot be forgotten. There are dreams that are just about what you have encountered during day or been thinking about. And another type of dream is the one from the shaitan, in order to scare you. So true visions are not limited to certain people, it can be anyone, Muslim or not, to have true visions. (أُعْصِرُ) means to squeeze, which is even why salat al asr as if it is squeezed before the maghrib. So he was squeezing the fermented grapes.
- A true vision should not just be mentioned to anyone because if someone who does not know how to interpret dreams and they interpret it, then it will happen. You must trust the person and be sure they know how to interpret dreams. A vision can be a warning or glad tidings. Also, you should not add to the dream, because if someone lies about a dream, on the Day of Judgement, they will be commanded to tie two barley seeds into a knot, which is difficult. The true vision is from Allah, so if you lie, you are lying against Allah.

- (وَقَالَ الْأَخْرُ إِنِّي أَرْنِي أَحْمِلُ فَوْقَ رَأْسِي خُبْرًا تَأْكُلُ الطَّيْرُ مِنْهُ): this is dream #2, the longer the dream, the more trouble. This young boy dreams that he saw himself carrying bread above his head, and the birds were eating from it.
- (نَبَأًا بَتَأْوِيلِهِ): it comes from (نَبَأًا) which is great news, so they don't want Yusuf to just tell them the interpretation because they feel this will be great information for them since it will be related to their future. (تَأْوِيل) means interpretation.
- (إِنَّا نَرَاكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ): we see you of the good-doers, so why did they decide among all the people to go and speak to Yusuf? Because they can tell from his face if he is a criminal or not. (نَرَاكَ) to see, so ihsan can be visible. They said that they felt comfortable when seeing him. Subhan Allah. When someone is good, it will show on his face, and when someone is evil, it will show on his face too. When you do good deeds sincerely for Allah, you will see a glow. And vice-versa, when someone commits sins, you will see darkness and dullness on their face.
- Prison is a place for criminals, but for those who are innocent and are good-doers, it is a means of elevation, and it gives them time to focus on devotion, to getting closer to Allah, to perform worships, to increase knowledge. You will also find that it becomes a mean of reforming, for seeking repentance, for accounting themselves, many will even end up memorizing the Qur'an.
- Goodness can be recognized by all, even criminals can recognize goodness, but maybe they don't do it for themselves. All the souls of

the humans were given (the fitra) to know what is good and what is evil. Sometimes people do bad to others, but don't recognize how bad it is until it is done to them. We don't want to learn our lessons when bad is being done to us. Before we deal with people, put yourself in that situation. If you do this, you will see that most of the problems would get solved. How do you want people to treat you? Treat people the same way – do it for the sake of Allah.

- A young man came up to the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) to ask permission to commit adultery. Subhan Allah, the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not scream at him or get angry. Imagine what your reaction would have been. So the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) told him would you like someone to commit adultery with your mom, or with your sister. He said 'no', then why with this girl. So the young man understood the lesson, so this is showing us that when we want to reform, put yourself in that situation.
- Ihsan attracted the two prisoners, so Yusuf asked them what attracted you to me, they said it's his way of treating others. So he told them he will teach them ihsan. So he wants to make these two prisoners to trust him before interpreting their dreams. For da'awa, you need to be trusted, don't just jump into it. If people don't trust you, then how will they listen to you? So they trusted him partially from his outer appearance, but now he will tell them something about him (inner), that is hidden, to trust him more.

Surat Yusuf: 37

قَالَ لَا يَأْتِيكُمَا طَعَامٌ تُرْزَقَانِهِ إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ ۚ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَأْتِيَكُمَا ذَٰلِكُمَا مِمَّا عَلَّمَنِي رَبِّي إِنِّي
(تَرَكْتُ مِلَّةَ قَوْمٍ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَهُمْ بِالْآخِرَةِ هُمْ كَافِرُونَ ٣٧)

He said: "No food will come to you (in wakefulness or in dream) as your provision, but I will inform (in wakefulness) its interpretation before it (the food) comes. This is of that which my Lord has taught me. Verily, I have abandoned the religion of a people that believe not in Allâh and are disbelievers in the Hereafter (i.e. the Kan'ânyyun of Egypt who were polytheists and used to worship sun and other false deities).

- (قَالَ لَا يَأْتِيكُمَا طَعَامٌ تُرْزَقَانِهِ إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ ۚ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَأْتِيَكُمَا): Yusuf told them before any meal will come to you, that Allah will inspire me to tell you what the meal will be. (أَرْزَقَ): provided for. Yusuf will tell them what their meal will be before it arrives. (إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ) so the wording, similar to the dream, is that he will tell them in detail. He is telling them this to gain their trust and comfort. Because if he gains their trust, then they will listen to him. He is telling them about the unseen (like the meal), and when the meal comes and it matches his words, then they will believe him. So when he talks to them about Allah (unseen), even though Allah cannot be seen, but since they trust Yusuf now, then he can talk to them about Allah and the true path.
- (ذَٰلِكُمَا مِمَّا عَلَّمَنِي رَبِّي): all of this interpretation of the unseen is what Allah taught Yusuf, so Yusuf attributes this talent to Allah. Allah is the One who inspired me and favored me to do this. Subhan Allah. So even in

our lives, if we know how to do something, it is because Allah favored this upon us. We are created from dust and enter this world naked – without any talents. So who gave us these talents (without struggling to get it)? It is from Allah. You need to remember your origin, don't be proud and attribute your talents and favors to Allah.

- Also Yusuf told them that 'I'm not a magician or fortune-teller' in order to clarify.

Surat Yusuf: 37

قَالَ لَا يَأْتِيكُمَا طَعَامٌ تُرْزَقَانِهِ إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَأْتِيَكُمَا ذَٰلِكُمَا مِمَّا عَلَّمَنِي رَبِّي إِنِّي تَرَكْتُ مِلَّةَ قَوْمٍ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَهُمْ بِالْآخِرَةِ هُمْ كَافِرُونَ (٣٧)

He said: "No food will come to you (in wakefulness or in dream) as your provision, but I will inform (in wakefulness) its interpretation before it (the food) comes. This is of that which my Lord has taught me. Verily, I have abandoned the religion of a people that believe not in Allâh and are disbelievers in the Hereafter (i.e. the Kan'ânyyun of Egypt who were polytheists and used to worship sun and other false deities).

- (قَالَ لَا يَأْتِيكُمَا طَعَامٌ تُرْزَقَانِهِ إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَأْتِيَكُمَا): Yusuf told them before any meal will come to you, that Allah will inspire me to tell you what the meal will be. (أَرْزَقَ): provided for. Yusuf will tell them what their meal will be before it arrives. (إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ) so the wording, similar to the dream, is that he will tell them in detail. He is telling them this to gain their trust and comfort. Because if he gains their trust, then

they will listen to him. He is telling them about the unseen (like the meal), and when the meal comes and it matches his words, then they will believe him. So when he talks to them about Allah (unseen), even though Allah cannot be seen, but since they trust Yusuf now, then he can talk to them about Allah and the true path.

- **(ذَٰلِكُمَا مِمَّا عَلَّمَنِي رَبِّيَ):** all of this interpretation of the unseen is what Allah taught Yusuf, so Yusuf attributes this talent to Allah. Allah is the One who inspired me and favored me to do this. Subhan Allah. So even in our lives, if we know how to do something, it is because Allah favored this upon us. We are created from dust and enter this world naked – without any talents. So who gave us these talents (without struggling to get it)? It is from Allah. You need to remember your origin, don't be proud and attribute your talents and favors to Allah.
- Also Yusuf told them that 'I'm not a magician or fortune-teller' in order to clarify.
- Despite giving a dawah to two people, look at how many people now are reading about Yusuf's story in the Qur'an. Sometimes you might teach just one person, but you don't know how that could bring hundreds as a result of it.
- So before telling them what their meals will be, he said they must listen to what he has to say. Of course if he told them about the meals, then they will not listen to him.
- All of the messengers believe in (لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ) and this is Yusuf's dawah, and now we get to see how he presented this way of life in order to connect with his audience (even if it's just 2 people).

- Yusuf begins with 'there is no true god but'. He is telling them that he came to a land of disbelievers, but he is not a part of them. So he is trying to show them that just because the majority is doing something wrong, he is not a part of it.
- (إِنِّي تَرَكْتُ مِلَّةَ قَوْمٍ) He said that he left a group. People come together according to their beliefs, and sometimes you find support groups: like groups for divorced people, group for disabled, etc. But the bond of deen of (لا اله الا الله محمد رسول الله) is the strongest, that people love each other for the sake of Allah. Other earthly relationships would not be able to withstand, for example, if a divorcee gets married from the group, then they have left the group. The deen unites and disbelief separates.
- (مِلَّةَ قَوْمٍ): the way of a group of people. Yusuf did not specifically mention the House of Aziz. He does not want to backbite, so he kept it general, this shows his taqwa.
- (لَّا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ): they do not believe in Allah. When choosing friends, who eats in your house, choice of spouse, etc – all look at deen. Our life should be for the sake of Allah, so imagine dealing with others whose lives are not for the sake of Allah. It will not be compatible and could lead to your own destruction. There are many different types of disbelief: atheists, associating worship, worship of idols – all fall under the category of not believing in Allah (لَّا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ). (يُؤْمِنُونَ) is in the verb form, meaning believing. So their beliefs can change over time. I.e: someone could be born into something then becomes atheist.

- (وَهُمْ بِالْآخِرَةِ هُمْ كَافِرُونَ): and in this part of the verse, it is all noun. A noun is stronger in affirmation than a verb. Meaning they are in constant disbelief of the hereafter. So whatever evidence you bring to them, the disbelief of the hereafter is attached in their hearts. (كَافِرُونَ) is a noun, which is 'constant disbelievers'. To disbelief in the hereafter means they do not believe that they will be resurrected and be recompensed. Subhan Allah.

Surat Yusuf: 38

وَاتَّبَعْتُ مِلَّةَ آبَائِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْحَاقَ وَيَعْقُوبَ مَا كَانَ لَنَا أَنْ نُشْرِكَ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ فَضْلِ اللَّهِ عَلَيْنَا وَعَلَى النَّاسِ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَشْكُرُونَ (٣٨)

"And I have followed the religion of my fathers[], - Ibrahîm (Abraham), Ishâq (Isaac) and Ya'qûb (Jacob) [A.S.], and never could we attribute any partners whatsoever to Allâh. This is from the Grace of Allâh to us and to mankind, but most men thank not (i.e. they neither believe in Allâh, nor worship Him).

- (وَاتَّبَعْتُ مِلَّةَ آبَائِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْحَاقَ وَيَعْقُوبَ) (الا لله), this is the part describing 'Allah alone'. So Yusuf phrased it in a way that they can understand. So Yusuf told them that he followed the way of his forefathers. Because this is something they can associate with, since they too are following the way of their forefathers.

- So Yusuf mentions his chain (إِبْرَاهِيمَ) his great-grandfather and the father of the Prophets. (وَإِسْحَاقَ) Isaac, who is the son of Ibrahim and a messenger of Allah. (وَيَعْقُوبَ) Jacob, his father who is also a messenger of Allah. So he is showing that his forefathers were believers, righteous, and messengers of Allah. So he is emphasizing that he is following his forefathers. So what did his forefathers believe?
- (مَا كَانَ لَنَا): (مَا كَانَ لَنَا) no way can it be upon us that (أَنْ نُشْرِكَ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ) that we associating anything (whether major or minor shirk) with Allah (اللَّهِ). It specifically mentions Allah and not (رب). Major shirk is invoking someone besides Allah, or doing tawaf for other than Allah, etc – this is major shirk and spoils all the good deeds and brings eternity in hellfire. Minor shirk is wanting the praise from others for the deeds you are doing. For example, you are reciting the Qur'an, and you want someone to pass by and say something. Even if no one praises you, but since you had that desire, it spoils the good deed. We can encounter this when doing a deed, so we should reject this thought and say (اللهم إني أعوذ بك أن أشرك بك وأنا أعلم، وأستغفرك لما لا أعلم) **(O Allah! I seek refuge with You from associating any partner with you while I know, and I ask for Your Forgiveness [if I do so] for what I'm not aware of).**
- (ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ فَضْلِ اللَّهِ عَلَيْنَا): this is Allah's favor upon us. Allah chose us to be messengers, so this is a favor from Allah, because we are all humans

like the rest. So if you have guidance you must attribute it to Allah. This is a favor from Allah.

- (وَعَلَى النَّاسِ): and upon the people, so it's not just them, but others as well. So if you want favor from Allah, which is the favor of faith, of Islam, you need truthfulness. If a person wants the truth, and is truthful about going to paradise – Allah will guide them. If you see that Allah opens the gate to the straight path and the gates to doing goodness, this is a favor from Allah. By mentioning (وَعَلَى النَّاسِ), upon other people as well, is indirectly telling them that they can be a part of this too. You have to make them inclined to Islam through softening the heart. Especially people in prison, whose sin is so apparent, their heart is soft and broken, so if they are guided, they become elevated and become better than they were in the first place. This is true for anyone else. If a person commits a sin, and feels so guilty, and cries for doing it – this is the feeling of being broken, down, and humble in front of Allah. This repentance actually is a means and mercy from Allah to elevating you to becoming a better person. If a person never sins, then they would become too proud of themselves.
- (وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَشْكُرُونَ): except most people are not appreciative, not thankful. Allah knows His creation. So if you thank Allah for His favors and you appreciate that you can even say 'alhamd Allah' to Allah, Allah brings more bounty, Allah gives you more energy, and power. So what makes you lazy and lethargic? It's because of always being negative, complaining, always looking at the bad and cracks.

- The biggest favor is guidance to the faith, because this leads to paradise.
- So when giving dawah, Yusuf is telling them do you want to join me? Not come and follow me. A lot of people give dawah, like I'm the leader and you're the follower – this is wrong. You can't force the people, or dictate the people. We need to go together. Even when we enter Paradise, it is all one line that is behind the Prophet Muhammed ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) that enters together.

Surat Yusuf: 39

(يَصْحَبِي السِّجْنِ ءَارِبَابٌ مُتَفَرِّقُونَ خَيْرٌ أَمْ اللَّهُ الْوَاحِدُ الْقَهَّارُ ٣٩)

"O two companions of the prison! Are many different lords (gods) better or Allâh, the One, the Irresistible?"

- When you love the guidance and appreciate it, you want to save someone else, and you want someone else to taste the sweetness of faith. Look at the approach of Yusuf when speaking to the prisoners – they want mercy. If you thank Allah for the blessing of the guidance, Allah will give you more guidance and make you closer to Him.
- Despite Yusuf being a messenger, he addresses the prisoners in a very approachable way. He calls them (يَصْحَبِي السِّجْنِ) Oh two companions of the prison. Yusuf is softening their hearts, because if the heart is soft then the message can be reached, unlike a hard heart.
- While giving dawah, you cannot give the message straight away, you need to raise questions in the minds of the other party. What do you

think about this? If you tell them this is wrong, this is wrong, then they will not listen.

- Yusuf decided to present them with a parable (ءَأَرْبَابٌ مُتَفَرِّقُونَ خَيْرٌ أَمْ إِلَهُ) (الْوَاحِدُ الْقَهَّارُ). Since these prisoners are servants, Yusuf selected a parable about masters. So when giving dawah, select something that the other person can relate to, what you tell a child is different from a male, female, rich, poor, etc. When making dawah, don't make it sound like 'I'm right and your're wrong and force them'. This is not the way.
- (ءَأَرْبَابٌ) is plural for (رب) which is master. These servants go from master to master. (مُتَفَرِّقُونَ) from (فرق) which is to make division. So they go from one different masters to another, and each one is different, dealing with them in a different way, character, behavior, etc. And they need to adjust themselves for each master, they will not change for you.
- So is that better (خَيْرٌ أَمْ إِلَهُ الْوَاحِدُ الْقَهَّارُ) or to be a servant to just Allah, The One, The Dominant. Yusuf mentions His Lord in three names. Subhan Allah.
- Why did Yusuf choose the name 'Allah' (إِلَهُ)? It is the greatest name, and it is the summation of all attributes in this name. Also, Allah forbade the human mind from thinking of calling himself 'Allah'. Subhan Allah. You might find names like Raheem, or Qudoos, but never Allah.

- Allah is one name that if you put the heavens and earth on one side of the scale and the name of Allah – Allah will be heavier. If you use this name Allah, even for praying for something little, Allah will give you more. Allah is the One who if the creation knew about Him, they will not be able to think about anything else but Allah. Allah is the One which your heart will be drawn to. (المألوه) (المعبود) The Most Divine, The Supreme Being. May Allah increase us in knowledge of knowing about Allah and filling our hearts with Allah. Ameen.
- (اللهم) Al Wahad (The One): Allah is One, even why praying, ask (اني اسأل الواحد الاحد، الصمد، الذي لم يلد ولم يولد ولم يكن له كفن احد) Allah is One, He is Unique. One equals One, it cannot be a trinity. No one resembles Allah, Allah is Unique. Nobody is unique, when you think someone is unique, you will find that Allah will bring someone else is even more unique. We are all copy and paste of each other.
- You need the Oneness of Allah, Allah is One, and you should make Him One in your life. But many of us fail this test. When you worship Him, worship Him alone, when you love Him, love Him alone. When you attach to Him, attach to Him alone.
- With all of the problems on this earth, at work, at home, between friends, etc, the solution is tawheed. If we are dealing with Allah alone, knowing that we want to please Him and not our desires – it would be the solution to everything. Without tawheed, a person cannot be saved in the duniya and in the akhira. When you have One, you can focus.

- (الْقَهَّارُ) Al Qahar means the All-Dominant, all power and control over everything. Everybody is subjected and surrendering to Al Qahar. No one can hide away from Allah, and no one can be absent from worshipping Allah. Al Qahar has power and control over all creation. What makes a human become a slave to another human, thinking they can benefit, or fear, or they hope from them, but it is Allah who is in control of all. Even the disbeliever that does not surrender to Allah – Allah will put him in a decree that will make him taste what it means to be a slave of Allah. Allah will put them down, or give them a disease that no doctor can cure.
- Allah Al Qahar will make all taste the surrendering to Allah at the time of death. Why are people stubborn, sinner, or disbeliever? They forget their size, they really think they are something. They forget that Allah is Al Qahar. And subhan Allah, on the Day of Judgement, they will wish to become dust.
- What will the name of Al Qahar make you feel? Humiliation, submission, feeling very low in front of the Creator. And this is an honor to surrender and be a slave to Allah, and this is what will free us and this is what suits us.
- Even if a person from the time of birth until death is just serving Allah, it is still not worthy of worship to Allah, but alhamd Allah, our Lord is Al Shakir Al Shakoor, The Most Thankful, The Most Appreciative.
- So which is better, masters that can't give you life, can't give you death, don't have control over things. Look at idols that are worshipped, who gives these statues value? The people. Can they

give values to themselves, no, and they need to be cleaned, moved around etc. Allah is the Most Rich.

- Or is attaching to Allah, Al Wahad, Al Qahar better? Your life will be reformed, your heart will be reformed, your duniya will be reformed, and your akhira.
- So Yusuf did not answer them, he kept it open for them to reflect and decide.

Surat Yusuf: 40

مَا تَعْبُدُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ إِلَّا أَسْمَاءُ سَمَّيْتُمُوهَا أَنْتُمْ وَآبَاؤُكُمْ مِمَّا أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ سُلْطَانٍ إِنَّ
(الْحُكْمَ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ أَمَرَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ ذَٰلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ (٤٠))

"You do not worship besides Him but only names which you have named (forged), you and your fathers,— for which Allâh has sent down no authority. The command (or the judgement) is for none but Allâh. He has commanded that you worship none but Him (i.e. His Monotheism), that is the (true) straight religion, but most men know not.

- (مَا تَعْبُدُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ): what you worship besides (below) Allah. Now Yusuf is talking about the idols they are worshipping. So Yusuf went from masters to idols now.
- When hearing about any names of Allah, it will open the heart, do you know why? Because it goes with your fitra, it goes with your nature. Subhan Allah.

- (عباده) worship: means attachment with love and magnification and (من دونه) is below Allah.
- (إِلَّا أَسْمَاءَ سَمَّيْتُمُوهَا أَنْتُمْ وَءَابَاؤُكُمْ): these are only names that you worship, but they do not have value. They are names that you and your forefathers made up. These names are not divine, they have no perfections, they have no attributes. When the mind is so far away from Allah, a person will worship things far below, that even the mind cannot imagine – even animals as lowly as mice. Truly Islam is an honor that we should be thankful for all the time. Al hamd Allah Rabb Al Alameen.

Surat Yusuf: 40

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(الْحُكْمَ لِلَّهِ أَمْرًا لَا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ ذَلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ (٤٠))

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- When hearing about any names of Allah, it will open the heart, do you know why? Because it goes with your fitra, it goes with your nature. Subhan Allah.
- (عباده) worship: means attachment with love and magnification and (مِنْ دُونِهِ) is below Allah.
- (إِلَّا أَسْمَاءَ سَمَّيْتُمُوهَا أَنْتُمْ وَءَابَاؤُكُمْ): these are only names that you worship, but they do not have value. They are names that you and your forefathers made up. These names are not divine, they have no perfections, they have no attributes. When the mind is so far away from Allah, a person will worship things far below, that even the mind cannot imagine – even animals as lowly as mice. Truly Islam is an honor that we should be thankful for all the time. Al hamd Allah Rabb Al Alameen.
- Tawheed is one of the important things to tell the people.
- (مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ بِهِ مِنْ سُلْطَانٍ): Allah did not send any evidence about such idols. So these idols did not even name themselves, it is the people who named these idols. Allah named Himself and He has the best names, that no one can add to or take away from.
- (إِنَّ الْحُكْمَ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ): Judgement and decisions are for Allah alone. (حُكْمٌ) means to judge or to decide. Look at how Yusuf introduced them about Allah. Allah is Al Wahad Al Qahar, and now he is adding more information about Allah. So it shows you that you cannot present everything at one time, otherwise it will be overwhelming.

Allah is (الْحَاكِم) The Ruler, (الْحَكَم) The Judge, (الْحَكِيم) The All-Wise. So you see that whatever Allah judges and decides, it is not random, even when the leaves fall there is wisdom, even when you blink there is wisdom, and sleeping that extra 5 minutes there is wisdom. So with these three meanings together, you can see (إِنَّ أَلْحُكْمَ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ).

- Sometimes people want to complain, thinking it can console them, and when they do complain, you don't know what the other person is thinking when you complain. They might think, really? This is what she's complaining about?
- So complain to Allah who knows exactly how you are feeling. So just as Yusuf was sent to jail, even though he was innocent, he did not complain. He knew he was a slave of Allah, and he did not transgress his boundaries. He knew that Allah put him in that situation, and that He decreed it and that is the best what Allah wants for him. So Yusuf always thinks good about Allah.
- **Where can you find Allah's judgement?**
 1. **In His decree (الحكم القدری):** Don't you see how many places you've been to, where you came, how many homes you've moved to, how many people have you met. - everyone has different stations in their life. So you cannot say I wish I knew the Qur'an before, you cannot even say I wish I knew this one day before, this is all from Allah, and He knows when is the best time for you.

- 2. In His legislation (الحكم الشرعي):** you see that there are rules to everything, about gravity, about the sun and moon, and there is especially legislation about do's and don'ts. So if you want to live in security and peace, then do what is halal and abstain from the haram. Because if you do the haram, it will hurt you and the environment around you. So when people say why do they make it so hard? It is not the people deciding, this is Allah's legislation. And these are the best rules because Allah is the Most-Wise, and Allah knows His creation and it suits all nationalities, cultures, etc. This is even inclusive of jinn, not just humans.
- 3. In His recompense (الحكم الجزائي):** your reward or punishment according to how much you apply the rules. It is a blessing that we are created as humans, but it is a big responsibility because we have to follow the commands of Allah because there is a recompense of paradise or hell for us (also for jinn). Unlike animals who will become dust on Day of Judgement. Allah even calls the human and jinn as (ثقلان), which means there is heaviness / weight to their creation, referring to the responsibility. Also judgement should remain only to Allah. We should not judge others, thinking this one will go to paradise, or this will go to hell. Judgement is reserved only for Allah, otherwise we would have transgressed our limits.
- So Yusuf is indirectly telling them that it is not from me who is saying this, it is Allah.

- So what is the matter that Allah will judge us for, sent rules for, and will recompense for → (أَمَرَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ) **Allah commanded to worship Him alone.** Notice how Yusuf did not start with the main message, he gave an introduction, he softened their hearts, raised doubts in their religion, judgement remains only with Allah, and finally he delivered his core message.
- People want to worship something, so they look at things that have power. Worship is I am poor and need who is rich, I am weak and need who is strong, which is why you notice that cartoons try to attach the children to what is 'super'.
- The honor is when you are humble to Allah, why is why the best place in the prayer is sujood, this is to say that I am a slave of Allah, that I will lower my head only to Allah. And the lower you go, the higher Allah will take you, and the higher you think you are, the lower Allah will take you. Subhan Allah
- (ذَٰلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ): that is the straight religion, which is Islam. To submit and surrender yourself to Allah. (الدِّينُ) is religion: which means it is the way that leads you to all good. Which is why one of the questions of the grave is 'what is your religion?'. (الْقَيِّمُ): means straight and there are no inconsistencies, and there is no crookedness, and it is firm and consistent. Don't do everything at one time, like all of the voluntaries. You should feel then do and remain consistent with it.

- (وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ): but most people do not know. So what is the problem? Lack of knowledge. You as a human being, you want to reach Allah, so you need the key of knowledge - use it as way to reach Allah. Most people are ignorant, they might have other knowledge, but not the right knowledge. Shouldn't you prepare for going to paradise, similar to how people prepare themselves to enter university. Look at verse 38, it said most people are not grateful, and now, most people do not know. So we do not want to be of the majority, but of the minority.

Surah Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)): 41 – 42

يُصَوِّجِي السِّجْنَ أَمَّا أَحَدُكُمَا فَيَسْقَى رَبَّهُ خَمْرًا وَأَمَّا الْآخَرُ فَيُصَلَّبُ فَتَأْكُلُ الطَّيْرُ مِنْ رَأْسِهِ
(قُضِيَ الْأَمْرُ الَّذِي فِيهِ تَسْتَفْتِيَانِ ٤١)

"O two companions of the prison! As for one of you, he (as a servant) will pour out wine for his lord (king or master) to drink; and as for the other, he will be crucified and birds will eat from his head. Thus is the case judged concerning which you both did inquire." (41)

- When you talk about the duniya, you will not be able to satisfy everyone. But when you speak about Allah and you are convinced of it, you will see people are satisfied. So the two prisoners started liking Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) because of what he said about Allah. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not give the interpretation immediately, because one of them will be crucified, so imagine telling him this from the

beginning. So Yusuf (ﷺ) began by telling them why they are created. When you meet people for the first time, do not say something that will shock them, that's why the first impression matters.

- (يُصْحٰجِي ٱلسِّجْنِ) (ﷺ): O two companions of the prison. This shows Yusuf (ﷺ) humbleness when addressing them. We do not know if they accepted Islam, but that is not what is important, what is important is to have conveyed the message. There are Messengers of Allah who did not have any followers, but they will still get the full reward. We always want to see the results, but we are not on this earth to see the results.
- (أَمَّا أَحَدُكُمَا) (ﷺ): As for one of you. Look at the manner of Yusuf (ﷺ), at times of judging or presenting heavy news, Yusuf (ﷺ) placed a barrier in order to control the emotion. So he made it generic by saying 'one of you', rather than 'you will live and you will be crucified'.
- Their dreams are visions because they are clear and true dreams. Anyone, believer or non-believer, righteous or sinner, can have a vision. Sometimes Allah sends visions to people in order to bring them back or repent. That's why when you dream something, you should not tell it to anyone except to the ones who love you, and you should only tell it to someone who has knowledge of interpretation. A vision doesn't happen everyday, it's only once and while. And you need to take care not to change the dream, not to add or delete from the dream. Once a dream is interpreted, it happens as it is interpreted.

- (فَيَسْقِي رَبَّهُ خَمْرًا): Will pour out wine for your master. His dream was to squeeze the grapes to become wine. So Yusuf (صلى الله عليه وسلم) specifically interpreted the dream, without even mentioning that you will leave the prison.
- (وَأَمَّا الْآخَرُ): As for the other. He had dreamt that he had bread on his head and the birds were eating it. (فَيُمْلَأُ فَتَأْكُلُ الطَّيْرُ مِنْ رَأْسِهِ): will be crucified and the birds will eat from his head. So imagine he will be crucified, he will not be covered, and the birds will eat from the head (including brains). So the bread referred to the brain / head, in terms of the baker. Dream interpretation depends on the case of each person. Two people can dream the same dream, but the interpretation is different depending on the person. Once a man went to Ibn Sireen (famous dream interpreter) and told him I saw a vessel with water inside, the vessel broke but the water remained intact. The man was only making this up, but did not tell Ibn Sireen this. Ibn Sireen told him you didn't dream this. Then the man came back again and said this is what I dreamt. Then Ibn Sireen told him your wife is pregnant, he said yes, she will give birth, but she will die. The man said, "no! no! I didn't dream this", but that is what happened.
- (قُضِيَ الْأَمْرُ الَّذِي فِيهِ تَسْتَفْتِيَانِ): The matter is decreed that which you ask about. That's why we do not know matters of the unseen, because if we did, it would be too difficult to live with. As soon as he gave the dream interpretations, the two were taken out. One to the king and one to be crucified.

وَقَالَ لِلَّذِي ظَنَّ أَنَّهُ نَاجٍ مِّنْهُمَا آذْكُرْنِي عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ فَأَنَسَهُ الشَّيْطَانُ ذِكْرَ رَبِّهِ ۖ فَلَبِثَ فِي

(السِّجْنِ بِضْعَ سِنِينَ ٤٢)

And he said to the one whom he knew to be saved: "Mention me to your lord (i.e. your king, so as to get me out of the prison)." But Shaitân (Satan) made him forget to remember Allah. So [Yûsuf (Joseph)] stayed in prison a few (more) years (42)

- (وَقَالَ): Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) said, (لِلَّذِي ظَنَّ أَنَّهُ نَاجٍ مِّنْهُمَا): to the one whom he thought is going to be saved.
- (آذْكُرْنِي عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ): Mention me to your master. When you are oppressed, you can rely on people, after relying on Allah first, if you know they can actually help you. So don't just try to go to people you know can't help you. And he is telling him to mention his name while serving his master, since he would be in a different state while being served. Which is very smart of Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم))! Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) wants the prisoner to mention his name, his story, his dream interpretation. It is not showing off. Even the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) and the companions would dress in their best clothes when they had foreign delegation asking about Islam. So they would dress up to show their power and make others amazed for the sake of Allah, not for the sake of the duniya. So when seeking help from people, if you are oppressed, go directly to the one who can help you. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم))

((وسلم)) went to the prisoner who is working directly with the king. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not even go to the Aziz, despite being a minister, but he is lower than the king.

- ((فَأَنسَاهُ الشَّيْطَانُ ذِكْرَ رَبِّهِ)): But the shaitan made him forget to remember Allah. So it shows that you cannot rely 100% on people, ultimately, it is all what Allah wils. The shaitan can make us forget things, sometimes you want to do a good deed and you forget or istighfar and you forget. But even forgetting, it is willed by Allah, the means are different, in this case the shaitan made him forget. So nothing can happen without the permission of Allah.
 - ((ذِكْرَ رَبِّهِ)) can have three interpretations:
 1. To remember Allah
 2. To remind you of what brings you close to Allah: so Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) made them to get close to Allah by telling them about Allah, but the prisoner completely forget all of these things.
 3. Remembering Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) who deserves the best of reward
- Allah will not account a person for forgetting. Like sometimes you want to say dhikr but you forget. Allah will not account you for this. The shaitan wants to make you forget things that will bring you closer to Allah.

- (فَلَيْثَ فِي السَّجْنِ بِضْعَ سِنِينَ): So he stayed in prison for more years. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) stayed for another 3-9 years (بِضْعَ) refers to 3-9 years in Arabic. But this is the will of Allah – Allah wanted something better for him later, not now. When you want something, like work, marriage, etc – it is like a treasure that is there and Allah wants to give it to you when the time is best for you. Allah is the Most Rich and can give you anything, but He gives it to you with gentleness and with honor. Imagine if Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) had left immediately, the king would not have had his dream yet, and Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) would not have had his future position. So it was only after some years when the king had his dream. Subhan Allah. And this time period was all nurturing for Yusuf.

Surah Yusuf: 43-44

وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ إِنِّي أَرَى سَبْعَ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعٌ عِجَافٌ وَسَبْعَ سُنبُلَاتٍ خُضْرٍ وَأُخَرَ يَابِسَاتٍ
(يَا أَيُّهَا الْمَلَأُ أَفْتُونِي فِي رُءْيَايَ إِن كُنْتُمْ لِلرُّءْيَا تَعْبُرُونَ ٤٣)

And the king (of Egypt) said: "Verily, I saw (in a dream) seven fat cows, whom seven lean ones were devouring - and seven green ears of corn, and (seven) others dry. O notables! Explain to me my dream, if it be that you can interpret dreams." (43)

- When Allah afflicts people with trials, Allah is always there to support. So with every difficulty there is ease. The support can come through different means. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) never

complained about anyone. Yusuf was waiting in prison and he is waiting for relief from Allah. This period of waiting is also a type of worship.

- Allah kept Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) in jail with wisdom and for a purpose. Even if people wrong you, there is wisdom why you are in that situation, so that you may see the actions of Allah.
- Dreams cannot be controlled and this is one of the signs of Allah.
- ((وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ)): And the king said. Notice that Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is in Egypt, and the title of the ruler was 'king' not 'pharaoh', unlike 'pharaoh' during the time of Moses ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)). This is one of the historical miracles of the Qur'an. During the time of Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), Egypt was under a different leadership of a different tribe so the title used was 'king', different to that of at the time of Moses ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)). For a long time people assumed all rulers of Egypt were called 'pharaoh' which was not the case. Subhan Allah.
- ((إِنِّي أَرَى)): Verily I saw a vision. This is not a dream, but a vision. A vision is very clear and it will happen because it is a truthful vision from Allah. Types of dreams:
 1. Vision (رؤيا): don't try to interpret it because it will happen as it is first interpreted, allow only a person who knows how to interpret and only tell the ones that love you. A vision is from Allah.

2. Dream (حلم): it is from the shaitan, just trying to scare the human being. You don't need to mention this dream to anyone and it will not harm you, just seek refuge in Allah from the shaitan, and spit 3 times to your left. The shaitan just wants to make you sad.
 3. Self dream (حديث نفس): you dream about the things and people you're seeing and thinking about throughout the day.
- (سَبْعَ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعٌ عِجَافٌ): seven fat cows that were being eaten by seven thin cows. There are two strange things, cows eating cows and the thin eating the fat. That's why the king was really baffled by this.
 - (وَسَبْعَ سُنْبُلَاتٍ خَضْرَاءٍ وَأَخْرَ يَابَسَاتٍ): and seven green grains and others dry. It doesn't say what's being done, but the tafsir says that the seven dry ones are eating the seven green ones. The usage of the verb of eating is a continuation. So it's strange to see grains eating each other.
 - (أَفْتُونِي فِي رُءْيَايَ): Oh chiefs. This the inner circle of the king. (يَا أَيُّهَا الْمَلَأُ): Give clarification of my vision. (رُءْيَايَ): my vision. You can see possession about the vision – the king wants to show that only he can dream such a dream.
 - (إِنْ كُنْتُمْ لِلرُّءْيَا تَعْبُرُونَ): if you know how to interpret. So the king is setting a condition that only if you have knowledge about interpreting dreams, then tell me. Otherwise don't say anything.

Not a single of the chiefs knew how to interpret the dream, and they do not want the king to worry about it either. They wanted to remove it from his thoughts.

(قَالُوا أَضْغَتْ أَحْلُمَ وَمَا نَحْنُ بِتَأْوِيلِ الْأَحْلَمِ بِعَلَمِينَ ٤٤)

They said: "Mixed up false dreams and we are not skilled in the interpretation of dreams." (44)

- (قَالُوا أَضْغَتْ أَحْلُمَ): they said (the chiefs) these are just mixed up dreams. Perhaps you saw cows or you were hungry and that's why you saw such dreams. (أَضْغَتْ) means mixed, coming from (ضَغَتْ). (أَحْلُمَ) is dreams, so they are saying that you did not have a vision, but a dream, and dreams do not have interpretations. They don't know how to interpret, so they will give any excuse. It shows that the king's inner-circle is not a group that sincerely advises him. Subhan Allah how we see so many different characters in Surah Yusuf.
- (وَمَا نَحْنُ بِتَأْوِيلِ الْأَحْلَمِ بِعَلَمِينَ): And we are not skilled in the interpretation of dreams. They are not saying this as way of admitting they don't know, they are lying and showing pride. Notice the pride of this inner-circle, they say that we are not the one to interpret (أَحْلُمَ) dreams, alluding that 'dreams' are below their standard, rather they interpret 'visions'. They did not say 'visions' but this is what it is

referring. You can see how tadabur opens the meaning and reveals a different dimension. What are the characteristics of this inner-circle? (ما صفات الملائكة؟)

1. Lying (الكذب): they are actually do not know how to interpret, but won't admit to it, so they lie about it instead.
 2. Think highly of themselves, proud (العجب بالنفس): they are saying it is sub-standard to interpret dreams, they are the ones to interpret 'visions'.
- Look at qadr Allah, His decree. Allah put the one who serves the drinks to be there and hear what is going on. Allah wants to bring Yusuf in the best form, with the highest honor. The inner-circle proved that they are useless to the king when interpreting dreams, so when Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) comes, he will appear in a more elevated manner, thus fascinating the king. Subhan Allah, this is the decree of Allah, and this should increase our faith when we see the actions of Allah.
 - It is similar in Surah Al Baqarah when Allah asked the angels to give the names and they said we do not know, and then Allah asked Adam to answer, and he was able to. So Allah made that situation to honor the human. Same with the great intercession on the Day of Judgement, the people will go to the all of the different prophets, and each will turn them away, and then only the Prophet Mohammed ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) will begin the intercession, thus

showing the honor Allah has bestowed on the Prophet Mohammed ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)).

(وَقَالَ الَّذِي نَجَا مِنْهُمَا وَادَّكَرَ بَعْدَ أُمَّةٍ أَنَا أُنَبِّئُكُمْ بِتَأْوِيلِهِ ۚ فَأَرْسَلُونِ ۙ ٤٥)

Then the man who was released (one of the two who were in prison), now at length remembered and said: "I will tell you its interpretation, so send me forth." (45)

- The king's circle could not interpret the dream, but all along the drink server was listening to the conversation and he knew who could interpret it. Look at who had the solution to the king – sometimes people underestimate who has the solution and it shows Allah chooses whom he wills.
- (وَقَالَ الَّذِي نَجَا مِنْهُمَا): the man who was released of the two. Notice that Allah did not call him the 'server' rather what is important is that he was the one released from jail. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) told him to remember him to the king, but for years he totally forgot about it, and this was Qadr Allah.
- (وَادَّكَرَ بَعْدَ أُمَّةٍ): and he remembered after some time. (أُمَّةٍ) means several years.
- (أُنَبِّئُكُمْ): inform you (أَنَا أُنَبِّئُكُمْ بِتَأْوِيلِهِ ۚ): I will tell you its interpretation. (بِتَأْوِيلِهِ ۚ): interpretation (of the dream). Imagine the

scenario, there's the king who is desperate and the king's circle all confused, so the server decided to speak out loud, which is not easy. He said the most concise statement since he's a server and cannot talk too much, so he directly said, 'I will tell you its interpretation'. And this was exactly what the king wanted to hear.

- (فَأَرْسَلُونِي): so send me. His statement was very short and to the point, and in the 'Arabic' it is a very respectful way of saying 'to send me'. Imagine he did not tell him I need to go to the jail and ask for the interpretation and then I will come back and tell you. That is too long and the king doesn't have time. Ex: children might say, 'don't you want me to get good grades', you will say yes, they will then say 'send me to my friend's house'.
- Also, the server did not give a second thought about not talking to Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) after all of these years. He knew Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) was so good that he would not blame him or scold him for forgetting him after all of these years – this shows you how pure and free of sicknesses the heart that Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) has.

يُوسُفُ أَمَّا الصِّدِّيقُ أَفْتِنَا فِي سَبْعِ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعٌ عِجَافٌ وَسَبْعِ سُنبُلَاتٍ خُضْرٍ وَأُخَرَ
(يَابِسَتْ لِّلْعَالِيِّ أَرْجِعْ إِلَى النَّاسِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَعْلَمُونَ ٤٦)

(He said): "O Yûsuf (Joseph), the man of truth! Explain to us (the dream) of seven fat cows whom seven lean ones were devouring, and of seven green ears of corn, and (seven) others dry, that I may return to the people, and that they may know." (46)

- (يُوسُفُ أَيُّهَا الصِّدِّيقُ): O Yusuf, the man of truth. (الصِّدِّيقُ) means always truthful and never living for himself. If someone is living for himself, he will argue, scream, fight, but he is living for Allah and he is content to wherever Allah takes him, he totally trusts Allah. Subhan Allah. When we argue and fight about a situation we are rejecting the nurturing coming from Allah. When you are patient you will get the victory. When you are patient you are fighting the biggest enemy, which is your self. The shaitan is already defeated because if you can defeat your self then the self will not listen to the shaitan.
- He called him by his first name because he remembered him and it softens the other person when you remember them by their first name, and he called him by his most prominent attribute, which is (الصِّدِّيقُ), man of truth.
- (أَفْتِنَا): means to seek a fatwa, clear the confusion.
- The dream is فِي سَبْعِ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعٌ عِجَافٌ وَسَبْعِ سُنبُلَاتٍ خُضْرٍ وَأُخَرَ (يَابَسَتْ): of seven fat cows whom seven lean ones were devouring, and of seven green ears of corn, and (seven) others dry.
- (لَعَلِّي أَرْجِعُ إِلَى النَّاسِ): so that I may return to the people. The server is telling him that it's not his dream and Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) already knows this because he knows a server could not have a dream like this. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) can recognize that someone high-level is having this dream. That's why you should not make up dreams.

- Notice that (الْأَنَاسِ) was used instead of (مَلِك) king. For Yusuf (صلى الله عليه وسلم) it is not important if it's for a king or not. Yusuf (صلى الله عليه وسلم) interpreted dreams for prisoners, for himself, so if it's a king, it would not matter to him.
- Allah is the All-Knower and He knows what can distract you and can be an obstacle for you. From Allah's special mercy, He will remove and protect you from situations that can deviate your intention. For example, avoid hearing something that can put doubts in you.
- The server's past experience with Yusuf (صلى الله عليه وسلم) is that Yusuf (صلى الله عليه وسلم) did not give them the dream interpretation immediately, he gave them a dawah first. So the server is telling him that he really needs it quickly so that he may return to the people and (لَعَلَّهُمْ يَعْلَمُونَ): so that they may know.
- What will they know? To know the interpretation of the dream (تَأْوِيلَ) and they will know indirectly about Yusuf (صلى الله عليه وسلم) that he has the Allah given skills to interpret dreams (فَضْلِكَ وَمَعْرِفَتِكَ لِفَنِّ) (التأويل).

(قَالَ تَزْرَعُونَ سَبْعَ سِنِينَ دَأْبًا فَمَا حَصَدْتُمْ فَذَرُوهُ فِي سُنْبُلِهِ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّمَّا تَأْكُلُونَ ٤٧)

[(Yûsuf (Joseph)) said: "For seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual and that (the harvest) which you reap you shall leave it in ears, (all) - except a little of it which you may eat. (47)]

- Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) not only gave them the interpretation of the dream, but also a solution, and all of this is inspiration from Allah.
- Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) knew that it's a king dreaming this because it is impacting many people. Egypt is known for its agriculture and its source of water is the Nile River.
- (قَالَ تَزْرَعُونَ سَبْعَ سِنِينَ دَأْبًا) : He said: for seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual. Imagine this dream will impact them for more than 14 years. (دَأْبًا) means consecutive (متتالية), no gap in between. So for seven years they will have a harvest (خصب) each year. They will have abundant growth for seven years thus this represents the seven fat cows and seven green ears of grain.
- (۱) فَمَا حَصَدْتُمْ فَذَرُوهُ فِي سُنْبُلِهِ : and that (the harvest) which you reap you shall leave it in ears. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is giving them a solution after interpreting the first part of the dream and there is hikma, wisdom behind this. Imagine if he interpreted the full dream in one shot, 7 good years, then 7 bad years – it would have been too hard to take.
- (فَذَرُوهُ فِي سُنْبُلِهِ) : so whatever you harvest. (فَمَا حَصَدْتُمْ) : means to keep the grain in its husk so that it remains preserved for another 7-14

years. If it's removed from its husk, then it can spoil due to the weather or it can get infested.

- (إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّمَّا تَكُلُونَ): except a little of it which you may eat. So they should eat only a minimum of what they need and save the rest for the upcoming 7 hard years. They should not trade or export their extra harvest either.

ثُمَّ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ سَبْعٌ شِدَادٌ يَأْكُلْنَ مَا قَدَّمْتُمْ لَهُنَّ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّمَّا تُخْصِنُونَ (٤٨)

"Then will come after that, seven hard (years), which will devour what you have laid by in advance for them, (all) except a little of that which you have guarded (stored) (48)

- After seven consecutive years of harvest, (ثُمَّ) refers to after a while, unlike (فَ) which is more immediate. (ثُمَّ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ سَبْعٌ شِدَادٌ): Then will come after that, seven hard (years). (شِدَادٌ) is plural for (شَدِيد) – severe. So they will have seven years of drought. And this is telling us how this duniya is like, sometimes it's opened, sometimes it's closed – but it's always an opening from Allah Al Fatah (الفتاح).
- (يَأْكُلْنَ مَا قَدَّمْتُمْ لَهُنَّ): which will devour what you have laid by in advance for them. So these seven years of drought will devour all of that they have preserved. When you see you have abundance, you should appreciate it, because it will help you in harder days. In good times, you need to know Allah, and in bad times, Allah will be with you. You especially want to gather your good deeds while you can so that they are preserved for the akhira.
- (إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّمَّا تُخْصِنُونَ): except a little of that which you have guarded. All that will be left is what they had preserved. When you plan your good deeds, you will get tired of planning and not end up doing it. We plan what we want to do for Ramadan, and end up not doing it, so best to do it on the spot. When you have the energy and time, then do it – don't give the chance for the shaitan to spoil it. When you say you want to read Quran, read it, don't say after 5 minutes – that five minutes will be full of distractions that can lead to not even reading it.

ثُمَّ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ عَامٌ فِيهِ يُغَاثُ النَّاسُ وَفِيهِ يَعْصِرُونَ (٤٩)

"Then thereafter will come a year in which people will have abundant rain and in which they will press (wine and oil)." (49)

- This is not part of the king's dream, after the 7 yrs + 7 yrs = 14 yrs, (ثُمَّ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ عَامٌ): then thereafter will come a year. The ayat of the Quran should increase your faith in Allah because you need Allah at all times – in good and bad years.
- (فِيهِ يُغَاثُ النَّاسُ): they will be rescued. (يُغَاثُ): means to be rescued and saved, (غيث) is beneficial rain in the Quran, and it can also refer to the Nile, that it would flood. In the Quran, (مطر) also means rain but is not referring to beneficial rain. When you feel really tight, like a 'bottleneck' feeling, then that's when the relief will come. (ان النصر مع الصبر) victory comes with patience. People ask, 'why is it taking too long' it is because they are impatient.
- (وَفِيهِ يَعْصِرُونَ): they will press. When you have lots of fruits, then you will start to make juice out of it. So they had so much abundance, that they were pressing it, making juice out of it. When you read this ayah, you will see that the difficulty will never be forever – comfort and relieve will arrive. Even if it's 7 years, 20 years, it will be nothing compared to the reward that follows. And in that period of patience, you are being rewarded. Subhan Allah.
- Look at Yusuf's (pbuh) generosity and good manners to provide this extra information. Similar to when someone asks you for directions, you can either give them directions or you can say follow

me, which is more generous. Look at his pure heart, he could have been very miserly and bitter in his manner considering he was stuck in jail for many years.

وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ ائْتُونِي بِهِ فَلَمَّا جَاءَهُ الرَّسُولُ قَالَ ارْجِعْ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ فُتْلَهُ مَا بِالِ النَّسْوَۃِ اَلَّتِي قَطَّعْنَ اَيْدِيَهُنَّ اِنَّ رَبِّي بِكَيْدِهِنَّ عَلِيمٌ (٥٠)

And the king said: "Bring him to me." But when the messenger came to him, [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Return to your lord and ask him, 'What happened to the women who cut their hands? Surely, my Lord (Allâh) is Well-Aware of their plot.'" (50)

- We understand that the servant went to the king and told him about the dream interpretation. Notice he did not attribute the interpretation to himself because he was affected by Yusuf's (pbuh) truthfulness and righteousness. Sometimes, a person's good manners can be a means to guidance.
- Yusuf (pbuh) became recognized without making a big advertisement for himself.
- (وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ ائْتُونِي بِهِ): And the king said: "Bring him to me." The king is speaking to the people around him, not to the servant. (ائْتُونِي): to bring him to me. So they knew that they had to follow this order, and these chiefs didn't go themselves, they sent a messenger. So in a very official manner, a messenger is being sent to Yusuf (pbuh). When the messenger told him to come out of jail and meet the king, Yusuf (pbuh) refused. Why? He wants to come out of jail that all will know his innocence. He does not want to come out of jail because he did a favor to the king. You can see that he is not living for himself.
- Sometimes we wait for the relief and when the relief comes we attribute it to ourselves, but this is a bigger test. We need to attribute it to Allah, and also enter the relief also with patience.
- (فَلَمَّا جَاءَهُ الرَّسُولُ قَالَ ارْجِعْ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ): But when the messenger came to him, [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Return to your lord. You can find that in this Surah (رب) is being used in different ways. A believer when he does a favor, he does not want to be rewarded from others, he's doing it for Allah and wants the reward from Allah.
- He wanted to reopen the case, notice how this is how it is right now, this shows that Allah knows His creation. Look at his gentleness and modesty by not saying that the Aziz's wife tried to approach him, he did not want to expose her. So instead he mentioned the obvious, he asked about the women who cut their hands.
- (فُتْلَهُ مَا بِالِ النَّسْوَۃِ اَلَّتِي قَطَّعْنَ اَيْدِيَهُنَّ): Ask him, 'What happened to the women who cut their hands?' People think they are living for the truth by exposing people, but look at Yusuf (pbuh) and his approach. (مَا بِالِ): what happened. When we have pain, we cannot control our emotions, and end up saying more hurtful words. But look at the guidance and reformation from Allah, that Yusuf (pbuh) was able to even react and talk in this manner. After all these years in jail and purification, Yusuf (pbuh) was able to become who he is now.
- Hadith: عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ - قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " لَوْ لَبِثْتُ فِي السَّجْنِ مَا لَبِثَ يُوسُفُ، ثُمَّ أَتَانِي () (الدَّاعِيَ لِأَخِيَّتِهِ) (Allah's Apostle said, "If I stayed in prison as long as Joseph stayed and then the messenger came, I would respond to his call (to go out of the prison).") – Al Bukhari.
- Each messenger has a different characteristic that was suitable for them and their time. You cannot say Jesus (pbuh) should have been more like Moses (pbuh) or vice versa. But what we learn from this hadith is that we should follow the way of the Prophet (pbuh) and take the relief when it comes.

- Look at the nurturing, before the prison, Yusuf (pbuh) told the servant to remember him to the king and after all of these years of nurturing, Yusuf (pbuh) response was not to leave the jail even though the king told him to leave, he wanted to clear his name first.
- (إِنَّ رَبِّي بِتَيِّدِهِمْ عَلِيمٌ): Surely, my Lord (Allâh) is Well-Aware of their plot. Look at his manners, he did not say 'I know what they're like'. Look at the difference, when Yusuf (pbuh) says (رَبِّي), My Lord, that Allah is His Lord, showing exclusivity. Yusuf (pbuh) was very concise and direct in his approach, he told the messenger to go back, he asked the question 'what happened to the ladies', and said 'Allah knows what they plot'.

قَالَ مَا خَطْبُكُنَّ إِذْ رَأَوْتُنَّ يُوسُفَ عَنِ نَفْسِهِ ۖ قُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ مَا عَلِمْنَا عَلَيْهِ مِنْ سُوءٍ قَالَتِ
(أَمْرَأَتُ الْعَزِيزِ أَلَمْ أَحْصِ الْحَقُّ أَنَا رَأَوْتُهُ عَنِ نَفْسِهِ ۖ وَإِنَّهُ لَمِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ ٥١)

(The King) said (to the women): "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yûsuf (Joseph)?" The women said: "Allâh forbid! No evil know we against him!" The wife of Al-'Azîz said: "Now the truth is manifest (to all), it was I who sought to seduce him, and he is surely of the truthful." (51)

- Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) refused to leave the prison until all knew that he was innocent. And he gave a clue about the ladies that cut their hands. So they reopened the 'case' and called all of the city ladies after nine years to appear in front of the king.
- (إِذْ رَأَوْتُنَّ يُوسُفَ عَنِ نَفْسِهِ): The king asked the women. (قَالَ مَا خَطْبُكُنَّ): "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yûsuf (Joseph)?" Notice Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not mention anything about seducing, but after the king investigated, they managed to find out

that it was the ladies that were trying to seduce Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)).

(رَأَوْدَتُنَّ): to seduce, by walking, talking, gazing.

- At this point, we see that a confession is taking place, and the women said (قُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ): Allah forbid. It's not possible that Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) would do such a thing. So when they said this, they have confessed, and it's the biggest proof. And indirectly they are attributing the goodness to Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) and that they are in the wrong. (مَا عَلِمْنَا عَلَيْهِ مِنْ سُوءٍ): "No evil know we against him!". Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is a righteous messenger of Allah and if someone is good that is what will remain. If you are on the truth, don't be pressured to change by others. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) wants to leave with complete innocence, even though he is innocent at this point, he still wants to clear his name in front of Al Aziz. A sin is very embarrassing, when a sin is just by the person himself, like not praying, not fasting, then one can repent but would not feel the guilt compared to someone who has sinned by wronging someone, there will always be a lingering guilt. So the wife of Al Aziz felt immense guilt and she too wanted to repent by confessing, especially after hearing all the good things about Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) from the other ladies.
- (قَالَتْ أَمَرَأْتُ آلْأَزِيزِ): The wife of Al-Aziz (minister) said. She said three things:

1. (حَصَّحَنَّ): Now the truth is manifest (to all). (أَلَّنَ حَصَّحَنَّ الْحَقُّ): means that is it very clear and apparent. (حَقُّ): truth. The truth is Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is innocent and it was her and the ladies who tried to seduce him. The truth will come out one day, but it just needs patience. There are people who are good but people are oppressing them or against them, but this gives hope that the truth will come out, and it will even come out from the very ones who are guilty.
2. (أَنَا رَأَوْدَتْهُ عَنْ نَفْسِهِ): it was I who sought to seduce him. She confessed that it was she who sought to seduce him and he did not want it. Look after all of these years it was a type of reforming for her to be able to confess. And here you can see the 'way of Allah' is the same, in that sense when someone wrongs someone else, you will find that end of the day, the person who is guilty will confess. This story of Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) and the wife of Al Aziz is a repeat of what happens in this day and age. If a person is patient, it is a way of elevation.
3. (وَإِنَّهُ لَمِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ): he is surely of the truthful. Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) never complained and he was in jail during his youthful years, when he could have been married and having children and starting to work.

(ذَٰلِكَ لِيَعْلَمَ أَنِّي لَمْ أَخُنْهُ بِالْغَيْبِ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي كَيْدَ الْخَائِنِينَ ٥٢)

" In order that he (Al-'Azîz) may know that I betrayed him not in his (absence). And, verily! Allâh guides not the plot of the betrayers. (52)

- Sometimes a person might completely confess but then give an excuse to say it could have been this too, and here you can see the inclination of the human. You can see that everyone loves themselves, they might confess, but don't make them completely bad. Subhan Allah.
- There are two interpretation for (ذَٰلِكَ لِيَعْلَمَ أَنِّي لَمْ أَخُنْهُ بِالْغَيْبِ)
 - (لِيَعْلَمَ): referring to the husband. That confession in order that he (her husband) many know that I did not betray him secretly. So the wife is saying that I tried to seduce Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), but I didn't do anything – it didn't work out. (أَخُنْهُ): to betray, but in this context of husband and wife, it is betrayal by committing adultery. So she is telling her husband that she did not commit that sin. But it is still a betrayal by looking at him in that manner, that why it's said even the eyes can commit adultery.
 - (لِيَعْلَمَ): referring to Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)). Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is not there to hear the confession, he is still in jail, but she is saying that even though she confessed that Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is truthful, but I did not betray him (Yusuf) by lying about him, when I could have since he is not here. So she is trying to show that there

is still some goodness in her and that she is not trying to take revenge against him.

- So you can slowly see her repentance taking place and the nurturing from Allah. Guilt can change a human being.
- (وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي كَيْدَ الْخَائِنِينَ): And, verily! Allâh guides not the plot of the betrayers. Look at how Allah nurtured her to make her realize this and make this statement. The ayat of the Qur'an are there as nurturing shortcuts, for example you don't need to go through a situation in order to learn. For example, reading the Qur'an and its stories, if you understand it and apply it, then you passed the test, but if not, you will see you will get placed in a situation in order to learn your lesson and realize it. For her to make a statement to say that Allah will not guide the plot of the betrayers, that means she tasted it and she had to understand it through her nurturing, through her situation. So you can see that the Qur'an is a shortcut to Allah. Everyone goes through nurturing, both she and Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) went through nurturing, but the difference is to accept things and not blame others or lie.
- She had an amanah with her husband, her house, and she betrayed it. We have different amanah, for example not exposing secrets between husband/wife, mother/children, friends. When a person betrays it is a plot, and Allah is telling them that Allah will not allow the plot to go to the end, no matter how much a person tries to cover it or not talk about it, Allah will expose it in the end. What goes around, comes around, and it is mercy from Allah to be exposed in the duniya, at least to make him repent. If it is not exposed in the duniya, it will be

exposed in the akhira in front of everyone, which is even worse, and there is no chance for repentance at that point.

(وَمَا أُبْرِئُ نَفْسِي إِنَّ النَّفْسَ لَأَمَّارَةٌ بِالسُّوءِ إِلَّا مَا رَحِمَ رَبِّي إِنَّ رَبِّي غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ ٥٣)

And I free not myself (from the blame). Verily, the (human) self is inclined to evil, except when my Lord bestows His Mercy (upon whom He wills). Verily, my Lord is Off-Forgiving, Most Merciful." (53)

- In this ayah, it is as if the wife of the Aziz is making a confession again, but not just about herself, but all selves in general.
- (وَمَا أُبْرِئُ نَفْسِي): And I cannot make myself innocent. (أُبْرِئُ): to make innocent. (برأ): innocent, pure, freedom, to be cured from a sickness. She is saying she is doing wrong, and cannot say otherwise. She's not innocent from trying to seduce Yusuf ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), she's not innocent from wanting to have a relation, and she's not innocent from plotting. And all of this started with just a desire, she was close to the sin – which is having woman and man alone. Allah says don't be close to the sin, otherwise you will do it. That's why Allah told Adam don't come close to this tree.
- (نَفْسِي): self, soul. The soul and the body are sharing the sin. In hellfire, all types of torture are there, physical, mental, and emotional torture. In hellfire, everybody is fighting. Fighting among themselves, fighting with their fake idols, fighting with their shaitan, and the body will fight with its soul. The soul will blame the body for doing the sin, and vice

versa. On the Day of Judgement, the punishment is both the body and soul. On this earth, the body feels punishment. In the grave, the soul is being tortured.

- In this ayah, the wife said I do not make my self (nafs) innocent, she did not say body.
- (لَأَمَّارَةٌ): verily, the nafs is commanding to evil. (إِنَّ النَّفْسَ لَأَمَّارَةٌ بِالسُّوءِ): comes from (أمر) which is to command, but it is commanding with intensity. Human beings, nufu's, without Allah will have these defects and imperfections. (بِالسُّوءِ): evil, and the ba'a shows attachment. So the nafs in general is attached to commanding evil, the self is inclined to desire. The self will think bad, say something bad, it is impatient. Imagine this is not the shaitan commanding evil, the plot of the shaitan is weak. The nafs commands to do bad, and it is very deceiving. In the book, "Fiqh of the Hearts", it states that the first enemy is the nafs, the second enemy is the shaitan, the third enemy is duniya, the fourth enemy are the hypocrites, and fifth enemy is disbelievers and polytheists.
- Our nafs is our first enemy, and paradise is the great success because you have to fight yourself and it is very painful – this is the test of this life, but alhamd Allah we have a Rabb to nurture us and show us the way.
- The nature of the nafs:
 - Inclined to desire (تأمر بالسوء و الفحشاء)
 - Commit sin, enjoin evil (ميلها الى الشهوات)

- Can get quickly influenced because the nafs is very light (تأثرها)
- It is very difficult to suppress. (صعوبة قهرها).
- Ride / seat of the shaitan. (مركب للشيطان) This is a very comfortable place for the shaitan to ride the nafs. We ask Allah to protect us from the evil of ourselves. Ameen.
- Sometimes a person might say they can't differentiate the bad thoughts from the self or the shaitan. The first bad thought is from the shaitan, he just gives the first idea, he will roll the ball in your court, but you are now playing with the ball. So all the other bad thoughts are yours – the self, not the shaitan anymore. If you see a sin is persisting and keeps getting repeated, it is your nafs. People say in Ramadan the shaiteen are chained, but people are still committing sin, that is the nafs, the self.
- Allah put desires in the nafs, and either you will use these desires as steps to reach Allah or you will use these desires to go to hellfire. For example, we have the desire to talk, this desire can take this person to paradise, if you talk good talk, or it can be a bad desire with the talk of vain talk, talk of sins, etc.
- Angels do not have desires, but have intellect. Animals have desire, but no intellect. A human is a mixture of desire and intellect, and you need to have a balance, and this balance can only come from the divine – from Allah.
- The nafs is commanding to evil before knowing Allah. If you do not know Allah, then the self is committing evil and sin, it commands so much to the point it becomes your own boss. That's why when you

know Allah, your Master, then it will suppress the self, then you do not follow the self's desires or commands, but follow the commands of Allah. The nafs, the selves, anyways belong to Allah, so it's only logical to follow Allah. That's why, don't live for yourself, live for Allah.

- When the self is cut off from Allah, then it will be blind and it will just follow its desires, it will think it's independent, etc. The nafs (self) becomes blind, and what will make it move, its desires. This nafs has no light, no book, no guidance.
- Don't make knowing about yourself just for information or curiosity or the sake of duniya, you have to know about your self (nafs) to follow Allah.
- How can you take care of the self?

1. The nafs (Self) needs reminders all the time in order to do good. How will reminders come? Allah reminds you in different ways, through people, books, etc. A reminder is something you know, and you are being told again and again – this is the way to guidance. You are in the trials of this duniya and you need reminders. When it is dark and you feel you are inside a hole, at that time, you need a reminder. You need somebody to come to remind you, and Allah is the Most Subtle and Gentle, He will send a reminder to you. Don't trust yourself or be confident with yourself - how can you trust a self that is commanding evil? You need to trust Allah and put your confidence in Allah. (لا حول ولا قوة الا بالله) is a treasure in paradise.

2. Don't blame anybody else, you need to blame yourself. But a person needs a way out. Some personalities just blame themselves all the time, but then this can depress a person. So the way out is to return to Allah.
3. You need to repent and return to Allah all the time.
4. Need to seek refuge from Allah from the evil of yourself. (اللهم اني اعوذ بك من شر نفسي) You are saying that you cannot control yourself, so you need Allah to take care of you. There is also good to the self, but the bad needs to be controlled and suppressed first by submitting to Allah, by putting the weight down on the self by submitting to its Master and not to its self.
5. Al Isti'ana (الاستعانة) – meaning asking Allah to help you all the time.

▪ Different types of selfs (nufoos) and what it likes (انواع انفوس و ما تحب):

1. A self that is like a wild animal, a self that likes power, control and oppressing people, it's very violent. (نفوس سبعية غضبية). Ex: Flraoun. Not everybody is like this, but some selves like to be dominating, they want to be the best, they are arrogant and proud. These selves are friends of the shaitan. (أولياء الشيطان). The shaitan will encourage them to do sins and become violent. The shaitan will make the way to sin very easy, and the path to do good very difficult. We need to know Allah and ourselves in order to

overcome. Allah brings guidance to everyone, but in different ways, these types will receive guidance through afflictions, being put down, but if they don't accept that guidance, they end up committing suicide.

2. A self that is like an animal, just following its desires (نفوس حيوانيه). This self does not think about halal or haram, it just wants to live its desires, indulge, 'living its life', 'living the moment' without thinking that it's doing haram.
3. Heavenly, elevated souls (نفوس سمائية علويه). All souls are commanding evil, except they need mercy and nurturing from Allah, and that is how these souls become heavenly, they accepted the nurturing of Allah, and that is why they have mercy. Their friends are the angels. You can get a good thought from the angels and bad thoughts from devils, and you are in the middle – mercy from Allah will allow you to take the good thought, and the self commanding evil will make you take the bad thoughts. For these heavenly souls, Allah assigns angels for them. The angels will take charge of advising them, giving them good thoughts, guiding them and teaching them through means, keeping them firm, and all they say will be truth – truth will come out of their tongues. Allah will teach you without a teacher and without a book – just through thoughts. If this heavenly soul slips and makes a mistake without realizing, the angels will ask forgiveness for him. If he forgets, they will remind him of good. Sometimes, they forget prayer or forget fajr and they will remind him. And when they are sad, they will

console them and give them good feelings. All of this is from Allah providing the means. These are the souls that are at rest, at peace. (مطمئنة).

(وَمَا أَكْبَرُ نَفْسِي إِنَّ النَّفْسَ لَأَمَّارَةٌ بِالسُّوءِ إِلَّا مَا رَحِمَ رَبِّي إِنَّ رَبِّي غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ ٥٣)

And I free not myself (from the blame). Verily, the (human) self is inclined to evil, except when my Lord bestows His Mercy (upon whom He wills). Verily, my Lord is Off-Forgiving, Most Merciful." (53)

- The Qur'an has a solution to every problem in your life. People's natures are different, some are more logical, some are more emotional, so in the Qur'an, you find different techniques to reach out to different types. Some ayat are parables, some are stories, some are questions asking, do you not understand?
- The way to repentance is when you confess your sin in front of Allah. For the wife of the Aziz she needs to confess in front of others because it is directly related to wronging others. But it is unlike other religions where in order to be purified from the sins, you need to confess to others. Alhamd Allah we only need Allah.
- We don't know ourselves because our self is the biggest enemy, before trying to defeat any outer enemies, like the shaitan, it is our inner-self we must overcome. What will make your heart filled with worship and the love of Allah? You need to defeat yourself, then very quickly you will be sensitive and able to feel your heart. That's why a

barrier to the heart is the self. The self is commanding evil but there are exceptions.

- What makes a person to be deceived in the duniya, it's the fitnas, thinking he is doing good, but he's really not. Trials (الابلاء) are composed of:
 - The shaitan beautifies the evil: he will present the first idea. Evil is ugly, sins are ugly, but what makes it tempting, the shaitan decorates it and makes it shine.
 - Ignorance: I am ignorant of my self, what a loss that Allah gave humans intellect, and they are using only to learn about others and not about themselves. We need to put ourselves under a microscope first.
- The shaitan and the nafs work together, in the beginning the shaitan will bring the first thought. For example, you want to get angry, you want to shout. He will not bring the haram in front of you, he will adorn it because he knows the self, and he will bring it to your thoughts. When the shaitan throws the ball towards you, it depends on which type of ball suits. He does not throw the same ball to everybody, he will come from the side of your weakness. If somebody's weakness is desire, he will come from that direction, if somebody's weakness is doubt, he will come from that angle. Who will receive the ball? The nafs. The nafs will think about it, and if you accept the shaitan's idea, it will become a desire in your heart. For example, she said something bad about you, and you want to talk back at her and scream at her. After becoming a desire, it becomes determination, now you really

want to do it, and then there is an action. Just from one thought from the shaitan, it becomes a desire in your self, then you become determined (it's an intention), and then you act on it. So who is blamed? The nafs, the nafs, the self, acted in the end.

- The nafs is very amazing and dangerous. If you purify your nafs, your self, it will reach the highest of paradise. If the person neglects himself, he will ultimately destroy himself and take himself to hellfire.
- The nafs is a barrier between the heart and reaching to Allah. Don't you know in order to reach Allah, Allah wants to see how much you love Him, how much do you hope and fear in Him. So many people say they do not feel their heart? Meaning nothing affects it. They say that the Qur'an is light for heart, but they don't feel it. They talk about death and it does not move them. What is the barrier? It the nafs, the self.
- How do people taste the sweetness of faith? There is a feeling to it, and the barrier is the nafs.
- **Purification of the nafs (تزكية النفس):**
- The nafs commands for evil but must realize and know in order to overcome it: you need mercy and your Rabb (إِلَّا مَا رَحِمَ رَبِّي).
- (زكى) means (تطهير) to clean and (زيادة) increment, increase in blessings.
- What makes a person to be jealous, to be impatient, to argue, etc? It's because of the self, because it commands for evil, it is persistent.
- So the self needs to be purified and cleansed, which are the sins.

- After you clean and remove the sins, you need to add and fill it with goodness. If you don't keep your self occupied with good, then it will occupy you with evil.
- So purification is not just about cleaning, it is about cleaning and then filling it with good. Extract the evil and fill it with good. For example, you don't want to attend a party because you know there will be haram things, so you get yourself out of it, but now you have this empty time slot, so you need to fill it with good, otherwise the shaitan will still come to you and put thoughts in your mind and could divert you to something else.
- This process is not easy, who will show you your faults? (ربي), My Lord. He will take charge of nurturing you and showing you your faults, He will upgrade you. Purification means reforming, it is equal to nurturing, and becoming fixed and becoming better. Who took charge of reforming all of us? It's ربي, My Lord, My Creator, My Owner, My Provider, My Nurturer and Reformer. You need to believe that only Allah is nurturing you. Don't think it's your mother, because even your mother is going through a nurturing from Allah. When you look around? Is everybody being purified to be good? Majority of people selves are commanding for evil and they are not able to overcome their selves.
- How will Allah reform you? Your purification of the self depends on how much you observe from the nurturing coming to you from Allah. If a person does not understand that nurturing is coming from Allah, then he will not be able to purify his self. Subhan Allah. You need to

understand how Allah nurtures you, so that you can purify your self.

How does Allah nurture me? How can I interpret what is around me to know that this is nurturing from Allah.

- The decree: Allah put you in a decree, you are the only one going through that decree, especially the decree that causes pain. For example, a person loves praise, and can't stand it if not being praised by others. This is a problem. He will start to blame others for no one praising him. If you feel pain, you feel a pinch in something, then this means you have a fault in this area. When you feel pain, this means there is a defect. Our problem is we say others have defects, but not ourselves. And the things we have faults with, we see these problems will get repeated, we will get these decrees more often, because this is a process of nurturing. Allah wants to show you your defect, and this is a mercy from Allah. Everybody's nurturing is different because each self is different, you can have two friends who enter a shop, and each reaction is different. One might get angry and the other one tells her it's no big deal, and she wonders why you don't feel like her, that's because it's her nurturing.
- Knowledge: You have a problem, like you are arrogant, angry, jealous, etc. And you enter a class and you hear your problem being spoken about it. You feel like you are on the spotlight. So Allah is giving you nurturing through knowledge. Don't think people know about your problem, this is nurturing from Allah. You feel like you are exposed, but at least you know that this

feeling is a nurturing from Allah. Don't ignore it, these are signs from Allah.

- Good thoughts from Allah: something will cross your mind about wanting to do good. It's like a gentle ray of light coming to you. Some people don't get guided from others, Allah just puts a thought in their mind and makes them think, is this the true religion? Nurturing from Allah is a mercy, because if you do not accept it, it will lead a person to be deviated, he will be deceived by this life and the shaitan. Hadn't been for Allah's nurturing, no one would have reached paradise. If we don't accept the nurturing, then the self will be corrupt.
- When Allah brings in front of you the way of good and protects you from all harm. For example, a mother brings goodness to her child, for example she takes her child to a Qur'an class. Another situation she might notice that her child is with bad companions and she takes him out of that situation. Did this child ask for this nurturing? No. So Allah will bring a way of good for you without you even seeking it, and will take you away from harm without you even knowing – all of this is nurturing from Allah.
- If you understand these four points, then you can understand life and what you are going through. You shouldn't blame others, just look at yourself, and if you don't know what to do, just be patient – this of itself is a good virtue.
- When you complain and blame others, then you are negating the purification of the self.

- So the wife of the Aziz went through a nurturing, despite the many years, she was eventually guided and Allah accepted her repentance.
- (إِنَّ رَبِّي غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ): Verily My Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. She knows that Allah is Merciful because He nurtures us. Because we are being nurtured, it means we have mistakes, so we need Allah to forgive us our sins. Allah will forgive your sins. Allah will nurture you to show you that you made a sin, and make you feel its guilt, this is to remind you to repent and seek forgiveness. After Allah removes the sin, He will fill it with good. That is why if a person truly repents sincerely for the sake of Allah, then Allah forgives him his sin, and He pours mercy upon him, and fills him with goodness.

(وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ أَتُتُونِي بِهِ ۖ أَسْتَخْلِصُهُ لِنَفْسِي ۚ فَلَمَّا كَلَّمَهُ قَالَ إِنَّكَ الْيَوْمَ لَدَيْنَا مَكِينٌ أَمِينٌ ۝٥٤)

And the king said: "Bring him to me that I may attach him to my person." Then, when he spoke to him, he said: "Verily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted." (54)

- The king now believes that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is not just anybody, so he is really keen on seeing him. Yusuf (عليه السلام) not once was thinking about himself, he just wants to live for Allah. When you deal with Allah with yaqeen (full certainty) in His promises, then that is what makes a person remain patient. Yusuf (عليه السلام) knows that things will be better and better but only with nurturing, this is the way of Allah.

- Even though the king was not a believer, Allah put love in his heart to adore the characteristics of Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- (وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ أَتُتُونِي بِهِ): And the king said, "Bring him to me". So again he is commanding for Yusuf (عليه السلام) to come, but this time it is not just to be seen – he has something in store for him. What is it?
- (أَسْتَخْلِصُهُ لِنَفْسِي): That I may attach him to my self. Look how strong these words are – he will make Yusuf (عليه السلام) exclusively for himself. He wants Yusuf (عليه السلام) to be his advisor, counselor, he will not work anywhere but with him (the king). Imagine someone just coming out of jail and gets this treatment, subhan Allah. This is the favor of Allah.
- Even this type of treatment does not affect Yusuf (عليه السلام) because he knows himself. Now everybody knows about Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- (فَلَمَّا كَلَّمَهُ): When he spoke to him. Now Yusuf (عليه السلام) is in front of the king. Imagine sometimes you see someone from a distance and think they're something, but as soon as they speak, it really tells what they're like. The tongue and heart both have to be clean. A person can't say I have a 'white heart' but a 'dirty tongue'. The tongue is a reflection of what's in the heart. When a person says something and they say 'I didn't mean it' – they did, because it is something that is hidden deeply inside the heart, and this is a way of detecting a sickness and then nurturing it, there is nothing random.
- When a person applies for a job, you read their CV and then have an interview, because sometimes what's on the CV doesn't match in appearance, so that is why the king spoke to Yusuf (عليه السلام), it is a sort of interview.

- When he spoke to Yusuf (عليه السلام) he was totally impressed by him and with his words, so he told him – (قَالَ إِنَّكَ آلْيَوْمَ لَدَيْنَا مَكِينٌ أَمِينٌ) (he said: "Verily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted"). When you are good and straight in your life, then of course Allah will give you the best in life.
- (عليه السلام): to establish. (مكننا) appeared with the Aziz, when Yusuf (عليه السلام) was reformed from the well and became established with the Aziz, who was also a minister, but now Yusuf (عليه السلام) is established with the king. However, there was a jail in between – there had to be nurturing. Allah's way is beautiful, the problem is that people think badly about Allah.
- (أَمِينٌ): trustworthy. Yusuf (عليه السلام) will be trusted with the secrets of the country.
- So now Yusuf (عليه السلام) has a very big position, and look how quickly his response was.

(قَالَ أَجْعَلْنِي عَلَى خَزَائِنِ الْأَرْضِ إِنِّي حَفِيظٌ عَلَيْمُ ۝٥٥)

[Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Set me over the storehouses of the land; I will indeed guard them with full knowledge" (as a minister of finance in Egypt). (55)

- You know that it was a quick response because he said (قَالَ), the ayah did not start with 'and' or 'then' – immediately it starts with 'he said'.

- (قَالَ أَجْعَلْنِي عَلَى خَزَائِنِ الْأَرْضِ): Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Set me over the storehouses of the land". Yusuf (عليه السلام) is not living for himself, he wants to spread Islam and guide the people. He knows that it was not a Muslim country and he asked for the financial position. The economy is the largest stronghold of a country, and that is what Yusuf (عليه السلام) asked for. He said to have power over all of the treasuries of the country, he did not say for one treasury.
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) didn't ask for it, it came to him because the king already told him you are trustworthy, so Allah inspired Yusuf (عليه السلام) to ask for the position. If something comes to you, then Allah made it easy for you and it will come with help and aid – because it is a gift from Allah. But if someone is asking for something and is taking wrongful means to achieve it, like bribing, etc then it will be a trial for that person.
- Also Yusuf (عليه السلام) knows from the dream that the country will face difficult years.
- Since he asked for that position, now he will give his qualification. He said (إِنِّي حَفِيزٌ عَلِيمٌ) (I will indeed guard them with full knowledge), a person can say goodness about himself when acquiring a job, but when a person says it, there must be so much taqwa. The king already mentioned that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is trustworthy, so this is just affirming it.
- (حَفِيزٌ): protector, because he is honest and (عَلِيمٌ) because he has knowledge of what to do with the treasures and how to handle them. Also, it is not haram for a believer to work with a disbeliever because it is an opportunity to spread Islam.

- Notice the dawah of Yusuf (عليه السلام) is different from other messengers, he was not calling the people out rightly, rather it was all based on his life and character.
- When the opportunity came, Yusuf (عليه السلام) grabbed it, but it came after nurturing. This is a lesson for us, we can't just jump into something. The higher you want to go, the more struggle. When we say we want to go to paradise, there will be some struggle, because it is a test of your truthfulness. Do you really want to go to paradise? Are you really serious?
- Everybody wants to go to paradise. When the angels saw paradise, they said everyone would want to go there, so Allah surrounded it with commands, obligations – to test who will truly want to go there now. Then the angels said I don't know who might want to go there. When the angels saw the hellfire, they said no one would ever want to go there, so Allah surrounded it with desires and temptations – to test who will avoid these.
- Every struggle we face fits us and is custom made for us. Think of it like a dress, is not too loose or too tight that it will make you die. And that struggle is a means to reach paradise.
- We all want to be established on this earth and the hereafter, and trials / tests have to come along with it. And the journey to Allah is not alone, we have to have tawakul on Allah. If we didn't have Allah, it would be impossible for us.

وَكَذَٰلِكَ مَكَّنَّا لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ يَتَّبِعُوا مِنْهَا حَيْثُ يَشَاءُ نُصِيبُ بِرَحْمَتِنَا مَنْ نَشَاءُ وَلَا نُضِيعُ أَجْرَ
(الْمُحْسِنِينَ ٥٦)

Thus did We give full authority to Yûsuf (Joseph) in the land, to take possession therein, when or where he likes. We bestow of Our Mercy on whom We will, and We make not to be lost the reward of Al-Muhsinûn (56)

- Now we are turning the page from a chapter of hardship to a chapter of victory. Allah will never forsake Yusuf (عليه السلام) – that is the yaqeen – you need patience. When a trial comes, it suits the person exactly – like a dress – it's not too loose that it's too easy, nor too tight that it will make us die.
- When the relief comes from Allah it will overflow – at the moment of bottleneck when it's getting harder and harder and you say you just can't take it, just be patient, because after that is when the relief will come. Look after jail, Yusuf (عليه السلام) was demanding what he wants. Subhan Allah.
- (وَكَذَٰلِكَ مَكَّنَّا لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ يَتَّبِعُوا مِنْهَا حَيْثُ يَشَاءُ): Thus did We give full authority to Yûsuf (Joseph) in the land, to take possession therein, when or where he likes. Did Yusuf (عليه السلام) ever dream or wish that he would be with the king or did he think about his past – he was never sad about the past. He didn't think about the future – he didn't say I want to have children, wife – he just lived for the present.

- (نُصِيبُ بِرَحْمَتِنَا مَن نَّشَاءُ): We bestow of Our Mercy on whom We will. This is a special mercy from Allah. The difference between general and special mercy is when Allah teaches you beneficial knowledge, when he puts the love of the deen in your heart – anything related to the deen is a special mercy. Anything related to the duniya and you are indulging in it, then it is a general mercy. But if anything related to duniya and you are using to get closer to Allah, then it is a special mercy. So even Yusuf (عليه السلام) working with the king is a special mercy.
- Entering paradise is out of Allah's special mercy. So we need to ask Allah for His mercy and Allah bestows His mercy upon whom He wills. And it's not random, it is out of Allah's wisdom. There is no such thing as coincidence, whatever comes to you, it's meant for you. There is no luck, everything is pre-ordained.
- (وَلَا نُضِيعُ أَجْرَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ): and We make not to be lost the reward of Al-Muhsinûn. If you are a muhsin, Allah will preserve your reward. A muhsin does things with excellence – Allah will not make your reward go to vain. Praying with ihsan, cleaning with ihsan, even if it's wordly – Allah likes what is done with excellence.
- Ihsan means to do things with excellence, how? When you believe that you are seeing Allah. Not physically seeing Allah – but you are so sure of Allah's names and attributes – you see all of His actions around. You have so much passion, you don't wait for the people to appreciate you because you are doing it for Allah. But if you are not

at that stage, then believe that Allah is seeing you. You are under constant observation.

- Yusuf's (عليه السلام) ihsan reached the max because he showed ihsan to the ones who hurt him. He pardoned them, he forgave them, he didn't complain, he didn't blame – imagine after years not being able to see his father, and he did not say anything. This is the noble character.
- Prophet Mohammed (صلى الله عليه وسلم) went to Ta'if and the people and children were stoning him and they knew this was the Messenger of Allah. The angel of the mountains said if you want I can crush them, but the Prophet Mohammed (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said 'Oh Allah forgive my people, for they do not know'. Perhaps one of their offspring will become Muslim. Subhan Allah.
- This is the best excuse to give for the ones who harm you, 'Oh Allah forgive them, for they do not know'. Subhan Allah. There is an impact when you do ihsan to those who wrong you, you repel the evil with good. You might have an impact on that person because of your treatment, and then that person changes for the good, and you earn all of those hasanat (good deeds).
- Allah loves the muhsineen, and you will have the nearness and the mercy of Allah.

(وَلَا جَزَاءَ الْآخِرَةِ خَيْرٌ لِلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَكَانُوا يَتَّقُونَ ٥٧)

And verily, the reward of the Hereafter is better for those who believe and used to fear Allâh and keep their duty to Him (57)

- (وَلَا جَزَاءُ الْآخِرَةِ خَيْرٌ): And verily, the reward of the Hereafter is better. Don't only focus on the duniya because the reward of the akhira will be better. If you are muhsineen – Allah will allow you to be established on the earth, will give you victory over your enemies, and the reward of the akhira is far better than the duniya.
- Imagine when you have something cheap and it breaks – you're not affected, but if something really expensive breaks, then you're affected. This is like the duniya and the akhira. Don't complain about the duniya, it's not worth it relative to the akhira.
- (لِّلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَكَانُوا يَتَّقُونَ): for those who believe and used to fear Allâh and keep their duty to Him. The akhira will be good for those who believe and have taqwa. Those who believed in Allah, His names and attributes, actions – they see everything and it reminds of Allah. And they have taqwa.
- In this ayah, it did not just say they had taqwa, but belief and taqwa. They believed in Allah with actions and they worshiped Him and the taqwa is that they abstained from sin and kept themselves away from the wrath of Allah.

وَجَاءَ إِخْوَةُ يُوسُفَ فَدَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ فَعَرَفَهُمْ وَهُمْ لَهُ مُنْكَرُونَ (٥٨)

And Yûsuf's (Joseph) brethren came and they entered unto him, and he recognized them, but they recognized him not. (58)

- The grains were stored and the drought was not only in Egypt, but extended further. So Egypt became the center, and people heard that only in Egypt were people able to find food. Look at the wisdom behind this, it forced all of the brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام) to come to Egypt. Yaqoub (عليه السلام), their father, sent all of the brothers except for the youngest one, Benjamin. Notice the test of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is the love he has for his children. Subhan Allah.
- It was also said that the drought was so severe that Yusuf (عليه السلام) and the king would eat only one meal a day.
- Before, the brothers used to have the upper hand and now they have the lower hand. Also, they cannot go to anyone to get the food except for Yusuf (عليه السلام) himself, and not to any of his assistants.
- (وَجَاءَ إِخْوَةُ يُوسُفَ): And came the brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام). Notice how Allah mentioned (إِخْوَةُ), the brothers, to show that despite what happened between them, they are still brothers. Sometimes even if there are problems between family members, you are still family. Subhan Allah.
- (فَدَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ): so they entered to him. Notice that it was immediate that they entered to see him due to the fa'a, it shows that Yusuf (عليه السلام) was very approachable.
- (فَعَرَفَهُمْ): and he knew them. He immediately recognized them because before he was young and they were already grown up, so the features didn't change much.

- (وَهُمْ لَهُ مُنْكَرُونَ): but they did not recognize him. Since Yusuf (عليه السلام) was very young when they last saw him, and clearly your features change as you grow older. And they could not recognize him either because he was dressed in authority, and they could never imagine their brother to be like that. Imagine from being a servant to a minister. Imagine his beauty and now he is with authority, he would be double 'attractive' but notice the trial of women was not there because he already passed it. Subhan Allah.
- There is wisdom why Yusuf (عليه السلام) recognized them and not his brothers recognizing him in order to use the ploy to bring his entire family to Egypt, in no way was this to seek revenge.

وَلَمَّا جَهَّزَهُمْ بِجَهَّازِهِمْ قَالَ أَتُنُونِي بِأَخٍ لَّكُم مِّنْ أَبِيكُمْ أَلا تَرَوْنَ أَنِّي أُوفِي الْكَيْلَ وَأَنَا خَيْرُ الْمُنْزِلِينَ
(٥٩)

And when he had furnished them with provisions (according to their need), he said: "Bring me a brother of yours from your father; (he meant Benjamin). See you not that I give full measure, and that I am the best of the hosts? (59)

- The amount of food that could be given was according the capacity of what a camel can carry. Similar to how we have max luggage weight when flying.
- (وَلَمَّا جَهَّزَهُمْ بِجَهَّازِهِمْ): While he was preparing their provisions, he asked them how many brothers they were? They said twelve at first, but there were only ten present. They dodged about one brother missing

(Yusuf as) and then they mentioned the youngest was with their father. Because Yusuf (عليه السلام) was honest, he said you are therefore only ten, so I can only give you provision for ten.

- When you are wronged, and you are patient and have full trust that Allah will bring you back your rights, you will find that the very person who wronged you will give you back your rights, and while you have the upper hand and they have the lower.
- (قَالَ أَتُتُونِي بِأَخٍ لَّكُمْ مِّنْ أَبِيكُمْ): Bring me the brother of yours from your father. The reason for that is because all twelve sons had the same father, but Yusuf (عليه السلام) and Benjamin were from another mother.
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) was telling them about himself in order to convince them and to pass on this information to their brother so that he can come next time. Notice that he is not doing this to plot or seek revenge, everything is inspiration from Allah.
- (أَلَا تَرَوْنَ أَنِّي أُوفِي الْكَيْلَ وَأَنَا خَيْرُ الْمُنْزِلِينَ): Do you not see that I give full measure and I am the best of hosts? He is showing them that he is just since ten are present, he will give ten shares, and being the best of hosts refers to accommodating them for days while they arrived in Egypt.
- Despite praising himself, there is taqwa in his heart, it is not for pride or to show-off. Sometimes people misunderstand this and think it is ok to start praising yourself in front of others.

فَإِنْ لَّمْ تَأْتُونِي بِهِ ۖ فَلَا كَيْلَ لَكُمْ عِنْدِي وَلَا تَقْرَبُونِ (٦٠)

"But if you bring him not to me, there shall be no measure (of corn) for you with me, nor shall you come near me." (60)

- The ayah is like a condition and warning at the same time. It is very clear that if they do not bring their brother (فَإِنْ لَّمْ تَأْتُونِي بِهِ), then they will not have any measure (فَلَا كَيْلَ لَكُمْ عِنْدِي). Meaning everyone needs to present to receive the measure of food, otherwise they will not get anything.
- Look at the power that Allah granted Yusuf (عليه السلام) to be able to set conditions that they cannot find a way out. The rule cannot be broken, all must be present, otherwise no food for anyone. And the brothers were in the lower hand so they could not say anything. Subhan Allah at the reversal of roles.
- (وَلَا تَقْرُبُونِ): and do not come close to me, meaning I will not host you next time. Notice this ayah is the opposite of the previous ayah. Before he was giving measure and hosting, and now there is no measure and no hosting if the condition is not met.
- It is a difficult condition but it is in line with the situation, because the drought is a difficult situation, and the resources are limited so no exceptions can be made. The brothers are clearly desperate at this point.

(قَالُوا سَنُرَاوِدُ عَنْهُ أَبَاهُ وَإِنَّا لَفَاعِلُونَ) ٦١

They said: "We shall try to get permission (for him) from his father, and verily, we shall do it." (61)

- They are thinking how will they ask their father to take their youngest brother to another country. This is nowhere close to when they said they will take Yusuf (عليه السلام) out to play – this is taking their brother to another country.
- (قَالُوا سُرَّأَوْدُ عَنْهُ أَبَاهُ): They said we shall try to get permission from his father. The word (سُرَّأَوْدُ) was similarly used when the wife of the Aziz was trying to seduce Yusuf (عليه السلام), but it does not mean the same thing with their father.
- (سُرَّأَوْدُ): (راود) means they will try to talk and persuade, and it alludes to a bit of cheating as well. So it's not easy to try to convince their father after the incident with Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- Notice they said (أَبَاهُ) – 'his father' and not (أَبَانَا) which is 'our father'. This shows the closeness between the father and the young son. Keep in mind that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is listening to all of this, and look how Allah brought the brothers to him to show him their reality. Subhan Allah.
- (وَإِنَّا لَفَاعِلُونَ): and verily we will do it. They did not even say 'in sha Allah', it shows how certain they are, almost too confident. And it says that all of them will do it, not just one of them. This shows you that wrongdoing is usually done as a group. Their tone of speaking shows their arrogance, it shows a sickness in their hearts.
- And it shows you how Allah is so merciful, that even to this day, they are still speaking like this, and Allah has been so forbearing with them. Subhan Allah.

وَقَالَ لِفَتْنِهِ آجْعُلُوا بِضْعَتَهُمْ فِي رِحَالِهِمْ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَعْرِفُونَهَا إِذَا أُنْقَلَبُوا إِلَى أَهْلِهِمْ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْجِعُونَ
(٦٢)

And [Yûsuf (Joseph)] told his servants to put their money (with which they had bought the corn) into their bags, so that they might know it when they go back to their people, in order that they might come again. (62)

- Look at how Allah inspired Yusuf (عليه السلام) to speak in order to bring his brother. The food was given to the brothers and it was placed on their caravan. But he told them if you want food next time, then you need to bring everyone.
- Notice that the brothers could have taken the food and not bothered to come again since they already got their food, but look how Allah inspired Yusuf (عليه السلام) to make them come back.
- (وَقَالَ لِفَتْنِهِ): and he said to his servants. Notice he was a servant before and now he not only has a servant, but servants. Subhan Allah. Look at how Allah gives status to whom He wills and brings down whom He wills. Never underestimate anybody, that's why the duniya is a test.
- (آجْعُلُوا بِضْعَتَهُمْ فِي رِحَالِهِمْ): put their money (goods) back in their rides (caravan). As if they did not pay for the food they took. And you can see that both it is a kind gesture and also a way to attract them to trust him so they may return.

- (لَعَلَّهُمْ يَعْرِفُونَهَا): so that they may recognize it. So the servants should not hide it in a place they won't end up seeing it, but they should recognize it (إِذَا آنَقَلَبُوا إِلَىٰ أَهْلِهِمْ): when they return to their family. So the servants hid their goods inside the already packed food, so that when the brothers return to unpack, they will find their goods have been returned to them. And only Allah can plan like this, and Allah plans the best.
- (لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْجِعُونَ): so that they may return. As if they have been cornered. So when they go back and see their goods have been returned, they will feel how kind the Aziz is, and this can be used as an argument to convince their father to send their brother to show that the Aziz was so kind and generous to them, and so that they feel ashamed for not returning. Also, they might think that they will be accused of stealing, so they would want to go back to clear their name. Subhan Allah. Only Allah can plan like this and place all of these scenarios.
- Allah knows our nature and how we think. In the end they will return, whether it's because they thought it was a kind gesture, or feel ashamed for not returning again, or to clear their name so that they are not accused of being thieves. Subhan Allah.
- You can find so many actions of Allah in this ayah, subhan Allah. And it reveals many of the secrets of the nature of the human. So never think the stories of the Qur'an do not relate to us. The Qur'an is an open book of telling us what we are like, our faults, etc. Subhan Allah.

فَلَمَّا رَجَعُوا إِلَىٰ أَبِيهِمْ قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا مُنِعَ مِنَّا الْكَيْلُ فَأَرْسِلْ مَعَنَا آخَانَا نَكْتَلْ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ (٦٣)

So, when they returned to their father, they said: "O our father! No more measure of grain shall we get (unless we take our brother). So send our brother with us, and we shall get our measure and truly we will guard him." (63)

- **When they returned to their father** (فَلَمَّا رَجَعُوا إِلَىٰ أَبِيهِمْ)
- **They said, Oh our father** (قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا) → imagine after this long journey, and after having been blessed with having food, what did they say?
 - **Deprived from us the share of grain** (يَا أَبَانَا مُنِعَ مِنَّا الْكَيْلُ) → and this is not true, they got the share for ten people, but were deprived of one share because of the brother that is missing, but they made it a general statement that they got nothing. Subhan Allah.
 - Notice a believer always sees the good. And is grateful for any good, even if little. The more you know Allah, the more you see the good.
 - *Glimpse from hajj*: a taxi driver said that he can tell between a rich and poor person, when they want to pay, the rich person is trying to bring the price down, even if it's 10dhs, and the poor person is saying just take me to the haram, and he will give even more than the fare. Subhan Allah. So we should not be picky about these few bucks, see it as charity.

- And only in the future, they will be prevented from taking a share of grain if they do not bring their brother.
 - That's why we should always remember our past, and see that once we did not have and now we do. Alhamd Allah.
 - **So send him with us our brother, to get our share** (فَأَرْسِلْ مَعَنَا أَخَانَا نَكْتَلْ)
- notice this time they are not going around and being very wordy, they are so direct because they are desperate.
- **And truly we will protect him** (وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ) → notice they mentioned this before when plotting against Yusuf (عليه السلام). But when they said it the first time, it was only a lie, but this time they are truthful. And only Allah knows the motive behind this, despite the same words being used, subhan Allah.
 - Before their desire was to get rid of Yusuf (عليه السلام) and this time their desire is to protect their other brother. And they did not say more than this.

قَالَ هَلْ ءَامَنُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا أَمِنْتُكُمْ عَلَىٰ أَخِيهِ مِنْ قَبْلُ ۖ فَالَلَّهُ خَيْرٌ حَافِظًا ۖ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ (٦٤)

He said: "Can I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yûsuf (Joseph)] to you aforetime? But Allâh is the Best to guard, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy." (64)

- **He said (father):** (قَالَ) → notice before he said he would be sad, and then scared that the wolf would eat him, let's see how he replies now.
 - **Should I entrust him with you, as I had entrusted his brother with you from before?** (هَلْ ءَامَنُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا أَمِنْتُكُمْ عَلَىٰ أَخِيهِ مِنْ) (قَبْلُ) → he did not directly say 'I don't trust you', rather he worded it in question form to not humiliate them and because he does not want to lose his sons, subhan Allah. He was diplomatic to not lose them and said in a way for them to answer it themselves. And this makes them feel guilty, they cannot say something after this.
 - If you tell someone that you do not trust them, then you have lost that person.
 - Notice he did not say (إِخِيكُمْ), your brother, but rather (أَخِيهِ), his brother. To show that they are two separate groups. Subhan Allah.
 - **Verily Allah is the Best Protector** (فَاللَّهُ خَيْرٌ حَافِظًا) → notice his reforming that now his trust is complete in Allah. Look at how much trust he has in Allah, to give his son away to the same brothers who lose the first son, and not just to go out and play, but to go travel for months to Egypt.
 - **And He is the Most Merciful of the merciful** (وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ) → the more you trust Allah, the more your level of faith increases. If you trust yourself 50%, then you will have a chance to lose

50%. So have 100% trust in Allah and 0% trust in everything else.

- Dua'a: (يَا حَيُّ يَا قَيُّوْمُ بِرَحْمَتِكَ أَسْتَغِيْثُ ، أَصْلِحْ لِيْ شَأْنِيْ كُلَّهُ ، وَلَا تَكِلْنِيْ) (إِلَى نَفْسِي طَرْفَةً عَيْنٍ ('O Ever Living, O Self-Subsisting and Supporter of all, by Your mercy I seek assistance, rectify for me all of my affairs and do not leave me to myself, even for the blink of an eye.') → it is asking Allah to take care of everything, myself, my house, my children, my work, etc, and it have mercy on me as I start my day, to even protect me from myself.
- Our problem is that we trust ourselves even more when we have experience.
- And what two names make you trust Allah? Allah Al Hafidh (الحافظ) and Al Raheem (الرحيم).

قَالَ هَلْ ءَامَنْتُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا ءَامَنْتُمْ عَلَىٰ أَخِيهِ مِنْ قَبْلُ فَاللَّهُ خَيْرٌ حَفِظَهُ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ (٦٤)

He said: "Can I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yûsuf (Joseph)] to you aforetime? But Allâh is the Best to guard, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy." (64)

Trusting Allah:

- Some people trust other's, medicine, experience of themselves or others and there will always be a percentage of those who are

exceptions. For example, in medication maybe 1% will get side effects, so you cannot fully trust anything. And then we end up getting wiswas (excessive whispers) thinking we will be that 1%.

- We are trusting objects, computers, mobiles, etc, and we are not trusting Who is perfect, and to Him belongs everything, subhan Allah. That is why Allah does not accept any hesitance from anyone. If there are doubts, Allah will leave you, why? Because you are trusting something else together with Allah, you are putting hesitancy with Allah – this can never go together.
- When you make dua'a, you must be confident, sure, and persistent. Do not say, if you want Allah, take me to paradise.

How to build that trust?:

- Allah (خَيْرُ حَفَظًا) → Allah is the Best to guard.
- In this life, you have security guards, banks, fridge, vitamins, etc to protect and guard.
- But the One Who guards is Allah. The shaitan likes to play on our insecurity. For example, if your husband or your children are out, the shaitan will try to put a scenario in your head. And this feeling happens because there is a lack of trust in Allah, there is no yaqeen. Subhan Allah.
- And only Allah is the One Who protects, because the fridge, alarm, bank account are just means, and just as Allah is the One to enable to means to work, He can disable them as well. Subhan Allah. So do not trust the means.

- People go to a doctor after being told that he is very good and as soon as they go, he fails them. Why? Because they trusted the doctor, the mean, when they should have trusted Allah.
- When you read ayat al kursi, it protects you from the shaitan, but do you trust the words? No. You trust Allah to protect you. That is why Allah in the ayah says that He is protecting the heavens and the earth, the grand creations, so how about you?
- Don't ever think you are old enough, that you do not need protection. Everyone in this universe needs protection from Allah.
- Now we think if a person goes out without a mobile as if we have lost that person. Glimpse from Hajj: sometimes you will find that your mobile has no network or there is zero balance. There was a story of a woman at the hajj whose one of the grandfather's of her husband came from Russia to Makkah walking, and it took him 3 years, and he was an old man. SUBHAN ALLAH. And now we complain if we get tired.
- Twenty years ago, we could go out without a mobile phone and still come back home. Now, we are calling each other at every signal while driving, then where are you, near the house, where are you, parking the car. Subhan Allah.

Allah protects the religion and faith and good deeds:

- Allah protects the religion as well, sometimes you find a family all praying and one comes out atheist because they trusted the means rather than Allah. Thinking if we all pray then we are protected, but

the trust is in Allah, not the means. We cannot protect our religion, Allah is the One Who protects it.

- When Allah makes good deeds easy for you, you need to love them, and appreciate them and be thankful for them because your deeds will be attached to you – they will accompany you in your grave. Subhan Allah.
- We need to ask Allah to protect our faith. We need to say, Allah You are (الحافظ الحفيظ), protect my faith. Hadith: (يَقُولُ أَنَّهُ سَمِعَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ " إِنَّ قُلُوبَ بَنِي آدَمَ كُلَّهَا بَيْنَ إصْبَعَيْنِ مِنْ أَصَابِعِ الرَّحْمَنِ كَقَلْبٍ وَاحِدٍ يُصَرِّفُهُ حَيْثُ يَشَاءُ) (Verily, the hearts of all the sons of Adam are between the two fingers out of the fingers of the Compassionate Lord as one heart. He turns that to any (direction) He likes.)
- The hearts are between the fingers of Allah. Imagine a person can be a believer, but did not appreciate his faith, and Allah can easily take it away. Imagine if you were given a million dollar ring, you will protect it and polish it and keep it close to you. And your faith is even more precious, it is the most precious thing, and if you do not appreciate it, Allah can easily take it away and give to someone who will appreciate it. Subhan Allah.
- Even when you are doing your good deeds, you want to ask Allah to protect your good deeds because you do not want to commit a sin that will wipe out your good deeds. Hadith: (رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم قال: "أتدرون من المفلس؟" قالوا: المفلس فينا من لا درهم له ولا متاع فقال: "إن المفلس من أمتي يأتي يوم القيامة بصلاة وصيام وزكاة، ويأتي قد شتم هذا، وقذف هذا وأكل مال هذا، وسفك دم هذا، وضرب هذا، فيعطى هذا من حسناته، وهذا من حسناته، فإن فنيت حسناته قبل أن يقضي ما عليه، أخذ من خطاياهم فطرحت

(صلى الله عليه وسلم) (Messenger of Allah) said, "Do you know who is the bankrupt?" They said: "The bankrupt among us is one who has neither money with him nor any property". He said, "The real bankrupt of my Ummah would be he who would come on the Day of Resurrection with Salat, Saum and Sadaqah (charity), (but he will find himself bankrupt on that day as he will have exhausted the good deeds) because he reviled others, brought calumny against others, unlawfully devoured the wealth of others, shed the blood of others and beat others; so his good deeds would be credited to the account of those (who suffered at his hand). If his good deeds fall short to clear the account, their sins would be entered in his account and he would be thrown in the (Hell) Fire".) – Muslim.

- And there is the parable of the tornado, you have a beautiful, bountiful garden, and a tornado comes and rips it and destroys it.

Allah protects the love between us:

- The love that we have for each other for the sake of Allah, we also need to ask Allah to protect it. Also for the love between husband and wife, do not think that because you are doing something that the love is there. You need to ask Allah to protect it, because you can find husbands and wives who have become enemies. We ask Allah to protect us. Ameen.
- If you have so much trust in Allah, even if the heavens fall to the earth, Allah will provide for you to get out. Subhan Allah. You need to have complete trust in Allah, and when you have that trust, you will have the peace and tranquility and always think good about Allah.

- Now with so much advanced technology, we see more complications. It's not your money, fame, status, will protect you, it is only the power and strength of Allah.

قَالَ هَلْ ءَامَنُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا أَمِنْتُكُمْ عَلَىٰ أَخِيهِ مِنْ قَبْلُ ۖ فَاللَّهُ خَيْرٌ حَفِظًا ۖ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ

(٦٤)

He said: "Can I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yûsuf (Joseph)] to you aforetime? But Allâh is the Best to guard, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy." (64)

Allah is the Best Guardian (اللَّهُ خَيْرٌ حَفِظًا):

- Most of the time, we are being protected by Allah from accidents. Look at how much protection we need, and we must believe that only Allah can protect your family, wealth, heart, memory, knowledge, faith, prayer, etc.
- When we do not know Allah, there is no clarity, and subhan Allah, when we know about Allah, then we see that all along it was just means we were using, and we should have not trust in the means, but in Allah is the Protector.
- Some people are over-protective of their children, and they start to panic, and this is a sickness. But that is why we ask Allah to teach us and our children that Allah is the One Who protects.
- Many people get nervous to send their children to go to fajr prayer, but the hadith says: (مَنْ صَلَّى الصُّبْحَ فَهُوَ فِي ذِمَّةِ اللَّهِ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ)

(He who prayed the morning prayer (in congregation) he is in fact under the protection of Allah) – Sahih Muslim. Protection from Allah from bad companions, accidents, etc. subhan Allah. So you live a worry-free life.

- In order to get the protection from Allah, you need to guard yourself from falling into sin – falling into the displeasure of Allah. Just as there is protection, there are different levels of protection subhan Allah.
 - For certain people, who know about Allah, and they are guarding themselves from sins and from the displeasure of Allah, there is a different type of protection. For example the prayer of fajr or ayat al kursi. We have to make the first step, and look how Allah completes. So why are you scared to come forward?
 - If your self is weak, then seek help from Allah. If it's from the shaitan, then seek refuge in Allah from the shaitan. Some people want to go forward, but they are being held back by others.
 - Sometimes people are pressuring you to backbite or gossip, but you don't want to, then Allah will give you protection. Similarly, you want to lower your gaze and do not want to look at something indecent, and alhamd Allah, Allah gave us the instinct to know when something is indecent. And when you protect your eyes, Allah will protect you. Same with your feet, you protect your feet from going to haram places and Allah will protect you.

- And Allah will not only protect you, but your offspring after you, subhan Allah. Either Allah is protecting them from poverty, from misguidance. For a woman, if she protects herself, then Allah will protect her offspring.
- In the time of ease, come forward and know Allah, and Allah will know you and protect you in times of difficulty.
- Yunus (عليه السلام) was inside the whale, and imagine the whale did not eat him, even though a whale by nature wants to eat, so look how Allah protected him. Allah disabled the means, subhan Allah. And imagine being in darkness for forty days, and Allah inspired him to say a dua'a: (لا اله الا انت سبحانك اني كنت من الظالمين) (There is no god but You, glory be to You, verily I am of the wrongdoers) – this will give you immediate relief, but you must believe in it.
- Yunus (عليه السلام) kept saying this dua'a, and he was crying and invoking. The angels could hear his cry and invocation, but they did not know where he was, subhan Allah. This shows you that only Allah knows where you might be, only Allah can protect you. Our problem is that we deal with Allah with lack of confidence, there are doubts. But there should be no doubts.
- Yunus (عليه السلام) then came out with a skin ailment, and a 'wild pumpkin' tree was grown for him to heal his skin. Subhan Allah. Surah Al Saffat 146: (وَأَنْبَتْنَا عَلَيْهِ شَجَرَةً مِّنْ يَّقْطِينٍ) (And We caused a plant of gourd to grow over him.)
- Allah protected Yusuf (عليه السلام) more than his father, because the protection of his father would have been harmful, subhan Allah.

He is the Most Merciful of the merciful (وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ):

- If someone asks you about Allah, Allah is the Most Compassionate, Most Merciful – perfect in His mercy.
- Surah Ghafir 7: (رَبَّنَا وَسِعْتَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ رَّحْمَةً وَعِلْمًا) ("Our Lord! You comprehend all things in mercy and knowledge,)
- Allah knows about every leaf, every drop of rain, everything, and if Allah knows about it, then it is encompassed with mercy. Allah knows about you, knows what's in your heart, and because Allah knows about you, He will show you mercy.
- Allah is the Owner of True Mercy and He is Rich in Mercy. Some people are merciful to their children, but spoil them and let them do what they want, and some people are merciful by being harsh, thinking they are taking care of them. But Allah's mercy is perfect and it suits you exactly.
- Allah will not make anyone go through anything in life without preparing him, and one of these preparations is mercy. Before Allah will make you teach the people, or be a mother or a wife, He will give you mercy.
- Surah Al An'am 133: (وَرَبُّكَ الْغَنِيُّ ذُو الرَّحْمَةِ) (And your Lord is Rich (Free of all wants), full of Mercy)
- Sometimes richness can make a person very harsh, and stern towards others. Or people can be full of wealth, but buying things that are harmful, like drugs and alcohol, so where is the mercy with this wealth? That is why only Allah is the True Owner of Richness and Mercy.

- Sometimes criminals are forsaken by society, but who is the only One Who will stretch forth His hands to the most wicked? Only Allah, as long as that person repents and returns to Allah. Subhan Allah.
- Hadith: أبي سعيد سعد بن مالك بن سنان الخدري رضي الله عنه أن نبي الله صلى الله عليه وسلم قال: (كان فيمن كان قبلكم رجل قتل تسعة وتسعين نفساً، فسأل عن أعلم أهل الأرض، فدل على راهب، فأتاه فقال: إنه قتل تسعة وتسعين نفساً، فهل له من توبة؟ فقال: لا، فقتله فكمّل به مائة، ثم سأل عن أعلم أهل الأرض، فدل على رجل عالم فقال: إنه قتل مائة نفس فهل له من توبة؟ فقال: نعم، ومن يحول بينه وبين التوبة؟ انطلق إلى أرض كذا وكذا، فإن بها أناساً يعبدون الله تعالى فاعبد الله معهم، ولا ترجع إلى أرضك فإنها أرض سوء، فانطلق حتى إذا نصف الطريق أتاه الموت، فاختصمت فيه ملائكة الرحمة وملائكة العذاب. فقالت ملائكة الرحمة: جاء تائباً مقبلاً بقلبه إلى الله تعالى، وقالت ملائكة العذاب: إنه لم يعمل خيراً قط، فأتاهم ملك في صورة آدمي فجعلوه بينهم- أي حكماً- فقال: قيسوا ما بين الأرضين فإلى أيتهما كان أدنى فهو له، ((متفق عليه)) (Prophet of Allah (ﷺ) said: "There was a man from among a nation before you who killed ninety-nine people and then made an inquiry about the most learned person on the earth. He was directed to a monk. He came to him and told him that he had killed ninety-nine people and asked him if there was any chance for his repentance to be accepted. He replied in the negative and the man killed him also completing one hundred. He then asked about the most learned man in the earth. He was directed to a scholar. He told him that he had killed one hundred people and asked him if there was any chance for his repentance to be accepted. He replied in the affirmative and asked, 'Who stands between you and repentance? Go to such and such land; there (you will find) people devoted to prayer and worship of Allah, join them in worship, and do not come back to your land because it is an evil place.' So he went away and hardly had he covered half the

distance when death overtook him; and there was a dispute between the angels of mercy and the angels of torment. The angels of mercy pleaded, 'This man has come with a repenting heart to Allah,' and the angels of punishment argued, 'He never did a virtuous deed in his life.' Then there appeared another angel in the form of a human being and the contending angels agreed to make him arbiter between them. He said, 'Measure the distance between the two lands. He will be considered belonging to the land to which he is nearer.' They measured and found him closer to the land (land of piety) where he intended to go, and so the angels of mercy collected his soul".

[Al-Bukhari and Muslim].

In another version: "He was found to be nearer to the locality of the pious by a cubit and was thus included among them". Another version says: "Allah commanded (the land which he wanted to leave) to move away and commanded the other land (his destination) to draw nearer and then He said: "Now measure the distance between them.' It was found that he was nearer to his goal by a hand's span and was thus forgiven". It is also narrated that he drew closer by a slight movement on his chest.)

- This shows you that angels don't know what's in the people's hearts, only Allah.
- Surah Al An'am 54: (كَتَبَ رَبُّكُمْ عَلَىٰ نَفْسِهِ الرَّحْمَةَ) (your Lord has written (prescribed) Mercy for Himself,)
- Allah obliged upon Himself mercy, Allah wrote upon Himself mercy, subhan Allah. Allah's mercy precedes His anger. Allah is always

merciful, but He is not always angry. Subhan Allah. Anger is not one of the names of Allah, it is a restricted attribute of Allah, only when there is something that warrants it, but Allah is always merciful. Subhan Allah.

- And to be merciful is a gift from Allah, you cannot take a mercy tablet ☺, Allah is the source of all mercy.
- Hadith: (فَقَالَ لَنَا النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " أَتَرَوْنَ هَذِهِ طَارِحَةً وَلَدَهَا فِي النَّارِ ". قُلْنَا لَا وَهِيَ تَقْدِرُ) (the Prophet said to us, "Do you think that this lady can throw her son in the fire?" We replied, "No, if she has the power not to throw it (in the fire).") The Prophet then said, "Allah is more merciful to His slaves than this lady to her son.") – Al Bukhari
- Allah does not want us to be in hellfire, but it is ourselves who wrong ourselves and do not show mercy to ourselves when we sin – that leads us to the hellfire. Subhan Allah.

Mercy of Allah (ﷻ):

- No one is merciful like Allah (ﷻ), if you take all of the mercy in this life, from humans and animals, it is nothing compared to the mercy of Allah.
- Hadith: (قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " إِنَّ لِلَّهِ مِائَةَ رَحْمَةٍ فَمِنْهَا رَحْمَةٌ بِهَا يَتَرَحَّمُ) (Salman Farisi reported Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him) as saying: Verily, there are one hundred (parts of) mercy for Allah, and it is one part of this mercy by

virtue of which there is mutual love between the people and ninety-nine reserved for the Day of Resurrection) – Sahih Muslim.

- Mercy is made of 100 parts, and Allah held 99 parts of this mercy, and sent one part to the earth. So whatever mercy you see on this earth is only 1%, subhan Allah. And Allah (ﷻ) kept the remaining 99 for the Day of Judgement.
- Imagine this 1% of mercy has been distributed to everyone, and not everyone receives the same amount of mercy, it depends on how much you need, and this is a provision from Allah (ﷻ). For example, if you have disabled children, Allah will give you more mercy. If we had more than 1% of mercy on this earth, we will die, we will not be able to handle it. Subhan Allah.
- Only 1% is needed for life on this earth, and 99% is preserved for the Day of Judgement, that is how much mercy we need on that Day. Paradise is a mercy from Allah. Subhan Allah.
- When Allah (ﷻ) blew the soul of Adam (عليه السلام), the first thing Adam said is 'alhamd Allah' (الحمد لله) after sneezing, and the first word he heard 'May Allah have mercy on you' (يرحمك الله).
- But the problem is that people deprive themselves from mercy because of doing haram things. There are some haram things that when done Allah (ﷻ) curses those people. And to be cursed by Allah (ﷻ) is to be deprived of His mercy. Some of these things include plucking the eyebrows, and hair extensions.

- Allah (ﷻ) does not want to hurt us or punish us, He only commands us for what is best for us. And when He says that it is haram, it means that it is harmful for us. And no one wants to be deprived of mercy, especially on the Day of Judgement, when the mercy will only come from Allah (ﷻ).

Surah Yusuf Ayat 65

وَلَمَّا فَتَحُوا مَتَاعَهُمْ وَجَدُوا بِضَاعَتَهُمْ رُدَّتْ إِلَيْهِمْ قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا مَا نَبْغِي هَذِهِ بِضَاعَتُنَا رُدَّتْ إِلَيْنَا وَنَمِيرُ أَهْلَنَا وَنَحْفَظُ أَخَانَا وَنَزِدَادُ كَيْلَ بَعِيرٍ ذَٰلِكَ كَيْلٌ يَسِيرٌ (٦٥)

And when they opened their bags, they found their money had been returned to them. They said: "O our father! What (more) can we desire? This, our money has been returned to us, so we shall get (more) food for our family, and we shall guard our brother and add one more measure of a camel's load. This quantity is easy (for the king to give)." (65)

When they opened their baggage (وَلَمَّا فَتَحُوا مَتَاعَهُمْ):

- (متاع): is anything you benefit from, is pleasurable, and have a desire for it. They got their baggage from Egypt. What did they find?

They found their merchandise returned to them (وَجَدُوا بِضَاعَتَهُمْ رُدَّتْ إِلَيْهِمْ):

- This merchandise was used to purchase the food they needed. Then Yusuf (عليه السلام) told his servants to return his brothers' merchandise to them. And to hide it in a way that they will not see it until they unpack.
- And subhan Allah look at the decree of Allah (ﷻ) because that merchandise must be big and a lot, but it was hidden from them.
- So when they reached and saw the merchandise returned to them:
 - They realized that they received this food for free (الطعام بلا مقابل),
 - That it was planned and intentionally returned to them by Yusuf (عليه السلام) (در البضاعة بقصد من يوسف عليه السلام).
 - It shows how gentle Yusuf (عليه السلام) was and that he acts with ihsan (احسان يوسف عليه السلام). Imagine if someone gives you something for free, you would feel embarrassed to take it, imagine getting something for free without even knowing, it's just placed in your bag.
- This shows you that this is the plan of Allah (ﷻ) because it gives them a reason to return with all of the brothers, and that is what Yusuf (عليه السلام) wanted – for them to return again.

They said 'Oh our father' (قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا):

- Notice that despite their old, adult age, they will still call their father 'Oh our father', but this shows you it is a truthful calling of their father, unlike when they were younger and said 'Oh our father' in order to lie and get rid of Yusuf (عليه السلام).

- They are really sincere in telling their father, 'what other choice do they have but to return?' - especially after someone has treated them so kindly.

What more can we ask for (مَا تَبْغِيْ هٰذِهِ):

- After this kindness and generosity of Yusuf (عليه السلام), they have to return, and this gives you a tip when dealing in business. When you want to attract customers and make them return, you have to give free samples, offer promotions etc.
- Also when dealing with people, the buyer should be easy and the seller should be easy. Don't fuss over 10 dhs even 100 dhs, because it is just duniya.

Arguments used to convince the father to take their younger brother

(1) Our merchandise was returned to us (بِضَاعُنَا رُدَّتْ اِلَيْنَا):

- They received 10 camel loads of food, and on top of that they were returned the merchandise that was given to them.

(2) And to bring the food to our family (وَنَمِيْرُ اَهْلَانَا):

- (مَار): means to bring essential food. This includes wheat, rice, sugar.
- And the brothers are saying that even our families have now been benefited from this food. They are saying this to convince their father to take their younger brother, but they are being truthful this time.

(3) We will protect our brother (وَنَحْفَظُ اَخَانَا):

- Notice this time they did not mention to protect their brother from the start. Instead they presented other points to their father, and then finally to protect 'our brother' – they are genuine this time.
- Also (وَنَحْفَظُ) is a verb which shows less intensity than a noun, a noun was used when convincing to take Yusuf (عليه السلام), (و انا لحافظون).

(4) And we will increase a measure of a camel-load (وَنَزِدَادُ كَيْلَ بَعِيرٍ):

- And finally they are saying that we will benefit even more since we will receive an extra measure of a camel-load of food since their brother will be with them now.

And this is an easy profit (ذَلِكَ كَيْلٌ يَسِيرٌ):

- They are telling their father that it will be ok, there is no harm because we are dealing with a generous and honest person. Also Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not make a difficult request, it's a fair request to get the complete load according to all of the members present.
- And also, it will be easy to get that extra measure because already we managed to get 10 loads plus our merchandise returned to us.
- It is clear that their intention is not to do bad or lie – they are honest.

قَالَ لَنْ أُرْسِلَهُ مَعَكُمْ حَتَّى تُؤْتُونِ مَوْثِقًا مِّنَ اللَّهِ لَتَأْتِنَنِي بِهِ إِلَّا أَن يُحَاطَ بِكُمْ فَلَمَّا ءَاتَوْهُ

مَوْثِقَهُمْ قَالَ اللَّهُ عَلَىٰ مَا نَقُولُ وَكِيلٌ (٦٦)

He [Ya'qûb (Jacob)] said: "I will not send him with you until you swear a solemn oath to me in Allâh's Name, that you will bring him back to me

unless you are yourselves surrounded (by enemies)," And when they had sworn their solemn oath, he said: "Allâh is the Witness over what we have said." (66)

- Here we see in this ayah that we learn from our mistakes. Previously, Yaqoub (عليه السلام) sent Yusuf (عليه السلام) with his brothers, and he trusted them, but they betrayed him. And now he's being tested again. Someone in a similar situation could have easily said I will never send him with you again. But it's not about closing the door, it's about learning from your mistake. Let us see the reaction of Yaqoub (عليه السلام).

He said I will not send him with you, until you swear an oath to me in Allah's name (قَالَ لَنْ أُرْسِلَهُ مَعَكُمْ حَتَّى تُؤْتُونِ مَوْثِقًا مِّنَ اللَّهِ):

- Imagine that between the father and son, an oath needs to be made. And this shows us that even when dealing with family, we need to have something in writing in terms of business between each other, etc.
- From the word (وثق) it means 'to record everything' and (ميثاق) is a 'heavy covenant'. As if he wants to make it very official, even though it is from father to son. He lost one son and now he does not trust them, so he wants a covenant from Allah. How do you get a covenant from Allah? When you swear to Allah (ﷻ). That is why it is very heavy. Sometimes people just say, 'wallah' and take it very lightly.
- That is why you need to hold the rope from the middle – meaning don't be restrictive or too easy either. And you see that Yqcoub (عليه السلام)

(السلام) was not selfish, because he could have not sent his son and deprived the rest of his family from receiving the food provision, and on the other hand, he was not easy going about it either. He was just because he just wanted an oath this time. So he took the means and had full trust in Allah, subhan Allah.

- And he knows that his sons would not lie against Allah (ﷻ). Though they might have done wrong in the past, but not to the level of lying against Allah (ﷻ). Keep in mind they are the sons of a messenger as well.

That you will bring him back to me (إِنِّي آتِنِّي بِهِ):

- So this shows you that the fulfillment of the oath is to bring back his son Binyamin, Benjamin.

Except if you are surrounded (إِلَّا أَنْ يُحَاطَ بِكُمْ):

- Yacoub (عليه السلام) is giving conditions in which the oath cannot be fulfilled, then they are not liable, which is if they are surrounded. Meaning to be surrounded by an obstacle, and this is open to anything that leaves you without a choice or exit. So it means they need to try their best to bring him back.
- Look at the middle path Yaqoub (عليه السلام) took. Sometimes things happen that are not under our control, obstacles like extreme weather, falling sick, etc. So this shows you to not be too hard on the people, you need to be practical, because things that are out of our control can happen.

- And he was just again because he told them this from the start because he could have easily kept it to himself and then told them later.

And when they had given him their oath, he said: "Allâh is the Witness over what we have said (فَلَمَّا ءَاتَوْهُ مَوْثِقَهُمْ قَالَ اللَّهُ عَلَىٰ مَا نَقُولُ وَكِيلٌ):

- Now that they have made their oath, Allah is Al Wakil, He is the One Witnessing, Protector, Trustee, Guardian of their oath. That is why it is the best name for a covenant. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is trusting Allah Al Wakil to bring back his son, but he is taking the means.
- When we make a verbal oath, our words are not being registered at some notary, but rather they are being registered by Allah Al Wakil, subhan Allah. They rely on Allah (ﷻ) and are trusting Him, and that is sufficient for them. They cannot accept anyone else to be more sufficient than Allah Al Wakil.

وَقَالَ يَبْنَى لَا تَدْخُلُوا مِنْ بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ وَادْخُلُوا مِنْ أَبْوَابٍ مُتَفَرِّقَةٍ وَمَا أُغْنِي عَنْكُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ
إِنِ الْحُكْمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ عَلَيْهِ تَوَكَّلْتُ وَعَلَيْهِ فَلْيَتَوَكَّلِ الْمُتَوَكِّلُونَ (٦٧)

And he said: "O my sons! Do not enter by one gate, but enter by different gates, and I cannot avail you against Allâh at all. Verily! The decision rests only with Allâh. In him, I put my trust and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him." (67)

And he said to his sons, do not enter from a single date (وَقَالَ يَبْنَى لَا تَدْخُلُوا مِنْ بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ):

- And it is said that all of the sons of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) were tall and handsome. He had twelve sons, Yusuf (عليه السلام) is not with them, so eleven of them all together. Their presence will not go unnoticed, and Yacoub (عليه السلام) is also thinking about himself that people might envy who is the father that has all of these good-looking sons?
- Sometimes even the parents can be envious of their children, they might say 'oh how wonderful' and then something happens to the child. Or sometimes we look at ourselves and admire ourselves, and then something happens. Or we say we haven't fallen sick for some time, and istaghfar Allah the next day we fall sick.
- So don't show the blessing especially if you are not sure of the surrounding. And at the same time, Yacoub (عليه السلام) was not overprotective to the point that he did not allow them to go. But he was taking the means.
- Also the evil eye is haqq, it is a reality/truth. When a person sees something that they admire, they need to remember Allah, should say, (Barak Allah), because if Allah (ﷻ) is not remembered, then the shaitan will come and he will harm the person. Subhan Allah.
- Notice the tenderness of Yacoub (عليه السلام), after all they have done, he still says (يَبْنِيَّ).
- During that time, Egypt was considered more advanced, since you had the 'ladies of the city' and they are probably not used to having so many children, unlike Bedouins, as the family of Yacoub (عليه السلام) were. Similar to how it is today, if you go the west and tell them you have 11 children it would be a shocker.

- And not to enter from a single gate in order not to attract too much attention.

And enter from different gates (وَادْخُلُوا مِنْ أَبْوَابٍ مُتَفَرِّقَةٍ):

- Reasons to enter from different gates:
 - Multitude, many of them (كثرتهم)
 - Attractive appearance (بهاء منظرهم)
 - Sons all from one father (ابناء رجل واحد)
- Anyone who has a blessing will have someone envious of him.
- Hadith: (لَا تُصَاحِبْ إِلَّا مُؤْمِنًا وَلَا يَأْكُلْ طَعَامَكَ إِلَّا تَقِيٌّ "رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ) ("Do not accompany except a believer, and do not serve your food except to one with Taqwa."(Sahih)) – A person who does not have taqwa will have no restrictions and will expose your secrets. The house is filled with secrets. If a person is envious and you make them enter your house, it can make them even more envious and upset if they see what you have or what kind of relations you have with your family. May Allah (ﷻ) protect us and be our Guardian. Ameen.
- At the same time, don't be paranoid to the point where you don't invite anyone, and wear bad clothes and not wear jewelry, etc. You have to be balanced. We ask Allah (ﷻ) for the guidance. Ameen.
- Even with dreams, share it with someone you love, not with someone who can't stand you or is jealous of you. Yacoub (عليه السلام) knows the sons and told Yusuf (عليه السلام) not to tell his dream to his own brothers.

- It is said that Yacoub (عليه السلام) also wanted them to go through different doors in order to explore different areas to see if Yousef (عليه السلام) is there. Yacoub (عليه السلام) had the feeling that Yousef (عليه السلام) might be in Egypt.
- Also as a troop of men entering, it might attract attention and raise suspicion since they are foreigners in Egypt.
- We are supposed to take the means, but have no hope in them, and full trust in Allah (ﷻ). The problem with us is that we are desperate to take the means and see them work, but we should not have hope because anything can happen. The opposite is true, we cannot just say I leave it up to Allah (ﷻ) and not take any means either, this is extreme. The balanced way is have trust in Allah and take the means.
- Notice that ten of the brothers had already gone to Egypt before when they got the first load of food, but Yacoub (عليه السلام) did not advise them of these means before. Why? Because perhaps that thought didn't come to him before, but know he is remembering. And alhamd Allah, Allah protected them the first time. And Allah (ﷻ) reminds you to take the means, but not be attached to it.
- Sometimes you don't make a dua'a for a certain matter and Allah (ﷻ) is protecting you, until a thought comes to you, and this is from Allah (ﷻ) to remind you to make a dua'a.
- Dua'a: إِنَّ أَبَاكُمْ كَانَ يُعَوِّذُ بِهَا إِسْمَاعِيلَ "كَانَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يُعَوِّذُ الْحَسَنَ وَالْحُسَيْنَ وَيَقُولُ ("وَإِسْحَاقَ، أَعُوذُ بِكَلِمَاتِ اللَّهِ التَّامَّةِ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْطَانٍ وَهَامَّةٍ، وَمِنْ كُلِّ عَيْنٍ لَامَّةٍ (The Prophet used to seek Refuge with Allah for Al-Hasan and Al-Husain and say: "Your

forefather (i.e. Abraham) used to seek Refuge with Allah for Ishmael and Isaac by reciting the following: 'O Allah! I seek Refuge with Your Perfect Words from every devil and from poisonous pests and from every evil, harmful, envious eye.'") - Al Bukhari

- Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) used to make this ruqyah for Hasan and Hussein, and this dua'a was originally said by Ibrahim (عليه السلام) to his sons Ishmael (عليه السلام) and Issac (عليه السلام).

Real tawakul – true reliance:

- Real tawakul does not come until you have complete trust in Allah (ﷻ), and that trust comes with faith. Suhhan Allah. And the guarantee comes from all that is mentioned in the Qur'an. Moderation is tawakul – that is the middle path. You take the means and have tawakul. You cannot take the means without tawakul. And you cannot make tawakul without taking any means. Subhan Allah.
- So Yaqoub (عليه السلام) told his sons to enter from different gates and that is taking the means, and notice what he said afterward, because that is important.

And I cannot avail you against Allah from anything (وَمَا أُغْنِي عَنْكُمْ مِّنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ)

: (إِسْحَاقُ)

- Yacoub (عليه السلام) is saying that I am taking the means, but there is nothing to stop Allah's decree to prevail. So do not put any trust or hope in the means – you take them, but put your trust is in Allah (ﷻ).
- (وَمَا) : this is to negate, not.

- (غني): is to be sufficient (كفى). So when we put it together, it means 'I am not sufficient for you'.
- It means I will not benefit (ما ينفع), I will be of no use (يجدي), I cannot avert (ما دفع), I cannot make it far (ابعد ونحي).
- For example, when you advise someone to take medicine, tell them it is just a means and that the cure is with Allah (ﷻ). This is to make them attached to Allah (ﷻ). You can't say this is good for you, it worked for me – say Allah (ﷻ) cured me. You truly need to feel poor. Take the means and lose hope from the means, you really need to feel like you are zero. Subhan Allah.
- (مَنْ أَلَّهِ): From Allah. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is saying how can I stop anything from what Allah wants? Subhan Allah. Maybe I want something, and Allah wants something else and there is nothing to stop it, this is the decree of Allah (ﷻ). And many times we think we need to fight the decree. For example, we fall sick and think we need to fight the battle, we need to battle the decree, but actually we need to battle ourselves to attach to Allah (ﷻ) and be patient. Even when we have a problem with somebody, we say we need to fight them and show that we are brave, but the real fight is to fight yourself, and to have taqwa, and hold yourself from doing something wrong, and exceeding your boundaries. If you want to fight, fight yourself and the shaitan.

- Imagine how can someone with sicknesses of the heart enter paradise? Which is pure and where you will see Allah, subhan Allah. It's not possible.
- People think they can do anything they want, but they can only do things by the will of Allah (ﷻ). Imagine if anything you wanted, was 'be and it is'.. how many firaouns would be in this life? Subhan Allah. Allah (ﷻ) wants to show us that you cannot do anything without the decree of Allah, and that is good for us. In paradise, you can get whatever you want because you are perfect there. But now we are not perfect. In this life, we are not perfect. Subhan Allah.
- How can you apply this part of the ayah in your life? Allah (ﷻ) wants us to feel poor, even if we are the richest the person. Everyone is misguided until Allah (ﷻ) guides us. Subhan Allah.
- When we are healthy we read our dhikr, but when we are sick we read it with such intensity. And this is true when we feel rich and self-sufficient, we take our worship lightly.
- The one who is rich and grateful is better than one who is poor and patient. Because the poor person has no choice but to be patient, whereas the rich person has decided to be grateful rather than ungrateful, and that is a greater test. Subhan Allah.
- With the means it tests our faith. When we have all the means, then it lowers our faith, and when we don't have the means, we are more attached to Allah (ﷻ) and stronger in faith. But this does not mean that we do not take the means. It means we take it, even though we

hate it, because it is very easy to not take the means. It's not easy to take the means and lose hope in them, but we ask Allah (ﷻ) to make it easy. Ameen. Human beings rely and trust more what is tangible and can be seen, but the test is to trust Allah (ﷻ) alone. Subhan Allah.

- In the Qur'an, we see examples where all the means were given but they had full trust in Allah (ﷻ) and were grateful, for example Dawud and Suleiman (عليه السلام), and Dhul Qurnayn. And unlike Qarun who was given the means but was a disbeliever.

Verily the ruling is with Allah alone (إِنَّ الْحُكْمَ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ):

- And this shows you that the decree, the command, is all with Allah (ﷻ). The decision is with Allah (ﷻ). And this shows you (لا اله الا الله).
- Yaqoub (عليه السلام) told them to take the means and enter from different doors, but it doesn't mean that nothing bad will happen to them. It just shows you to put your trust in Allah (ﷻ).
- Every single step in your life is decided, decreed by Allah (ﷻ). The decree is His decree and the command is His command (القضاء قضاؤه). Subhan Allah.
- Our requirement is (وما خلقت الجن والانس الا ليعبدون) (And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship (Me)) and (اياك نعبد و اياك نستعين) (You alone we worship and You alone we seek Your help) –

besides that don't worry about other people's business. Our problem is that we cross our boundaries.

- And whatever Allah (ﷻ) decrees for me, then I am pleased and trust Him. And I have to remember that Allah (ﷻ) is the Most Merciful, He does not want to make my life miserable. And Allah is More Merciful than my own mother, subhan Allah.
- Many people do not accept the rules of Allah (ﷻ) because they forget that Allah is The Most Merciful and that He is protecting you. Subhan Allah.
- The muttawakil is like a dead person in ghusl, he does not go against what is being done to him. Meaning a person does not go against what Allah (ﷻ) has decreed. That is why the muttawakleen have freedom like the birds. They are not worried. Unlike others who are chained and do not have their freedom, they are chained to the means.
- Hadith: سمعت رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم يقول : "لو أنكم تتوكلون على الله حق توكله (I heard Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) saying: "If you all depend on Allah with due reliance, He would certainly give you provision as He gives it to birds who go forth hungry in the morning and return with full belly at dusk".[At-Tirmidhi].)
- When you see the birds remember the tawakul and the freedom they have.

- Imagine if a bird is caged, then of course he will be tense because he does not know if someone will forget to feed him. But when he is out, he has freedom and knows he will get his food, because they have full tawakul in Allah (ﷻ).
- And to have this tawakul in this life, will make you fly to paradise, that is why they are the 70,000 that are first to enter paradise with no reckoning or punishment.
- ***Think about it, Allah (ﷻ) is taking care of the big affairs like the sun rising every day, the oxygen being available, gravity around us, etc. So if you trust Allah (ﷻ) to take care of the big universal affairs, then why do not trust Allah (ﷻ) with your smaller affairs???? Subhan Allah.***

Nobody enriches except Allah (لا يغيث الا الله) + There is no judgement

except Allah (لا حكم الا الله) = TAWAKUL (التوكل)

Real tawakul – true reliance:

- Notice that Yacoub (عليه السلام) took the means first and then he ended with having tawakul on Allah (ﷻ). And this is telling us how we should preach and advise the people when telling them about tawakul. People like the means because they are tangible, so start with it, but then tell them that you only rely and trust in Allah.

And upon Him let all those put (وَعَلَيْهِ فَلْيَتَوَكَّلِ الْمُتَوَكِّلُونَ):

- Notice that the 'lam' in (فَلْيَتَوَكَّلْ) is to command, but in a very gentle manner.
- (مُتَوَكِّلُونَ): those who have trust and this includes all of the people, regardless of who they are, because all people love to trust in something, be it Allah or not. It is part of our nature to put our trust in something.
- Because we have this inborn nature, we should use it to attach to Allah (ﷻ). Allah (ﷻ) wants worship, trust, reliance, and attachment from you because all of these are inborn qualities in you.
- Allah (ﷻ) gave you this inborn quality so that you use it to attach to the Most worthy. Subhan Allah. That is why knowledge is a shortcut to paradise, it is better to be nurtured through knowledge than through experience. Subhan Allah.
- Allah (ﷻ) wants you to learn about tawakul because it is your test. And if you do not learn this lesson, then He will make you experience it through feeling pain. When you attach to something besides Allah (ﷻ) then Allah will make it fail and fall before your very eyes. This is the way of Allah. Why? Because He knows if He does not make it fail in front of you, then you will stay attached to it. Subhan Allah. So this is a mercy of Allah (ﷻ). Allah really loves you more than anyone and He cares about you more than anybody. Of course He does not want you to lead a miserable life and to be a slave to something else other than Him (ﷻ). Subhan Allah.

- People get attached to their job, their desires, and they put this first before Allah, istaghfar Allah. And if they happen to have spare time, then they will give it to Allah (ﷻ), istaghfar Allah.
- Since you have the inborn quality of being a mutawakkal, of being attached to something, then attach yourself to the best, attach yourself to Allah (ﷻ).
- Because anything else will cause you disappoint, Allah (ﷻ) will never let you down.
- People rely on their phone, their car, etc – they feel if they have it, then they're fine, istaghfar Allah.
- While in the womb, before the soul enters the womb, there is already a heart. Everything is about our heart, while we are sitting, while we are reading, where is your heart? Your heart will determine your place in the hereafter. That is why the heart is the place of the love and magnification of Allah alone. Subhan Allah.
- Sometimes people think that tawakul is an abstract concept, I don't know how to do tawakul. But it is already there by default, our problem is that we are channeling it to something besides Allah (ﷻ), so now direct it to Allah, subhan Allah.
- The secret to tawakul is to:
 - Rely on Allah
 - Trust Allah
 - Take the means and don't rely on the them

- Must take the means: There were a group of pilgrims who came from far, and the Prophet Mohammed ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) said did you take any provision? They said no, we are mutwakileen. He said this is wrong, you need to take the means and have tawakul on Allah. Because if you don't take the means then that negates tawakul. It is easy to just say I put my trust in Allah and not take any means. The middle path is to take the means and have tawakul in Allah.
- Take the means even they are small means: For example, Maryam was about to give birth, and Allah (ﷻ) inspired her to go outside the city and go near the palm tree. Imagine after giving birth, despite Jesus (عليه السلام) was born without means, but she still had to take the means to eat the dates by shaking the trunk. Surah Maryam 25: (وَهَزَىٰ) (إِلَيْكَ بِجِدْعِ النَّخْلَةِ تُسْقِطُ عَلَيْكَ رَطْبًا جَنِيًّا) ("And shake the trunk of date-palm towards you, it will let fall fresh ripe-dates upon you."). And this shows you that Jesus (عليه السلام) was born in the summer because the fresh dates, (رطب) appear in the summer. He is not born in the winter. Subhan Allah. Allah (ﷻ) is teaching us even when we are in a weak state, we should still take the means, little as they may be. Or for example, the story of Ibrahim (عليه السلام) in which he had his two children at a late age, and there is wisdom behind that so that his children are not born in a disbeliever land. And imagine after having his first child Ismael (عليه السلام) at an old age, he is told to place him and his wife in the desert. What a test! Imagine if you did not have a house all your life, and finally you get a house at an old age, and then you

are told you have to give it to charity! Can you do this? That is why the Qur'an is giving us the best of examples and stories, nothing is above it, story of Ibrahim (عليه السلام), Yusuf (عليه السلام), Maryam, Jesus (عليه السلام), etc. Subhan Allah, so this shows to aim high and at the same time, we are told of the worst people, like Firaoun and Qaroon. So the Qur'an is showing us the best and worst examples, and we are in the middle and it is motivating us to aim high, and warning us to not go low either. Subhan Allah. So after Ibrahim (عليه السلام) left his wife Hajar and Ismael (عليه السلام) in the desert they had no water, but she said that Allah will be with us. She had strong belief, but she still took the means of going back and forth between Safa and Marwa. Subhan Allah.

- The problem with us is that we will only take the means if it is guaranteed that it works. When we take a face cream, we want to know percentage of wrinkles it removes, etc. but what will make it work? It is only Allah (ﷻ).
- And when you have so much tawakul, Allah (ﷻ) will even change the rules of the universe to accommodate you. Subhan Allah. There are stories of karamahs, similar to miracles but given to non-messengers. Only the messengers have miracles. After the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) passed away, there was the believer army that wanted to cross the river, Allah (ﷻ) made their horses walk over the river. That is a karamah from Allah, subhan Allah.

- Surah Al Furqan 58: (وَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى الْحَيِّ الَّذِي لَا يَمُوتُ وَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِهِ) (And put your trust (O Muhammad SAW) in the Ever Living One Who dies not, and glorify His Praises)
- Surah Al An'am 102: (ذَٰلِكُمْ اللَّهُ رَبُّكُمُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ خَلَقَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ فَأَعْبُدُوهُ وَهُوَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَكِيلٌ) (Such is Allâh, your Lord! Lâ ilâha illa Huwa (none has the right to be worshipped but He), the Creator of all things. So worship Him (Alone), and He is the Wakîl (Trustee, Disposer of affairs, Guardian) over all things)

What will Allah (ﷻ) give you when you trust Him?

- Never disappoint you: Will Allah (ﷻ) disappoint you when you trust Him? No. Allah (ﷻ) will never disappoint you and Allah (ﷻ) appreciates it even more because you do not see Him but you believe in Him and trust Him. Subhan Allah.
- Victory: Allah (ﷻ) will give you victory when you rely on Him. If you rely on Allah (ﷻ) to provide you – you will feel as if you have nothing and you know for sure Allah (ﷻ) will provide you, then Allah (ﷻ) will give you. And if Allah (ﷻ) gives you victory and success, then no one can overcome you. Tawakul is to have so much confidence in Allah (ﷻ) that you don't even have 0.1% attachment to the means.
 - Surah Al Imran 160: (إِنْ يَنْصُرْكُمُ اللَّهُ فَلَا غَالِبَ لَكُمْ وَإِنْ يَحْذِلْكُمْ فَمَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَنْصُرُكُمْ) (If Allâh helps you, none can overcome you; and if He forsakes you, who is there after Him)

that can help you? And in Allâh (Alone) let believers put their trust.)

- Safeguard from the shaitan: The shaitan cannot have any control or power over the mutawakileen. Why did it mention the shaitan? The shaitan wants to mislead us by giving whispering ideas to us and then nafs implements that hint. But when you have tawakul, then it prevents that 'hint' from the shaitan coming and on top of that it is protection from the evil of the nafs. If there is a family of mutawakileen or friends are mutawakileen, then the shaitan cannot separate between them. But if you are attached to the means then he can separate between the people, subhan Allah.

- Surah An Nahl 99: (إِنَّهُ لَيْسَ لَهُ سُلْطَانٌ عَلَى الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَعَلَى رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ) (Verily! He has no power over those who believe and put their trust only in their Lord (Allâh).)

- Provision: Allah (ﷻ) will provide you, like money, food, mercy, companionship, friendship, a smile – provision is very vast. A provision is anything that benefits you. And ways without even thinking about it, Allah (ﷻ) will bring you things of the duniya.

- Hadith: "عمر رضي الله عنه قال: سمعت رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم يقول : (: (I heard Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) saying: "If you all depend on Allah with due reliance, He would certainly give you provision as He gives it to birds who go forth hungry in the morning and return with full belly at dusk") – At Tirmidhi

- Sign of a true believer: A sign of a true believer is his tawakul. If you believe in Allah (ﷻ) then it will truly show when you rely and trust Allah, subhan Allah. Our problem is we rely on the means because we see it as a guarantee that it will work, but you need to trust Allah (ﷻ). Look at your day to day, when you cook, are you relying on Allah (ﷻ) or the cookbook? When you are typing your notes, are you relying on Allah (ﷻ) to save the notes or the computer? Subhan Allah. When you leave the house, do you say (بسم الله توكلت على الله ولا حول ولا قوة الا بالله) (In the name of Allah, I put my trust in Allah, there is no might or power except with Allah)
 - Surah Al Anfal 2: (إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ الَّذِينَ إِذَا ذُكِرَ اللَّهُ وَجِلَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَإِذَا تُلِيَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتُهُ زَادَتْهُمْ إِيمَانًا وَعَلَىٰ رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ) (The believers are only those who, when Allâh is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and when His Verses (this Qur'ân) are recited unto them, they (i.e. the Verses) increase their Faith; and they put their trust in their Lord)
- Allah (ﷻ) will be sufficient for you: Allah (ﷻ) made Himself sufficient for you, imagine! Can anyone harm you? No. Does anything matter if you have Allah (ﷻ) with you? Even if you are living alone, Allah (ﷻ) will be your Guardian, Protector, Companion, subhan Allah.
 - Surah At Talaq 3: (وَيَرْزُقْهُ مِنْ حَيْثُ لَا يَحْتَسِبُ وَمَنْ يَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ فَهُوَ حَسْبُهُ إِنَّ) (And He will provide him from (sources) he never could imagine. And whosoever puts his

trust in Allâh, then He will suffice him. Verily, Allâh will accomplish his purpose. Indeed Allâh has set a measure for all things)

- Love of Allah (ﷻ): Allah (ﷻ) loves the mutwakileen. There is nothing better than the love of Allah. Sometimes people are begging for other people's love, if you want to attain love, attain Allah's love. Subhan Allah.
 - Surah Al Imran 159: (إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الْمُتَوَكِّلِينَ) (Certainly, Allâh loves those who put their trust (in Him).)
 - Hadith: (إِذَا أَحَبَّ اللَّهُ الْعَبْدَ نَادَى جِبْرِيلُ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ "عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ) فَلَانَا فَأَحْبِبْهُ. فَيُنَادِي جِبْرِيلُ فِي أَهْلِ السَّمَاءِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ فَلَانَا فَأَحْبِبُوهُ. فَيَحِبُّهُ أَهْلُ السَّمَاءِ، ثُمَّ يُوضَعُ لَهُ الْقَبُولُ فِي الْأَرْضِ) (The Prophet said, "If Allah loves a person, He calls Gabriel saying, 'Allah loves so and-so; O Gabriel! Love him.' Gabriel would love him and make an announcement amongst the inhabitants of the Heaven. 'Allah loves so-and-so, therefore you should love him also,' and so all the inhabitants of the Heaven would love him, and then he is granted the pleasure of the people on the earth.")
– Al Bukhari
 - Enter paradise without reckoning or punishment: That is because in their life they are not standing in front of anyone's door. They are always standing in front of Allah's door. Subhan Allah. And for that reason they will be the first to enter paradise. (وما جزاء الاحسان الا الاحسان)
- (So what is the reward for goodness except goodness?)

- Hadith: (يَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ مِنْ أُمَّتِي سَبْعُونَ) رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم قال " هُمُ الَّذِينَ لَا يَسْتَرْقُونَ، وَلَا يَتَطَيَّرُونَ، وَعَلَى رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ (أَلْفًا بِغَيْرِ حِسَابٍ، هُمُ الَّذِينَ لَا يَسْتَرْقُونَ، وَلَا يَتَطَيَّرُونَ، وَعَلَى رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ) Allah's Apostle said, "Seventy thousand people of my followers will enter Paradise without accounts, and they are those who do not practice Ar-Ruqya and do not see an evil omen in things, and put their trust in their Lord.) – Al Bukhari

Look at Yacoub (عليه السلام) he lost not one but two sons, and both came back to him. And the second one came back even faster. Why? Because of the tawakul. Once you have tawakul you will see your results will come quicker and in the best way. Subhan Allah.

Surah Yusuf Ayat 68

وَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا مِنْ حَيْثُ أَمَرَهُمْ أَبُوهُمْ مَا كَانَ يُغْنِي عَنْهُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِلَّا حَاجَةٌ فِي نَفْسٍ يَعْقُوبَ قَضَاهُ وَإِنَّهُ لَذُو عِلْمٍ لِمَا عَلَّمْنَاهُ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ (٦٨)

And when they entered according to their father's advice, it did not avail them in the least against (the Will of) Allâh, it was but a need of Ya'qûb's (Jacob) inner-self which he discharged. And verily, he was endowed with knowledge because We had taught him, but most men know not (68)

وَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا مِنْ (And when they entered according to their father's advice)

(حَيْثُ أَمَرَهُمْ أَبُوهُمْ)

- The sons took the advice of their father of entering from different doors. It shows that now they are following the commands of their father. (اتبعوا وصية ابوههم يعقوب عليه السلام)
- Allah (ﷻ) could have easily mentioned that they entered from different doors, but rather He said that they took their father's advice to show that they are now on the right track of listening to their father. Subhan Allah.
- Hadith: عَنْ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " رِضَا الرَّبِّ فِي رِضَا الْوَالِدِ وَسَخَطُ الرَّبِّ فِي سَخَطِ الْوَالِدِ (the Prophet said: "The Lord's pleasure is in the parent's pleasure, and the Lord's anger is in the parent's anger.") – At Tirmidhi. This is also a reminder to mend any relations cut off with our fathers or even between children and father. Subhan Allah.
- Just follow the advice of your parents because they are simply material things, to enter this door and not. Or wear this color or not. You should just do it.
- They took the means (اخذوا الاسباب), by following the father's advice.

It did not avail them in the least against (the Will of) Allâh, (مَا كَانَ يَغْنِي عَنْهُمْ)

(مِنْ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ)

- But it doesn't mean that the means will not prevent anything from whatever is decreed for you. For example, sometimes you take the means and start a business but it doesn't prosper. So when you make reliance, don't sit and wait to see the result. Because that shows you

are not sincere because reliance is a worship. Similar to dua'a or making dawah and you just wait for the result. You just have to convey the message and don't wait for the result – this shows a lack of faith. Allah (ﷻ) created you to worship Him. Dua'a is worship, salat is worship, tawakul is worship, so don't wait for some worldly result. Subhan Allah.

- Allah (ﷻ) decreed that the youngest son would not come back and stay in Egypt, but not for a long time. There is always a test for your reliance. Will you still rely on Allah (ﷻ) or will you quit?
- If you start a business and put reliance on Allah (ﷻ) and see that the business did not prosper, so will you continue to rely on Allah (ﷻ)? That is your test. Subhan Allah.
- Taking the means and relying on Allah (ﷻ) will not prevent from what Allah (ﷻ) has decreed.
- Notice this part of the ayah was mentioned before in ayah 67 as well. Subhan Allah.
- So despite the sons taking the means, and following the advice of their father, that will not stop Allah's (ﷻ) decree of not having his youngest son return with them.

It was but a need of Ya'qûb's (Jacob) inner-self which he discharged

(إِلَّا حَاجَةً فِي نَفْسِ يَعْقُوبَ قَضَاهَا)

- Whether you take the means or not, whatever is decreed will happen. So why do we take the means? Because of a need that is inside ourselves. For example, if someone you know is sick, and you say whatever Allah (ﷻ) has decreed for them will happen, so you don't bother to do anything about it, and in the end, the person dies. Now imagine if you tell yourself why did I not give them medication or take them to the doctor – now you have to live with this guilt and regret, and it is too hard to deal with. So when you take the means, you fulfill a need inside you and it can at least minimize the feeling of regret and guilt for not having done something. Subhan Allah. And this shows you how Allah (ﷻ) truly knows His creation inside and out. Subhan Allah.
- It's the same with studying, whether you study or not, you will get your grade. But if you fail, then you will regret for not having studied.
- Sometimes suddenly, you might decide to tell your child to make a prayer, or tell your husband don't talk on the phone while driving. Though it is not something you normally say, but is an inspiration from Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. It is something inside that needs to be said.
- (حَاجَةً): something that a person needs that is essential and it is also something he wants (الشئ المحتاج له لا يقدر بدونه الامر المرغوب). What is the need in Yaqoub (عليه السلام)? He loves his children, he cares about them and has mercy for them, and he wants their safety. (محبة ابنائه و الشفقة)
(عليهم سلامتهم)

- Where is the place of the need? In the nafs (فِي نَفْسٍ), in yourself. Notice it is not in the heart. In Surah Yusuf, the nafs is mentioned many times throughout the surah, subhan Allah.
- (قَضَلَهَا): to fulfill it. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) wants his sons to enter from different gates, and that was a need inside the nafs of Yacoub (عليه السلام). That is why subhan Allah, kalam Allah is so precise, pointing so deeply to your inner-self, subhan Allah.
- And it shows you that the means are for you, it is not for Allah (ﷻ), because the means make you satisfied. And this shows you how Allah (ﷻ) knows us perfectly and you cannot find any book that can tell you more about yourself except the Qur'an. Imagine when you meet someone who totally understands you and can read your thoughts, your heart flies, and you can find this in the Qur'an, subhan Allah.
- Everyone in paradise will be one heart, meaning everyone understands each other and is feeling the same as the other – when you are happy, others are happy. That is why when you talk about (لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ) everyone feels they are in one world, on one page, all the hearts are united. But as soon as you talk about 'him, her, she, etc' then everyone has a different opinion, different heart. That is why the study circles are gardens of paradise, subhan Allah.
- Sometimes you don't even understand yourself, you're moody and you don't know why you're moody, you're happy and don't know why. Only Allah (ﷻ) knows about you. And it's better to know about this with knowledge than to have to experience it.

- And it is better when others can't understand you, so that you are attached only to Allah (ﷻ) to truly know you and what you need. Subhan Allah. So that you always turns to Him. All of my needs are only in the hands of Allah (ﷻ) anyways and only He can give it to me.
- (فَضْلَةٌ): means to fulfill, implement, execute (الانفاذ).
- Sometimes Allah (ﷻ) can make a scene cross your mind so that He brings the needs forward, for example, Allah (ﷻ) made Yaqoub (عليه السلام) see a scene in his mind with all of his sons entering the city, so with that thought, he told them to enter from different gates. And this does not mean that there is a weakness in his faith or defect in his tawakul. It is to fulfill a need.
- There was once a story of a woman that was praying, and just like that, she decided to make a prayer for her daughter. The moment she was making the dua'a, her young daughter was actually stuck in an elevator, and she started to jump, until the elevator went down to the lower floor and then it opened. Who would have inspired a young girl to jump? Clearly this is from Allah (ﷻ).
- Sometimes you all of a sudden decide to say a prayer for one who is deceased, and this is inspiration from Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah.
- If you see the next part of the ayah, it removes any place for doubt, because some people might wonder what is the connection between his need and then knowledge? It is to show that Allah (ﷻ) is

praising him because he has knowledge of Allah (ﷻ) and tawakul, but he is still taking the means. So this sequence in the ayat shows you how Allah (ﷻ) knows that people might have doubt, and this immediately removes the doubt, subhan Allah. That is why the Qur'an reads you before you read it, subhan Allah, this is kalam Allah.

And verily, he was endowed with knowledge because We had taught him (وَإِنِّهٖ لَذُو عِلْمٍ لَّمَّا عَلَّمْنَاهُ)

- Imagine Allah (ﷻ) is the One who taught him, Who gifted him with knowledge, and Allah on top of that is praising him, subhan Allah. Imagine someone giving you gifts and he's praising you, you should be praising him. But this is Allah (ﷻ) to show to not underestimate Yaqoub (عليه السلام) because he has a need. In no way is this a sign of a defect in his faith or tawakul.
- And this shows you that you will be endowed with knowledge when you seek it from Allah, subhan Allah. Had it not been for Allah (ﷻ) teaching him, then he would not have known anything.
- Had it not been for Allah (ﷻ) then you would not been a seeker of knowledge, or in the dawah, subhan Allah. So this is all a favor from Allah (ﷻ). Any good that Allah (ﷻ) guides you to do in this life, is a FAVOR from Allah? What does favor mean? It means you do not deserve it.

- If you do not worship Allah, there are millions worshipping Allah. That is why when Allah (ﷻ) bestows upon you with good deeds, you need to grab it, and grab it with shukr. Because if you don't take it, it will go to others. There always be a carrier for Allah's deen. Even if no human believes, you have the angels and all other creation praising Him, subhan Allah.
- Don't ever think that we have a blood relation with Allah (ﷻ), we are nothing.
- Nothing is more precious when Allah (ﷻ) gives you the deen, the dawah, the knowledge, even sisters that you love for the sake of Allah. And this reminds that you need to always be submitting to Allah, and asking Allah to make you grateful and stay firm.

وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ (But most men know not)

- And this is so true, most of us do not know this. We ask Allah (ﷻ) to make us of the minority. Ameen.
- It shows you even more how the sequence of the ayat are totally reading us and telling us who we are, subhan Allah.

وَمَا دَخَلُوا عَلَى يُوسُفَ ءَاوَىٰ إِلَيْهِ أَخَاهُ قَالَ إِنِّي أَنَا أَخُوكَ فَلَا تَبْتَئِسْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ (٦٩)

And when they went in before Yûsuf (Joseph), he took his brother (Benjamin) to himself and said: "Verily! I am your brother, so grieve not for what they used to do." (69)

And when they went in before Yusuf (عليه السلام) (وَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَى يُوسُفَ)

- Notice when the brothers went into the city the first time, they entered through different gates, but this time all of them entered through one door – all eleven brothers came to Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- (عَلَى): being used here does not mean to be 'above' but rather it means place (ظرف).
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) wanted to accommodate all of them, so he said that each pair goes into one room, and the last one stays with me. And the youngest brother was the last to remain – Benjamin.

He took his brother to himself (ءَاوَىٰ إِلَيْهِ أَخَاهُ)

- (ءَاوَىٰ): means to accommodate, give shelter, a place of refuge where no harm will come (لجأ ، سكن).
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) took his brother Benjamin, who is his brother from the same father and mother. Imagine what a nice moment when he can meet his brother after all these years. And clearly this was the plan of Allah (ﷻ) to make it fall into place.
- Let us see what was the advice that Yusuf (عليه السلام) gave to his brother.

He said, 'I am your brother' (قَالَ إِنِّي أَنَا أَخُوكَ)

- So imagine, Benjamin thinks Yusuf (عليه السلام) is a minister, high-ranking official, etc. But Yusuf (عليه السلام) identified himself to his brother, and told him 'I am your brother'. And by doing this, he removes the discomfort and suspicion that Benjamin might have been feeling for being singled out.
- Also, he did not hug him or show extra emotions because it could make Benjamin nervous. It shows you that messengers really have to be men, subhan Allah.

So do not grieve for what they used to do (فَلَا تَبْتَئِسْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ)

- What is the meaning of (تَبْتَئِسْ)? It means to be sad, weak, complaining (تحزن ، تضعف ، تشتك).
- So Yusuf (عليه السلام) is telling his brother to not be sad, weak, or to complain, subhan Allah, it is the perfect advice, and it shows you it is inspiration from Allah (جَلَّ).
- Notice even the dua'a for the sick is (لا بأس طهورا ان شاء الله) – So don't be sad, weak, or complain of the sickness, subhan Allah.
- What is he telling him to not grieve about?
- Imagine what the brothers did to Yusuf (عليه السلام), but he did not complain and say what they did to him. Now that he is a minister, and

has rank and status, and servants, how can he complain? This would have been ingratitude. And if he did not complain in the prison, how could he complain now? Subhan Allah.

- And without realizing, you see how Allah (ﷻ) elevated Yusuf (عليه السلام), it's very gentle, because Allah (ﷻ) does not want to shock you, this shows you the name of Allah Al Lateef Al Khabeer. Allah (ﷻ) is very gentle with the nurturing in order to reach the person reach an elevated place.
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) is telling Benjamin to not grieve with what the brothers will do. And this shows you that before Allah (ﷻ) will test you and put you in difficult situation, Allah (ﷻ) will inform you, subhan Allah.
- Look at the ihsan of Yusuf (عليه السلام) he did not complain or even mention what his brothers did to him, and now he is just telling him to not grieve for what the brothers might do. He did not give details if they do evil or evil to him – because that would be backbiting then, subhan Allah.

فَلَمَّا جَهَّزَهُمْ بِجَهَّازِهِمْ جَعَلَ السَّقَايَةَ فِي رَحْلِ أَخِيهِ ثُمَّ أَذَّنَ مُؤَذِّنٌ أَيُّهَا الْعَيْرِ إِنَّكُمْ لَسَرِقُونَ (٧٠)

So when he had furnished them forth with their provisions, he put the (golden) bowl into his brother's bag, Then a crier cried: "O you (in) the caravan! Surely, you are thieves!" (70)

So when he had prepared them with their provision (فَلَمَّا حَضَرَهُمْ بِحِزَّائِهِمْ)

- Notice this time the servants were not involved. Before the servants placed the extra provision in their brother's bags as Yusuf (عليه السلام) had ordered them. But this time, he could not involve the servants because they can misinterpret what is happening, so Yusuf (عليه السلام) was involved only.
- This shows you that you do not need to reveal your secrets to everyone.
- Meaning of (حَضَرَهُمْ): to make them ready by giving them what they need in order to go back to their country (اعد و أعطاهم ما في حاجتهم اليه) (ليرجعوا الى بلدهم).
- When the brothers saw that Yusuf (عليه السلام) was taking care of them and preparing their belongings, though he is a minister, imagine how great they must think of him. Keep in mind they still do not know that it is Yusuf (عليه السلام) their brother, except Benjamin. The reason Yusuf (عليه السلام) was preparing their belongings was so that he could place the measuring cup in his brother's bag.
- Meaning of (بِحِزَّائِهِمْ) (ب+حِزَّاء+هم): the ب shows it is attached, as if it is a personal touch from Yusuf (عليه السلام) taking care of them.
- What is it that they want? (الميرة) – food, provision.
- And to prepare their belongings includes even placing the provision on their camels. So we can even learn customer service here, subhan

Allah. Imagine what must be going through the brother's minds when they see a minister doing all of this for them! Subhan Allah.

He placed the measuring cup in his brother's bag (جَعَلَ آلِ سَقَايَةَ فِي رَحْلِ)

أَخِيهِ

- The measuring cup that was used to measure the money was made of silver and embellished with jewels – so it was precious. The one who was measuring the food was Yusuf (عليه السلام) as well.
- (جَعَلَ): means to place (وضع).
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) placed the measuring cup in Benjamin's bag and he knew which camel he was riding since he was with him throughout.
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not plot to seek revenge because that is not the attitude of a messenger, his plot was for a noble reason, which is to bring his entire family, including father and mother to Egypt. And this is Allah (ﷻ) plotting for him, subhan Allah.
- (آلِ سَقَايَةَ): comes from (سقى) which is to quench. It is a vessel that they would drink from, and it was said to be either gold or silver. Of course eating or drinking from gold or silver utensils is haram. That is why it is better to avoid gold or silver plated. You have stainless-steel, glass, etc. Because it is said that is the attitude of the disbeliever, to be proud to eat and drink in gold and silver.
- If you are doing something for a noble reason, don't put yourself in a situation where people can suspect you, that is why you need to

clarify. Don't make the people think, 'why did she leave quickly', etc – that is why don't assume people to know what is in your heart. For example, once the Prophet Mohammed ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) was out at night and walking with his wife, and it was dark and they passed by a person, and just so that no one would suspect anything wrong, even though it is the Prophet Mohammed ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), no one would suspect from him, he told him that is my wife 'Safiah' (ra), subhan Allah.

- And this is especially true if it happens to often, because then it can make people suspicious.
- (رحله): means to travel, transport. (راحله) is a mode of transport. It is the bag that will be placed on his camel – so in modern day terms, basically his 'suitcase'.

Then a crier cried (ثُمَّ أَدَّأَنَّ مُؤَدِّنٌ)

- As they were travelling back to their homes, a caller cried out, and it is not random. Similarly when you go through inspection, and are asked to be inspected. It is because they are given information to inspect.
- (أَدَّأَنَّ): means ear and (أَدَّأَنَّ): to give permission. So it is giving permission to hear it in the ear. And when you hear a call, you hear it in the (أَدَّأَنَّ), ear. As if you are giving an announcement (أَكْثَرُ الْإِعْلَانِ), and is recognized by everyone. It also means (يَدْعُو), to give an invitation.

- (مُؤَذِّنٌ): a caller and notice it is in the indefinite. So it can be anybody calling, and because it's in the indefinite, Sheikh As Saady said as if the person who is announcing does not know what is happening. He was just told to announce, but he does not have details about who they are and why they are being stopped.
- This should increase us in faith when we go through the ayat of the Qur'an because it shows us the details of human nature. And people act the same whether during that time or now, that is why Allah (ﷻ) is (الاه الناس).

"O you (in) the caravan! Surely, you are thieves!" (أَنْتُمْهَا الْعَيْرُ إِنَّكُمْ لَسَرْقُونَ)

- (أَيُّهَا): means 'all of you'.
- And they are being called from a distance, but how did they know it's them? They were a (أَلْعَيْرُ), what does that mean?
- (أَلْعَيْرُ): is a caravan (قافلة), which means it consists of both people and animals. And this caravan means that it is carrying both people and belongings. Because sometimes you can have a camel with belongings only. But (عَيْرٌ) means specifically that there is a person and belongings on the camel, subhan Allah. That is how they were identified.
- (إِنَّكُمْ لَسَرْقُونَ): Surely you are thieves! Notice it was not Yusuf (عليه السلام) who said they were thieves because then it would have been a lie.

But this caller just got some news from another place, and it is in the affirmative. He did not say you have stolen, but you are thieves.

- Notice (إِنَّكُمْ) is in the affirmative, and then (لَ) is another affirmation, and (سَارِقُونَ) is a noun, and that is stronger than a verb. For example, when you say (آمَنُوا) which is to be in a constant state of belief, but (مُؤْمِنُونَ) means they have already reached, it is affirmed they are believers, subhan Allah.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 71

قَالُوا وَأَقْبَلُوا عَلَيْهِمْ مَاذَا تَفْقِدُونَ (٧١)

They, turning towards them, said: "What is it that you have lost?" (71)

- Look at the reaction of the brothers since they were innocent.
- (قَالُوا وَأَقْبَلُوا عَلَيْهِمْ): They came to them.
- (وَأَقْبَلُوا): is to face. Look at the body language, meaning they gave their full face and body. Sometimes people give half their face.
- (عَلَيْهِمْ): 'them'. Who is 'them'? First it was just one caller, but out of human nature, whenever there is something, people like to gather and look out of curiosity. Similar when there is an accident on the road, the traffic slows down just because people are looking to see what's happening. And this shows you that people are the same, regardless of when or where, subhan Allah. In addition, it shows you that the Qur'an is for all, believer/ disbeliever, man / woman, young / old. It is for all of mankind.

- (مَاذَا تَفْقِدُونَ): 'What is it that you have lost?'. It was an innocent answer, they did not say 'we did not steal', but rather it was a diplomatic answer. For example, if you tell your child, why did you take the bag?, and instead they won't say I didn't take it, but rather 'maybe you misplaced it.'
- And this teaches us how to answer with ihsan. Instead of being defensive, 'no I didn't', rather they are thinking good about them, and just said 'what did you lose?', subhan Allah. And it shows maturity of the brothers.

قَالُوا نَفَقِدُ صُوعَ الْمَلِكِ وَلِمَن جَاءَ بِهِ حِمْلُ بَعِيرٍ وَأَنَا بِهِ زَعِيمٌ (٧٢)

They said: "We have lost the (golden) bowl of the king and for him who produces it is (the reward of) a camel load; I will be bound by it." (72)

They said: "We have lost the (golden) bowl of the king (قَالُوا نَفَقِدُ صُوعَ)

الملك

- Notice they used the same kind of language as the brothers. When the caller said you are thieves, they did not say 'we are not thieves' but rather 'what have you misplaced '. And now the caller answered in the same manner as the brothers had spoken, so they said 'we have lost the golden bowl of the king'. They did not reply back to

them and said again, 'you are thieves'. So when you speak calmly and positively, it calms the other person as well, subhan Allah.

- (نَفَقِدُ): to lose, which comes from (فَقَدَ)
- (صُوعًا): it's a cup that is very precious. Notice before it was called (سَقَايَةً), which means cup as well. But (صُوعًا) is just to give it more value.

And on top of that, they said it's the (أَمْلِكِ), the king's cup to make it more valuable and significant.

And for him who produces it is (the reward of) a camel load (وَلِمَن حَآءَ)

(إِلَيْهِ حِمْلُ بَعِيرٍ)

- So this is a reward if they bring it back, and notice it was not announced to the public, but just to them, subhan Allah.
- At the time, a reward of a camel load is valuable since food was scarce.
- And does the king really know about this? No. And this shows you how established Yusuf (عليه السلام) is, subhan Allah. Yusuf (عليه السلام) was the one who was giving the orders, subhan Allah.
- (جَاءَ بِهِ): to bring it.
- (حِمْلُ): load / (بَعِيرٍ): camel

- So they will have 12 loads instead of 11. And they offered a reward that they are in need of. Similarly, when you want to motivate your children, you reward with something they want, subhan Allah.
- And Yusuf (عليه السلام) gave all of these orders just to keep his brother.
- The brothers might think that they might have it, but they want proof that they will not be caught if they do have it. That it is not a trick.

And I am responsible (وَأَنَا بِهِ زَعِيمٌ)

- Meaning if they hand over the cup, nothing will happen to them. They will not be caught or placed in jail. So it is assurance for them.
- And notice the caller did not immediately go and search for it, rather he announced what they need, and this shows manner and to make it easy instead of going in and checking each bag.
- (زَعِيمٌ): means chief (رئيس), master (سيد), one who is responsible (مسئول), sponsor (كفيل), guarantor (ضامن).
- And notice Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not tell his younger brother what will happen because he did not want to put his brother in a situation where he has to lie, subhan Allah. That is why he told him previously, 'don't not worry about what happens'.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 73

قَالُوا تَاللّٰهِ لَقَدْ عَلِمْتُمْ مَّا جِئْنَا لِنُفْسِدَ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَمَا كُنَّا سَارِقِينَ (٧٣)

They said: "By Allâh! Indeed you know that we came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!" (73)

They said: "By Allâh! Indeed you know (قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ عَلِمْتُمْ)

- The brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام) said:
- (تَاللَّهِ): By Allah, it is to swear, but it is more intense. In Arabic you have (و) and (ت) as letters for taking an oath. That is why they are called (حروف معنى) because they are one letter with meaning. The (ت) is affirmation.
- The brothers are believers and though the others do not know who is Allah, they will still swear by Allah (ﷻ).
- (لَقَدْ): this is double affirmation, you have (ل) and (قد).
- (عَلِمْتُمْ): knowledge without doubts. We need knowledge without doubts, that is (علم). That is why Allah (ﷻ) said most people do not know, meaning they do not know without doubts.
- Notice they did not swear by Allah in the beginning until it reached the max. That is why a believer does not immediately swear by Allah, it is not used casually. When the situation reached its max, they swore by Allah.

That we came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves! (مَا جِئْنَا لِنُفْسِدَ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَمَا كُنَّا سَارِقِينَ)

- Spreading mischief is to commit a sin and it shows you that stealing is part of mischief. And notice they mentioned the greater issue, which is to not cause mischief, and then they mentioned stealing.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 74

قَالُوا فَمَا جَزَاؤُهُ إِن كُنتُمْ كَاذِبِينَ (٧٤)

They [Yûsuf's brothers] said: "What then shall be the penalty of him, if you are (proved to be) liars." (74)

They said: What then shall be the recompense, if you are liars. (قَالُوا فَمَا)

(جَزَاؤُهُ إِن كُنتُمْ كَاذِبِينَ)

- (قَالُوا) is referring to the brother's speaking.
- (فَمَا جَزَاؤُهُ): what is the recompense? (for stealing). The brother's are being accused of stealing, but they want to know what is the punishment for one who steals the cup?
- (إِن كُنتُمْ كَاذِبِينَ): if you are liars (in your accusation). They are defending themselves, so those who are accusing them are liars since they are innocent.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 75

قَالُوا جَزَاؤُهُ مَنْ وَجَدَ فِي رَحْلِهِ ۖ فَهُوَ جَزَاؤُهُ ۚ كَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي الظَّالِمِينَ (٧٥)

They [Yûsuf's men] said: "His penalty should be that he, in whose bag it is found, should be held for the punishment (of the crime). Thus we punish the Zâlimûn (wrong-doers)!" (75)

- Though they are in Egypt, and the rules are based on the king, who does not follow the shari'a of Yacoub (عليه السلام), but notice Yusuf (عليه السلام) still applies the shari'a of his father, let us see how.

They said: "His recompense for whose bag it is found" (قَالُوا جَزَاؤُهُ مَنْ وَجَدَ فِي رَحْلِهِ ۖ فَهُوَ جَزَاؤُهُ ۚ كَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي الظَّالِمِينَ (٧٥))

(فِي رَحْلِهِ ۖ)

- (قَالُوا): 'They said' refers to the officers of Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- (جَزَاؤُهُ): His recompense. In Arabic the recompense refers both to punishment and reward.
- You can see that Yusuf's men do not know the full story, that is why they keep using the same words as the brothers because they were just told to this, they do not know the reason, it is only for Yusuf (عليه السلام) to know.
- The rules of the king for whoever steals is they need to give back double of what they stole and they need to be lashed. But Yusuf (عليه السلام) does not want his brother to be beaten innocently. In the shari'a of Yacoub (عليه السلام), if anyone steals, then they have to be a slave for a certain period time to the one they stole from. Similar to someone

who eats in a restaurant and does not pay the bill, he has to wash the dishes ☺.

- (مَنْ وُجِدَ فِي رَحْلِهِ): whoever's bag it is found. The one who has the cup in his bag, then he will be taken. But they do not give further details as to what his punishment will be. Keep in mind the two different rulings, of the king and sharia'a of Yacoub (عليه السلام).

Thus we recompense the Zâlimin (wrong-doers) (كَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِي الظَّالِمِينَ)

- Notice the word 'punish' is not being used, rather (نَجْزِي), which is to recompense. It is a softer wording.
- Notice they did not say (السارقين) – the thieves, but rather (الظَّالِمِينَ), which shows that stealing is a type of injustice. Also, they are mentioning a broad category of injustice in order to show the bigger picture because it can lead to imbalance and mischief in a society, subhan Allah. And they want justice in their society.
- And this shows you that having laws is a safeguard for society, and this is good. Why? Because Allah (ﷻ) made everything in balance, and everything has its boundary. The sun cannot outpace the moon, or vice versa.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 76

فَبَدَأَ بِأَوْعِيَّتِهِمْ قَبْلَ وِعَاءِ أَخِيهِ ثُمَّ أَسْتَخْرَجَهَا مِنْ وِعَاءِ أَخِيهِ كَذَلِكَ كِدْنَا لِيُوسُفَ مَا كَانَ لِيَأْخُذَ أَخَاهُ فِي دِينِ الْمَلِكِ إِلَّا أَنْ يَشَاءَ اللَّهُ نَرْفَعُ دَرَجَاتٍ مَن نَّشَاءُ وَفَوْقَ كُلِّ ذِي عِلْمٍ عَلِيمٌ (٧٦)

So he [Yûsuf (Joseph)] began (the search) in their bags before the bag of his brother. Then he brought it out of his brother's bag. Thus did We plan for Yûsuf (Joseph). He could not take his brother by the law of the king (as a slave), except that Allâh willed it. (So Allâh made the brothers to bind themselves with their way of "punishment, i.e. enslaving of a thief.") We raise to degrees whom We will, but over all those endowed with knowledge is the All-Knowing (Allâh) (76)

- (فَبَدَأَ): So he started. Who is starting? The officer who is searching (المفتش / التفتيش).
- (بِأَوْعِيَّتِهِمْ قَبْلَ وِعَاءِ أَخِيهِ): He started with the bags of the brothers first before his brother. And that is in order to keep the youngest brother last. And clearly this is a command from Yusuf (عليه السلام) that was inspired to him by Allah (ﷻ).
- Notice there are so many words for 'bag' in the surah depending on the situation – there is (وِعَاءٍ / بضاعه / جهاز / رحال / غير), subhan Allah.
- (وِعَاءٍ): is a container, it is used for preserving and collecting (الاناء الذي / يجمع ويحفظ).
- There is wisdom to begin with the older brothers before Benjamin, we shall see next week in sha'a Allah what is the wisdom.

Then he brought it out of his brother's bag (ثُمَّ آسَخَرَهَا مِنْ وَعَاءِ أَخِيهِ)

- (آسَخَرَهَا): comes from (استخرج) (خرج) which means to remove something after having searched for it.
- Someone who does not know about Allah (ﷻ) will think badly out Allah (ﷻ) if they were to think why did the brother have to be removed in this way. And our problem in this life is that we think bad about Allah (ﷻ). We have to remember that Allah (ﷻ) does not do anything bad or evil. Every decree of Allah (ﷻ) is the best, and we need to negate any imperfection from Allah (ﷻ) – we need to always say, 'subhan Allah'.
- That is why it is important to have iman before going to the Qur'an because it can cause doubts about Allah (ﷻ) and His actions. Allah's decrees are always the best, no one plans better than Allah (ﷻ). Remember that our minds are incomplete, they are lacking, and we do not see the full picture.

Thus did We plan for Yûsuf (Joseph). (كَذَٰلِكَ كُنَّا لِيُوسُفَ)

- (كيد): means to plot. But when used with Allah (ﷻ) it does not mean plot and it is incorrect to say that. The plot of the people is full of desire and it is not for a noble reason, either out of jealousy or hatred. People

who are not perfect are going with their desires. For Allah (ﷻ), when there is (كيد) it is not for Himself, it is for Yusuf (عليه السلام). Allah (ﷻ) does not benefit for being merciful to His creation, we benefit, subhan Allah.

- The (كيد) of Allah (ﷻ) is to make things easy for Yusuf (عليه السلام) and it was planned perfectly by Allah (ﷻ). Why did Allah (ﷻ) do (كيد) for Yusuf (عليه السلام)? To keep his brother Benyamin in Egypt so that the entire family of Yusuf (عليه السلام) comes to Egypt, which is better from where they are now. Everything that you have is the best for you, there is nothing out of place. Even if a fly comes to eat from your food, it is not out of place. When you accept, you get rewarded.

(كيد الله)

- (كيد) is an attribute of Allah (ﷻ) but it is not like His attribute of mercy, kindness, etc because that is for everyone. (كيد) is a restricted attribute (صفة مقيدة), meaning Allah (ﷻ) is not doing it all the time, only for certain people. And there is no name of Allah (ﷻ) that is derived from it.
- So restricted attributes of Allah (ﷻ) mean:
 - There is no name of Allah (ﷻ) linked to it

- It is not a constant attribute but only used for certain people when doing certain actions
- Examples of other restricted attributes:
 - (الغضب / السخط): This is similar to the wrath of Allah (ﷻ), this is a restricted attribute, meaning Allah (ﷻ) is only angry at certain doers for certain actions. Allah (ﷻ) is not angry all the time, Allah (ﷻ) is merciful all the time, subhan Allah.
 - (لعنة): to curse
 - (يستهزئ): to mock
 - (يخادع): to deceive
 - (مكر): to plan
 - (كيد): to plot
- When people do any of attributes, whether they are wrathful, mocking, deceiving, etc it is all for desires and they are dispraised attributes for the human, because for them it is an imperfect attribute being done by an imperfect person. When Allah (ﷻ) does any of these attributes, it is praised, it is perfect because it is full of wisdom, there is no desire associated.
- When Allah (ﷻ) mocks, plots, etc it is all just. That is why it is important to know about Allah (ﷻ).

- Life should be between subhan Allah and alhamdulillah. When you see something negative, you say subhan Allah, when you see something good, you have to say alhamdulillah. This is (لا اله الا الله). People are doing the opposite, when they see something bad they just complain and think bad and when they have something good, they attribute it to themselves instead of thanking Allah (ﷻ).
- The people of paradise have the joy of remembering Allah (ﷻ) and their breathing is 'subhan Allah' and 'alhamdulillah', subhan Allah.
- And between these is 'salam' meaning my words are peace, I will not saying that will harm you.

He could not take his brother by the law of the king (مَا كَانَ لِيَأْخُذَ أَخَاهُ فِي دِينِ) (الْمَلِكِ)

- (دين): means the sharia or rule, it does not mean religion here.
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) does not want the rule of the king to be applied because their rule includes being lashed and giving double of what is stolen, and Yusuf (عليه السلام) does not want this for his brother.
- The penalty of the sharia of Yacoub (عليه السلام) – which was Islam at the time, is the thief is taken as a slave for a certain period of time.
- Every messenger has the same belief of (لا اله الا الله) but their legislations / laws are according to the time and nation.

- Allah (ﷻ) brings the good to you in a gentle way, there is nothing random, the name of Allah Al Lateef will appear after this ayah. Look at how Yusuf (عليه السلام) went from a well, to the wife of the aziz, to prison, and now setting the laws, this is all from the gentleness of Allah (ﷻ) to bring it.
- If you look at these two legislations, it shows you the greatness of Allah's plans and decrees, subhan Allah. Allah (ﷻ) wants that the stories increase you in faith. Allah (ﷻ) wants you to trust Him, believe in Him, etc.

The will of Allah (مشيئة الله)

- We use words related to (مشيئة الله), such as (ان شاء الله / ما شاء الله).
- (مشيئة الله) is not a name of Allah (ﷻ), but an attribute of Allah (ﷻ). Allah (ﷻ) also has actions. The names of Allah (ﷻ) have both attributes and actions. Like (رحمة) is an attribute and there is a name linked to it, like (الرحمن). But not every attribute has a name of Allah (ﷻ), for example (كيد) or (مشيئة), there is no name attached to that.
- You also have (ارادة الله) which means 'the want of Allah (ﷻ)', so how is this different from (مشيئة الله)?

- (مشيئة الله): is only for the decree, it is not for legislation. You cannot say Allah wills to make you pray. Allah wants you to pray.
- (إرادة الله): it is for the decree and legislation. Allah (يريد الله بكم) (اليسر ولا يريد بكم العسر) (Allah wants the ease for you and He does not want the hardship for you)
- Definition of (مشيئة الله): All the situations that Allah (ﷻ) has decree, be it who you marry, where you live, how many children etc, that is why nothing is coincidence, everything is pre-ordained. For example, someone unexpectedly gives you a gift, and when you think about it, Allah (ﷻ) willed that I have this gift, at this time, from this person, and specifically this gift. This should not make you focus on the gift or yourself for getting it, thinking Allah must love, because you will not get rewarded for that. Instead, to increase your faith, you think that Allah willed that I get it.

People's will and Allah's will:

- People's will is imperfect. For example, you want to go out, and someone comes over instead. And when this happens, it should increase you in faith to show you that your will is imperfect and Allah's will is perfect, subhan Allah.
- Allah's will, whether you get something or do not get something, it is all the will of Allah (ﷻ). For example, you are at home and you want

people to come over and no one comes. And sometimes you are at home and busy, and now everybody wants to come over. This happens because our will is imperfect so we need to strengthen our faith in Allah's will.

- Our will has desire, sometimes we are in the mood to go out, sometimes not – so this makes our will imperfect, and we are imperfect as well.
- Allah's will is perfect because anything that happens or does not happen is all associated with the Wisdom and Knowledge of Allah (ﷻ).
- When Allah (ﷻ) wills that you get something, it is not random, it is because Allah (ﷻ) has complete knowledge, everything is pre-decreed based on knowledge and wisdom. For example, when you the guests arrive, at that moment, not one day later, not one hour later, all of this has wisdom behind it. Not a leaf will fall without the wisdom of Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah.
- Even when you go out, how many steps you take, what is your speed, who you will meet, etc is all known to Allah (ﷻ).
- And anything that does not happen is according to the will of Allah (ﷻ), and it is filled with wisdom and knowledge. Our knowledge is imperfect. Sometimes you go out and you get delayed, and then you end up meeting someone. Then you say subhan Allah, that you got

delayed in order to meet this person. There is nothing random, there is wisdom behind everything.

- That is why the will of Allah (ﷻ) (مَشِيئَةُ اللَّهِ) is associated with the decrees.
- (مَشِيئَةُ اللَّهِ) is part of the 'Belief in the Decree', which is one of the Pillars of Faith – Belief in Allah, His Angels, His Messengers, His Books, The Last Day, and the Decree – good and evil.

Belief in the Decree:

- Knowledge of Allah (ﷻ) (عِلْمٌ): You need to know that Allah (ﷻ) knows everything before the existence of everyone and the heavens and earth. Allah (ﷻ) knew everything without even putting a date to it. Do not think about how, it will open the gates of the shaitan. We cannot encompass the knowledge of Allah (ﷻ).
- Preserved Tablet (الْكِتَابَةِ): Before the creation of the heavens and the earth by 50,000 years, Allah (ﷻ) commanded the pen to write. The pen said what to write, He said write the decree of everything to the Day of Judgement. This is all in the Preserved Tablet. And this shows you the power of Allah (ﷻ). Who made the fire to be cool for Ibrahim (عليه السلام)? The decree shows you the power and strength of Allah (ﷻ). And your strength is when you believe in the decree, subhan Allah. How did Allah (ﷻ) know what will happen? This is a secret.

- Will of Allah (مشيئة): this is when the decree takes place. Allah (ﷻ) wrote that at this time, on this day, you will get this gift from this person.
 - Allah (ﷻ) gives permission at that time that it will happen. So imagine in one second, how many wills of Allah (ﷻ) are taking place, subhan Allah. Now imagine the whole universe. It is so vast and overwhelming. Nothing in this universe happens without Allah's will and permission, and this really shows you the power of Allah (ﷻ). This is the secret of Allah (ﷻ) that you need to believe. People have a problem with accepting the decree, why? Do they not believe that Allah (ﷻ) is all powerful and all-able? You need to believe this. Many deviations happen because of this. Our mind is limited to understand the secrets of Allah (ﷻ).
- Allah (ﷻ) will create the means (الخلق): Allah (ﷻ) will create the means for the decree to happen. For example, Allah (ﷻ) will create the mean for the leaf to fall, and Allah (ﷻ) knows this is the best time for the leaf to fall because subhan Allah when it falls, an animal might eat from it, etc. Everything happens in its place. A group of scholars were discussing what is the best way to die, sometimes we say I want to do die like this, or I don't want to do like this. And one man said, Allah (ﷻ) knows the best way for me to die, so why do I need to think

about it? For example, Allah (ﷻ) wills that a leave will fall. Allah (ﷻ) will create the means be it wind, or someone shakes the tree. Anything that is willed for you, will come to you. Anything that is not willed for you, will miss you. The belief in the decree is a great way to increase your faith because we are going through decrees every moment. People get scared of the decrees because they think it is about a calamity, but this is not true. Everything in the decrees are connected. You could be writing, and you decide to change pens, Allah (ﷻ) knows about this already, and what made you change? Allah (ﷻ) put a need in your heart to change it, subhan Allah.

- The decrees of Allah (ﷻ) are perfect because His knowledge is perfect, His writing is perfect, His will is perfect, and His creation is perfect.
- If something in the duniya did not happen, then you should not be upset, because it is not best for you, alhamdulillah.

(مشيئة الله) in the Qur'an

- Surah Al Baqarah 105: (وَاللَّهُ يَخْتَصُّ بِرَحْمَتِهِ مَن يَشَاءُ) (But Allâh chooses for His Mercy whom He wills)

- We all want mercy, but Allah (ﷻ) will give it to whom He wills.

Whom He wills means who deserves it, and that is based on His knowledge about you. Are you sincere to get the mercy?

Are you taking the means for the mercy? And then Allah (ﷻ)

will create the means to get the mercy, subhan Allah.

- Surah Al Baqarah 142: (يَهْدِي مَنْ يَشَاءُ إِلَى صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ) (He guides whom He wills to a Straight Way)
 - The guidance is based on the knowledge of Allah (ﷻ), and Allah (ﷻ) gives it who deserves it. Are you being sincere, are you truthful to want guidance? Allah knows what is in your heart.
- Surah Al Baqarah 212: (وَاللَّهُ يَرْزُقُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ بِغَيْرِ حِسَابٍ) (And Allâh gives of His Bounty to whom He wills without limit)
 - Your provision is based on the will of Allah (ﷻ) which is based on His knowledge and wisdom. He knows what suits you. He knows how many children, how much wealth, etc suits you.

People's Will:

- Surah Al Insan 29-31: (إِنَّ هَذِهِ تَذْكِرَةٌ فَمَنْ شَاءَ اتَّخَذَ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِ سَبِيلًا (٢٩) وَمَا تَشَاءُونَ إِلَّا أَنْ (إِنَّ هَذِهِ تَذْكِرَةٌ فَمَنْ شَاءَ اتَّخَذَ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِ سَبِيلًا (٢٩) وَمَا تَشَاءُونَ إِلَّا أَنْ يُدْخِلَ مَنْ يَشَاءُ فِي رَحْمَتِي وَالظَّالِمِينَ أَعَدَّ لَهُمْ عَذَابًا (يَشَاءُ اللَّهُ إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَلِيمًا حَكِيمًا (٣٠) (أَلَيْمًا (٣١)) (Verily, this (Verses of the Qur'ân) is an admonition, so whosoever wills, let him take a Path to his Lord (Allâh). (29) But you cannot will, unless Allâh wills. Verily, Allâh is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise (30) He will admit to His Mercy whom He wills and as for the Zâlimûn — (polytheists, wrong-doers) He has prepared a painful torment. (31))
- We have a will, it means something we want to do.

- For example, we are invited to a place, and we don't want to go, but we say (ان شاء الله). This is being used wrongly. Don't use (ان شاء الله) without wanting to go. That is why if you don't want to come, say 'no'. If you want to come, instead of saying 'yes', then say (ان شاء الله).
- So use it when you want to do something, not when you don't want to do it, subhan Allah.
- When you want to do something, you are saying (ان شاء الله) because it can only happen with the permission of Allah (ﷻ), and this shows you tawheed and magnification of Allah, subhan Allah.
- We should not take (ان شاء الله) lightly, we don't want to lose our faith by misusing the attribute of Allah, subhan Allah.
- With your will, the decision is yours. Do you will to go to paradise? Do you not will to go to paradise? – So if you will to go to paradise, you will take the reminder and admonition.
- Hadith: عَنْ عَلِيٍّ بْنِ حُسَيْنٍ، أَنَّ الْحُسَيْنَ بْنَ عَلِيٍّ، حَدَّثَهُ عَنْ عَلِيِّ بْنِ أَبِي طَالِبٍ، أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ طَرَفَهُ وَفَاطِمَةَ فَقَالَ " أَلَا تُصَلُّونَ ". فَقُلْتُ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ إِنَّمَا أَنْفُسُنَا بِيَدِ اللَّهِ فَإِذَا شَاءَ أَنْ يَبْعَثَنَا بَعَثَنَا . فَأَنْصَرَفَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ حِينَ قُلْتُ لَهُ ذَلِكَ ثُمَّ سَمِعْتُهُ (Husain b. 'Ali narrated on the authority of (his father) 'Ali b. Abu Talib that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) came one night to see him ('Ali) and Fatimah (the daughter of the Holy Prophet) and said: Don't you observe (Tahajjud) prayer? I ('Ali) said: Messenger of Allah, verily our souls are

in the hands of Allah and when He wants to awaken us, He awakens us. The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) went back when I said this to him. He was striking his hand on his thigh while returning, and I heard him say: Verily the man disputes with many things.)

- You have a will on your way to paradise or hellfire. That is why your will is very apparent there. Anything that you are doing, or not doing, is your will.
- For example, you went out and an accident happened, this was done on you, so this is Qadr Allah.
- But anything that you do, that is your will.
- This is a reminder (إِنَّ هَٰذَا تَذَكُّرٌ) – Allah (ﷻ) is showing it to everyone. So

it is up to you if you will take up that reminder, if you want to go to paradise or hellfire. For example, we have listened about the pillars of Islam, this means since you got to listen to it, it means that everybody received this information, everyone received this guidance. People cannot say if Allah wills, I will pray. That is injustice. How can you reach paradise without praying? You got the guidance, now it is up to you to take the action.

- The will begins in your heart, you accept it and you have the will to do it. And when you have that will in your heart, you will take the means, and you will see that Allah (ﷻ) will open the means.
- Another example, someone is poor, he cannot say, 'if Allah wills, He will make me rich, if not, then I will stay poor' – this is nonsense. You have to strive for it. And imagine this is for small matters, so what about going to paradise and saying if Allah wills? Subhan Allah and

istaghfra Allah. How can someone not strive for it, this is injustice to say that if Allah willed for me to go to paradise, I'll go, istaghfar Allah.

- When you have a will, you will strive for it, and you will ask Allah (ﷻ) and will take the means. And how will the means come? They will come easily, subhan Allah.

Types of Decrees of Allah (ﷻ)

- Something you are born with (فيك): you don't have a will when to be born or who are your parents.
- Something done on you (عليك): this is Qadr Allah. For example, you go out and a person comes along the way. There are people, istaghfar Allah, who say if they think of someone they get a message from them, as if they have power over their mind. This is a test, you have to believe the power is with Allah (ﷻ), not with you. Or sometimes, someone might ring the bell and you guess who it is, and you are right, and again it happens – these are all tricks of the shaitan. And this is (استدراج) – going down and losing the faith. We ask Allah (ﷻ) to forgive us. Ameen.

- You are responsible for your actions, not what others do to you. Look at Surah Yusuf, he was of the muhsineen, did he cry over what his brothers did to him? Sometimes people have a bad relation with their husband and they put of all their frustration on their children and housekeepers, and this is

wrong. That is why Surah Yusuf gives a lot of console to those who have had things done to them from the outside. You cannot blame the society for making you do something, you have the will. When you focus on people's actions, you will not do ihsan, subhan Allah.

- When you will good, Allah (ﷻ) wills good for you (منك). If you do not will to do good, Allah (ﷻ) does not will good for you.
- That is why when you make a dua'a, do not end it with (ان شاء الله). Do not make a dua'a, 'Oh Allah take me to paradise (ان شاء الله). You have to will to want to go to paradise and strive for it.
- For example, you have a will and a desire in your heart to help a poor person. You will see that Allah (ﷻ) will create the means and a poor person will come along the way and you will get to help them. He knows when your will is truthful, subhan Allah.
- (نَرْفَعُ دَرَجَاتٍ مِّنْ نَّشَأٍ): We raise to degrees whom We will. Allah (ﷻ) will raise a person in ranks, and it did not say how much in ranks, so it's unlimited. And how does a person get elevation? With knowledge. Everybody is learning, but not everyone has the same rank. In this life, you have those in work who 'climb the ladder', but once you reach the top, you retire in the end, but Allah (ﷻ) raises according to His will.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 77

قَالُوا إِن يَسْرِقْ فَقَدْ سَرَقَ أَخٌ لَهُ مِنْ قَبْلُ فَأَسْرَهَا يُوسُفُ فِي نَفْسِهِ وَلَمْ يُبْدِهَا لَهُمْ قَالَ أَنْتُمْ شَرُّ مَكَانٍ وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا تَصِفُونَ (٧٧)

They [(Yûsufs (Joseph) brothers] said: "If he steals, there was a brother of his [Yûsuf (Joseph)] who did steal before (him)." But these things did Yûsuf (Joseph) keep in himself, revealing not the secrets to them. He said (within himself): "You are in worst case, and Allâh is the Best Knower of that which you describe!" (77)

- Imagine in a class of 2nd graders, they might all pass and go on to the 3rd grade, but each one passed with a different level.
- Only Allah (ﷻ) knows what is our level in knowledge, so we should not judge others. Maybe the person who you think doesn't have knowledge, knows more, and the one you think has knowledge, might not know. And we should not worry about what others have because that causes sicknesses in the heart – it causes jealousy, hatred, etc.
- And when Allah (ﷻ) elevates in rank, it is associated with His will – meaning based on His knowledge and wisdom. Allah (ﷻ) knows if that person deserves that rank or not.

Who are the people who deserve to go up in ranks?

- Surah Al Mujadila 11: (يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا إِذَا قِيلَ لَكُمْ تَفَسَّحُوا فِي الْمَجَالِسِ فَافْسَحُوا) يَفْسَحِ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَإِذَا قِيلَ انشُزُوا فَانْشُزُوا يَرْفَعِ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا مِنْكُمْ وَالَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْعِلْمَ دَرَجَاتٍ

(وَاللَّهُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ خَبِيرٌ) (O you who believe! When you are told to make room in the assemblies, (spread out and) make room. Allâh will give you (ample) room (from His Mercy). And when you are told to rise up [for prayers, or for any other good deed], rise up. Allâh will exalt in degree those of you who believe, and those who have been granted knowledge. And Allâh is Well-Acquainted with what you do)

- Sometimes in a very crowded place like the harem, masjid, make space for others and Allah (ﷻ) will make space for you, be in the duniya, grave, or on the Day of Judgement. Who is the one who will do this? Those with belief and knowledge.
- These are the two means you need to do in order to get elevation in rank and knowledge. We don't want to be machines, we want to have the urge and then do.

(1) Allâh will exalt in degree those of you who believe (يَرْفَعُ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا)

(مِنْكُمْ)

- When you believe in Allah (ﷻ), Allah will bring you up. The more you increase your faith, the more elevation you will get. Allah (ﷻ) surrounded us with different opportunities to increase our faith:
 - Look at the birds, they are great teachers, no attachment, ihsan, ikhlas, and tawakul. Look at the sea, it teaches you submission and vastness. Look at the flowers, their beauty and perfection, subhan Allah.

- And look at the creation, will make you think of the Creator who created it all. A Bedouin was asked how do you know that Allah (ﷻ) is there? He said if I see traces, then I will know someone was there. So when I see the vast creation, of the heavens, the sun and the moon, then of course it is sign of Al Lateef Al Khabeer.
- The Prophet ((ﷺ)) asked a little girl where is Allah? And she pointed up. Then he said free her since she was a slave girl, for she is a believer. When you are a believer you free yourself from the hellfire, you free yourself from the duniya, you free yourself from attachments.
- Decrees increase you in faith.
- The Qur'an increases you in faith. If you cannot read, you can see. There was a famous actress who was tired of her life. She wanted to escape and went to an island. And that island happens to be where there are Muslims and they gave her the Qur'an as a gift. So she took the Qur'an, and opened to Surah Al Mulk, and it said to look at the sky and she looked at the sky. Look at the earth, she looked at the earth, and she said her heart was open to these words. And then she went back and investigated about Islam and became a Muslim, subhan Allah.
- An atom of good deed, or atom of bad deed, you will see. Elevation in ranks is unlimited, but our means is to increase in faith.

- Alhamdulillah that we have our hearing and seeing in order to be grateful. Allah (ﷻ) wants you to see and hear in order to increase you in faith.

(2) Those who have been granted knowledge (وَالَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْعِلْمَ)

- What will make my faith increase? To increase in knowledge. That is why the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not ask for any increment, except (ربي زدني علما) (Oh My Rabb, increase me in knowledge) and that is a dua'a that Allah (ﷻ) told him to make. Someone who knows is different from someone who does not. Which knowledge will reform a person? The beneficial knowledge, any knowledge that you will learn that will make you learn more about Allah (ﷻ). The knowledge that will make you believe more in Allah (ﷻ). You have so many things associated with the Qur'an, like memorization, tajweed, pondering, but which one is the top? When you ponder upon the Qur'an. Don't worry about when you will finish. Allah (ﷻ) does not want us to hasten with the Qur'an.
- The knowledge I need to learn needs to increase me in faith. We all know the story of the companions of the Elephant, but look at the first ayah (الم تر كيف فعل ربك بأصحاب الفيل), did you not see what your Rabb

did to the companions of the elephant? So it shows you to look at the actions of Allah (ﷻ).

(3) The Qur'an

- Hadith: وعن عمر بن الخطاب رضي الله عنه: أن النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم قال : " إن الله (ﷻ) يرفع بهذا الكتاب أقوامًا " ((رواه مسلم)) ('Umar bin Al-Khattab (May Allah be pleased with him) reported: The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "Verily, Allah elevates some people with this Qur'an.") – Muslim Book 9, Hadith 996
- If you focus and ponder the Qur'an, Allah (ﷻ) will elevate people in rank. Don't you find sweetness when you ponder the ayat of the Qur'an? It upgrades you and makes you think about the Qur'an. What will elevate you in rank, it is the Qur'an.
- When you look at a person before the Qur'an and after the Qur'an, you see they have been an upgraded person. We do not see our rank, but we need to continue.

(4) Whoever humbles himself before Allah (ﷻ) (من تواضع لله رفعه)

- If you humble yourself then Allah (ﷻ) will elevate you. The more you humble yourself to Allah (ﷻ), to others, spouse, those who work with you, then Allah (ﷻ) will elevated you. Don't see yourself as better than others – the opposite of humbleness is arrogance. People say if you

are so kind to the housekeeper then she will take advantage of you, but Allah (ﷻ) said if you are humble, then He will elevate you, this is the promise of Allah (ﷻ).

- (وَفَوْقَ كُلِّ): There will always be someone above you in knowledge, whether knowledge of the duniya or the deen. And whoever is higher in knowledge, there is always one even higher than them in knowledge, and one always higher than that, and this continues until it reaches Allah (ﷻ) Who is the Knower of the Seen and Unseen, subhan Allah.
- (ذِي عِلْمٍ > عَلِيمٌ): (ذِي عِلْمٍ) is a hyperbole of how much knowledge, it is an excessive form of knowledge and that is more than (ذِي عِلْمٍ) which means owner of knowledge, for example, someone is owner of knowledge in hadith, tafseer, chemistry, etc.
- (ذِي عِلْمٍ عَلِيمٌ): this also teaches you that there will always be someone more knowledgeable than you, you will not be number one. And this removes any sickness in the heart, do not complete or be jealous. Do not worry about being better than someone, you need to compete against yourself to overcome your weaknesses. And when you are wanting to be better than someone else then that is arrogance.

- Remember Surah Al Ikhlas, Allah is (أحد) – and He made each of us unique, and the way we will reach Him is unique. Even with your children, you cannot say ‘your brother, your sister is better’ because that is unjust. No two are alike, not even twins. So when you are comparing then that is unjust. You cannot compare one student to another or one teacher to another because that is (ظلم), unjust. Because we don’t like to be compared to our brothers or sisters or even to our mothers. Allah (ﷻ) created everything beautiful, so who are we to compare, subhan Allah. Everyone has a different talent.
- You need to strive for elevation in order to reach Allah (ﷻ), and it is specifically mentioned about knowledge, because with knowledge a person can become very arrogant, a tyrant, like Qarun.
- Don’t stress about being first, because there will always be someone else above. Just like when you go to Mecca, you think you want to go early and no one will be there, but there is always someone there, subhan Allah.
- Another benefit from this ayah is that it is impossible for anyone to be the most knowledge because only Allah is Al Aleem (العليم) – The Most Knowledgeable. So the First and the Last is Allah, He is the First to have knowledge and He is the Last to have knowledge.
- Anyone who claims that I have so much knowledge, then he actually does not know. The more knowledge you have, the more you realize that you don’t know.

- Surah Al Isra'a 85: (وَمَا أُوتِيتُمْ مِّنَ الْعِلْمِ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا) (And you have been given from knowledge only little)
- We don't know anything about souls. We don't know how it looks like, where it is located, etc?
- When you take the knowledge of the two most knowledgeable people, which was Musa (عليه السلام) and Al Khudr, who was a righteous man, each had a different kind of knowledge, Musa (عليه السلام) had divine knowledge and Al Khudr had knowledge of decrees. And if you combine all of their knowledge, it is just like a drop in the ocean relative to the knowledge of Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah.
- In self-development classes they are just pumping people, and in the end, they pump them so much that when they pop, it is just air inside. And they end up being a pain to those around them, so they go from one problem to another, subhan Allah.
- The results of knowledge are with Allah (ﷻ), He elevates whom He wills, that is the impact of Al Akhar. We take the means, but it is Allah (ﷻ) who elevates. And the more humble you are, the more Allah (ﷻ) will elevate you.
- You cannot graduate from knowledge, imagine getting a certificate that says you finished the Qur'an, did you really finish the Qur'an? No subhan Allah. You will graduate when you enter paradise. That is why the scholars do not call themselves scholars but students of knowledge.

- The students of Abdul Wahab finished Kitab Al Tawheed, so they said we want to move on. So he did a practical test for them. He said there was a man who committed an affair with his mother, and there reaction was of absolute disgust, how can this be? Then he told them he saw some people worshipping a tree, and the students' reaction was mild, so then he told them you all failed, we will repeat the book again, subhan Allah. Why? Shirk is the greatest of sins.
- You feel there are no boundaries with knowledge, there is no end. In religion, Allah is Vast, for example, you might learn an ayah, and you think you want to move on, but when you learn it again, and there is elevation, you learn more out of it. Learning does not mean you need new information, learning old information again will benefit you more than new information. Learning old information will make you see it from another angle and it is elevation in rank.
- When you know this ayah, it will make you humble to the truth. Also, if a teacher is being corrected by a student, it is to make the teacher humble and to show the students that all are human, even a teacher, so don't elevate teachers. And the first teacher to humanity was the crow, to Qabeel to bury his brother, subhan Allah. For example, even if your children might say you told me we will do this, you need to accept the truth and lower yourself.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 77

قَالُوا إِن يَسْرِقْ فَقَدْ سَرَقَ أَخٌ لَهُ مِنْ قَبْلُ فَأَسْرَهَا يُوسُفُ فِي نَفْسِهِ وَلَمْ يُبْدِهَا لَهُمْ قَالَ أَنْتُمْ شَرُّ مَكَانٍ وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا تَصِفُونَ (٧٧)

They [(Yûsufs (Joseph) brothers] said: "If he steals, there was a brother of his [Yûsuf (Joseph)] who did steal before (him)." But these things did Yûsuf (Joseph) keep in himself, revealing not the secrets to them. He said (within himself): "You are in worst case, and Allâh is the Best Knower of that which you describe!" (77)

- They are saying that if he steals, then he has another brother that steals. To say as if they come from one mother, and Benyamin and Yusuf (عليه السلام) come from another mother, so they are alike in doing bad things, subhan Allah. And this shows pride in their lineage.
- And look at this situation, they did bad to him and he pardoned them. And now they are accusing him of things he did not do, and they are in a position of being needy on top of that. So what is a person supposed to do in such a situation?
- They are saying that if he steals, then he has another brother that steals. To say as if they come from one mother, and Benyamin and Yusuf (عليه السلام) come from another mother, so they are alike in doing bad things, subhan Allah. And that they are the good ones, and this shows pride in their lineage.
- The reality in their heart appeared because they said:
- (إِنْ يَسْرِقْ): If he steals. Notice this time they mentioned stealing and before when the king's cup was missing they mentioned perhaps it was forgotten, subhan Allah.
- (فَقَدْ سَرَقَ أَخٌ لَهُ مِنْ قَبْلُ): there was a brother of his [Yûsuf (Joseph)] who did steal before (him). This is information that does not even need to be mentioned. And when we see someone doing bad, we say yeah

his dad does the same, subhan Allah. And this shows that we do this, it is in our nature, and Allah (ﷻ) is pointing this out to us to show it is unjust, subhan Allah.

- Similarly when a person has something against another person in their heart, when someone else comes to the one who has the sickness in the heart and mentions the name of the person they have something against them, they will just explode when they hear their name. And this is nurturing to show that there is a sickness in the heart. And this can be held in the heart even for years. For example, the brothers were away from Yusuf (عليه السلام) for years, thinking that there would not be something in their heart, but this situation shows that it is still embedded in their heart, and this nurturing exposes them, subhan Allah.
- Sometimes a person might say look at what those people are doing, and then you say, 'well I don't do that'. It is not necessary to say this, because this exposes you to show there is something.
- (أَخِيَّ): brother of his. Notice they did not say 'our brother', but rather a 'brother of his' to show distance and disconnection from them, and all the while they do not know they are talking to their brother Yusuf (عليه السلام), subhan Allah. And this shows you that you do not know who you are talking to, that is why a believer will only say what is good or remains quiet.
- After hearing this, Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not lash out at them, he even controlled his inner-thoughts. He did not judge them or react, subhan

Allah. And this shows how much forbearance and (إناة), no hastiness, that he has.

كيف تعامل يوسف عليه السلام (عليه السلام) deal with his brothers? (مع اخوته؟)

Imagine someone who has oppressed you before, is accusing you, and they are in the lower hand as well. What will you do in such a situation?

1. (فَأَسْرَهَا يُوسُفُ فِي نَفْسِهِ): He kept it secretly to himself. What is this secret?

Whatever they did to him in the past and what they are accusing of him now, he hid his feelings from his brothers. And this shows so much ihsan. He did not disclose this to anybody, he did not go to others and talk about his feelings or emotions. If he did not hide his feelings, then it will show in his face, tongue, and reaction, and this can lead to (ظلم), and wronging them on the other hand. Don't think that it is not possible to reach this level, but at least hoping from Allah (ﷻ) to have these characteristics is a reward of itself, even if you did not achieve. And alhamdulillah that we can always hope from Allah (ﷻ) because that is what keeps us going in this life. And Allah (ﷻ) is Ar Rahman Ar Raheem (الرحمن الرحيم), He is the Most Merciful. And you are always a winner when you are with Allah (ﷻ).

- Also Yusuf (عليه السلام) has an image in front of Allah (ﷻ), so he will not show it in his face that he is affected by their accusation, subhan Allah.
2. (وَلَمْ يُبْدِهَا لَهُمْ): It did not show in his face, reaction, or speech. He had feelings inside himself, but no one one knew. When we see these reactions of the Prophets it shows us that is the balanced way, because they are on the Sirat Al Mustaqeem, and this is the correct way of reacting. But we need have hope from Allah (ﷻ) to be able to reach.
 3. What was his boundary of speaking? He just spoke to himself, he did not speak to others about his situation, subhan Allah. We think that we can say whatever we want when we are talking to ourselves, that we can talk bad about people as long as it is to ourselves, but this is not what Yusuf (عليه السلام) did, subhan Allah. He remembered Allah (ﷻ) because if not, then a train of endless thoughts would go in the mind, and it just makes you sad in the end. He did not mention directly to them you need to seek forgiveness in Allah (ﷻ) for what you did because that is not the time or place now, and this shows so much wisdom, subhan Allah.
 - (قَالَ أَنْتُمْ شَرُّ مَكَانٍ): You are in a worst position. Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not call them as evil or wicked people (أَنْتُمْ أَشْرَارُ), he did not describe them as evil people, but he just said that the position they took was bad, subhan Allah. He is not saying

they are bad as a whole, because they are still his brothers, and they are still slaves of Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Look at his justness, he has been oppressed and accused, and he is still being just and this shows so much ihsan. He is not elaborating on the evil they did because it will weaken you when you remember the details of the bad that has been done to you. You will not be able to do ihsan in your worship.

- (وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا تَصِفُونَ): And Allâh is the Best Knower of that which you describe. So Yusuf (عليه السلام) is remembering Allah (ﷻ) and this gives him closure and relief to his thoughts to know that Allah (ﷻ) is the All-Knower and that there will be a Day when all will be held accountable.

قَالُوا يَا أَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ إِنَّ لَهُ أَبًا شَيْخًا كَبِيرًا فَخُذْ أَحَدَنَا مَكَانَهُ إِنَّا نَرَاكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ (٧٨)

They said: "O ruler of the land! Verily, he has an old father (who will grieve for him); so take one of us in his place. Indeed we think that you are one of the Muhsinûn (78)

- They had previously mentioned that they have a brother who also steals, though this was a false accusation, and it shows that the sickness in their heart is still there, subhan Allah. Keep in mind the brothers are in the lower-hand, and now their tone changes because they realized they said something that was out of line. Though Yusuf (عليه السلام) could have replied back to them since he is in that position,

but he did not, and this elevated Yusuf (عليه السلام). Nothing goes to waste with Allah (ﷻ). So what did the brothers do next?

- (قَالُوا يَا أَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ): **They said: "O ruler of the land!.** Notice that before these very brothers were placing Yusuf (عليه السلام) in a well, and know they are calling Yusuf (عليه السلام) the title of 'Aziz'. And this shows you the ability of Allah (ﷻ) to honor whom He wills and humiliate whom He wills. Allah (ﷻ) will always show His support to His slaves. And Yusuf (عليه السلام) is seeing the actions of Allah (ﷻ) before his eyes.
 - They are saying (الْعَزِيزُ) meaning the 'one who is dear and the one in a high rank'. And this shows human nature that when we want something, we call upon the person with the best names, subhan Allah.
- (إِنَّ لَهُ أَبًا شَيْخًا كَبِيرًا): **Verily, he has an old father.** They are saying this to play with Yusuf's (عليه السلام) emotions in order to soften him. And they are saying that the father is really, really old since (شَيْخًا) already means old man, and again they are saying (كَبِيرًا), which is also old. They are trying to hint that their father is old, and he would grieve if he would be separated from this son in particular. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is being tested with the two sons that he is attached to the most, Yusuf (عليه السلام) and Benjamin. But it is nurturing in order to be elevated and purified. What are they giving as a suggestion?

- (فَخُذْ أَحَدَنَا مَكَانَهُ): **so take one of us in his place.** For anyone else, it wouldn't have mattered which brother to take, but for Yusuf (عليه السلام) it matters because he specifically wants his younger brother.
 - The brothers made this suggestion because they knew that their father is more attached to the younger brother. And this shows you that children are a test for the parents and the parents are a test for the children. And for the parents, they are supposed to give to their children equally, but when it comes to feelings it is difficult to be fair, because you love the child that treats you the best. And the other children can sense who the parents love the most, subhan Allah.
 - The brothers need to know that love is a provision from Allah (ﷻ), you cannot fight for love. You cannot force anyone to love or hate.
- (إِنَّا نَرَىكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ): **Indeed we think that you are one of the Muhsinûn.**

This was the same statement that was mentioned by the prisoners. The prisoners do not even know Yusuf (عليه السلام) but from Yusuf's (عليه السلام) attitude that could see that he is of the muhsineen, good-doers. And similarly, with the brothers, they are calling him of the muhsineen. This shows affirmation that truly he is of the muhsineen. For example, if you go through an incident and someone calls you something, maybe it was just in that situation, but if you are told again in another situation then it shows that truly it is a part of your attitude, subhan Allah. Though Yusuf (عليه السلام) was in prison and now he is in a place of position, he was of the muhsineen in both situations, and this shows

you that situations do not change the goodness of a person, subhan Allah.

- The two prisoners were disbelievers and the brothers are the sons of Yaqoub (عليه السلام), so they are believers. And this shows you that Yusuf (عليه السلام) was good both to the believers and disbelievers, subhan Allah.
- The Prophet (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said the best among you are those who are good in the house first. And we end up being on 'good behavior' when outside, but so different inside the house, subhan Allah.
- So the brothers are calling Yusuf (عليه السلام) of the muhsineen in order to indirectly tell him to be good to us (فاحسن اليينا), our father (احسن الى ابينا), and to our younger brother (احسن الى اخينا), subhan Allah. Instead of saying 'give me and do this for me', they are using a title instead, subhan Allah.

قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ أَنْ نَأْخُذَ إِلَّا مَنْ وَجَدْنَا مَتَّعَنَا عِنْدَهُ إِنَّا إِذَا لَظَلِمُونَ (٧٩)

He said: "Allâh forbid, that we should take anyone but him with whom we found our property. Indeed (if we did so), we should be Zâlimûn (wrong-doers)." (79)

- (قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ): **He said: "Allâh forbid.** This was mentioned before when the wife of Aziz was following Yusuf (عليه السلام), so he sought refuge in Allah (جَلَّ). And this time, he is saying it because, Allah forbid, how

could he take one of them since that would be unjust, subhan Allah. And this shows you that his attitude did not change according to the situation, subhan Allah.

- And the test this time is greater for Yusuf (عليه السلام) because he in a place of position and he could have easily said no, but it shows that he did not rely on his position, but he relied on Allah (ﷻ).

قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ أَنْ نَأْخُذَ إِلَّا مَنْ وَجَدْنَا مَتَّعْنَا عِنْدَهُ إِنَّا إِذَا لَظَلِمُونَ (٧٩)

He said: "Allâh forbid, that we should take anyone but him with whom we found our property. Indeed (if we did so), we should be Zâlimûn (wrong-doers)." (79)

Introduction:

- Don't deal with Allah (ﷻ) as if you are rich and sufficient, as if you already know, or already have. You have to be poor and in need of Allah (ﷻ).
- In the story of Yusuf (عليه السلام), though he is the main character, but we learn many things from the others. We see how they act, and we see how Allah (ﷻ) dealt with them, so we see the actions of Allah (ﷻ). And this is sunnat Allah, the way of Allah (ﷻ) is one. This shows you that

you can understand this life with the correct knowledge of (قال الله و), without having to go through experiences in life.

He said: Allâh forbid (قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ):

- (قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ): **He said: "Allâh forbid.** This was mentioned before when the wife of Aziz was following Yusuf (عليه السلام), so he sought refuge in Allah (ﷻ). And this time, he is saying it because, Allah forbid, how could he take one of them since that would be unjust, subhan Allah. And this shows you that his attitude did not change according to the situation, subhan Allah.
- And the test is greater for Yusuf (عليه السلام) because he is in a place of position and he could have easily said no, but it shows that he did not rely on his position, but relied on Allah (ﷻ).
- (مَعَاذَ): means refuge, shelter. And Who is his refuge? Allah (ﷻ). When someone is being pushed to transgression, don't be confident in yourself that you are strong and can handle it – that is failing the test. You need to feel that you can only have protection and shelter with Allah (ﷻ).
- He is seeking refuge in Allah from doing any kind of wrong, injustice, or sin. In this case he is seeking refuge to not commit a wrong, which is to take a brother that did not do anything. And it shows you that he did not depend on himself, though he is a messenger, subhan Allah. So what about us? We need to always turn to Allah, subhan Allah.

That we should take anyone but him with whom we found our property
(أَنْ نَّأْخُذَ إِلَّا مَنْ وَجَدْنَا مَتَّعَنَا عَنْدَهُ):

- (أَنْ نَّأْخُذَ إِلَّا مَنْ وَجَدْنَا مَتَّعَنَا عَنْدَهُ): **That we should take anyone but him with whom we found our property.** Notice Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not say who 'stole' from us, though the brothers are speaking with the word 'stolen'. He is so careful to not say any lie, he is so truthful. It shows how much we have to take care of our tongue. For example, if someone comes and says 'they stole this from me', don't say, what did they 'steal'? Because you have not verified it is stolen, instead say what was is missing, subhan Allah.

Indeed (if we did so), we should be Zâlimûn (wrong-doers). (إِنَّا إِذَا لَظَلِمُونَ):

- (إِنَّا إِذَا لَظَلِمُونَ): **Indeed (if we did so), we should be Zâlimûn (wrong-doers).** There are three affirmations here. (إِنَّا) and (لَ) and (ظَلِمُونَ), which is a noun, it is stronger.
- Notice the humbleness of Yusuf (عليه السلام) for someone in a position of authority to say that he would be a wrong-doer. People in authority do not normally say this, but it shows the humbleness of Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- It would be an oppression to lay out a penalty against someone who is not deserving of it – it would be out of place (وضعنا العقوبة في غير محلها).

Surah Yusuf Ayah 80

فَلَمَّا اسْتَيْسُوا مِنْهُ خَلَصُوا نَجِيًّا قَالَ كَبِيرُهُمْ أَلَمْ تَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ أَبَاكُمْ قَدْ أَخَذَ عَلَيْكُمْ مَوْثِقًا مِنَ اللَّهِ
وَمِنْ قَبْلُ مَا فَرَّطْتُمْ فِي يُوسُفَ فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِيَ أَبِي أَوْ يَحْكُمَ اللَّهُ لِي وَهُوَ خَيْرُ الْحَكِمِينَ
(٨٠)

So, when they despaired of him, they held a conference in private. The eldest among them said: "Know you not that your father did take an oath from you in Allâh's Name, and before this you did fail in your duty with Yûsuf (Joseph)? Therefore I will not leave this land until my father permits me, or Allâh decides my case (by releasing Benjamin) and He is the Best of the judges. (80)

- (فَلَمَّا اسْتَيْسُوا مِنْهُ) **So, when they despaired of him:** this is when the brothers were trying to convince Yusuf (عليه السلام) to not take their younger brother, until they reached the point of desperation (اليأس). Desperation is reaching the point of no hope (قطع الأمل). But using the word (اسْتَيْسُوا) shows no hope whatsoever, it is very intense.
- They lost hope because Yusuf (عليه السلام) was saying no all the time. He did not respond to what they wanted.
- (وَمِنْ قَبْلُ مَا فَرَّطْتُمْ فِي يُوسُفَ فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِيَ أَبِي أَوْ يَحْكُمَ اللَّهُ لِي وَهُوَ خَيْرُ الْحَكِمِينَ) **they held a conference in private:** after having lost hope, the ten older brothers, without the younger brother, met all together.
 - (اجتمعوا) (وَمِنْ قَبْلُ مَا فَرَّطْتُمْ فِي يُوسُفَ فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِيَ أَبِي أَوْ يَحْكُمَ اللَّهُ لِي وَهُوَ خَيْرُ الْحَكِمِينَ): means they secluded themselves, it is private. (وَمِنْ قَبْلُ مَا فَرَّطْتُمْ فِي يُوسُفَ فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِيَ أَبِي أَوْ يَحْكُمَ اللَّهُ لِي وَهُوَ خَيْرُ الْحَكِمِينَ). It is purely, and only them.
 - (خلص): means to separate, seclude, and finish.

- They lost hope because Yusuf (عليه السلام) was saying no all the time. He did not respond to what they wanted.
- (خَلَصُوا) **they held a conference in private**: after having lost hope, the ten older brothers, without the younger brother, all met together.
 - (اجتمعوا): means they secluded themselves, it is private. (وحدهم منفردين ليس معهم غيرهم). It is purely and only them.
 - (خلص): means to separate, seclude, and finish.
- (نَجِيًّا) **very low voice**: though the brothers were already separated from the rest, but (نَجِيًّا) means to speak in a very low voice about something secret and private (النجوى أسر الحديث و خاص). For example, when there are three people, and two people are talking lowly amongst themselves, this is not allowed, because the shaitan will make the third person think that they are talking about him. But if it is four people, and two are talking with each other, then it is ok. If you see two people sitting and talking to each other and then their voices are lowered, don't approach them, don't say what are you talking about. You should know that these two people are talking to each other, don't come and interrupt, subhan Allah.
- (قَالَ كَبِيرُهُمْ): **The eldest among them said**: there is always a head in a meeting/conference, and in this case it was clear that the oldest brother is the one leading. What did he say?

- (أَلَمْ تَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ آبَاكُمْ قَدْ أَخَذَ عَلَيْكُمْ مَوْتَقًا): **Know you not that your**

father did take an oath from you: Notice he said 'your father', to show that they are all involved, not just him. This is a good way to start a meeting by reminding others why they are here in the first place. And they made an oath by Allah (مِنَ اللَّهِ).

The oath was to protect their younger brother Benjamin and bring him back, unless they are surrounded and unable to do so. Imagine if you borrow a set of jewelry from your friend and you lose it. Would you have the face to ask borrow her jewelry again? Now imagine they have lost Yusuf (عليه السلام) and they asked to take Benjamin and now they are in a situation where they could lose him again, subhan Allah.

- (وَمِنْ قَبْلُ مَا فَرَّطْتُمْ فِي يُوسُفَ): **And before this you did fail in your**

duty with Yûsuf (Joseph)?: They did not say to 'lose' him, but (فَرَّطَ), which means to lose something (ضَيَّعَ) out of negligence (أَهْمَلَ) and shortcomings (قَصَرَ). It can also mean exceeding the boundaries (مَجَاوِزَةُ الْحَدِّ وَاعْتِدَاءً). They exceeded their boundaries with Yusuf (عليه السلام) by putting him in a well, they intentionally did it, subhan Allah. What is the decision?

- (فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ): **Therefore I will not leave this land.** This shows it is the diplomatic way that when making a decision, he needs to give the reasons first, and then the decision. Imagine if making a decision that affects all without giving a reason, it will make the people upset and

can make them think wrongly. So this shows you especially what to do when people are in a leadership role and have to control the crowd when making a decision, subhan Allah. (أَبْرَحَ) means 'to leave' (تَرَكَ), and the verb is in the future tense. And notice that he did not mention Egypt, but 'the land' to show that he is fixed there. He will not leave this land unless one of these two things happen:

- (حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِي أَبِي): **Until my father permits me.** For the father to give him permission to leave the country without his brother. And this shows there are still principles, subhan Allah. He gave an oath to his father, and he cannot face him, so he needs permission from him if he can leave, and this is good, subhan Allah.
- (أَوْ يَحْكُمَ اللَّهُ لِي): **or Allâh decides my case (by releasing Benjamin).** Or that Allah (ﷻ) will decree something for me that will allow me to return back with my brother Benjamin, subhan Allah. And this shows that he has great hope from Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. (يَحْكُمَ لِي) means to make a judgement in my favor, meaning victory for him. He has no way to bring him back, but he knows that Allah (ﷻ) can decree something to bring back his brother, subhan Allah.
- (وَهُوَ خَيْرُ الْحَكَمِينَ) **And He is the Best of the judges:** There is always a solution when you return to Allah (ﷻ). Sometimes we go through

problems, but it gives us relief when we turn to Allah (ﷻ). It gives us tranquility when we know that Allah (ﷻ) is the best to decide. When you look at the end, Allah (ﷻ) decreed that all of the family, including the father and mother to come. Allah (ﷻ) gave him even better what he was thinking, subhan Allah. But it is important to always think good about Allah (ﷻ). Allah (ﷻ) is the best to judge and decide because He is perfect. Alhamdulillah.

أَرْجِعُوا إِلَىٰ آبَائِكُمْ فَقُولُوا يَا أَبَانَا إِنَّ أَبْنَاكَ سَرَقَ وَمَا شَهِدْنَا إِلَّا بِمَا عَلِمْنَا وَمَا كُنَّا لِلْغَيْبِ حَفِظِينَ

(٨١)

"Return to your father and say, 'O our father! Verily, your son (Benjamin) has stolen, and we testify not except according to what we know, and we could not know the unseen! (81)

- When making repentance you need to really feel bad and regret, you can't just say I will repent. The older brother is telling the other brothers what to say to their father.
- (أَرْجِعُوا إِلَىٰ آبَائِكُمْ): **Return to your father.** He is telling all of his brothers to go back because imagine their father Yacoub (عليه السلام) is now losing two sons. So the older brother does not want that all of the brothers to not return. And notice he said (أَبِيكُمْ) – 'your father'. And he did not

say return to 'so and so place', but to their father because that is what is important.

- What did the older brother tell his other brothers to say to their father?
- (فَقُولُوا يَا أَبَانَا إِنَّ أَبْنَكَ سَرَقَ): **And say, 'O our father! Verily, your son**

(Benjamin) has stolen. Though he has not actually stolen, but this is what they know. They did not want to give full details of what happened, how they tried to negotiate with Yusuf (عليه السلام), etc. So he told them to begin by telling their father of the rights of Allah, which is that his younger son stole. And their father is a messenger, so he would not like stealing. If they tell him this, then he would accept that this is something wrong, so it makes sense that it would cause him to stay behind.

- And notice they said (أَبْنَكَ) 'your son' instead of 'our brother' to dissociate themselves from the wrong-doer. And this is very common, when your child does something bad, you go and tell your spouse, 'look what your son did, look what your daughter did', subhan Allah.
- (وَمَا شَهِدْنَا إِلَّا بِمَا عَلِمْنَا): **and we testify not except according to what we**

know. They are saying what they witnessed. And they saw the cup in their younger brother's bag. Though remember that Yusuf (عليه السلام) never said he stole, he only said that the cup was in the brother's bag. And the brother's also said before that it might be missing, so they never used the word 'stole' throughout, but now they are telling the father that he stole, subhan Allah. Why? Because they want to give a strong excuse to their father as to why their son stayed behind, so they said that he stole, subhan Allah.

- Though they did not really witness any stealing, they just saw that the cup was in his bag.
- (وَمَا كُنَّا لِلْغَيْبِ حَافِظِينَ): **and we could not know the unseen.** So the older brother is telling them to tell their father by shocking him first, that his son stole. And now they are saying they are not 'memorizing/preserving the unseen', which is very exaggerated, they did not even say what is normally said, 'we do not know the unseen'. And notice the brothers use the word (حَافِظِينَ) a few times throughout the surah.
- So by making this statement, they are saying that if they knew the unseen:
 - Then we would not have given a promise to you, oh father.
(لَمَا اعْطَيْنَاكَ الْمِيثَاقَ)
 - Then we would not be eager in taking him, the younger brother, with us (لَمَا حَرَصْنَا فِي ذَهَابِهِ مَعَنَا)
 - Then we would have known that he would do something like this (مَاذَا فَعَلَ اخُونَا)
- The older brother then said if the father is not convinced with this argument, then to tell him what is next in ayah 82.
- Remember when they placed Yusuf (عليه السلام) in the well, they told their father that he was eaten by a wolf, and they told their father you would not believe us even if we are truthful, but notice this time they did not say it in this manner, subhan Allah.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 82

وَسَلِّ الْقَرْيَةَ الَّتِي كُنَّا فِيهَا وَالْعِيرَ الَّتِي أَقْبَلْنَا فِيهَا وَإِنَّا لَصَدِّقُونَ (٨٢)

"And ask (the people of) the town where we have been, and the caravan in which we returned, and indeed we are telling the truth." (82)

- (وَسَلِّ): **And ask.** They are telling the father to ask, ask who?
- (الْقَرْيَةَ الَّتِي كُنَّا فِيهَا): **(the people of) the town where we have been.**
Notice that they are calling Egypt as a 'town' (الْقَرْيَةَ), though remember that before there are 'women of the city' (نسوة المدينة). They are calling Egypt as a town as if all the people would know about it, subhan Allah.
- (وَالْعِيرَ الَّتِي أَقْبَلْنَا فِيهَا): **and the caravan in which we returned.** Though it is easier to ask the caravan first than to ask the people of the town, subhan Allah.
- (وَإِنَّا لَصَدِّقُونَ): **indeed we are telling the truth.** They are saying that they are telling the truth.

Surah Yusuf Ayah 83

قَالَ بَلْ سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ عَسَى اللَّهُ أَنْ يَأْتِيَنِي بِهِمْ جَمِيعًا إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ (٨٣)

He [Ya'qûb (Jacob)] said: "Nay, but your ownelves have beguiled you into something. So patience is most fitting (for me). May be Allâh will

bring them (back) all to me. Truly He! only He is All-Knowing, All-Wise."
(83)

- (قَالَ): **He [Ya'qûb (Jacob)] said** . Yaqoub (عليه السلام), their father is speaking.
- (بَلَى): **Nay**. This means whatever comes before is all false, and whatever comes next is affirming the truth. So he is rejecting all that they said, and he is affirming what he says after (بَلَى), subhan Allah. And this shows you that once you break the trust, it is very difficult to fix it again, subhan Allah.
- (سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا): **but your ownelves have beguiled you into something**. And this shows you that Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is a human as well, he is not an angel, so he is bound to have feelings inside, but he controls his outside, subhan Allah. You need to control the outside because it can affect the people. For example, sometimes you are feeling sad or upset in the inside, but you don't need to show it to everyone because it can affect the people, subhan Allah. And this is the middle path because people can be of two extremes, they reveal everything inside of them, or there are those who think they can just get rid of these feelings, subhan Allah. These words were also mentioned in ayah 18 when they brought the shirt with fake blood, and he did not believe them because they were lying anyway. Though they are telling the truth this time, the trust has been broken, subhan Allah. Let's say for example, if you have a child that is always lying and you label that child, then they will believe it. You don't want

to give a title to your child that they are lazy, useless, etc because it becomes a part of them, subhan Allah.

- (سَوَّلَ) → (سَوَّلَ): means to love to do what you want (حَبَبَ), to make it easy for you (سَهَّلَ), to beautify it for you (زَيَّنَ), to persuade, convince you (أَغْرَى). If you give the key to your nafs, then it will take you to the hellfire, that is why you have to struggle against your nafs, otherwise it commands to evil, subhan Allah. For example you are tempted to backbite, the nafs will make you want it, to say that it is confidence to talk back, and it debates with you to show you that it is easy, subhan Allah.
- (لَكُمْ): for you
- (أَنْفُسُكُمْ): your nafs.
- (أَمْرًا): matter, what is the matter that their self is insisting upon?

That his son has stolen (ان ابنك سرق).

- (فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ): **So patience is most fitting (for me).** Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is saying to himself very loudly that he is fleeing to Allah (ﷻ) in order to give him this beautiful patience (الصبْر الجميل). He did not say 'I will be patient', he said 'beautiful patience' so he detached it from himself and relied fully on Allah (ﷻ). That is why do not say 'I am patient', do not be confident in yourself, and do not

ascribe purity to yourself. Confidence in Islam is your belief in Allah (ﷻ), you cannot get it from yourself because we are weak and our mind is limited. What does beautiful patience mean?

- Similar to (لا حول ولا قوة الا بالله) – there is no might and no power except by Allah
- It also means (انا لله وانا اليه راجعون) – We belong to Allah and verily to Him we will return. And Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is in a situation of hardship.
- (صبر) means (حبس النفس), holding the nafs.
- How can patience be beautiful? It includes holding the nafs as mentioned before, but it also includes not being angry inside yourself or complaining to the creation (لا تسخط فيه ولا) (شكوى للخلق). It is not a beautiful patience when you are being patient and complaining to the people – this is harming yourself and it is not patience anyways.
- You find people who might not be complaining to the people but they are steaming inside, and they have anxiety, they are slamming doors, cutting their hair, screaming loudly to themselves, etc – they are hurting themselves and they are also hurting the nature, subhan Allah. That is why your attitude and manner is very important, what you do, how you do it, and why you are doing is important.

- (عَسَىٰ اللَّهُ أَنْ يَأْتِيَنِي بِهِمْ جَمِيعًا): **be Allâh will bring them (back) all to me.**

Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is so hopeful that he will have all of his sons come back. Others might think one or two is enough, but he did not lose hope from Allah (ﷻ), especially for Yusuf (عليه السلام) though he has been away from him for years. Never lose hope in Allah (ﷻ), you can lose hope from the people, but not from Allah, and have big hope from Allah (ﷻ), don't have little hope from Allah (ﷻ). If a doctor tells you there is no hope, you have to have 100% hope in Allah in your heart. Allah (ﷻ) could have easily have given us everything, but He puts needs in us so that we are attached to Him. Allah (ﷻ) will initiate the needs so that the attachments appear, but the attachment needs to be Allah alone, and this is the meaning of (لا اله الا الله). Shirk happens when people attach to besides Allah (ﷻ).

- (عَسَىٰ): there is hope, possibilities only from Allah (ﷻ). (اللَّهُ)
- (أَنْ يَأْتِيَنِي بِهِمْ جَمِيعًا): that Allah (ﷻ) will bring all of them, all of them includes Yusuf (عليه السلام), Benyamin, and the older son. And this shows you to have big and vast hope from Allah (ﷻ).
- (إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ) **Truly He! only He is All-Knowing, All-Wise.:** Allah (ﷻ) knows me better than I know myself, and Allah (ﷻ) knows my condition, my needs, my feelings, and my desperation. Allah (ﷻ)

is (الْحَكِيمُ) Al Hakeem, meaning everything is in its place, everything is decreed and it is according to Allah's divine wisdom. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) never said I regret sending him with you, etc. He knows that Allah (ﷻ) puts everything in place, nothing is out of place, subhan Allah.

Ayah 84 – (وَتَوَلَّى عَنْهُمْ وَقَالَ يَا سَفَى عَلَى يَوْسُفَ وَأَبْيَضْتُ عَيْنَاهُ مِنَ الْحُزْنِ فَهُوَ كَظِيمٌ) (And he turned away from them and said: "Alas, my grief for Yûsuf (Joseph)!" And he lost his sight because of the sorrow that he was suppressing.)

- (وَتَوَلَّى عَنْهُمْ) (And he turned away from them): He turned away from his children/his sons, and he did not show his sorrow and sadness to them. Should a father or mother cry in front of their children? No, because that will affect them even more and it will make them lose hope. What did Yaqoub (عليه السلام) say to himself?
- (وَقَالَ يَا سَفَى عَلَى يَوْسُفَ) (and said: "Alas, my grief for Yûsuf (Joseph)!"): it has been years since Yaqoub (عليه السلام) had lost since Yusuf (عليه السلام) and he has now lost Benjamin, but he remembered Yusuf (عليه السلام), subhan Allah. May Allah (ﷻ) protect all children, ameen. But for those who have lost a child, and they have more children after that they will still remember that child – there is always a special place in the heart

for every child. Allah (ﷻ) grants a 'house of praise and thanks' (بيت الحمد) in paradise for those who have lost a child.

- تَأْسَفِي (my grief): this is an expression for sorrow and pain. And this shows you that love is not in your hands, it is a provision from Allah (ﷻ). If you love someone or someone loves you –it is because Allah (ﷻ) put that love, subhan Allah. And it shows you that when you have the love for someone, even if they are not there physically –that love is still there. And this should remind us as well that though the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is not here, we should love him before ourselves, subhan Allah. When you love Allah (ﷻ) – then you are longing to meet Allah (ﷻ), and when you love the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), then you are longing to meet him, subhan Allah.
- As if Yaqoub (عليه السلام) had this sorrow and longing all along in his heart, but now this incident triggered it and he let it out, but only to himself, subhan Allah (ظهر منه ما خفي من الهم القديم والشوق).

- (وَأَبْضَتْ عَيْنَاهُ مِنَ الْحُزْنِ) (And he lost his sight because of the sorrow): notice that Allah (ﷻ) is telling us what will happen to the eyes when there is too much crying, it affects the eyesight, subhan Allah. It does not mean he lost the color of his eyes, but he lost his sight from too much sorrow. So many physical ailments happen as a result of mental/emotional stress. That is why in the dua'a (اللهم اني اعوذ بك من الهم والحزن) (Oh Allah I seek refuge from the worries and sorrows). May Allah (ﷻ) grant us balanced emotions. Ameen. And it also shows us it's ok to cry – Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is a messenger, a man, and he's old – it shows us that they are human too. But the Qur'an tells us how to deal with negative feelings, subhan Allah.
- (فَبُؤَ كَظِيمٌ) (that he was suppressing): when someone is crying so much, they can be very emotional and react with emotions, but Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is keeping the emotions to himself. He knows that if he shows his emotions, then everyone will get affected. And (كَظِيمٌ) is a noun, and it is (صيغة مبالغة) – it is intense.

Ayah 85 – (قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ تَفْتُوْا تَذْكُرُ يُوسُفَ حَتَّى تَكُوْنَ حَرَضًا أَوْ تَكُوْنَ مِنَ الْهٰلِكِيْنَ) (They said: "By Allâh! You will never cease remembering Yûsuf (Joseph) until you become weak with old age, or until you be of the dead.")

- (قَالُوا) (they said): the brothers/sons said, what did they say?
- (تَاللَّهِ) (by Allah): they are making an oath
- (تَفْتُوْا تَذْكُرُ يُوسُفَ) (You will never cease remembering Yûsuf (Joseph)):
 until now, you (Yaqoub (عليه السلام)) still remember Yusuf (عليه السلام)?
 And this shows that Yaqoub (عليه السلام) had great love for Yusuf (عليه السلام) in his heart, subhan Allah.
 - (تَفْتُوْا): comes from (فتأ) meaning 'still' (ما زال). And it shows people try to do things to make others hate each other, but no matter how much you try to plot, Allah (ﷻ) is All-Aware. What are they saying to their father, bearing in mind he is a messenger, if he continues to remember Yusuf (عليه السلام)?
- (حَتَّى) (until):
 - (تَكُوْنَ حَرَضًا) (you become weak with old age): what does (حَرَضًا) mean? You will have no movement (لا حركة), meaning paralyzed and you will not have the ability to speak (لا قدرة على الكلام), subhan Allah. (حَرَضًا) → is a severe sickness until a person loses his mind,

he will not be sane (مرض مرضاً شديداً حتى أذهب عقله). It also means close to death (أشرف على الموت) and spoiled (أفسد). This can actually happen to someone who is so sad, that's why if you think so much about people it is actually a sickness. But when you remember Allah (ﷻ) that is the cure. Surely with the remembrance of Allah (ﷻ) do the hearts find rest.

- (أَوْ تَكُونُ مِنَ الْهَالِكِينَ) (or until you be of the dead): that he will die out of extreme sadness (تهلك بسبب حزنك الشديد). It shows though he is a messenger, he is still a human and grieves, but that did not negate his belief and tawakul in Allah (ﷻ).

Ayah 86 – (قَالَ إِنَّمَا أَشْكُوا بَنِي وَحُزْنِي إِلَى اللَّهِ وَأَعْلَمُ مِنَ اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ) (He said: "I only complain of my grief and sorrow to Allâh, and I know from Allâh that which you know not)

- He didn't reply back to them and say you don't know, etc. He didn't complain to others about his situation. How can someone complain about Allah's decrees to those who have no mercy, subhan Allah. And when you complain to others you get even more angry because you feel they don't know what you're facing, subhan Allah. People can never be in your shoes – everyone is different and you will always be misunderstood when you speak of your situation, subhan Allah. Problems happen between people because we are all different and we think differently. So don't force others to 'wear your shoes' and

don't wear other people's shoes, subhan Allah. And this is especially between husband and wife – a wife might complain to her husband, and he just gives a solution and the wife doesn't like it. She doesn't want a solution, she only wants sympathy. Allah (ﷻ) said He made us fitnas for each other, so will you be patient? So don't embarrass yourself by complaining. That's why in paradise, there are no problems because everyone is one heart. So we want to grow in faith together, not in age, subhan Allah.

- (قَالَ إِنَّمَا أَشْكُوا) (He said: "I only complain): this is the solution for those who are depressed and are thinking about a person. And why does a prophet go through this, because he can handle it. But if we were to go through it, we would not be able to handle it. When you complain to Allah (ﷻ) you will never be misunderstood because He knows you in and out – and it is private, with Allah (ﷻ) it is a secret. You don't need so many words to complain to Allah (ﷻ) – you just ask Allah (ﷻ) – 'help me'. You don't need to say oh I forgot to mention this point – Allah (ﷻ) knows all of your feelings. We try to explain our feelings to people and we cannot explain it, but Allah (ﷻ) knows these feelings. And people might be sad, but no one knows the percentage of their sadness except Allah (ﷻ). People go to counseling, but no one knows the depth of their sadness, so they end

up being pumped so much about their self, that it actually harms them, subhan Allah.

- (بَيِّنَاتٍ) (my words): it means like 'an announcement' (كلامي).

Anyone who complains wants everyone to know because they want pity from others. Sometimes a person might not be listening to you, so you complain to them in order to get their attention, subhan Allah. You cannot complain to people about your heart because no one will understand. People just want to talk to let it out, but perhaps there is no solution since it already happened in the past. So don't speak to people, speak to Allah (ﷻ).

- (وَحُزْنِي إِلَى اللَّهِ) (and my sadness to Allah): what makes a person to

speak and complain to Allah (ﷻ)? If they believe in Allah (ﷻ).

Don't deal abstractly with Allah (ﷻ) – as if He does not see or hear. People want tangible, but where is the belief in the unseen? It is not a weakness if you cry to Allah (ﷻ). In the night you want to complain and no one is there, but Allah (ﷻ) is there.

You want to complain to those closest to you, but there is no one closer than Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Complain to someone who is worthy to complain to and He will listen to you. And this is a worship of itself and you get rewarded for it, subhan Allah.

- (وَأَعْلَمُ مِنَ اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ) (and I know from Allâh that which you know

not): I know for sure that Allah (ﷻ) is listening to me and He will bring

them all back – this shows thinking good about Allah (ﷻ). When you believe that Allah (ﷻ) will cure you, He will cure you, when you believe He will help you, He will help you. You have to be think good about Allah (ﷻ) and be firm in your belief.

Ayah 87 – (يَبْنَى أَذْهَبُوا فَتَحَسَّسُوا مِنْ يُوسُفَ وَأَخِيهِ وَلَا تَأْيَسُوا مِنْ رَوْحِ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ لَا يَأْيَسُ) ("O my sons! Go you and enquire about Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother, and never give up hope of Allâh's Mercy. Certainly no one despairs of Allâh's Mercy, except the people who disbelieve.")

- (يَبْنَى) (O my sons): Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is addressing his sons, besides Yusuf (عليه السلام), Benjamin, and his older son.
- (أَذْهَبُوا فَتَحَسَّسُوا مِنْ يُوسُفَ وَأَخِيهِ) (Go you and enquire about Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother): Yaqoub (عليه السلام) wants all of his sons to go search for them. Imagine Yaqoub (عليه السلام) has 12 sons, and 3 are not there, and he is sending all of sons to enquire about them, subhan Allah. Imagine if you had 12 children, and 3 are not there, you might send a few of the children to enquire about them, but not all, subhan Allah. And notice Yaqoub (عليه السلام) mentioned Yusuf (عليه) specifically by name and this shows the love he has for him in his heart, and then he mentioned (أَخِيهِ) – his brother, which is

referring to Benyamin, but he did not mention him by name. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) did not mention the older son since he stayed there on his own will.

- (تَحَسَّسُوا): comes from (حَسَّ) which means 'sense', similar to the five senses, which are hearing (السمع), seeing (البصر), smelling (الشم), touching (اللمس), tasting (الذوق) – so this is how you realize the outside the world. If someone is not using these senses, then it becomes illusion – for example, the phone is ringing and you say it must be so and so, and it is – these are tricks of the shaitan to make you think you have power of the unseen. The shaitan can actually see, and he puts the thought in your mind that it's so and so, so you get it right, subhan Allah. And a person keeps doing this until they think they have some 'special sense'.
- (فَتَحَسَّسُوا): is to make the effort and strive to search for them (تتبع), it also means to trace the news (أخباره).
- The older son and other sons, do not know that Yusuf (عليه السلام) and Benyamin are together, but look how Allah (ﷻ) inspired Yaqoub (عليه السلام) to search for them together. And this shows you that as a person knows more about Allah (ﷻ) and has gone through different experiences, they will have more hope in Allah

(ﷻ), and you will find the one who does not know about Allah (ﷻ) and has gone through bad experiences, they will be so bitter and will always think bad, subhan Allah. That's why you want to grow in age with knowledge about Allah (ﷻ), that is wisdom.

- (وَلَا تَأْيِسُوا مِنْ رَوْحِ اللَّهِ) (and never give up hope of Allâh's Mercy.): in the Qur'an, you also have (لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِنْ رَحْمَةِ اللَّهِ), which also gets translated as do not despair from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ).
 - (وَلَا): means 'do not' (نهي).
 - (تَأْيِسُوا): means to lose (فقد الأمل), surrender (الاستسلام), from what?
 - (رَوْحِ اللَّهِ):
 - (رَوْح) literally means a please breeze (نسيم), joy and happiness (الفرح و السرور), anything that has life (ما به حياة), vastness (سعة), relief (فرج), mercy (رحمة).
 - So in the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) you will find joy, happiness, vastness, relief, it will give you life, and it will be like a pleasant breeze. And a person needs all of these in times of distress, subhan Allah. (لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِنْ رَحْمَةِ اللَّهِ) is mentioned when Ibrahim

(عليه السلام) was given the glad tidings of a son, this is not a time of distress, subhan Allah.

- Someone who is sick and who isn't, who needs more mercy? The one who is sick. Someone who is alive and a person at a time of death, who needs more mercy? At the time of death. Imagine two children taking an exam – one fails and the other does excellent. The one who does excellent, people give them a party, tell them you're so great, etc – and this is making them arrogant and proud. And for the one who failed, you say there is no use with you, no matter how much you study, you will still fail – you are making the person despairing from Allah (ﷻ) – and both are sins, subhan Allah.

To be arrogant and to despair from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) are both sins. Some people break their children so much, they might have two daughters, one pretty and the other not, and all of the attention goes towards the pretty one, and for the other one, they will say you don't have taste, this doesn't suit you, etc – and you see they are really broken, subhan Allah. Ahmad bin Hanbal (may Allah have mercy on him) went to propose to a lady, and when he went to propose, he found out that she had an older sister. Then they told him, the younger one is prettier, the older one is cross-eyed. He said it doesn't matter, he will marry the older one because the younger one others will marry her. Look at how truly he was marrying for the akhira. And from this wife, so many of their

children became scholars, subhan Allah. And anyways in paradise, everyone will be perfected, subhan Allah. Who despairs from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ)?

- (إِلَّا الْقَوْمُ الْكَافِرُونَ) (except the people who disbelieve.): only a disbeliever will despair and lose hope in the mercy of Allah (ﷻ). Next week in sh'a Allah, reasons for despairing.
- (وَلَا تَأْسُوا مِنْ رَوْحِ اللَّهِ) (and never give up hope of Allâh's Mercy.): the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) is vast so a person should never give up hope in Allah (ﷻ). For example, in the start of a sickness a person might have lots of hope, but with time, the hope becomes less. But in this ayah, it is showing us that as more time passes and the more you know about Allah (ﷻ) – you will never give up, you will still have hope in your heart and you will not stop making dua'a. You have hope that your problem will be solved, even after 20, 30 years, why? Because of your belief in Allah (ﷻ) and you know you will be rewarded. Who despairs from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ)?
- (إِلَّا الْقَوْمُ الْكَافِرُونَ) (except the people who disbelieve.): the disbeliever who does not believe in Allah (ﷻ) and does not know about Allah (ﷻ) and His mercy, then he will despair, subhan Allah. We believe in blood tests, ultrasounds – anything tangible, but we don't believe in Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Before, people didn't have blood tests,

ultrasounds, etc. People before would become sick and become cured without even realizing because they had so much reliance and hope in Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Nowadays, as soon as a person has one symptom, they will look it up on the internet and so many things will come up, and they will lose hope from the start. We need to lose hope from the means, but we should not lose hope in Allah (ﷻ). The only ones who lose hope are people who disbelieve, and you don't want to be of those. And look at the diplomatic manner of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) – he did not say you are ungrateful sons, you are kafireen – he did not give a title, he just said not to be people of those who disbelieve. Don't give titles when reforming – when you tell a child 'you are arrogant, you are stubborn, you are spoiled' – without realizing you are reinforcing these characteristics in them – don't break or put down when reforming a person. Don't tell your child you are like a shaitan, firaoun, beast, istaghfar Allah. Allah (ﷻ) is reforming us so gently, though He doesn't need us, subhan Allah.

- Another word for losing hope is depression: a person doesn't want to do anything, they don't want to meet people, they don't want to leave the house or do anything – they need to be encouraged and know about the mercy of Allah (ﷻ).
- The believer that believes in Allah (ﷻ) will always have hope and he will never give up.

- So depending on your faith will be the level of your hope. The higher your faith, the greater your hope in Allah (ﷻ). Don't ever lose hope in Allah (ﷻ), and when you increase your faith, you will have more hope. If you lose hope, you will not be happy, whether you get what you want or not. But when you increase your faith, you won't lose hope and you will be happy.

Reasons why people despair from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) (ما أسباب اليأس)

(من روح الله؟)

The mercy of Allah (ﷻ) is very vast, yet people still despair, subhan Allah.

1. Ignorance about Allah (الجهل بالله تعالى) (ﷻ): when a person has lack of knowledge about Allah (ﷻ), then for sure he will have no faith or little faith. When a person has lost someone they might still think about them, but their dua'a is less, they lose hope. What exactly do they not know about Allah (ﷻ) that is making them despair?
 - Mercy of Allah (رحمة الله) (ﷻ): the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) precedes His anger. And there is one part of His mercy on this earth, and 99 parts are reserved for the Day of Judgement. And the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) is greater than a mother's mercy. And Allah the Most Merciful rose over the Throne in a manner that suits His majesty,

and He is the Most Merciful before there is a creation to be merciful to, subhan Allah.

- Ability of Allah (قدرة الله) (ﷻ): Allah (ﷻ) is able to cure this person, is able to bring this person back – don't look at the means because these are obstacles. Allah (ﷻ) is able to do everything – Be and it is (كن فيكون), subhan Allah.
- Allah is the All-Knower of your condition (علم الله بحالة العبد) (ﷻ): Allah (ﷻ) knows how desperate and sad you may be, He knows you are crying, but if you despair, then it shows that you do not know about Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Allah (ﷻ) will not leave you, and when you know about Allah's mercy, ability, and His knowing your condition, then it makes you strong and never give up. Never think that your son won't change, or your husband. There was a person who could not smell, she would eat, but can't smell, and the doctors told her she can't ever smell. But she said they are human beings, and I will not lose when I have hope in Allah (ﷻ). And then once she was sitting somewhere, and she could smell! Allah (ﷻ) is able to do everything, just 'Be and it is' (كن فيكون). In this life, our test are the means, but in paradise there are no means – you just think of something and it is there, you don't have to cook. Ibn Taymiyah said to lose hope in Allah (ﷻ) is a major sin, why? Because you are saying and not believing

that Allah (ﷻ) has mercy, is able, and knows your condition, istaghfar Allah. And a person needs to be very careful when he says 'there is no hope'. People are going to paradise because of their heart and people going to the hellfire because of their heart, subhan Allah.

2. Exaggeration in the fear of Allah (الغلو في الخوف من الله) (ﷻ): don't go to

the people scaring them – there is a hellfire, punishment, there is the angel of death, snakes in the grave, etc – it is not good to make people do things out of fear. People should do things out of love – you want the people to worship Allah (ﷻ) out of love first, then fear and hope. When you make a person scared too much, they might end up praying, wearing hijab, etc – but it won't last, and on the other hand you are breaking their hope in Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Imagine you are committing a sin by scaring the people and making them lose hope in Allah (ﷻ). You want to make your child behave, so you tell him you just wait until your father sees this, and it will make him scared and he will behave, but you have created a bad feeling between the child and father. This child will always have this feeling of fear, subhan Allah. And imagine doing this about Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah.

So what is the limit of fear? Ibn Taymiyyah said you need fear to stop you from committing sins and anything more is not needed (حد الخوف)

(ما حجزك عن معاصي الله وما زاد عنه فهو غير محتاج اليه).

- Accompanying depressed people (مصاحبة القانطين): 'misery loves company' – if someone is sad, uplift her and make her happy, don't be sad and cry with her.

Reasons why people despair from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) (ما أسباب اليأس)

(من روح الله؟) – Part 2

Points 1 to 3 were discussed last week.

3. Ignorance about Allah (الجهل بالله تعالى) (ﷻ): What exactly do they not know about Allah (ﷻ) that is making them despair?
 - Mercy of Allah (رحمة الله) (ﷻ)
 - Ability of Allah (قدرة الله) (ﷻ)
 - Allah is the All-Knower of your condition (علم الله بحالة العبد)
4. Exaggeration in the fear of Allah (الغلو في الخوف من الله) (ﷻ)
5. Accompanying depressed people (مصاحبة القانطين)
6. Attachment to the means (التعلق بالأسباب): example of means include medicine, doctors, computer, people, mobile, ruqyah, worships, dua'a, etc. (سبب) means rope, as if you are climbing the rope to reach to something higher. Do not be attached to your deeds either, because it is not by your deeds that you will enter paradise, but by the mercy of Allah (ﷻ). If you attach to something that is not worthy,

then Allah (ﷻ) will close the heart of that person, subhan Allah. For example, there are failures in relationships, why? The wife might be totally attached to her husband, and she wants the happiness and love from him, and this is attachment, because she wants feelings from a human. Hadith: (قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " مَنْ تَعَلَّقَ شَيْئًا وَكَلَّ إِلَيْهِ)

(The Prophet (S.A.W) said: "Whoever hangs something, he is entrusted to it.") – At Tirmidhi Book 28, Hadith 2214. When a person is standing at the door of anyone in order to get feelings from them or anything, then it will be total humiliation, this is what causes depression. Imagine when a child wants attention, they will say I am sick, they will scream, etc. And even adults do the same, they will hurt themselves, they will be in the hospital, etc just to get attention. And this is not the way. The solution is to increase your faith and be attached to Allah (ﷻ).

Experience without knowledge is actually harmful, and it causes really complicated personalities. That is why it is important to grow old with faith and knowledge. You can never retire from seeking knowledge. There are:

- Means in the religion (شرعي): like ruqyah, zamzam water, honey, etc.
- Means in the universe (كوني)
- More means around you are both a blessing and a test, why? Because you can get attached to it, they are tangible. People get attached to idols, people, etc.

7. التشدد في الدين (To be extreme in the religion and to leave the easy path)

(وترك الأخذ بالرخص): You will find those who are guided, they become all of a sudden strict, you and cannot last like that. It is all about moderation, and when you look at the true scholars, they are very approachable people. The opposite of those who think they have knowledge, and they act so strict and so serious. A young man came up to the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) seeking permission to commit adultery, this shows you that the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) was so approachable that the young man even felt comfortable to approach him with such a question, subhan Allah. And those who become so strict in the religion, they make it very difficult on others as well. For example, not everyone can pray voluntaries, everyone does according to their level. It is not righteousness to take the difficult path, these people think if they do things the harder way, then it is more pious, this is not true. For example, in times of travel, the prayer is shortened, this is what the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did, so why does a person make it difficult on himself by praying the whole thing, subhan Allah. Allah (جَلَّ) says in Surah Al Baqarah 185: يُرِيدُ اللَّهُ بِكُمْ الْيُسْرَ (Allâh intends for you ease, and He does not want to make things difficult for you). They think if one person makes a mistake, then they are kafir and this is wrong and it is a sin of itself to make a judgement on others – this shows sickness in the heart. The straight path is the easy and moderate path. Don't try to be like someone

else, Abu Bakr As Siddique (ra) and Omar bin Khattab (ra) had two very different personalities, did each one want to be like the other? No. It is important to be within the boundaries of halal and haram. The beneficial knowledge is supposed to make you more humble and approachable to the people, not the opposite. Bin Uthaymeen (may Allah have mercy on him) was in Makkah during Ramdan, so he had travelled there. He drank water in Makkah during Ramadan, and the people asked him, why are you not fasting? He said I am travelling.

8. Lack of patience and hasty for the results (قلة الصبر واستعجال النتائج): we can be so impatient, and want to get results quickly, but everything will come in its right time. When you make a dua'a to Allah (ﷻ), don't be hasty to get the result. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) said that Allah (ﷻ) will respond to you when you are not hastening for it in your heart, subhan Allah. We want to get something quickly, but it will be responded to when your heart is patient and relaxed. You might find that you are making dua'a, and you want it badly, and it doesn't come, so you despair and stop making dua'a, and this is not good, istaghfar Alah. You need to believe that Allah (ﷻ) will respond, never lose hope, and keep making dua'a.
9. Heart is attached to the duniya (تعلق القلب بالدنيا): meaning my heart is happy and sad because of the duniya, be it people, money, etc – and the duniya is always changing and this can make the person to despair from the mercy of Allah (ﷻ).

Reasons to have hope – opposite of the previous points

1. Knowledge about Allah (ﷻ)
2. Do not exaggerate in scaring the people
3. Accompany positive, happy people
4. Don't be attached to the means
5. Don't be extreme, take the easy, moderate way
6. Have patience and don't be hasty for the results
7. Don't be attached to the duniya

Ayah 88 – فَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ قَالُوا يَا أَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ مَسَّنَا وَأَهْلَنَا الضُّرُّ وَجِئْنَا بِبِضْعَةٍ مُزَجَّجَةٍ فَأَوْفِ)

(لَنَا الْكَيْلَ وَتَصَدَّقْ عَلَيْنَا إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَجْزِي الْمُتَصَدِّقِينَ) (Then, when they entered unto him [Yûsuf (Joseph)], they said: "O ruler of the land! A hard time has hit us and our family, and we have brought but poor capital, so pay us full measure and be charitable to us. Truly, Allâh does reward the charitable.")

2. فَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ (Then, when they entered unto him (Yusuf as):

notice (عَلَيْهِ) is used, 'unto him' as if they are used to entering at this point, subhan Allah. 'Entering' is mentioned in ayat 58, 69, and 88. And now what is Yusuf (عليه السلام) being called?

3. قَالُوا يَا أَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ (they said: "O ruler of the land!): remember that before Yusuf (عليه السلام) was living in the house of the Aziz and now he is the Aziz, the minister, particularly in charge of finance, subhan

Allah. And when they call him 'Aziz' – it shows respect and honor. This is a very diplomatic way of calling him because they will describe their condition to him. What is their condition?

4. (مَسَّنَا وَأَهْلَنَا الضُّرُّ) (A hard time has hit us and our family): they know that anyone who has taken the cup, then they will not be returned, and Yusuf (عليه السلام) had given his last word. But now they are coming back again, saying we have gone through hard times. This is exactly what people do in general when they want something and they're aren't getting it – they make themselves needy. They don't want to complain, but they are saying some harm touched us so we are in a desperate situation.
5. (وَجِئْنَا بِبِضْعَةٍ مُزَجَّجَةٍ) (and we have brought but poor capital): before they would give something in order to get something in exchange, but now they are saying they have something that is not of your standard (Yusuf (عليه السلام)). That their capital is (مُزَجَّجَةٍ), meaning it is not good quality – it is mixed with something. It also means inferior (رديئة), little (قليلة), and something that would not be accepted by others and is rejected (لا يقبله أحد و ترفض). And they are telling Yusuf (عليه السلام) that no one would accept it from us, but you o Aziz, only can help us – they have hope in him. What do they say next?

- (فَأَوْفِ لَنَا الْكَيْلَ) (so pay us full measure): notice the way they are speaking to Yusuf (عليه السلام), as if he is so familiar and approachable, though he is the Aziz – that is because Yusuf (عليه السلام) is very gentle and down to earth and he is a Prophet, subhan Allah.
- (وَتَصَدَّقْ عَلَيْنَا) (and be charitable to us): though their intention is just to try to get their brother Benyamin back, but they are also saying to give us something extra. And it is not easy for men to say such words, subhan Allah, as if they are paying for what they did to Yusuf (عليه السلام). And it is being done in front of Yusuf (عليه السلام) though he did not ask for it – as if it is a console for him, subhan Allah. What else do they say?
- 6. (إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَجْزِي الْمُتَصَدِّقِينَ) (Truly, Allâh does reward the charitable): they said this in the end, by using Allah's name, that Yusuf (عليه السلام) has to give them in the end. If a beggar approaches you and says 'give me or do this for me by the face of Allah' – then you have to do it, subhan Allah. You give because you honor and magnify Allah (ﷻ), not because of the person. The believer does not think that others are cheating me or mocking me – others will be accounted, but you are doing it for Allah (ﷻ).

Ayah 89 – (قَالَ هَلْ عَلِمْتُمْ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ بِيُوسُفَ وَأَخِيهِ إِذْ أَنْتُمْ جَاهِلُونَ) (He said: "Do you know what you did with Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother, when you were ignorant?")

- (قَالَ هَلْ عَلِمْتُمْ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ) (He said: "Do you know what you did): Notice the way Yusuf (عليه السلام) approached them – he did not say 'I am Yusuf'. Rather he posed a question to show them the mistake they made but not in a way to blame them, subhan Allah. He wants to know if they have knowledge of what they did (هل عندكم علم). Also, he is being careful with their hearts by not shocking them. Imagine if he told them directly 'I am Yusuf', it would have been a great shock, subhan Allah. You find so much psychology and the nature of humans in Surah Yusuf, subhan Allah.
 - (بِيُوسُفَ وَأَخِيهِ) (with Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother): He used the 3rd person and did not say, what you did to 'me', but rather to 'Yusuf', subhan Allah. You cannot accuse someone of a sin because of what others did. For example, if someone does something wrong, you can't say 'his father was like that', subhan Allah. When Benjamin was accused of stealing, the brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام) said it is because his brother Yusuf (عليه السلام) had stolen, subhan Allah. Disbelief is not in the gene, but belief is in the gene because it is in the fitra.

- (إِذْ أَنْتُمْ حَٰلُونَ) (when you were ignorant?): (جاهل) ignorant is the opposite of (عالم) knowledgeable. And this shows that when you have knowledge, you will know your boundaries, you will not do such things, subhan Allah. So Yusuf (عليه السلام) is giving the brothers the excuse that they did it out of ignorance (اعتذار لهم). Though Yusuf (عليه السلام) knows they did things intentionally, but he is still giving them the benefit of the doubt, subhan Allah. And this shows us that when we give an excuse for others, then it makes our heart at ease. Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not have the lower-hand, rather he had the upper-hand and he could have easily placed them in jail, yet he still pardoned. It can also have another meaning that what they did was something ignorant (فعلتكم فعل الجاهلين). And this shows guidance from Allah (ﷻ) that Yusuf (عليه السلام) spoke wisely. When you confront people, you don't want to break them.

Qālowā a'innaka lānta Yūsufu qāla anā Yūsufu wa-hadā akhi qad min Allahu 'alaynā innahu min yatiq - Ayah 90

(وَيَصْبِرْ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُضِيعُ أَجْرَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ) (They said: "Are you indeed Yûsuf (Joseph)?" He said: "I am Yûsuf (Joseph), and this is my brother (Benjamin). Allâh has indeed been gracious to us. Verily, he who fears Allâh with obedience to Him (by abstaining from sins and evil deeds, and by performing righteous good deeds), and is patient, then surely, Allâh makes not the reward of the Muhsinûn (good-doers - see V.2:112) to be lost.")

- (قَالُوا أَعْنٰكَ لَاَنْتَ يُوسُفُ) (They said: "Are you indeed Yûsuf (Joseph)?"):

Now the brothers recognized it is Yusuf (عليه السلام).

- (قَالَ) (He said): What did Yusuf (عليه السلام) say?

- (أَنَا يُوسُفُ وَهٰذَا أَخِي) (I am Yûsuf (Joseph), and this is my brother (Benjamin).): this is affirming that it is the two of them.

- (قَدْ مَنَّ اللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا) (Allâh has indeed been gracious to us): he did not complain at all or remember anything negative, but remembers the favors of Allah (ﷻ) and sees everything as a blessing – being the well, the prison, etc. You have to remember that Allah (ﷻ) wants the good for you in every situation, alhamdulillah. Allah (ﷻ) favored him with faith, taqwa, and being well-established in the land (الايمان والتقوى و التمكين في الارض).

He is saying that the incidents he went through did not make him a worse person, but rather a better, stronger person attached to Allah (ﷻ). And he is being so humble by saying that Allah (ﷻ) has favored him and his brother, though his brother just recently 'joined' him, subhan Allah. This truly shows the pure heart of Yusuf (عليه السلام).

- (إِنَّهُ مَن يَتَّقِ وَيَصْبِرْ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُضِيعُ أَجَرَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ) (Verily, he who fears Allâh with obedience to Him (by abstaining from sins and evil

deeds, and by performing righteous good deeds), and is patient, then surely, Allâh makes not the reward of the Muhsinûn to be lost): this the conclusion of all that he has learned throughout all of these different ordeals. Taqwa (التقوى) + patience (صبر) = muhsineen (محسنين). He did not say he is of the muhsineen because he is so humble, rather he said that Allah (ﷻ) does not make the reward of those who do ihsan to be lost, subhan Allah. Yusuf (عليه السلام) had taqwa and patience for not complaining – he faced the wife of the Aziz, being in prison, etc. Surah Yusuf is teaching us about ihsan.

Ayah 91 – (قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ ءَاثَرَكَ ٱللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا وَإِن كُنَّا لَخٰطِئِينَ) (They said: "By Allâh! Indeed Allâh has preferred you above us, and we certainly have been sinners.")

- قَالُوا (They said): The brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام) are speaking.
- تَاللَّهِ (By Allah): this is an oath, and it is the 3rd time they say it in this surah, subhan Allah. When someone is making an oath (القسم), then it is in order to have others accept what you are saying, you want them to believe you.
 - لَقَدْ ءَاثَرَكَ ٱللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا (Indeed Allâh has preferred you above us):
 - (ءَاثَرَكَ) comes from (آثر) which means preferred (فضل), chosen

- (اختار). The brothers were jealous of Yusuf (عليه السلام) because their father favored him, and now it is Allah (ﷻ) Who has favored him, subhan Allah. What made them to realize that he has been favored? His treatment and good manners (مكارم الاخلاق) were foremost before being in a position of power. Your true manners show when you are in a difficult situation. And good manners are the fruits of your faith.
- (وَإِنْ كُنَّا لَخَطِيئِينَ) (and we certainly have been sinners): this is the maximum in confession (غاية الاعتراف), it is not easy for them to confess after all these years, and to someone younger than them. And it is a mercy from Allah (ﷻ) to have confessed while they are still alive. (خَطِيئِينَ) sinners is a noun and this is greater than a verb, to say 'we have sinned' versus 'we are sinners' – we are sinners is greater, subhan Allah. (خَطِيئِينَ) comes from (خطأ عن قصد) – to make a mistake intentionally. But (أخطأ) – means to make a mistake unintentionally. That's why in the end of Surah Al Baqarah we say, (رَبَّنَا لَا تُؤَاخِذْنَا إِنْ نَسِينَا أَوْ أَخْطَأْنَا) (Our Lord! Punish us not if we forget or fall into error).

Ayah 92 – (قَالَ لَا تَثْرِيبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْيَوْمَ يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ) (He said: "No reproach on you this day, may Allâh forgive you, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy!)

- Here we see the max of goodness from Yusuf (عليه السلام) – and when Allah (ﷻ) loves a person, He will make him face different trials in order to upgrade him. Know that any test that you go through, Allah (ﷻ) knows you can handle it. Sometimes we get nurtured through people's bad behavior – people might be oppressing you, but for anyone who knows Allah (ﷻ) then he will know how to deal with it and overcome it.
- After Yusuf (عليه السلام) revealed his identity to his brothers, the brothers confessed to their wrongdoing, and Allah (ﷻ) forgave them – and this shows you need to admit to your mistake. If Allah (ﷻ) forgives, then why do we not forgive? Subhan Allah. Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not once blame them, so why did they confess to him? Because of Yusuf's (عليه السلام) treatment towards them, subhan Allah. We will later have a closer look at this, in sha'a Allah.
- The problem with the brothers was because of love, and then they confessed and knew that it is not because of their father's preference, but because of Allah's preference, subhan Allah. And no one can go against Allah (ﷻ) – He is The King.
- Look at the pure heart of Yusuf (عليه السلام) – especially to those who have been bad to him. And those who were bad to him were the ones closest to him. Everyone wants the support of their family,

subhan Allah. Keep in mind that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is in a position of power, yet he still pardoned – it is not between two parties of the same level, and this makes it even more noble, subhan Allah.

- (قَالَ) (He said): Yusuf (عليه السلام) said.
- (لَا تَثْرِبَ عَلَيْكُمْ أَيُّوْمَ) (No reproach on you this day)
- (لَا) (No): (نفي) negation
- (تَثْرِبَ) (reproach): blame (اللوم), scold (التوبيخ). Meaning he will not say anything that will make them feel bad. (تَثْرِبَ) comes from (ثرب), which means to remove fat from the body (الشحم). How is this related to being blamed? When you are blamed, you feel as if you have shrunk in humiliation – you are lesser in size, subhan Allah. To be scolded is worse than to be beaten. Physical pain can go away, but words go to the heart and that hurts more. The brothers knew they did something wrong. Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not want them avoid him so he made them feel relaxed and said I won't blame you, subhan Allah. Even among the study circles, don't blame someone if their mobile phone rings, or if they have not attended class – always give excuses for others, that way you won't have the urge to scold.
- (يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ) (may Allâh forgive you): Yusuf (عليه السلام) has forgiven them and he knows they have crossed the boundaries with Allah (ﷻ), so he makes dua'a for them to be forgiven by Allah (ﷻ). May

Allah (ﷻ) forgive them, meaning to cover their mistakes and he did not mention their sin. No one likes to be accounted or to hear their wrongs. What does he ask for after forgiveness? Mercy.

- (وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ) (and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy): He is making tawassul to the mercy of Allah (ﷻ), to make them to be attached to the mercy of Allah (ﷻ) – not to his mercy or the mercy of their father. Imagine after years of being oppressed – Yusuf (عليه السلام) just became better and better, subhan Allah. This is the maximum level of ihsan – so if you want to know about ihsan, this is ihsan. The Prophet (ﷺ) used this same ayah when facing Quraish – they used to mock him, threaten him, beat him, etc, so they migrated to Medina – and when the Prophet (ﷺ) and the believers returned to Makkah, the disbelievers were scared. So the Prophet (ﷺ) said, what do you think I will do with you? They said you are a generous brother, son of a generous brother. So the Prophet (ﷺ) said this very ayah, Abu Sufyan became a Muslim after this. The Qur'an is teaching us ihsan practically.

- **The Art of Admonition/Reproaching (فن العتاب)**
- When people do something wrong to you, there is way when dealing with them – taqwa is extremely important – to put your heart

in a cage. Because if you don't guard your heart and deal with taqwa, then you will deal with your desire.

- Too much blaming will not bring any good (كثرة اللوم لا يأتي بخير):

people keep asking why did you not call, visit, etc – and too much blame will only bring negative effects – whether you are dealing with your friends or enemies. If you are always blaming your friends, then your friend will eventually leave you (تنفر الصديق). If you are always blaming your enemies, then it will make them hate you even more (تبغض عليك العدو). Some people are blamed so much that it causes them to lose hope, die, even commit suicide, subhan Allah. Do not blame children especially. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) never blamed the servants by saying, 'why did you do this, why didn't you do this'. Questioning is more painful.

- Do not ask others not to make mistakes (لا تطلب من الآخرين عدم الخطأ):

We all make mistakes, people are of different levels, different cultures – so you cannot have the same expectations from everyone. We get into problems because we do not understand what others are capable of or not. For example, a child might break something. Do not tell the child, 'Why did you do this?' Rather one should say, 'don't do this next time. Don't repeat it again'. (انما تطلب)

(منهم ان لا يستمروا بالخطأ اذا علموه). This will make the person feel less embarrassed.

- Suppress your anger when someone does something wrong (لا تغضب): anger is from the shaitan, and when you are angry you will say or do something you will later regret. When a person is angry, it is as if a veil is in front of their eyes, subhan Allah. Don't expect people to be angels – everyone makes mistakes.
- Think before you speak – choose soft, gentle words (اختر الكلمات الرقيقة): imagine your child breaks something very expensive, what would your reaction be? Most people would say, 'why did you do that!'. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) said no good will come with harshness, and all good will come with gentleness. Sometimes people might insult, curse, or put people down (لا تسب ولا تلعن ولا تقبح). Ihsan is when people are doing bad to you, not good. When you reform and purify your heart, then all of this will be easy. When your heart is clean – it will be easy on the limbs and tongue – it will be easy to pardon, overlook, not scold, etc, subhan Allah.
- Leave arguing (اترك الجدل): when there is a problem, just move on. The more a problem is brought up, the bigger it will become. There are people who are carrying loads in their heart because they won't let go of the problem. As soon as a problem comes up, get rid of it. There is no one without problems and no one is an angel. Don't wait for anyone to solve your problem, just purify yourself. If you want Allah (ﷻ) to forgive you, then forgive others, especially those closest to you. When there is arguing, you will fail – even if you have a point

(الجدال تخسر النتيجة). The Prophet (ﷺ) said anyone who leaves an argument, even if he is in the right, then Allah (ﷻ) will give him a place in paradise. People might say but I am arguing about the truth – but they are actually not arguing for the truth, but for themselves – it is ego. The truth is clear, no one needs to argue about the truth. And when you do not argue or raise your voice – then that is strength. But when a person argues and raises his voice – then that is weakness. If you are not to argue about the truth, then what about duniya matters? Subhan Allah. When you don't argue, then you are killing the ego and this will make you humble.

- When someone does wrong, put yourself in their shoes and think of a solution (ضع نفسك في موضع المخطئ ثم فكر الحل): when someone is doing something wrong, we just think of scolding them, instead of thinking how to find a solution – in reality, we are just thinking about ourselves. But when you put yourself in the person's shoes, then that will make you have more mercy in order to help the person, subhan Allah. We become harsh when wanting to correct others because we do not put ourselves in their shoes, subhan Allah. When we criticize others, then we will find the same thing happening to us. For example, a person might criticize someone for their mobile phone ringing, then the same thing will happen to you, and you will hear the same thing, subhan Allah. This is the way of Allah (ﷻ), even it doesn't happen to you, it can happen to your children. So don't criticize others, but ask Allah (ﷻ) to guide them.

- Let others realize their mistake (دع الآخرين يكتشفون أخطاءهم): similar to Yusuf (عليه السلام), he did not tell the brothers what they did, rather by his treatment and goodness, the brothers were able to realize their mistake. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) would say something in general to make someone realize. May Allah (ﷻ) guide us and grant us wisdom. Ameen.
- Praise them for the good they do, even if little (امدح قليلا الصواب): before saying something bad, praise the person for the good they have done, even if little. For example, if your son breaks something, before saying why did you do this, praise him for waking up for fajr, listening to you, etc – this is in order to not put the person down. Because at that point, you can either uplift someone or break them, subhan Allah. At the time of the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), there was a man not waking up for tahhajud. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not tell him why are you not waking up, rather he said, how great this man would be if he would wake up for tahhajud, subhan Allah. No one is bad 100%, there is some good., so be fair when dealing with people. We are always looking at the negative of others and forgetting the good they have, subhan Allah.
- Give the mistake its size (اعط الخطأ حجمه): meaning don't exaggerate a wrong that a person does. For example, a person might break something, and they make it the biggest deal, subhan Allah. When you make the wrong small, then it will help the person to recover

from the wrong. There is no house without problems, there are no husband and wife without problems – so don't maximize the problems.

Ayah 93 – (أَذْهَبُوا بِقَمِيصِي هَذَا فَأَلْقُوهُ عَلَىٰ وَجْهِ أَبِي يَأْتِ بَصِيرًا وَأْتُونِي بِأَهْلِكُمْ أَجْمَعِينَ)

("Go with this shirt of mine, and cast it over the face of my father, he will become clear-sighted, and bring me all your family.")

- In Surah Yusuf, the concept of the shirt is mentioned three times. The first time is when the brothers took the shirt of Yusuf (عليه السلام) and put fake blood on it, and it was proof that they were liars. The second time is when the wife of the Aziz pulled his shirt, and it was evidence against her and for him. Imagine everyone wants Yusuf's (عليه السلام) shirt, subhan Allah. But the third time, he is giving his shirt to the brothers and this is inspiration from Allah (ﷻ).
- Imagine when children have their favorite blanket, they don't want it to be washed, it has a certain smell to it. Now the shirt of Yusuf (عليه السلام) has his scent.
- (أَذْهَبُوا بِقَمِيصِي هَذَا) (Go with this shirt of mine): Yusuf (عليه السلام) is commanding that they go with the shirt of his, meaning it's a journey of the shirt. Imagine before the brothers took his shirt when he was young and caused sadness to him and their father, and now they are taking his shirt to bring happiness back to him and their father, subhan Allah.

- (آذْهَبُوا) (Go): and this comes from (ذهب), which is to go.
- (بِقَمِيصِي هَذَا) (this shirt of mine): every person has their own scent according to their sweat, that's why you might smell perfume on someone and you like it, and when you get it, you don't like the way it smells on you, subhan Allah. And it has been discovered that when they place the sweat on those who have this type of white cataract, then within the first minute 60% of their eyesight returns, then the next minute is 90%, and within 1 hour, 99% of the eyesight is returned, subhan Allah. Sheikh As Saady said what is the relation between the shirt and eyes? He said every sickness is cured with the opposite of it (كل داء يداوي بضده). The sickness is losing sight from sadness and the opposite is to bring the shirt which has the scent of the one he loves, so it brings him happiness, subhan Allah. Every sickness has a cure, Allah (ﷻ) will not send a sickness without a cure, so you must believe it. Remember this is inspiration from Allah (ﷻ) to do it.
- (فَالْقُوهُ عَلَىٰ وَجْهِ أَبِي بَصِيرًا) (and cast it over the face of my father, he will become clear-sighted):
 - (فَالْقُوهُ) (cast it):
 - (عَلَىٰ وَجْهِ أَبِي) (over the face of my father): notice it did not say over his eyes, but face, subhan Allah.

- (يَأْتِ بِصِرَافٍ) (he will become clear-sighted): imagine he could have eyesight better than before. In this life there are many secrets, and Allah (ﷻ) revealed this secret to Yusuf (عليه السلام). And notice Yusuf (عليه السلام) told them what to do and what the result would be – he said take the shirt and their father will be clear-sighted. This means when we give people instructions, we should tell them what to expect – not make it a surprise for them.
- (وَأْتُونِي بِأَهْلِكُمْ أَجْمَعِينَ) (and bring me all your family): look at the kindness of Yusuf (عليه السلام), imagine what kind of memories he must have of his brothers, yet he is telling them to bring all of their aunts, uncles, spouses, and children. And this shows you that Yusuf (عليه السلام) has authority that he can bring so many people, he does not need to seek permission to bring them. And look how Allah (ﷻ) decreed the establishment of Banu Israel in Egypt, because Musa (عليه السلام) came after some time after Yusuf (عليه السلام), subhan Allah. And Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not go to them, but everyone came to him to the better place since he had authority there and Egypt was civilized at the time. And notice Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not say bring my father and I will put the shirt on him, he is not doing anything for himself – his heart is so pure. Rather he told the brothers to do it so that his father would forgive them, subhan Allah.

Ayah 94 – (وَلَمَّا فَصَلَتِ الْعِيرُ قَالَ أَبُوهُمْ إِنِّي لَأَجِدُ رِيحَ يُوسُفَ لَوْلَا أَنْ تُفَنِّدُونِ) (And when the caravan departed, their father said: "I do indeed feel the smell of Yûsuf (Joseph), if only you think me not a dotard (a person who has weakness of mind because of old age).")

- (وَلَمَّا فَصَلَتِ الْعِيرُ) (And when the caravan departed): (الْعِيرُ) is a caravan that is loaded with food, and this word has been mention before in Surah Yusuf.
 - (فَصَلَّتْ) (departed): it literally means 'separated' (فارقت)
 - (الْعِيرُ) (caravan): it is the caravan which carries food (القافلة التي (تحمل الميرة), so when they took this caravan it departed or 'separated' from Egypt to Ash Sham (عن ارض مصر الى الشام). Then what happened after the caravan departed, and the brothers took Yusuf's (عليه السلام) shirt?
- (قَالَ أَبُوهُمْ إِنِّي لَأَجِدُ رِيحَ يُوسُفَ) (their father said: "I do indeed feel the smell of Yûsuf (Joseph),): imagine as soon as they separated, Yaqoub (عليه السلام) could feel that Yusuf (عليه السلام) was getting closer (احس بقرب), subhan Allah. This is not fortune telling or sixth sense, but it's a feeling that happens. When you are very close to your mother or father or friend, you can feel if they are sick, etc. Or when a person

feels they are going to die, they change, do things, and give away everything, subhan Allah. And these are feelings from Allah (ﷻ).

- (إِنِّي لَأَ) (I indeed): there are two affirmations here, meaning Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is so certain, don't say something is wrong with me.
- (أَجِدُ) (to find): from the point of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) this shows us you should never lose hope or give up. Don't lose hope to find something that you lost – no matter how big or small. You will see that Allah (ﷻ) brings it back better for both sides – better for Yusuf (عليه السلام) and Yaqoub (عليه السلام). You get it in a better situation than when you lost it, subhan Allah. Imagine if you don't see someone you love for 40 years and then you see them suddenly, it can be a shock, it can cause a heart attack. Even the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) said to not scare a Muslim. And notice the name of Allah Al Lateef – He is taking care of the hearts. Yusuf (عليه السلام) initiated it by telling the sons to go search for Yusuf (عليه السلام), then he can smell Yusuf (عليه السلام). So you can see that Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is being prepared to see Yusuf (عليه السلام) again, it is not a sudden shock – notice how Allah (ﷻ) is taking care of the heart, subhan Allah.

- (رِيحُ يُوسُفَ) (the scent of Yusuf): it's in the air, it is said Yaqoub (عليه) could smell his scent 8 days before they arrived.
- (لَوْلَا أَن تُفَنِّدُونِ) (if only you think me not a dotard): it is said that Yaqoub (عليه السلام) said this either to those around him, or when the sons came back. People might think he is just saying things that are nonsense (ان (هذا الكلام صدر من غير شعور). You can truly find the character of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) that he can be expressive of his feelings, though he is a messenger, subhan Allah.

Ayah 95 – (قَالُوا تَأَلَّهَ إِنَّكَ لَفِي ضَلَالِكَ الْقَدِيمِ) (They said: "By Allâh! Certainly, you are in your old error.")

- The brothers know that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is alive and safe, yet the traces of jealousy are still there. Why didn't they tell their father that Yusuf (عليه السلام) is there? Subhan Allah.
- If a person has the sickness of jealousy, when the person they are jealous of is out of sight, then they think they are not jealous, but as soon as the person reappears then the jealousy comes out. This means the jealousy was there are along, so you need to purify yourself, especially when the 'iron is hot' meaning when the person is there. Because if the person you are jealous of is not in front of you, then the feelings of jealousy will not be triggered and you will not purify yourself, subhan Allah.

- When you are jealous of a person, others might be talking about how good that person is, you will say who said that, they're not so good. Though you know the person is good, but you are jealous, subhan Allah. When a person is jealous of someone, they will always try to put them down. And jealousy covers you from the truth.
- Also when it comes to being obedient to your parents, the reality appears especially when they are old. If your parents like to have their furniture or cabinets a certain way, don't say you don't know, you're so old-fashioned, will anything happen because of the furniture? Subhan Allah.
- (قَالُوا تَأَلَّهْ) (They said: "By Allâh!): the sons are even swearing by Allah (جَلَّ)
- (إِنَّكَ لَفِي) (Certainly, you are): this is very rude to speak so directly in this manner to the parents
- (ضَلَّلَكَ الْقَدِيمِ) (in your old error): this is out of the son's jealousy of their father's love for Yusuf (حبك ليوسف) (عليه السلام). Even the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) loved Aisha (ra) more or Abu Bakr (ra), and you can't say why? Don't worry about other people's love, worry about Allah's love.

أَيَّاهُ ٩٦ - فَلَمَّا أَن جَاءَ الْبَشِيرُ أَلْقَاهُ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ فَارْتَدَّ بَصِيرًا قَالَ أَلَمْ أَقُلْ لَّكُمْ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ ()
(ثُمَّ، إِذَا كَانَ الْبَشِيرُ، أَلْقَاهُ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ، فَارْتَدَّ بَصِيرًا، قَالَ: أَلَمْ أَقُلْ لَّكُمْ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ ()
(Then, when the bearer of the glad tidings arrived, he
cast it (the shirt) over his face, and he became clear-sighted. He said:
"Did I not say to you, 'I know from Allâh that which you know not.' ")

- (فَلَمَّا أَن جَاءَ الْبَشِيرُ) (Then, when the bearer of the glad tidings arrived):
 - (جَاءَ) (came): means to come but with some struggle.
 - (الْبَشِيرُ) (the bearer of glad tidings): it comes from (بَشَّرَ), which means giving good news. (أَخْبَرَ بِخَيْرٍ سَارٍ) Also it is (صَيْغَةً مَبَالِغَةً), it is an excessive form and the (ال) – is drowning in good news (الاستغراق). Which good news? He got his sight back, his sons returned seeking forgiveness, and the reunion of his entire family (بِقَرَبِ اجْتِمَاعِ يُوسُفَ وَآخُوتهِ وَأَبِيهِمْ وَأُمِّهِمْ). Imagine for so long a member of the family is missing, and then another, then a third – how great it must be for Yaqoub (عليه السلام), subhan Allah. The bearer of glad tidings is actually referring to the shirt of Yusuf (عليه السلام).
- (أَلْقَاهُ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ) (he cast it (the shirt) over his face):
 - (أَلْقَاهُ) (he cast it): recall that (أَلْقَى) was also mentioned when Yusuf (عليه السلام) was thrown into the well. When they cast the shirt of Yaqoub's (عليه السلام) face, then his vision returned to him.
- (فَارْتَدَّ بَصِيرًا) (and he became clear-sighted):
 - (أَرْتَدَّ) (return): his eyesight completely returned to his original condition (رَجَعَ إِلَى حَالَتِهِ الْأُولَى). It's not like his eyesight returned

partially, but completely. Notice his eyesight needs to be returned first, and then can then be reunited with his family, subhan Allah.

- (قَالَ أَلَمْ أَقُلْ لَّكُمْ) (He said: "Did I not say to you): this is the reply of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) to his sons – he is proud of Allah's blessing upon him – Yaqoub (عليه السلام) told them to never lose hope in Allah (ﷻ), that the relief will come, and it will come soon – he even told that their reunion with Yusuf (عليه السلام) is coming near (قرب الاجتماع بيوسف). It is his moment to say, 'I told you so' to his sons. Sometimes our parents tell us to do something and we don't do it, and then it happens, subhan Allah. And most of the time, our parents say, 'I knew it would happen' – so they attribute it to themselves, as if they know. But what did Yaqoub (عليه السلام) say? He attributed it to Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah.
- (إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ مِنَ اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ) ('I know from Allâh that which you know not.'): Yaqoub (عليه السلام) did not say I know and you don't, but all the knowledge that I have is from Allah (ﷻ). And Allah (ﷻ) inspired Yaqoub (عليه السلام) to go search for Yusuf (عليه السلام), to not despair, to smell the scent of Yusuf (عليه السلام), and that they will be reunited again (تحيسبوا ، لا تيأسوا ، ريح يوسف ، عسى أنه أن يأتيني بهم جميعا). Allah (ﷻ) inspired him throughout to make him think good about Allah (ﷻ) and

to have strong hope in Him (قوة الرجاء بالله). Yaqoub (عليه السلام) was waiting for the worries and grief to be taken away (مترقبا لزوال الهم و), (انتظار الفرج عبادة), and waiting for the relief itself is a worship (الحن), subhan Allah. Does any religion tell you that waiting for the relief is worship? Subhan Allah. Imagine your waiting, your hope in Allah (ﷻ) never goes to waste with Allah (ﷻ). You are waiting, you are hoping, so change your intention, and you will be rewarded. If you think that Allah (ﷻ) will solve your problems, then He will solve your problems. It is not about the problem itself, but about your tawheed – deal with Allah (ﷻ) as One. Everyone is going through problems and these trials are the gates for you to attach to Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Dua'a does not get answered because we are hasty in our hearts – we say I am making dua'a and nothing has happened yet – this is thinking very badly about Allah (ﷻ). Imagine someone who is in a very high position and is given a task to do, and you are going back and forth to this person, saying did you finish, did you do it? This attitude is so disrespectful. And to Allah (ﷻ) is the best example, Allah (ﷻ) is able to give you everything, He is the Most Rich, but do you doubt Allah, do you not believe in Him? Subhan Allah. When Allah (ﷻ) doesn't give you now, then it means it is bad for you right now.

Ayah 97 – (قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا أَسْتَغْفِرُ لَنَا ذُنُوبَنَا إِنَّا كُنَّا خَاطِئِينَ) (They said: "O our father!

Ask forgiveness (from Allâh) for our sins, indeed we have been sinners.")

- Before, the brothers were thinking about their father's love towards Yusuf (عليه السلام), so they became jealous. But when they knew that the love is from Allah (ﷻ), then there is no jealousy. They confessed their mistake of jealousy to Yusuf (عليه السلام), they said that Allah (ﷻ) has favored him over them.
- (قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا) (They said: "O our father!"): noticed how they said 'our father'
- (أَسْتَغْفِرُ لَنَا ذُنُوبَنَا) (Ask forgiveness (from Allâh) for our sins): they are asking their father to ask forgiveness for them and to forgive them. This is a request (سؤال طلب). They are asking their father to seek forgiveness for them. They are asking their father as well in order to give comfort to him, to show they disobeyed him. Also, when you ask your parents to make dua'a for you, it makes them feel good because you took them into consideration, subhan Allah. So this approach will melt his heart because if Allah (ﷻ) forgives, so how can I not forgive? Subhan Allah. Though they can seek forgiveness from Allah (ﷻ) directly, but they are shy to ask. So they are asking their father to ask forgiveness from Allah (ﷻ) for them because they have wronged their father as

well. Also, it is ok to ask the parents to make dua'a because their dua'a is acceptable, subhan Allah.

- (إِنَّا كُنَّا خَاطِئِينَ) (indeed we have been sinners): the reason for their asking is because they have sinned. You need to confess and Allah (ﷻ) will bring you up. They are confessing their mistakes towards their father – they lied to their father, they disobeyed him, they spoke disrespectfully to him, so they are asking for forgiveness from their father and that he seeks forgiveness for them from Allah (ﷻ). So why is it greater with their father? Because it is the rights of the parents that are involved.

Ayah 98 – (قَالَ سَوْفَ أَسْتَغْفِرُ لَكُمْ رَبِّي إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ) (He said: "I will ask my Lord for forgiveness for you, verily He! Only He is the Off-Forgiving, the Most Merciful.")

He will not ask forgiveness for them now, but later? There are two reasons for that.

- (قَالَ سَوْفَ أَسْتَغْفِرُ لَكُمْ رَبِّي) (He said: "I will ask my Lord for forgiveness for you): the sons made an intentional mistake and they have asked their father to seek forgiveness for them from Allah (ﷻ). Recall the dua'a of Adam (عليه السلام) when he and his wife disobeyed Allah (ربنا ظلمنا): (أنفسنا) Our Lord, we wronged ourselves. You can see that Adam (عليه السلام) is more humble, subhan Allah.

- (سَوْفَ) (later): if Yaqoub (عليه السلام) said (سَأَسْتَغْفِرُ), then it means it would be immediate. But (سَوْفَ) means after some time. So in the far future he will seek forgiveness for them, someone might ask why would he say that? Put yourself in Yaqoub's (عليه السلام) position, he lost his eyesight, he lost his sons, they spoke to him rudely, etc. Instead of telling them all the things they did to him, he just said 'later', at least he responded to them, subhan Allah. So the response of Yaqoub (عليه السلام) is the middle path. Why was it later?

- (1): Sheikh As Saady said the time when the brothers asked their father was around noon time, and their father delayed it because he chose the best time (السحر), before fajr, to make istighfar for them. This is the time when it is most responded and is the best time to make istighfar. This shows so much ihsan from Yaqoub (عليه السلام), subhan Allah. (أَخْرَجَ). (الاستغفار الى وقت السحر الفاضل لأن في هذا الوقت أتم الاستغفار وأقرب للإجابة).

This shows us that sometimes you can delay deeds in order to pick a more virtuous time – for example, to make dua'a in the times it is responded. Or you want to give charity, and the next day happens to be sacred days or Ramadan, so it can be done then. Even in worldly matters, you might be given a project and you do it quickly in one day to get it out of the

way, but it has so many mistakes. But if you take one extra day longer , then it would be ihsan.

- When you make dua'a for others in the unseen, meaning they don't know you are making dua'a for them, then there is an angel that says ameen and for you to, subhan Allah. This means you should not go and tell someone you made a dua'a for them, then your reward goes away. Imagine when you say (اللهم اغفر) (Oh Allah forgive the believing men and women, the living and dead of them) –you would get a reward for all them, subhan Allah. And when you make dua'a for others it's reforming you because it purifies your heart towards others. If you have an enmity between yourself and another person, and you don't know how to remove it – make dua'a for them. Imagine someone is oppressing you and you make dua'a for them – it is not easy, but you are purifying your heart. Also if you are jealous of someone, in order to remove that jealousy, you need to make dua'a to remove it. Imagine two shops that are selling the same thing, so naturally they are rivals, and you are making dua'a 'O Allah increase them in customers, profits' – it's not easy, but when you make dua'a for others, especially for someone who

oppressed you or you are jealous of, then this purifies your heart and it will reform them as well, subhan Allah.

- (2): Another scholar said the reason for Yaqoub (عليه السلام) making the dua'a later can be compared to ayah 92.

<u>Yacoub (عليه السلام)</u>	<u>Yusuf (عليه السلام)</u>
▪ <u>What the brothers said to their father: Ayah 97:</u> (قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا أَسْتَغْفِرُ) (They said: "O our father! Ask forgiveness (from Allâh) for our sins, indeed we have been sinners.")	▪ <u>What the brothers said to Yusuf (عليه السلام): Ayah 91:</u> (قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ (لَقَدْ ءَاثَرَكَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا وَإِن كُنَّا لَخَاطِئِينَ) (They said: "By Allâh! Indeed Allâh has preferred you above us, and we certainly have been sinners.")
▪ <u>The reply of Yaboub (عليه السلام) to his sons: Ayah 98:</u> (قَالَ سَوْفَ) (أَسْتَغْفِرُ لَكُمْ رَبِّي إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ) (He said: "I will ask my Lord for forgiveness for you, verily He! Only He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful)	▪ <u>The reply of Yusuf (عليه السلام) to his brothers: Ayah 92:</u> (قَالَ لَا تَثْرِيْبَ) (عَلَيْكُمْ الْيَوْمَ يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الْعَالَمِينَ) (He said: "No reproach on you this day, may Allâh forgive you, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy)

▪ Notice they are seeking forgiveness for their sins, meaning they had so many, and it all began with a thought, our father loves Yusuf (عليه السلام) more, subhan Allah. And that lead to lying, cheating, etc. And they became humiliated so many times by being stopped, etc – so their nurturing took longer.	▪ From Yusuf's (عليه السلام) goodness, he sought forgiveness for them without them even asking, subhan Allah. And this shows so much ihsan, though Yusuf (عليه السلام) went through so much pain ▪ This teaches us that that if we have a chance to help others, then we should do it without waiting for them to ask us. For example, a person might be sick and they know if they ask someone to do ruqyah for them then it nullifies from the 70,000 who enter paradise with no punishment or reckoning. So they don't ask someone to do ruqyah for them, but you can offer it to them, and this shows ihsan.
▪ Notice Yaqoub (عليه السلام) said Allah (ﷻ) is (الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ) – The Most Forgiving, Most Merciful.	▪ Notice that Yusuf (عليه السلام) said that Allah (ﷻ) is the Most Merciful of those who show

Yaqoub (عليه السلام) knows that Allah (ﷻ) forgives the sins, meaning you will not face the consequence of the sins, and then He will open for you the doors of mercy, subhan Allah. So purification and beautification. This makes you understand that when you ask Allah (ﷻ), He gives you more, subhan Allah. When you seek forgiveness, then Allah (ﷻ) will give you mercy from knowledge, good deeds, manners, etc.

- So the reason for the delay is because it is harder to approach someone who is older versus someone your age. When you have a misunderstanding with someone your age is different when you have a misunderstanding with someone older. Someone who is older will take longer to give a response,

mercy (أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ) because perhaps Yusuf (عليه السلام) showed mercy to his brothers, but Allah (ﷻ) is the Most Merciful – so attach to Him and no one else.

because they will think about it more. ▪ For example, if you are with your mother and children and you offer to go to the water park – the children will immediately say yes, but your mother will say, look at the time, not now, etc. And this shows us it's human nature, subhan Allah. ▪ So with age, you become wiser as long as you have knowledge. Getting older without knowledge makes someone complicated, subhan Allah. ▪ When anything is delayed, then know for sure there is wisdom. If the answer to your dua'a is being delayed, then there is wisdom.	
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Ayah 99 – (فَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَى يُوسُفَ ءَاوَىٰ إِلَيْهِ أَبَوَيْهِ وَقَالَ ادْخُلُوا مِصْرَ إِن شَاءَ ٱللَّهُ ءَامِنِينَ)

(Then, when they came in before Yûsuf (Joseph), he betook his parents to himself and said: "Enter Egypt, if Allâh wills, in security.")

- Yusuf (عليه السلام) is able to bring the entire tribe of Banu Israel to Egypt, not one or two persons, this shows the great honor and power that Allah (ﷻ) bestowed upon him.
- (فَلَمَّا) (Then, when): Yaqoub (عليه السلام) and his sons all packed and left their land to Egypt (تجهز يعقوب و اولاده كلهم و ارتحلوا من بلادهم الى مصر).
- (دَخَلُوا عَلَى يُوسُفَ) (they came in before Yûsuf): When they reached Egypt, they went to Yusuf (عليه السلام) began he will take them in. And look at the pure heart of Yusuf (عليه السلام), despite his brothers taking him out and driving him away, Yusuf (عليه السلام) brought them all back, subhan Allah.
- (ءَاوَىٰ إِلَيْهِ أَبَوَيْهِ) (he betook his parents to himself): (ءَاوَىٰ): means to accommodate with affection, care, honor and love, unlike refuge which is to accommodate but with not as much special treatment. Yusuf (عليه السلام) showed a special welcome and treatment to his parents first. Why? This shows us the rights of the parents come first, you need to be dutiful to your parents (ابدى لهم البر والاکرام). Imagine you have a gathering with your parents and siblings – you need to make your parents feel extra special and take them in first. When we see this kind of treatment it should remind us that if anyone has oppressed you, don't do the same to them, do better – especially when you

have the upper-hand, don't misuse the power that you have, subhan Allah.

- (وَقَالَ آدْخُلُوا مِصْرَ إِن شَاءَ اللَّهُ ءَامِنِينَ) (and said: "Enter Egypt, if Allâh wills, in security): now they are given permission to enter Egypt, but notice that Yusuf (عليه السلام) said (إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ) first and then (ءَامِنِينَ) – he did not say 'enter in security' alone, why? To show that it is not in his power alone to make them safe, but it is by the will of Allah (ﷻ) to make them safe. He will do his best, but it is only by the will of Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. This shows us don't give people a guarantee you will do something, as if it is your final say, but you need to say (إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ) because you cannot work by yourself. Yusuf (عليه السلام) associated their entry to Egypt by the will of Allah (ﷻ) (قرن دخولهم مصر آمنين بمشيئة) (الله). If Allah wills it will happen and if He doesn't then it will not happen, subhan Allah.

آyah 100 – (وَرَفَعَ أَبَوَيْهِ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ وَخَرُّوا لَهُ سُجَّدًا وَقَالَ يَا أَبَتِ هَذَا تَأْوِيلُ رُءْيَايَ مِنْ قَبْلُ)
قَدْ جَعَلَهَا رَبِّي حَقًّا وَقَدْ أَحْسَنَ بِي إِذْ أَخْرَجَنِي مِنَ السِّجْنِ وَجَاءَ بِكُم مِّنَ الْبَدْوِ مِنْ بَعْدِ أَنْ نَزَغَ
(And he raised (الشَّيْطَانُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ إِخْوَتِي إِنَّ رَبِّي لَطِيفٌ لِّمَا يَشَاءُ إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ
his parents to the throne and they fell down before him prostrate. And he
said: "O my father! This is the interpretation of my dream aforetime! My
Lord has made it come true! He was indeed good to me, when He took
me out of the prison, and brought you (all here) out of the bedouin-life,

after Shaitân (Satan) had sown enmity between me and my brothers. Certainly, my Lord is the Most Courteous and Kind unto whom He wills. Truly He! Only He is the All-Knowing, the All-Wise.)

- (وَرَفَعَ أَبَوَيْهِ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ) (And he raised his parents to the throne): notice the parents are first because their rights are to be fulfilled first. They are placed on the throne, recall that Yusuf (عليه السلام) started with being thrown into a well, and now he has a throne – it is kings who have thrones, subhan Allah. He asked to be a keeper of the lands, then he was a Aziz, and now Yusuf (عليه السلام) has a throne – look at the elevation in his position as well. In the akhira, the one who is righteous and has a high level in paradise, then he will be able to take up the rest of his family with him, and this is a great favor from Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. May Allah (ﷻ) grant us someone righteous in our family. Ameen. Yaqoub (عليه السلام) suffered the most emotionally because the suffering of parents is greater than the children. That's why when you see the pain of others, you feel more pain, subhan Allah. Your children might be in pain but seeing them in pain makes you feel more pain.
- (وَخَرُّوا لَهُ سُجَّدًا) (and they fell down before him prostrate): and they all fell into prostration, including the parents and the eleven brothers (الابوان والاخوة 11). Keep in mind that Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not tell them to prostrate. (وَخَرُّوا) is similar to when you open the tap and the water

flows automatically, like its voluntary (لا ارادي), subhan Allah. They just prostrated voluntarily. Someone might ask how can they prostrate to other than Allah (ﷻ)? At the time of their sharia (السجود كان موجودا قبل), they had a prostration that was not a worship (هذا السجود), (شريعة الاسلام), but as a greeting (التحية), respect (التعظيم), and honor (الاکرام). In our sharia, we are not allowed to prostrate to anyone except Allah (ﷻ). When the angels prostrated to Adam (عليه السلام) that was a prostration out of honor. Notice they fell into prostration voluntarily – you don't need to fight for your rights, Allah (ﷻ) will give it to you., subhan Allah The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) said if he were to command prostration, he would command the wife to prostrate to her husband, subhan Allah. There is no prostration to the husbands in Islam but it is to show that obedience is important in a marriage. If there is obedience and trust in the marriage then the house will be a paradise. If there is no obedience and mistrust, then the house becomes a hell and the role of the mother is central to the house.

- (وَقَالَ يَا أَبَتِ) (And he said: "O my father!): notice the respectful words of Yusuf (يُوسُفَ) (عليه السلام) (O my father), he also said this in ayah 4 when he told his father about his dream. He didn't speak of his dream to anyone except his father, and this shows us that you should not tell others about your good dreams because they can be jealous of you.

The Prophet (ﷺ) said to only tell your dreams to those who love you. Also, if you speak about it to others then it puts arrogance in your heart as if I dreamt a dream like this, thinking you are special to have a dream like this, subhan Allah. When the dream was fulfilled, Yusuf (عليه السلام) only told his father again and not his brothers, this shows his pure heart, subhan Allah.

- (هَذَا تَأْوِيلُ رُؤْيَايَ مِنْ قَبْلُ) (This is the interpretation of my dream aforesaid): the interpretation of the dream was very clear, it has become fulfilled.
- (قَدْ جَعَلَهَا رَبِّي حَقًّا) (My Lord has made it come true): The dream was true because it took place (حقيقة بوقوعها). Look at his pure soul, he attributed its reality all to Allah (ﷻ) – he didn't mention himself once, subhan Allah. His speech does not include 'I, I, I', rather 'Allah, Allah, Allah', subhan Allah. He knows that Allah (ﷻ) is his Rabb, his Nurturer and he was nurtured to reach this level.
- (وَقَدْ أَحْسَنَ بِي) (He was indeed good to me): Yusuf (عليه السلام) saw ihsan from Allah (ﷻ) all throughout. There might have been difficult moments, but he didn't say they were difficult, it was all ihsan, subhan Allah. There are two types of hardship – if a person is going through pain then that is nurturing, but if there is no pain in the hardship then that is elevation, subhan Allah. The deeper the sin, the more painful the nurturing. It wasn't like Yusuf (عليه السلام) committed sins that he was afflicted in order to be nurtured, but he was afflicted in order to

be elevated, subhan Allah. For example, two people can go through the same sickness, for one it is painful and troublesome, that's nurturing, and for the other they don't feel any pain and they're calm, that's elevation, subhan Allah.

- (إِذْ أَخْرَجَنِي مِنَ السِّجْنِ) (when He took me out of the prison): Yusuf (عليه السلام) saw ihsan from Allah (ﷻ) all throughout, he said Allah (ﷻ) took me out from jail. He didn't say 'I was in jail and was taken out', he didn't say, 'I was in a problem'. Notice he is so embarrassed to even say something like this and he would never want others to hear something like this about Allah (ﷻ) – he just said 'Allah (ﷻ) took me out', subhan Allah.
- We all have problems in our lives but don't talk about your problem until you are taken out of it. Because while you are in the middle of the problem it's a critical time and you don't want to talk and get confused by others. When you are taken out of the problem, then you can say you have been relieved of the problem. Talk about your success, how you were saved, not the problem – and this is thinking good about Allah (ﷻ).
- Yusuf (عليه السلام) did not mention that he was taken out of the well, why? Because he didn't want to open that subject in front of his brothers, he doesn't want to make them feel bad and he already told them that he forgave them, so end of subject, subhan Allah. He didn't mention the wife of the Aziz either, though it could be enticing, but he skipped this part, subhan Allah. He avoided saying anything that can

cause fitna, subhan Allah. This shows so much purity and ihsan, subhan Allah.

- (وَجَاءَ بِكُمْ مِنَ الْبَدْوِ) (and brought you (all here) out of the bedouin-life):

he didn't say 'I brought you here', not once does he mention himself – it is Allah (ﷻ) who brought you here. And he didn't say you came out of a drought, but from the (الْبَدْوِ) – from the village life, subhan Allah. He is so polite in his speech that he doesn't want to mention their circumstances. And notice he said that Allah (ﷻ) is doing good to me, not 'us', though it was good for them, but to show it was good for him too, subhan Allah. Look at how much ihsan he has. He's not narrating a story for the sake of narrating a story, he's not speaking for the sake of speaking, but he's speaking because he wants to help them, so he is choosing words that will make them learn a lesson and think good about Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. It is all positive about Allah (ﷻ). Everyone has a story, but how do you tell that story? Subhan Allah.

- (مِنْ بَعْدِ أَنْ نَزَعَ الشَّيْطَانُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ إِخْوَتِي) (after Shaitân (Satan) had sown enmity between me and my brothers.): Yusuf (عليه السلام) went to the

core problem, he didn't point his fingers at his brothers, but he wanted to send a message – the shaitan doesn't like people to be together, the shaitan likes people to be separated. Why? Because if you're alone then he can really have power over you, unlike being in a

group. The shaitan does (نَزَعَ) – meaning he just pokes and then he leaves and watches you fighting, subhan Allah. The shaitan loves scenes of fighting, he goes and sits in the audience and shouts to do more, like a wrestling match, subhan Allah. We would think these brothers are so bad and mean, and we end up exaggerating it forgetting the shaitan is behind it too. The shaitan whispered to the brothers, but Yusuf (عليه السلام) mentioned himself though he didn't have any role in it, subhan Allah. And on top of that, he mentions himself first – this is the peak of ihsan – truly these are our superstars.

- The shaitan will go back and forth poking on the same wound, but you need to say (أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ) – you need to seek refuge in Allah (ﷻ) from the shaitan. Surah Al 'Araf 200: (وَأَمَّا يَنْزَغَنَّكَ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ نَزْغٌ فَاسْتَعِذْ) (And if an evil whisper comes to you from Shaitân (Satan) then seek refuge with Allâh. Verily, He is All-Hearer, All-Knower)
- And Don't give fuel to the shaitan by talking back, rather say what is best. Surah Al Isra'a 53: (وَقُلْ لِعِبَادِيَ يَقُولُوا آلَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ يَنْزَغُ بَيْنَهُمْ إِنَّ) (And say to My slaves that they should (only) say those words that are the best. (Because) Shaitân (Satan) verily, sows state of conflict and disagreements among them. Surely, Shaitân (Satan) is to man a plain enemy)

- The shaitan doesn't like peace, he likes problems – he knows the weakness of both sides, so Yusuf (عليه السلام) mentioned himself as well to say what is best and to push away the shaitan.
- (إِنَّ رَبِّي لَطِيفٌ لِّمَا يَشَاءُ) (Certainly, my Lord is the Most Courteous and Kind unto whom He wills.): Yusuf (عليه السلام) mentioned 'My Rabb' – He was nurturing him. He didn't become a tyrant or complicated as a result of the nurturing, rather Yusuf (عليه السلام) was innocent and oppressed but it was all elevation for him. Yusuf (عليه السلام) didn't speak about his brother's nurturing but his nurturing. He was nurtured from an incomplete state to a complete state, subhan Allah. How did Allah (ﷻ) nurture him? (لَطِيفٌ) It was all kind, gentle, and subtle. We think it's hard, but it was all gentle and subtle for Yusuf (عليه السلام). He didn't feel the pain of being in jail, in the well, in the house of Aziz, etc. The nurturing was subtle meaning he didn't think that being in the well would ultimately lead him to having a throne, subhan Allah. Through the decrees of Allah (ﷻ) it took him places he couldn't imagine, and it was all done gradually. And this type of nurturing is based on what? On knowledge and wisdom.
- (إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ) (Truly He! Only He is the All-Knowing, the All-Wise): Allah (ﷻ) is the All-Knower - He knows that Yusuf (عليه السلام) can take this kind of nurturing and He knows who is deserving of it. Everything

happens with wisdom and Allah (ﷻ) really wanted the good for Yusuf (عليه السلام). Allah (ﷻ) is the All-Wise, putting everything and everyone in the right place.

Ayah 101 – رَبِّ قَدْ ءَاتَيْتَنِي مِنَ الْمُلْكِ وَعَلَّمْتَنِي مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ)

(أَنْتَ وَلِيٌّ لِي فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ تَوَفَّنِي مُسْلِمًا وَأَلْحِقْنِي بِالصَّالِحِينَ) ("My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the sovereignty, and taught me something of the interpretation of dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Walî (Protector, Helper, Supporter, Guardian, God, Lord.) in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim (the one submitting to Your Will), and join me with the righteous.")

- This is the dua'a of Yusuf (عليه السلام) and recall he is among the muhsineen. The dua'a of a person shows the reality of that person.
- رَبِّ (My Rabb): Yusuf (عليه السلام) reached the max in duniya – he got the duniya because it wasn't his concern. Was his concern to leave his country so that he can get a higher position? No. When you have a 'duniya' goal – you limit your mind. For example, your goal is to be a good mother, ok you get it, and then what? Make your goals high, set up your bar very high – Firdaous Al 'Ala. We need to upgrade ourselves, and the change needs to be from inside, from yourself. When your concern is high, the duniya will come to you, and you will even tell it to sit in the back. You're the driver, the duniya is not driving you, subhan Allah. The dua'a of the Prophets begins with (رَبِّ) – My

Nurturer, they are calling on their 'Rabb' because they wanted to be nurtured, they want to be mature in faith to reach paradise, subhan Allah.

- (قَدْ ءَاتَيْتَنِي مِنَ الْمُلْكِ) (You have indeed bestowed on me of the sovereignty): Yusuf (عليه السلام) begins with confessing that the blessing are from you My Rabb – he attributes to it Allah (ﷻ). He reached, but he didn't make it his concern. Some people before getting a position, they were nice, and after they get the position, they're rude. The confession of Yusuf (عليه السلام) shows his gratitude. How do you make shukr? You confess to Allah (ﷻ) that it's from You alone. His first confession is that You gave me some of the dominion, because the entire dominion is for Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. Some people when they get the duniya, they're just wasting their time to preserve it. What else does he confess to?
- (وَعَلَّمَنِي مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ) (and taught me something of the interpretation of dreams): this is a favor from Allah (ﷻ) that he needs to admit and confess to. And Who's teaching him? Allah (ﷻ). There might be means in the middle, but The First and The Last is Allah (ﷻ). Whatever you're learning, you need to thank Allah (ﷻ) that He's teaching you, alhamdulillah.

Surah Al 'Alaq 5: (عَلَّمَ الْإِنْسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ) (He has taught man that which he knew not.) Allah (ﷻ) gave him the ability to interpret dreams and to understand the divine books of his time. So he is confessing to two favors – of the duniya and akhira. When you make a dua'a to Allah (ﷻ), it's very beautiful to confess to the favors of Allah (ﷻ), it shows humbleness before starting with your dua'a. Imagine starting with just 'give me, give me', subhan Allah. Before asking for something for the future, recall the past favors.

- (فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ) (the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth): now he's making a waseelah, calling on Allah (ﷻ), Fatir is an attribute of Allah (ﷻ), not one of His names. (فَاطِرٌ) is to split, to initiate the creation creatively from nothing. From nothing, Allah (ﷻ) creates something. Allah (ﷻ) is The Originator, The Creator, and The One Who Brings out from nothing something. Why is this attribute mentioned in particular? Because Yusuf (عليه السلام) came from a simple background and look at what he where he reached.
- (أَنْتَ وَلِيٌّ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ) (You are my Walî (Protector, Helper, Supporter, Guardian, God, Lord.) in this world and in the Hereafter): Yusuf (عليه السلام) understood the meaning of (waliya) – companionship which

protects you, helps you, loves you and supports you. Yusuf (عليه السلام) lived the companionship of Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. And he doesn't want this waliya to go away. Yusuf (عليه السلام) left his family, no mother and father, he didn't have anyone – so all of these years Who was his Companion? Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. And he confesses to Allah (ﷻ) that 'You are my Wali' – who was my Wali when I was in the well? Allah. Who was my Wali when I was in the house of Aziz? Allah. Who was my Wali and proved my innocence in jail? Allah. Al Wali is one of the names Allah (ﷻ). Allah (ﷻ) even protected Yusuf (عليه السلام) when he became a minister – he protected him from himself, subhan Allah. Allah (ﷻ) protected him in the well and protected him from falling into desire at the house of Aziz. He protected him in jail from complaining. And Yusuf (عليه السلام) was of the muhsineen when he was both inside and outside the jail. It doesn't matter whether a person is rich or poor, there is still ihsan. Allah (ﷻ) loves him and cares about him – He gave him victory over the shaitan and against himself. Surah Al Baqarah 257: (اللَّهُ وَلِيُّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا يُخْرِجُهُم مِّنَ الظُّلُمَاتِ إِلَى النُّورِ) (Allâh is the Walî (Protector or Guardian) of those who believe. He brings them out from darkness into light. But as for those who disbelieve, their Auliya (supporters and helpers) are Tâghût [false deities and false leaders], they bring them out from light into darkness) – (اللَّهُ وَلِيُّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا) – If

you want Allah (ﷻ) to be your Wali, then believe more. And if Allah (ﷻ) is your Wali, then who can be your enemy? No one, subhan Allah. You want Allah (ﷻ) to be you Wali. Allah (ﷻ) takes you out from the darkness of the shirk, sins, bida'a, sorrows, to the light of faith, obedience, and following the Sunnah. And this light gives you power in this life and you can survive in this life. You can walk on the Sirat with this light, subhan Allah. Awliya Allah there is no fear for them, why? Allah (ﷻ) is their Companion. And they are not sad. So it shows that 'awliya Allah' are stable and not complicated people. Yusuf (عليه السلام) went through so many ups and down, anyone else can come out complicated, but Yusuf (عليه السلام) didn't because he had only Allah (ﷻ) in his heart. Ihsan and the companionship of Allah (ﷻ) overpowered his feelings. Awliya Allah believe and have taqwa. Life is changing, people are changing, you cannot attach to something that's changing. And alhamdulillah that we have the supplications of the messengers in the Qur'an – it's not a secret that it's only for the messengers. Note you begin with: (فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ). And notice he didn't make his dua'a in the beginning but in the end, and he wasn't making dua'as asking for things, he only asked to be protected from the ladies. But now he's asking for requests, but not for the duniya.

- (تَوَفَّنِي مُسْلِمًا) (Cause me to die as a Muslim (the one submitting to Your Will)). Yusuf (عليه السلام) is so humble in his dua'a. He asks Allah (ﷻ) to take away his soul, not he is not asking Allah (ﷻ) to make him die, but he is asking for the state that he wishes he dies. (تَوَفَّنِي): to complete, to terminate his life. He is asking Allah (ﷻ) to make him die in a state of Islam, it is an honor for him to die as a Muslim. He didn't say a 'mu'min' – he is so humble in his dua'a. Muslim means to be submissive and subjected to Allah (ﷻ). Yusuf (عليه السلام) was always surrendering in his life, he didn't fight, reject, or object. He just asked Allah (ﷻ) to protect him from the ladies, subhan Allah. At the time of fitna, we can easily lose our faith. It's important to ask Allah (ﷻ) to keep us firm on the deen. What does it mean to be firm on the deen? It means situations can't change you, you are stable and firm. You change only for Allah (ﷻ). Don't rely on your knowledge, or that you're strong. Dua'a: يا مقلب القلوب ثبت قلبي (O Changer of the Hearts, keep our hearts firm on Your deen) and Surah Al Imran 8: رَبَّنَا لَا تُزِغْ قُلُوبَنَا بَعْدَ إِذْ هَدَيْتَنَا وَهَبْ لَنَا مِنْ ((They say): "Our Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us

mercy from You. Truly, You are the Bestower). When you have taqwa, then this will give you protection. How will you meet Allah (ﷻ) without taqwa? Subhan Allah.

- وَالْحَقِّنِي بِالصَّالِحِينَ (and join me with the righteous.): he is so humble, he is a messenger and it's the righteous people who follow him, yet he's asking to be with the righteous, subhan Allah. The believer will not look at his deeds and be proud of it. The hypocrite or disbeliever is only proud of his deeds – I did this, I did that, etc. This dua'a truly shows the purity of Yusuf's (عليه السلام) heart. Yusuf (عليه السلام) is asking to follow and be with the righteous, though the ones that Allah (ﷻ) has bestowed His grace upon are (أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ) – Surah An Nisa'a 69: وَمَنْ يُطِيعِ اللَّهَ وَالرَّسُولَ فَأُولَٰئِكَ مَعَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِمْ مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ وَالصِّدِّيقِينَ وَالشُّهَدَاءِ وَالصَّالِحِينَ وَحَسُنَ أُولَٰئِكَ رَفِيقًا (And whoso obeys Allâh and the Messenger (Muhammad SAW), then they will be in the company of those on whom Allâh has bestowed His Grace, of the Prophets, the Siddiqûn, the martyrs, and the righteous. And how excellent these companions are!). Notice the righteous are the last and the messengers are the first, though Yusuf (عليه السلام) is asking to be with the righteous and this shows his humbleness, subhan Allah.

Ayah 102 – ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ أَنْبَاءِ الْغَيْبِ نُوحِيهِ إِلَيْكَ وَمَا كُنْتَ لَدَيْهِمْ إِذْ أَجْمَعُوا أَمْرَهُمْ وَهُمْ (يَمْكُرُونَ) (That is of the news of the Ghaib (unseen) which We reveal to you (O Muhammad (ﷺ)). You were not (present) with them when they arranged their plan together, and (while) they were plotting.)

▪ ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ أَنْبَاءِ الْغَيْبِ (That is of the news of the Ghaib (unseen)): This is a story from the unseen.

○ أَنْبَاءِ (great news): it is plural for (نَبَأٌ) which is great news (الْخَبْرُ الْعَظِيمُ), news that should make you stop and listen.

○ الْغَيْبِ (unseen): the unseen is all that is hidden from the senses.

We have five senses – seeing, hearing, smelling, tasting, and touching. We don't have a 6th sense, this is all based on prediction. Some people say I know this person is calling, or I know it's this person knocking on the door, and many times we see it's correct. This is a test from Allah (ﷻ), don't say I have been gifted with this power, subhan Allah. There was story of someone who was dreaming and it would be fulfilled the next day, she became scared to sleep because she didn't want accidents, etc. She thought she was some 'wali', having some closeness to Allah (ﷻ). Then we she started seeking knowledge, she knew it was a test. The moment she knew it was a test she stopped

having these dreams, subhan Allah. The shaitan wants us to believe in ourselves, not in Allah (ﷻ).

- So there was no way the Prophet ((ﷺ)) would have known the story of Yusuf (عليه السلام) because it was unseen to him. The muttazeen believe in the unseen, they believe in the news being said to them by Allah (ﷻ). When Allah (ﷻ) says this is good, this is bad, this is paradise, this is the hellfire, etc – the muttazeen believe. Taqwa is based on the unseen.
- ﴿نُوحِيهِ إِلَيْكَ﴾ (which We reveal to you (O Muhammad ((ﷺ))): Allah (ﷻ) took some news of the unseen and inspired it to the Prophet ((ﷺ)). So had it not been for Allah (ﷻ) telling him, he wouldn't have known. This shows the Prophet ((ﷺ)) is not a fortune teller or magician or knower of the unseen. If we were able to see the unseen now then the test is over, we would see all of the answers to our test.
- ﴿وَمَا كُنْتَ لَدَيْهِمْ﴾ (You were not (present) with them):
 - (نفي): this is for negation
 - (النبى) ((ﷺ)): you were, referring to the Prophet ((ﷺ))
 - (لَدَيْهِمْ): with them, referring to the brothers (لدى الاخوة), when?

- (إِذْ أَجْمَعُوا أَمْرَهُمْ) (when they arranged their plan together): when the brothers gathered and all agreed to throw Yusuf (عليه السلام) in the well (اجتمع الاخوة و اجمعوا على القاء يوسف في البئر). What were they concerned about that made them plot and throw Yusuf (عليه السلام) in the well? Jealousy – they were jealous of their father's love towards Yusuf (عليه). This is an example of helping each other on sin and enmity. We need to know that love is a provision from Allah (ﷻ) so there's no need to be jealous. In general, people come and meet together when they are concerned about the same thing. This shows people of the same heart come together and people of different hearts repel from each other. If there is a room of 100 believers and one hypocrite, and a hypocrite enters, he will go and sit with that one hypocrite. And if there is a room of 100 hypocrites and one believer, and a believer enters, he will go and sit with that one believer, subhan Allah.
- (وَهُمْ يَمْكُرُونَ) (and (while) they were plotting): this is their condition while they were together, they were plotting. Was the Prophet (ﷺ) with them while they were plotting? No. Imagine their own father Yaqoub (عليه السلام) didn't know about his sons, so how could the Prophet (ﷺ) have known? And this shows it's a favor from

Allah (ﷻ) to His Prophet ((ﷺ)). And any favor of the Prophet ((ﷺ)) is also a favor for us, alhamdulillah.

Ayah 103 – (وَمَا أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ وَلَوْ حَرَصْتَ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ) (And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly)

- Allah (ﷻ) revealed the truth and the unseen to the Prophet ((ﷺ)). So the Prophet ((ﷺ)) wants to convey this to the people so that they may believe. But the rule of Allah (ﷻ) is telling us that the majority of people, no matter how eager you are trying to tell them, will not believe. This shows that only a minority will believe. May Allah (ﷻ) make us of the believers. Ameen.
- (حَرَصْتَ): is to have a very strong will and determination. This shows that it's not you who changes the people's hearts. When you are in the dawah, you cannot complain about the people not changing. Imagine the Prophet ((ﷺ)) who is the best of teachers yet not everyone believed, so what about us? Subhan Allah. You can't change people's actions, manners, characters, feelings, or hearts. Allah (ﷻ) says in Surah Ar Ra'ad 11: (إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُغَيِّرُ مَا بِقَوْمٍ حَتَّى يُغَيِّرُوا مَا بِأَنْفُسِهِمْ) (Allâh will not change the condition of a people as long as they do not change their state themselves). So it's the people who have to change, you can't change them.

- Your job is only to convey – you can't be pushy with the truth. You are actually underestimating the truth when you are just pushing it on the people. Allah (ﷻ) says there is no compulsion in the religion. Don't push people, otherwise you are bringing hypocrisy into a society while not knowing and you think you're doing something good, subhan Allah. When you bring the truth without mixing it with your desires, then it's beautiful. When you push someone, they will either draw back and go even further away, or they will do it out of fear and this is hypocrisy.
- Allah (ﷻ) is the Owner of the hearts, it is important to know this. You do not own your husband's heart or children's heart, just ask Allah (ﷻ) and don't stress. One of the tricks of the shaitan is to put duniya into the deen.
- Surah Qaf 45: (نَحْنُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا يَقُولُونَ وَمَا أَنْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ بِجَبَّارٍ فَذَكَرْ بِالْقُرْآنِ مَنْ يَخَافُ وَعِيدِ) (We know of best what they say; and you (O Muhammad (ﷺ)) are not the one to force them (to Belief). But warn by the Qur'ân, him who fears My Threat.)

Ayah 104– (وَمَا تَسْأَلُهُمْ عَلَيْهِ مِنْ أَجْرٍ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِلْعَالَمِينَ) (And no reward you (O Muhammad SAW) ask of them (those who deny your Prophethood) for it, it (the Qur'ân) is no less than a Reminder and an advice unto the 'Alamîn (men and jinn).)

- (وَمَا تَسْأَلُهُمْ عَلَيْهِ مِنْ أَجْرٍ) (And no reward you (O Muhammad SAW) ask of them (those who deny your Prophethood) for it): The Prophet (ﷺ) is calling on the people without wanting any reward or recompense from them. And this is true for the da'ee, he shouldn't have any expectations from the people, not even a thank you. How can someone talk about the words of Allah (ﷻ) and take money, subhan Allah. Some people might not continue their education due to financial reasons, but for the deen there is no cost.
- (إِنَّ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِلْعَالَمِينَ) (it (the Qur'ân) is no less than a Reminder and an advice unto the 'Alamîn): The Qur'an is a reminder for everyone so it is not suitable to take money from the people in order to learn the deen. That's why the Prophet (ﷺ) always said he doesn't want to take anything from the people. Imagine we need the Qur'an for our entire life, so how can we be spending money our entire life for it? Subhan Allah.

Ayah 105 – (وَكَايْنِ مِّنْ ءَايَةٍ فِي السَّمٰوٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ يَمُرُّونَ عَلَيْهَا وَهُمْ عَنْهَا مُعْرِضُونَ) (And how many a sign in the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom)

- (وَكَايْنِ مِّنْ ءَايَةٍ فِي السَّمٰوٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ) (And how many a sign in the heavens and the earth): All of the signs of Allah (ﷻ) are free of charge, do you need to pay money to see the sunset? No. Imagine how many signs

are in the heavens and the earth? There are so many ayat around us, even if you're at home, there are signs. Without stepping outside, the very situations you're going through are ayat. Yesterday is not like today and tomorrow is not like today. Even our moods changing are ayat – all to show you (لا اله الا الله).

- (يَمْرُؤْنَ عَلَيْهَا) (they pass by,): Allah (ﷻ) is telling us all of the answers to our test, are you sincere or associating, are you truthful or a liar, are you patient or impatient – we are wrapped with answers all around us, subhan Allah. The answer to everything is (لا اله الا الله). Sometimes you want to go somewhere and you don't, this is (لا اله الا الله). We are passing through all of these ayat, but what is our condition?
- (وَهُمْ عَنْهَا مُعْرِضُونَ) (while they are averse therefrom): we are heedless, we are ignoring it, we are not filling the answers to our test, subhan Allah. Why? Because we're focused on other matters, but if we look at the ayat then our problems are solved, subhan Allah. We think we go through things randomly, but anything we see or hear is not random. Sometimes you are passing by and you hear people talking, not that you want to listen but what you hear is a reminder for you. There are no mistakes in life, anything that befalls you is not random. Sometimes a person blames you for something you didn't do, but this could be a means of elevation or purification– everything is ayat for you. One of the reasons preventing us from learning these ayat is our ego, we think 'why me?' 'Subhan Allah. Don't look at things with narrow vision, look at the bigger picture.

Ayah 106 – (وَمَا يُؤْمِنُ أَكْثَرُهُمْ بِاللَّهِ إِلَّا وَهُمْ مُشْرِكُونَ) (And most of them believe not in Allâh except that they attribute partners unto Him [i.e. they are Mushrikûn])

- Most people do not believe, so only a minority believe. And of those who believe, majority of them believe while mixing with shirk. So a minority believe purely, subhan Allah. For example, the people of Quraish believed in Allah (ﷻ) but they associated with Him as well. When they are told Who is the Creator, Who is the Bestower? They will say Allah (ﷻ), they believe in the actions of Allah (ﷻ), in His Lordship (الربوبية). But when it comes to their actions they turn to shirk, they turn to the means, they turn to riyâ'a, etc. They make dua'a to other than Allah (ﷻ), love and fear other than Allah (ﷻ).
- If you believe in the actions of Allah (ﷻ), then you will have tawheed in your actions. Tawheed ar rubobiya (توحيد الربوبية) leads to tawheed al uloohiya (توحيد الألوهية/العبادة). The problem is with people and their actions, this is where shirk enters. That's why Allah (ﷻ) says in Surah Adh Dhariyat 56 (وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ) (And I (Allâh) created not the jinn and mankind except that they should worship Me (Alone).) Allah (ﷻ) didn't say to believe but to worship because if you truly believe then your worship will be for Allah (ﷻ) alone.

Ayah 107– (أَفَأَمِنُوا أَنْ تَأْتِيَهُمْ غَشِيَةٌ مِّنْ عَذَابِ اللَّهِ أَوْ تَأْتِيَهُمُ السَّاعَةُ بَغْتَةً وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ)

(Do they then feel secure from the coming against them of the covering veil of the Torment of Allâh, or of the coming against them of the (Final) Hour, all of a sudden while they perceive not?)

- (أَفَأَمِنُوا) (Do they then feel secure): Do those who deny, or disbelieve or believe but have shirk in their belief, do they feel secure?
- (أَنْ تَأْتِيَهُمْ غَشِيَةٌ مِّنْ عَذَابِ اللَّهِ) (from the coming against them of the covering veil of the Torment of Allâh): (غَشِيَةٌ) is an overwhelming torment, we also have Surah Al Ghashiyah, it is an overwhelming punishment in which the mind will be covered, the nursing mother will leave its child, and the people will be drunk, though they're not drunk. The Torment of Allah (ﷻ) is severe, this is a warning, so we need to wake up, subhan Allah.
- (أَوْ تَأْتِيَهُمُ السَّاعَةُ بَغْتَةً) (or of the coming against them of the (Final) Hour, all of a sudden): if you believe in the power and ability of Allah (ﷻ), then you will never feel secure from the punishment of Allah (ﷻ) in the duniya nor the Day of Judgement. One of the sins is to feel secure from the (مكر) of Allah (ﷻ). Allah (ﷻ) will not put two securities and two fears in the heart at the same time. A person cannot be secure both in the duniya and hereafter. Whoever felt secure in the duniya will be insecure in the akhira and whoever felt insecure in the duniya will be secure in the akhira. [Surah Ar Rahman](#)

46: (وَلِمَنْ خَافَ مَقَامَ رَبِّهِ جَنَّاتٌ) (But for him who fears the standing before his Lord, there will be two Gardens (i.e. in Paradise).) We are not talking about fear that will make you depressed and stop doing good deeds. The fear we are talking about is it what will make you conscious and alert of your actions and utterances. When the Hour comes, don't think it's something far away. When death comes, then your 'Hour', your qiyamah, has started. We think we are going to live forever, subhan Allah. Now sudden death is become more common, the healthy are dying before the sick, and the young are dying before the old, subhan Allah. And this should wake us up and make us think we could be that person, and then full stop to our life, subhan Allah. When the sun rises from the west which can happen any moment, then you can't do anything because the time is over, even if the person is alive. There is no chance for repentance. As the Day of Judgement approaches, people will look at the graves and wish they were there instead because of the many fitnas that will happen, subhan Allah. They're afraid to lose their faith. We need to be alert all the time because you don't know how your self can fail you or how the shaitan can trap you. You need to be alert all the time and hold on to the Rope of Allah (ﷻ) – the Qur'an and the Sunnah. Help everyone to do good, do not to leave them.

- (وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ) (while they perceive not): while they don't feel it. Even in the last moment of our lives we can't feel secure. Dua'a: (يا مقلب) (O Changer of the Hearts, keep our hearts firm

on Your deen) and Surah Al Imran 8: (رَبَّنَا لَا تُزِغْ قُلُوبَنَا بَعْدَ إِذْ هَدَيْتَنَا وَهَبْ لَنَا مِنْ ((They say): "Our Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from You. Truly, You are the Bestower,"). Ahmad bin Hanbal was asked when will the person feel secure, he said when he places his foot in paradise, subhan Allah.

- Surah An Nahl 45-47: (أَفَأَمِنَ الَّذِينَ مَكَرُوا السَّيِّئَاتِ أَنْ يَخْسِفَ اللَّهُ بِهِمُ الْأَرْضَ أَوْ يَأْتِيَهُمُ الْعَذَابُ مِنْ حَيْثُ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ (٤٥) أَوْ يَأْخُذَهُمْ عَلَى (أَوْ يَأْخُذَهُمْ فِي تَقْلِبِهِمْ فَمَا هُمْ بِمُعْجِزِينَ (٤٦) (تَخَوُّفٍ فَإِنَّ رَبَّكُمْ لَرَءُوفٌ رَحِيمٌ (٤٧) (Do then those who devise evil plots feel secure that Allâh will not sink them into the earth, or that the torment will not seize them from directions they perceive not? (45) Or that He may catch them in the midst of their going to and fro (in their jobs), so that there be no escape for them (from Allâh's Punishment)? (46) Or that He may catch them with gradual wasting (of their wealth and health). Truly! Your Lord is indeed full of Kindness, Most Merciful? (47))
 - أَفَأَمِنَ الَّذِينَ مَكَرُوا السَّيِّئَاتِ أَنْ يَخْسِفَ اللَّهُ بِهِمُ الْأَرْضَ أَوْ يَأْتِيَهُمُ الْعَذَابُ مِنْ حَيْثُ (لَا يَشْعُرُونَ): They are plotting to commit sins, so they have not done it yet. Do they feel secure that Allah (ﷻ) will not make them sink into the earth?
 - (أَوْ يَأْخُذَهُمْ فِي تَقْلِبِهِمْ فَمَا هُمْ بِمُعْجِزِينَ): or to be caught with no escape.

- (أَوْ يَأْخُذْهُمْ عَلَى تَخَوُّفٍ فَإِنَّ رَبَّكُمْ لَرَءُوفٌ رَحِيمٌ): Allah (ﷻ) is Ra'ouf

Raheem to warn us and tell us.

- Surah Al 'Araf 97-99: (٩٧) أَوَّامِنَ أَهْلُ الْقُرَى أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ بَأْسُنَا بَيِّنًا وَهُمْ نَائِمُونَ (٩٨) أَفَأَمِنُوا مَكْرَ اللَّهِ فَلَا يُأْمَنُ مَكْرَ اللَّهِ إِلَّا (أَهْلُ الْقُرَى أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ بَأْسُنَا ضُحًى وَهُمْ يَلْعَبُونَ (٩٩) (Did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our Punishment by night while they are asleep? (97) Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our Punishment in the forenoon while they were playing? (98) Did they then feel secure against the Plan of Allâh? None feels secure from the Plan of Allâh except the people who are the losers. (99))
 - (أَفَأَمِنَ أَهْلُ الْقُرَى أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ بَأْسُنَا بَيِّنًا وَهُمْ نَائِمُونَ): are they secure that the punishment will not come while they are fast asleep?
 - (أَوَّامِنَ أَهْلُ الْقُرَى أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ بَأْسُنَا ضُحًى وَهُمْ يَلْعَبُونَ): or are they secure that the punishment will not come during the day while they're playing. We take the day for granted, thinking the day has come so the night will come, and it just becomes routine. We need to be alert and not feel secure from the punishment of Allah (ﷻ). When you feel scared, then you will make dua'a with heart, you will say Dua'a: (يا مقلب القلوب ثبت) (O Changer of the Hearts, keep our hearts firm on Your deen)

- (أَفَأَمِنُوا مَكْرَ اللَّهِ فَلَا يَأْمَنُ مَكْرَ اللَّهِ إِلَّا الْقَوْمُ الْخَاسِرُونَ): (مكر) of Allah (ﷻ)
 is just and there is no wrong in it, the (مكر)/plot of the people
 is with desires and it is unjust. We cannot just rely on Ghafoor
 Raheem and forget that Allah (ﷻ) is severe in punishment.
 People will say, I will commit this sin and Allah you are Ghafoor
 Raheem, this is feeling secure. Don't take your deeds for
 granted, especially your faith. Don't think you're a believer
 and that will stay on that. You need to feel that your faith is
 so precious and valuable and your nafs wants to lose it and
 the shaitan wants to snatch it away from you. Our self is our
 greatest enemy. You don't want to be heedless and
 negligent, and then find your faith gone. It's not difficult we
 just need to put everything in its place. Don't think you have
 faith so you're done, you need to keep that faith until the
 end. We need to ask Allah (ﷻ) to keep us firm on the
 guidance and to thank Allah (ﷻ) for guidance. We need to
 thank Allah (ﷻ) that He allowed us to see His ayat, to read it,
 to say it, to talk about it – alhamdulillah this is a favor from Allah
 (ﷻ).

أَيَّاهُ ۚ سَبِيلِي أَدْعُوا إِلَىٰ آلِهِ عَلَىٰ بَصِيرَةٍ أَنَا وَمَنِ اتَّبَعَنِي وَسُبْحَنَ آلَهُ وَمَا أَنَا
فُلٌ هَذِهِ سَبِيلِي أَدْعُوا إِلَىٰ آلِهِ عَلَىٰ بَصِيرَةٍ أَنَا وَمَنِ اتَّبَعَنِي وَسُبْحَنَ آلَهُ وَمَا أَنَا
(مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ) (Say (O Muhammad SAW): "This is my way; I invite unto Allâh
(i.e. to the Oneness of Allâh - Islâmic Monotheism) with sure knowledge,

I and whosoever follows me (also must invite others to Allâh i.e to the Oneness of Allâh - Islâmic Monotheism with sure knowledge). And Glorified and Exalted is Allâh (above all that they associate as partners with Him). And I am not of the Mushrikûn (polytheists, pagans, idolaters and disbelievers in the Oneness of Allâh; those who worship others along with Allâh or set up rivals or partners to Allâh).")

- (قُلْ هَذِهِ سَبِيلِي) (Say (O Muhammad SAW): "This is my way): when you have a company, they have a mission statement stating who they are and what they do. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is making his mission clear and he needs to make others aware of it. The best path is the path of the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)). What is the way of the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم))?
- (أَدْعُوا إِلَى اللَّهِ) (I invite unto Allâh): don't think this is for the messengers alone but for everyone – 'inviting to Allah (ﷻ)'. When you invite someone, you do your best. So when you invite and do dawah you need to be welcoming others, not turning them away. To whom are you inviting? To Allah (ﷻ), not yourself. You have to tell people you can't benefit them or protect them from harm. You need to always turn them to Allah (ﷻ). People can't attach to the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), so how about attaching to someone below him? Subhan Allah. The da'ee will tell you who is Allah (ﷻ), what should you do to attain

His pleasure and stay away from His wrath. If you're inviting to Allah (ﷻ), but you're not saying you can't benefit them, then people will follow you, subhan Allah. When you invite, you need to invite with knowledge, act upon that knowledge, be sincere, and very encouraging. As the fitnas increase, the more motivation and hope is needed. If the da'ee is harsh to the people, then they will be snatched away by the shayateen.

- (عَلَىٰ بَصِيرَةٍ) (with sure knowledge): when you invite to Allah (ﷻ), it has to be upon insight. As if you're above and see everything. How can you invite to Allah (ﷻ) without knowing? It needs to be clear for you, how can you invite others without seeing clearly? One of the descriptions of the Qur'an is (بصائر), it's the plural for (بصيرة), which means clear and apparent (ظهور وبيان). The Qur'an is full of guidance, evidence, and signs. You can find everything in the Qur'an. And when you give dawah, it cannot be with knowledge alone, but that knowledge has to be yaqeen, it's clear to you. Sometimes you have knowledge about something but you haven't experienced it before, unlike someone who has yaqeen. So their delivery will be different. When you talk to people, it's a heart connection. The da'ee doesn't have doubts, how can you tell others about Islam if you have doubts, subhan Allah? You need to have evidence.
- (أَنَا وَمَنْ آتَبَعَنِي) (I and whosoever follows me.): referring to the Prophet (ﷺ) and the Companions. Ibn Masood (ra) said whoever

followed the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) refers to the Companions because they're the best followers of the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)). Ibn Masood (ra) said don't follow someone alive but dead because someone who's alive is still facing fitnas so he can change, his exam paper is not finished. Follow the Sunnah of the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), not someone else. The best of the Muslims are the Companions of the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), why? Because their heart is so pure and they faced tests and passed. Their knowledge is so deep because they are with the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)). They don't do any takaluf, they don't do things for the sake of the people, they don't burden others. We need to take them as examples because Allah (ﷻ) chose them to be with the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)), subhan Allah.

- (وَسُبْحَنَ ٱللَّهِ) (And Glorified and Exalted is Allâh (above all that they associate as partners with Him)): Imagine you are inviting to Allah (ﷻ), this is so great, and we can never be up to that standard, so 'subhan Allah' – Allah (ﷻ) is above our shortcomings of inviting others. Sometimes we do the opposite and call others to ourselves, istaghfar Allah. Don't ever think you're doing justice when inviting to Allah (ﷻ) because Allah (ﷻ) is so great. The angels are always saying tasbeeh and saying 'we didn't worship You as You deserve to be worshipped'.

Imagine Nuh (عليه السلام) was calling the people night and day for 950 years, so we're nothing when calling others, we should be very humble.

- (وَمَا أَنَا مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ) (And I am not of the Mushrikûn): don't do dawah for praise, for followers, or anything worldly – don't associate it with the dawah. The dawah needs to be pure and sincere for Allah (ﷻ). This ayah gives you balance whether you're a teacher or student.

Ayah 109 – (وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ إِلَّا رِجَالًا نُوحِيَ إِلَيْهِمْ مِنْ أَهْلِ الْقُرَىٰ أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ)
(And We sent not before you (as Messengers) any but men, whom We revealed from among the people of townships. Have they not travelled in the land and seen what was the end of those who were before them? And verily, the home of the Hereafter is the best for those who fear Allâh and obey Him (by abstaining from sins and evil deeds, and by performing righteous good deeds). Do you not then understand?)

- (وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ إِلَّا رِجَالًا) (And We sent not before you (as Messengers) any but men): This shows that messengers are men, not women, and they are humans, not jinn or angels. Women would not be able to handle the prophethood imagine with their emotions. And messengers are not angels because they are different from humans. How can they show us how to pray? They have wings and they fly,

and we don't. Angels have no temptations, so haram and halal would defeat the purpose, subhan Allah.

- (نُوحِيَ إِلَيْهِمْ) (whom We revealed): the messengers don't go with desires, they are inspired. The Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) did not speak according to desire, he was inspired. The messengers are not going according to their hawa or mood, if Allah (ﷻ) tells them to go, they go, if He tells them to stay, they stay – they are true slaves of Allah (ﷻ). When Yunus (عليه السلام) left the town, he was nurtured by being in the whale. Even the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) frowned and turned away from the blind man, though the man is blind and didn't see the reaction and his heart was not broken, but the Prophet ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) is a messenger and this cannot happen even if the person can't see, subhan Allah. May Allah (ﷻ) forgive us and pardon us for all that we do.
- (مِّنْ أَهْلِ الْقُرَىٰ) (from among the people of townships): the messengers were not chosen from the Bedouins, they came from civilized towns. The people of the towns are better in mind and are more correct in opinions than the Bedouins.
- (أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ فَيَنْظُرُوا كَيْفَ كَانَ عَاقِبَةُ الَّذِينَ مِن قَبْلِهِمْ) (Have they not travelled in the land and seen what was the end of those who were before them?): if you don't believe in the messengers and then go

and walk the lands and see what happened to those before them. For example, if your child is not studying, then you'll show him look at those before who didn't study and what happened to them. Sunnat Allah, the way of Allah (ﷻ) is one. If you do something bad to someone, it will come back to you the same way. If you call someone a liar, then you'll be called a liar as well. You don't want someone to make fun of you, so don't make fun of others. Someone who has been oppressed should feel what it's like and not go and oppress others afterwards, this is just making a chain of oppression. If you have a problem with your husband, you can't put your anger on your children or housekeeper. It has nothing to do with them. Some people might say she acts like this because of what happened, but we need taqwa. When we see others doing wrong we need to look at them with eyes of mercy and to take it as a lesson. You don't want to do the same wrong. When a penalty was imposed, it would be done in public, and this is taken as a lesson for all. It's a protection for the society because people will not do the same thing again and again.

- (وَلَدَارُ الْآخِرَةِ خَيْرٌ لِلَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا) (And verily, the home of the Hereafter is the best for those who fear Allâh and obey Him): those who have taqwa are the ones seeing the lessons and learning from it. When you're in a situation, you're either have taqwa or hawa. If you have taqwa, then you're holding yourself, hoping for the reward from Allah (ﷻ). But if you go according to your hawa, then you would be screaming, raising your voice just to prove your points and you won't even be able to understand what you're going through. The end will be good

for the muttaqeen. When you take a lesson from what has happened to others then you'll take a precaution, which is taqwa.

- (أَفَلَا تَعْقِلُونَ) (Do you not then understand?): don't you have minds to prefer the best over the least? Subhan Allah. People want to take what's in front of them forgetting the hereafter. But if you have a mind, you will prefer the best quality, which is paradise. And how do you get to paradise? Taqwa. People who have a mind will prefer the best and will prefer to get it in the best way, which is taqwa. And those who don't have a mind will prefer the least, the duniya and prefer the worst way, which is hawa. When you pray, when you feed your children, abstaining from sins, etc. Is it for taqwa or hawa? If you're doing taqwa, you're not getting anything now, you'll get it later. If you're doing hawa, then you want duniya.

أَحَقَّ إِذَا اسْتَيْسَرَ الرُّسُلُ وَظَنُّوا أَنَّهُمْ قَدْ كُذِّبُوا جَاءَهُمْ نَصْرُنَا فَنُجِّيَ مَنْ نَشَاءُ) – Ayah 110

((They were reprieved) until, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied (by their people), then came to them Our Help, and whomsoever We willed were rescued. And Our Punishment cannot be warded off from the people who are Mujrimûn (criminals, sinners, disbelievers, polytheists).))

- Allah (ﷻ) sent the messengers in order to help the people to know who is Allah (ﷻ), what He wants from you, and the Last Day. The messengers came inspired by Allah (ﷻ) and there are people who

followed them and those who didn't. As time passes, the messengers are waiting for the victory from Allah (ﷻ), but still it didn't come, so what happens? You think when you want to take the Straight Path then the victory will come straight away. Allah (ﷻ) is showing us that victory will come but with patience (ان النصر مع الصبر). Even if you make dua'a for years and still you didn't see anything, you have to know you haven't lost anything, and you have to know that you have to be sincere and patient. The victory will come but after a struggle. Imagine the messengers are the best of people, so of course they're doing the best actions. Messengers are supported by Allah (ﷻ), but the victory might take a long time because Allah (ﷻ) wants to purify the people. The messengers are humans, but what happens to them when the victory is prolonged?

- (حَتَّىٰ إِذَا آسَئْتُمُ الرُّسُلَ) (They were reprieved) until, when the Messengers gave up hope): The messengers are the highest in faith and yaqeen in Allah (ﷻ), but what can happen to them? (آسَئْتُمُ): that just for a moment they have a thought of 'where is the victory of Allah?' But they never lose hope in Allah (ﷻ). It shows they're human too, but they never think bad about Allah (ﷻ).
- (وَوَظَنُوا أَنَّهُمْ قَدْ كُذِّبُوا) (and thought that they were denied (by their people)): the messengers are inspired are by Allah (ﷻ) and they have

believers with them so they know there must be victory. But since the victory is being prolonged, the messengers never lost hope in Allah (ﷻ), but they thought that maybe the people who followed them are 'lying', they are not sincere and truthful, subhan Allah. The messengers have no problem with Allah (ﷻ), so the problem may be with those who are showing 'belief', but they are not true believers. That's why in the dua'a (و اجعلنا للمتقين إماما) (And make us a leader for the muttaqeen) – you don't want people who are just following their desires. If you see yourself not going forward, and you're still at the same point, then you need to look at yourself. If everyone is truthful, then the victory will come, but if the victory is being delayed then we need to look at ourselves. And this can be applied to anything whether a company, center, etc. The messengers know 'sunnat Allah' – the way of Allah (ﷻ). When you're making dua'a and you see it's being delayed, then don't lose hope in Allah (ﷻ) but look at yourself, look at your life, maybe something is not halal, something is not being done properly. When Allah (ﷻ) is prolonging the victory, the wisdom is in order to show forbearance to the disbelievers in order to repent and come back, and to purify those following the messengers, are they really following or not?

- (جَاءَهُمْ نَصْرُنَا) (then came to them Our Help): then the help will come but with a struggle because that is (جَاءَ), it is different from (أتى), which

is for something to come smoothly. When the victory comes from Allah (ﷻ) then you will appreciate the victory more had it come from the beginning. After the struggle and the patience, it is all rewarded by Allah (ﷻ) and it's expiation of sins, and when you get the victory, you will be grateful, and the gratitude will increase you – so nothing is lost with Allah (ﷻ). Look at Yusuf (عليه السلام), he got his victory after some time, but look at how much Allah (ﷻ) opened for him, subhan Allah. Look at Surah An Nasr (إذا جاء نصر الله والفتح), it also says (جاء), not (أتى). It shows there will be struggle until the victory comes. And if you were to know the wisdom behind every situation you go through in life, you will wish for the exact same thing to happen, and when you see the great reward you will have the on the Day of Judgment for your patience, you will ask Allah (ﷻ) to have had an entire life of struggles, subhan Allah.

- (فَنَجَّى مَن نَّشَاءُ) (and whomsoever We willed were rescued): Only the believers will be saved, those who are sincere. This is how it is in this life, it's elimination. Fitnas are for elimination, and even on the Day of Judgement, there is elimination of the hypocrites who looked like Muslims but they did not believe.
- (وَلَا يُرَدُّ نَاسُنَا عَنِ الْقَوْمِ الْمُجْرِمِينَ) (And Our Punishment cannot be warded off from the people who are Mujrimûn): the criminals cannot avert their punishment. Imam Ash Shafiee was asked should we ask Allah

(ﷺ) to be afflicted or to be established in the land? Imam Ash Shafiee said you will not be established in the land until you are tested, and this is exactly Surah Yusuf, subhan Allah. Surah Al Imran 179: (مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيَذَرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ عَلَىٰ مَا أَنْتُمْ عَلَيْهِ حَتَّىٰ يَمِيزَ الْخَبِيثَ مِنَ الطَّيِّبِ) (Allâh will not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good) – this means there are tests in this life and in order to be established in the land there needs to be patience, whether it's messengers or people, you need to be patient.

Ayah 111 – (لَقَدْ كَانَ فِي قَصَصِهِمْ عِبْرَةٌ لِأُولَى الْأَلْبَابِ مَا كَانَ حَدِيثًا يُفْتَرَى وَلَكِن تَصْدِيقَ) –
 (الَّذِي بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ وَتَفْصِيلَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَهُدًى وَرَحْمَةً لِّقَوْمٍ يُؤْمِنُونَ) (Indeed in their stories, there is a lesson for men of understanding. It (the Qur'an) is not a forged statement but a confirmation of Allâhs existing Books which were before it [the Taurât (Torah), the Injeel (Gospel) and other Scriptures of Allâh] and a detailed explanation of everything and a guide and a Mercy for the people who believe)

- This is the last ayah of Surah Yusuf and Surah Yusuf is the best of stories because it has so many ups and downs, changes from imprisonment to freedom, from servant to leader, from loss to gain, and all throughout, Yusuf (عليه السلام) didn't complain and this is what makes it the best.

- (لَقَدْ كَانَ فِي قَصَصِهِمْ) (Indeed in their stories.): This is referring to the stories of the messengers, all of the messengers and their followers are saved by Allah (ﷻ) and the disbelievers are destroyed.
- (عِبْرَةٌ) (there is a lesson): we take all of the messengers as a lesson and admonition for us. Why is Allah (ﷻ) telling us about the story of Yusuf (عليه السلام)? To be like him. Why is Allah (ﷻ) telling us about the disbelievers? To not be like them. But it's a lesson for whom?
- (لِّأُولِي الْأَلْبَابِ) (for men of understanding.): the men of understanding will take it as a lesson, they use their intellect to understand, not their emotions. And the place of intellect is in the heart, not the brain. The brain goes according to what's inside the heart. Hadith: The Prophet (ﷺ) said: (إِذَا صَلَحَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ، وَإِذَا (صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ)) (Beware! There is a piece of flesh in the body if it becomes good (reformed) the whole body becomes good but if it gets spoilt the whole body gets spoilt and that is the heart.) – Sahih al-Bukhari 52 If your heart is good, then your intellect and brain will be good. You will not only learn the actions of people in the story, but you will also learn the actions of Allah (ﷻ), subhan Allah. If you are like this and this is your attitude, then this is what will happen. So in any story, you need to look at two things: the characters of the story and what you will benefit from and to look at the actions of Allah (ﷻ). Most people only look at the characters and think why did this happen to

him, and you end up going with your emotions. But when you know the actions of Allah (ﷻ), it gives you balance. That's why when you tell your children about your story, you need to tell them about the actions of Allah (ﷻ) because that will give you a balanced and non-complaining story – you tell them about His mercy and His wisdom. You don't want to tell a sad and depressing story, you don't want to think bad life. When you see both sides of the story from the actions of the people and the actions of Allah (ﷻ) = (لا اله الا الله). Where you will find the most truthful stories? In the Qur'an. This ayah is a connection to the first part of the Surah. Allah (ﷻ) says in the beginning: Surah Yusuf 1-2: (إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا (الرَّ تِلْكَ آيَاتُ الْكِتَابِ الْمُبِينِ (١) (لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ (٢)) (Alif-Lâm-Râ. [These letters are one of the miracles of the Qur'an, and none but Allâh (Alone) knows their meanings]. These are the Verses of the Clear Book (the Qur'ân that makes clear the legal and illegal things, laws, a guidance and a blessing). (1) Verily, We have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'ân in order that you may understand. (2)).

- (مَا كَانَ حَدِيثًا يُفْتَرَى) (It (the Qur'an) is not a forged statement): This Qur'an is not a fabricated story or speech. If I want to take a lesson from any story, it needs to be a true story. Why? Because who decreed the true stories? Allah (ﷻ), and when Allah (ﷻ) decrees – it's perfect. You will not learn from man-made stories because they go above your mind

and make it 'perfect' and you end up getting disappointed because of false expectations, subhan Allah. You see movies or series about love that are not real. But you can learn from people's true life stories. You will learn so much when you hear people's stories – even the young and old. Don't underestimate their stories because it all shows you (لا اله الا الله). What else about the Qur'an?

- (وَلَكِنْ تَصْدِيقَ الَّذِي بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ) (but a confirmation of Allâhs existing Books which were before it [the Taurât (Torah), the Injeel (Gospel) and other Scriptures of Allâh]): the Qur'an is the truth and it's affirming whatever you see in this life. The Qur'an is not telling you something that cannot be applied. For example, when you read Surah Yusuf, you will say 'yes, there is something like this in this life'. The Qur'an doesn't go away from reality – the Qur'an is the reality, people say the outside world is the reality, subhan Allah. When you see someone forbearing and patient like Yusuf (عليه السلام) – don't say that's abnormal, that's actually normal, subhan Allah. The Qur'an is muhaymin over all other books, the Qur'an is the judge over things. Surah An Nisa'a 59: يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا أَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَأَطِيعُوا الرَّسُولَ وَأُولِيَ الْأَمْرِ مِنْكُمْ فَإِنْ تَنَازَعْتُمْ فِي شَيْءٍ فَرُدُّوهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ (O you who believe! Obey Allâh and obey the Messenger (Muhammad SAW), and those of you (Muslims) who are in authority. (And) if you differ in anything amongst yourselves, refer it to Allâh and His Messenger

(SAW), if you believe in Allâh and in the Last Day. That is better and more suitable for final determination). What else about the Qur'an?

- (وَتَفْصِيلَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ) (and a detailed explanation of everything): in the beginning of Surah Yusuf it says the Qur'an is (مبين) – it's clear. Don't take stories that aren't clear, the Qur'an is detailed, everything that you need in this life is all there. When you go to the Qur'an, you don't need to go to fabricated books, because the Qur'an gives you satisfaction. All that you need and will benefit in your duniya and akhira is in the Qur'an and Sunnah. Allah (ﷻ) is telling us this because people are not trusting it, istagfar Allah. If you don't trust what Allah (ﷻ) says, then you won't find the details of everything. Why do people not learn from the Qur'an? Because of the way they're looking at it. When you take the Qur'an, what will happen to you?
- (وَهُدًى) (and a guide): because you accepted all that is in the Qur'an because it's true and it's detailed, it will be a guidance for you. The Qur'an will guide you when you see that it is the most correct book and it has an explanation for everything. Any problem, any worry, any matter – you will find the solution in the Qur'an for sure, that's why it will guide you. The scholars said if you give a little bit of your time to the Qur'an, it won't give you anything. But if your concern is the Qur'an, then the Qur'an will give you a little of it, why? Because the Qur'an is kalam Allah, it's so precious, it's not man's word. No one can surround the words of Allah (ﷻ), we cannot encompass it, it's vast. The

Qur'an guides you to the best deeds, to the best creed/belief, to what you need to know about Allah (ﷻ), about paradise, the shaitan, etc. The Qur'an is guiding you to the best manners and character. When you have guidance, what will you have?

- (وَرَحْمَةً) (and a Mercy): you will have mercy when you have guidance.

But for whom?

- (لِقَوْمٍ يُؤْمِنُونَ) (for the people who believe): so the foundation and pre-requisite for everything is iman – faith. You need faith. In order to get the fruits and mercy, you need to have faith. If you don't believe the Qur'an is a light, a guidance, and a cure then you won't get anything. The Qur'an is kalam Allah and for it to enter to heart you need to believe it. If you are speaking to someone you don't believe, then how will benefit from them? Allah (ﷻ) is watching your heart and what you feel towards the Qur'an, subhan Allah.

This is the end of Surah Yusuf. All thanks and praise to Allah (ﷻ) that by His blessing good deeds are completed. May Allah (ﷻ) forgive us and accept from us. Ameen.

Lessons from Surah Yusuf (الفوائد من سورة يوسف)

We will mention the lessons and the ayat associated with it. All of these are from Sheikh As Saady may Allah have mercy on him.

(1) Keep away from any means to evil and conceal what can harm you

(البعد عن أسباب الشر وكتمان ما تخشى مضرته)

- The father advised Yusuf (عليه السلام) to not mention his dream to his brothers in fear of them being jealous. The father also advised his sons to enter from different doors when they reached Egypt because of their great number and stature.
- Ayah 5: قَالَ يَبْنَى لَا تَقْصُصْ رُءْيَاكَ عَلَىٰ إِخْوَتِكَ فَيَكِيدُوا لَكَ كَيْدًا إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ عَدُوٌّ (مُبِينٌ) (He (the father) said: "O my son! Relate not your vision to your brothers, lest they arrange a plot against you. Verily! Shaitân (Satan) is to man an open enemy!")
- Ayah 67: وَقَالَ يَبْنَى لَا تَدْخُلُوا مِنْ بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ وَادْخُلُوا مِنْ أَبْوَابٍ مُتَفَرِّقَةٍ وَمَا أُغْنِي عَنْكُمْ مِنَ (أَلَلَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِنْ أَلْحَكُمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ عَلَيْهِ تَوَكَّلْتُ وَعَلَيْهِ فَلْيَتَوَكَّلِ الْمُتَوَكِّلُونَ) (And he said: "O my sons! Do not enter by one gate, but enter by different gates, and I cannot avail you against Allâh at all. Verily! The decision rests only with Allâh. In him, I put my trust and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him.")

(2) It is permissible to advise someone about another person's harm/plot

(يجوز ذكر الانسان بما يكره على وجه النصيحة)

- The father advised Yusuf (عليه السلام) to not tell his dream to his brothers otherwise they would plot against him and harm him.

- Ayah 5: قَالَ يُبَيِّنْ لَا تَقْصُصْ رُءْيَاكَ عَلَىٰ إِخْوَتِكَ فَيَكِيدُوا لَكَ كَيْدًا إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ عَدُوٌّ (مُبِينٌ) (He (the father) said: "O my son! Relate not your vision to your brothers, lest they arrange a plot against you. Verily! Shaitân (Satan) is to man an open enemy!")

(3) Allah's blessing upon you benefits others close to you as well (نعمة)

(الله على العبد نعمة على من يتعلق بهم)

- Ayah 6: وَكَذَٰلِكَ يَجْتَبِيكَ رَبُّكَ وَيُعَلِّمُكَ مِن تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ وَيُتِمُّ نِعْمَتَهُ عَلَيْكَ وَعَلَىٰ آلِ (يَعْقُوبَ كَمَا أَتَمَّهَا عَلَىٰ أَبَوَيْكَ مِن قَبْلُ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْحَاقَ إِنَّ رَبَّكَ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ) ("Thus will your Lord choose you and teach you the interpretation of dreams (and other things) and perfect His Favour on you and on the offspring of Ya'qûb (Jacob), as He perfected it on your fathers, Ibrahîm (Abraham) and Ishâq (Isaac) aforetime! Verily, your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise.")

(4) Justice is needed in all matters for fear of harming others (العدل مطلوب)

(في كل الامور خشية الضرر)

- The father loves Yusuf (عليه السلام) more than the rest of his brothers. For this reason, a person should be just to everyone from the outside because if a person is not just, then there is a consequence as a result of it. For example it caused harm to Yusuf (عليه السلام) because the

brothers plotted against him as a result of their father's extra love for Yusuf (عليه السلام).

- As a side note, Sheikh As Saady said the interpretation of the dream were 11 stars, not something lowly like rocks. So the stars show they had a high position, and the brothers of Yusuf (عليه السلام) are also prophets, they are (الأسباط) which is mentioned in the Qur'an, subhan Allah. The messengers are stars whom you follow. And at the same time it shows the prophets are humans too.
- Ayat 8-9: (إِذْ قَالُوا لْيُوسُفُ وَأَخُوهُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْنَا مِنَّا وَنَحْنُ عُصْبَةٌ إِنَّ أَبَانَا لَفِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ (٨) (أَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ أَوْ اطْرَحُوهُ أَرْضًا يَخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهُ أَبِيكُمْ وَتَكُونُوا مِن بَعْدِهِ قَوْمًا صَالِحِينَ (٩) ٨))
(When they said: "Truly, Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother (Benjamin) are dearer to our father than we, but we are a strong group. Really, our father is in a plain error. (8) "Kill Yûsuf (Joseph) or cast him out to some (other) land, so that the favour of your father may be given to you alone, and after that you will be righteous folk (by intending repentance before committing the sin)." (9))

(5) Beware of the consequence of sins, because one sin brings forth another sin (الحذر من شؤم الذنوب لأن الذنوب تولد بعضها)

- When you have a sickness of the heart, it's a greater sickness by trying to remove the person you have ill feelings towards. Rather you need to overcome yourself and say that what they have is fadhli Allah, may Allah bless him, etc.

- The brothers went from being jealous, to having a secret counsel to plot, to lying, to arrogance, to having determination to commit the sin, to no one is advising the other to reconsider, cheating, lying again, dramatizing what falsely happened, to selling their brother, subhan Allah.
- Ayat 8-20: (إِذْ قَالُوا لْيُوسُفُ وَأَخُوهُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْنَا أَيْبِنَا مِنَّا وَنَحْنُ عُصْبَةٌ إِنَّ أَبَانَا لَفِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ) (8) قَالَ (اَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ أَوْ اطْرَحُوهُ اَرْضًا يَخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهُ أَبِيكُمْ وَتَكُونُوا مِن بَعْدِهِ قَوْمًا صَالِحِينَ ٩) (٩) (قَاتِلْهُمْ لَا تَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ وَالْقَوْه فِي غَيْبَتِ الْجُبِّ يَلْتَقِطُهُ بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ فَاعِلِينَ ١٠) (١٠) أَرْسَلَهُ مَعَنَا غَدًا يَرْتَع وَيَلْعَب وَإِنَّا (قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا مَا لَكَ لَا تَأْمَنَّا عَلَى يُوسُفَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَنَصِحُونَ ١١) (١١) قَالَ إِنِّي لَيَحْزُنُنِي أَنْ تَذْهَبُوا بِهِ وَأَخَافُ أَنْ يَأْكُلَهُ الذِّئْبُ وَأَنْتُمْ عَنْهُ غٰفِلُونَ ١٢) (١٢) فَلَمَّا ذَهَبُوا بِهِ وَأَجْمَعُوا أَنْ (قَالُوا لَيْنَ أَكَلَهُ الذِّئْبُ وَنَحْنُ عُصْبَةٌ إِنَّا إِذَا لَخَسِرُونَ ١٤) (١٤) (١٣) وَجَاءُوا أَبَاهُمْ (يَجْعَلُوهُ فِي غَيْبَتِ الْجُبِّ وَأَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْهِ لَتُنَبِّئَهُمْ بِأَمْرِهِمْ هَذَا وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ ١٥) (١٥) قَالُوا يَا أَبَانَا إِنَّا ذَهَبْنَا نَسْتَبِقُ وَتَرَكْنَا يُوسُفَ عِنْدَ مَتْعِنَا فَاكَلَهُ الذِّئْبُ وَمَا (عِشَاءً يَبْكُونَ ١٦) (١٦) وَجَاءُوا عَلَى قَمِيصِهِ بِدَمٍ كَذِبٍ قَالَ بَلْ سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ (أَنْتَ بِمُؤْمِنٍ لَّنَا وَلَوْ كُنَّا صَادِقِينَ ١٧) (١٧) وَجَاءَتْ سَيَّارَةٌ فَأَرْسَلُوا وَارِدَهُمْ (أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ وَاللَّهُ الْمُسْتَعَانُ عَلَى مَا تَصِفُونَ ١٨) (١٨) وَشَرُّهُ بِثَمَنِ بَخْسٍ (فَادْلَى دَلْوَهُ قَالَ يُبْشِرُ هَذَا غُلَامٌ وَأَسَرُّهُ بِضَعَّةٍ وَاللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ بِمَا يَعْمَلُونَ ١٩) (١٩) (20) (When they said: "Truly, Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother (Benjamin) are dearer to our father than we, but we are a strong group. Really, our father is in a plain error. (8) "Kill Yûsuf (Joseph) or cast him out to some (other) land, so that the favour of your father may be given to you alone, and after that you will be

righteous folk (by intending repentance before committing the sin)."

(9) One from among them said: "Kill not Yûsuf (Joseph), but if you must do something, throw him down to the bottom of a well, he will be picked up by some caravan of travellers." (10) They said: "O our father! Why do you not trust us with Yûsuf (Joseph) though we are indeed his well-wishers?" (11) "Send him with us tomorrow to enjoy himself and play, and verily, we will take care of him." (12) He [Ya'qûb (Jacob)] said: "Truly, it saddens me that you should take him away. I fear lest a wolf should devour him, while you are careless of him." (13) They said: "If a wolf devours him, while we are a strong group (to guard him), then surely, we are the losers." (14) So, when they took him away, they all agreed to throw him down to the bottom of the well (they did so), and We revealed to him: "Indeed, you shall (one day) inform them of this their affair, when they know (you) not." (15) And they came to their father in the early part of the night weeping. (16) They said: "O our father! We went racing with one another, and left Yûsuf (Joseph) by our belongings and a wolf devoured him; but you will never believe us even when we speak the truth." (17) And they brought his shirt stained with false blood. He said: "Nay, but your ownelves have made up a tale. So (for me) patience is most fitting. And it is Allâh (Alone) Whose help can be sought against that (lie) which you describe." (18) And there came a caravan of travellers; they sent their water-drawer, and he let down his bucket (into the well). He said: "What good news! Here is a boy." So they hid him as merchandise (a slave). And Allâh was the All-Knower of what they did (19) And they

sold him for a low price, - for a few Dirhams (i.e. for a few silver coins). And they were of those who regarded him insignificant (20))

- Ayah 77: قَالَوَا إِن يَسْرِقْ فَقَدْ سَرَقَ أَخٌ لَهُ مِن قَبْلُ فَأَسْرَهَا يُوسُفُ فِي نَفْسِهِ وَلَمْ يُبْدِهَا (They [(Yûsufs (Joseph) brothers] said: "If he steals, there was a brother of his [Yûsuf (Joseph)] who did steal before (him)." But these things did Yûsuf (Joseph) keep in himself, revealing not the secrets to them. He said (within himself): "You are in worst case, and Allâh is the Best Knower of that which you describe!")
- Ayah 85: (قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ تَفْتُوْا تَذْكُرُ يُوسُفَ حَتَّى تَكُوْنَ حَرَضًا أَوْ تَكُوْنَ مِنَ الْهَالِكِيْنَ) (They said: "By Allâh! You will never cease remembering Yûsuf (Joseph) until you become weak with old age, or until you be of the dead.")

(6) The lesson you get about a person's state is at the end when everything is complete not in the beginning when it's incomplete (العبرة

(في حال العبد بكمال النهاية لا بنقص البداية

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- No one starts perfectly, but what's important is the end. For example, someone born in Islam is not the lesson we get about that person's state, but the end which is to die on it. Look at the beginning of Yusuf (عليه السلام) and his end, the beginning and end of Yaqoub (عليه السلام), the beginning and end of the brothers, of the wife of the Aziz. And this shows you to not be proud of yourself and don't judge others because no one knows what their end will be. That's why it's important to ask Allah (ﷻ) to keep you firm on the deen till the end.

- Ayah 101: (رَبِّ قَدْ ءَاتَيْتَنِي مِنَ الْمُلْكِ وَعَلَّمْتَنِي مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ) ("My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the sovereignty, and taught me something of the interpretation of dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Walî (Protector, Helper, Supporter, Guardian, God, Lord.) in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim (the one submitting to Your Will), and join me with the righteous.")

(7) All that Allah (ﷻ) has favored upon Yusuf (عليه السلام) from knowledge, forbearance, good manners, and the dawah to Allah (ﷻ) (ما من الله على)
(يوسف بالعلم والحلم ومكارم الأخلاق والدعوة الى الله

- Ayah 6: (وَكَذَٰلِكَ يَجْتَبِيكَ رَبُّكَ وَيُعَلِّمُكَ مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ وَيُتِمُّ نِعْمَتَهُ عَلَيْكَ وَعَلَىٰ ءَالِ) ("Thus will your Lord choose you and teach you the interpretation of dreams (and other things) and perfect His Favour on you and on the offspring of Ya'qûb (Jacob), as He perfected it on your fathers, Ibrahîm (Abraham) and Ishâq (Isaac) aforetime! Verily, your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise.")
- Ayah 22-24: (وَرَأَوْدَتُهُ أَلْتِي (وَلَمَّا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ ءَاتَيْنَاهُ حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا وَكَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِي الْمُحْسِنِينَ (٢٢) هُوَ فِي بَيْتِهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ ۖ وَغَلَقَتِ الْأَبْوَابَ وَقَالَتْ هَيْتَ لَكَ قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ رَبِّي أَحْسَنَ مَثْوَايَ إِنَّهُ وَلَقَدْ هَمَّتْ بِهِ ۖ وَهَمَّ بِهَا لَوْلَا أَن رَّءَا بُرْهَانَ رَبِّهِ ۖ كَذَٰلِكَ لِنَصْرِفَ عَنْهُ (لَا يُفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ (٢٣)

۲۴) (And when he [Yûsuf (Joseph)]

attained his full manhood, We gave him wisdom and knowledge (the Prophethood), thus We reward the Muhsinûn (doers of good - see V.2:112). (22) And she, in whose house he was, sought to seduce him (to do an evil act), and she closed the doors and said: "Come on, O you." He said: "I seek refuge in Allâh (or Allâh forbid)! Truly, he (your husband) is my master! He made my living in a great comfort! (So I will never betray him). Verily, the Zâlimûn (wrong and evil-doers) will never be successful." (23) And indeed she did desire him and he would have inclined to her desire, had he not seen the evidence of his Lord. Thus it was, that We might turn away from him evil and illegal sexual intercourse. Surely, he was one of Our chosen, (guided) slaves. (24))

- Ayah 26: قَالَ هِيَ رَأَوْدَتْنِي عَنْ نَفْسِي وَشَهِدَ شَاهِدٌ مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا إِن كَانَ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ قُبُلٍ : (He [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "It was she that sought to seduce me," - and a witness of her household bore witness (saying): "If it be that his shirt is torn from the front, then her tale is true and he is a liar!)
- Ayah 33: قَالَ رَبِّ السِّجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ وَإِلَّا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ : (He said: "O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one (of those who commit sin and deserve blame or those who do deeds) of the ignorant.")
- Dawah to Allah (ﷻ) is the story in the prison

- Ayah 50: (وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ أَتُتُونِي بِهِ فَلَمَّا جَاءَهُ الرَّسُولُ قَالَ ارْجِعْ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ فَسَلِّهْ مَا بَالُ النِّسْوَةِ) (And the king said: "Bring him to me." But when the messenger came to him, [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Return to your lord and ask him, 'What happened to the women who cut their hands? Surely, my Lord (Allâh) is Well-Aware of their plot.'")
- Ayah 92: (قَالَ لَا تَثْرِيبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْيَوْمَ يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ) (He said: "No reproach on you this day, may Allâh forgive you, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy!")

(8) Some evils are better than others (بعض الشر أهون من بعض)

- To be in jail or to remain with the ladies are both evil, but Allah (ﷻ) decreed the lesser evil which is to be in prison. And the brothers wanted to killed Yusuf (عليه السلام) but one brother mentioned to place him in a well instead, which is the lesser evil. Because they committed the lesser evil, imagine the lesser sins they had instead of killing which is major, subhan Allah.
- Ayat 9-10: (أَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ أَوْ اطْرَحُوهُ أَرْضًا يَخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهُ أَبِيكُمْ وَتَكُونُوا مِنْ بَعْدِهِ قَوْمًا) (قَالَ قَائِلٌ مِّنْهُمْ لَا تَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ وَالْقَوَاهُ فِي غَيْبَتِ الْجُبِّ يَلْتَقِطُهُ بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ إِنْ صَالِحِينَ ٩) (كُنْتُمْ فَاعِلِينَ ١٠) ("Kill Yûsuf (Joseph) or cast him out to some (other) land, so that the favour of your father may be given to you alone, and after that you will be righteous folk (by intending repentance before committing the sin).") (9) One from among them said: "Kill not Yûsuf

(Joseph), but if you must do something, throw him down to the bottom of a well, he will be picked up by some caravan of travellers." (10))

(9) To be aware of being alone with ladies and to be aware of being in the kind of love which will cause harm (الحذر من الخلوة بالنساء والحذر من المحبة)

(التي يخشى ضررها)

- Yusuf (عليه السلام) to be alone with the wife of Aziz and the ladies. And the wife of Aziz to beware of this type of love, and the ladies to beware of loving Yusuf (عليه السلام) simply because of his looks. The wife of the Aziz got attracted to not only his look but personality as well since he was in her house, whereas the ladies of the city just saw him once and cut their hands as a result of it because they were in awe of his looks, subhan Allah.

(10) To be determined to do something but you don't do it, then you are not blamed for it (الهم بدون فعل لا يلام عليه العبد)

- The wife of the Aziz was determined to after Yusuf (عليه السلام) and she acted upon it, but Yusuf (عليه السلام) had something in his heart though he did not act on it, so he is not accounted for it.
- Hadith: عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " مَنْ هَمَّ بِحَسَنَةٍ فَلَمْ يَفْعَلْهَا كُتِبَتْ لَهُ عَشْرًا إِلَى سَبْعِمِائَةٍ ضِعْفٍ وَمَنْ هَمَّ بِسَيِّئَةٍ فَلَمْ يَفْعَلْهَا كُتِبَتْ لَهُ حَسَنَةٌ وَمَنْ هَمَّ بِحَسَنَةٍ فَعَمِلَهَا كُتِبَتْ لَهُ عَشْرًا إِلَى سَبْعِمِائَةٍ ضِعْفٍ وَمَنْ هَمَّ بِسَيِّئَةٍ فَلَمْ يَفْعَلْهَا لَمْ تُكْتَبْ وَإِنْ عَمِلَهَا كُتِبَتْ (It is narrated on the authority of

Abu Huraira that the Messenger of Allah ((صلى الله عليه وسلم)) observed: He who intended to do good, but did not do it, one good was recorded for him, and he who intended to do good and also did it, ten to seven hundred good deeds were recorded for him. And he who intended evil, but did not commit it, no entry was made against his name, but if he committed that, it was recorded.) – Sahih Muslim 130

- If you wanted to sin but you don't do it, then you are rewarded a good deed. And if you wanted to do a good deed but you didn't do it, then Allah (ﷻ) will reward you a good deed. Look at the mercy of Allah (ﷻ).
- Ayah 24: وَلَقَدْ هَمَّتْ بِهِ ۖ وَهَمَّ بِهَا لَوْلَا أَنَّ رَأَىٰ بُرْهَانَ رَبِّهِ ۖ كَذَٰلِكَ لِنَصْرِفَ عَنْهُ السُّوْءَ () (And indeed she did desire him and he would have inclined to her desire, had he not seen the evidence of his Lord. Thus it was, that We might turn away from him evil and illegal sexual intercourse. Surely, he was one of Our chosen, (guided) slaves)
- Ayah 77: قَالُوا إِن يَسْرِقْ فَقَدْ سَرَقَ أَخٌ لَهُ مِن قَبْلُ فَأَسْرَهَا يُوسُفُ فِي نَفْسِهِ ۖ وَلَمْ يُبْدِهَا () (They [(Yûsufs (Joseph) brothers] said: "If he steals, there was a brother of his [Yûsuf (Joseph)] who did steal before (him)." But these things did Yûsuf (Joseph) keep in himself, revealing not the secrets to them. He said (within himself): "You are in worst case, and Allâh is the Best Knower of that which you describe!")

(11) Keep away from any means to fitna and evil (البعد عن أسباب الفتنة و)

(الشر)

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- Yusuf (عليه السلام) physically ran away from the wife of the Aziz and he also asked for prison in order to be away from her and the ladies.
 - Ayah 25: (وَاسْتَبَقَا الْبَابَ وَقَدَّتْ قَمِيصَهُ مِنْ دُبُرٍ وَالْفَيَا سَيِّدَهَا لَدَا الْبَابِ قَالَتْ مَا جَزَاءُ مَنْ)
(أَرَادَ بِأَهْلِكَ سُوءًا إِلَّا أَنْ يُسْجَنَ أَوْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ) (So they raced with one another to the door, and she tore his shirt from the back. They both found her lord (i.e. her husband) at the door. She said: "What is the recompense (punishment) for him who intended an evil design against your wife, except that he be put in prison or a painful torment?")
 - Ayah 33: (قَالَ رَبِّ السِّجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ وَإِلَّا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ)
(وَأَكُنَّ مِنَ الْجَاهِلِينَ) (He said:"O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one (of those who commit sin and deserve blame or those who do deeds) of the ignorant.")

(12) When there's a fitna, the person should flee to Allah (ﷻ) and free

himself from his power and might (عند وجود الفتنة يلتجئ العبد الى الله ويتبرأ من)

(حوله وقوته)

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- Yusuf (عليه السلام) didn't rely on himself but relied on Allah (ﷻ) to take him out of the fitna with the ladies.

- Notice it was the outer beauty that placed Yusuf (عليه السلام) in jail but his inner beauty took him out of jail, his goodness, subhan Allah.
- Ayah 33: قَالَ رَبِّ السِّجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ وَإِلَّا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ () (He said:"O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one (of those who commit sin and deserve blame or those who do deeds) of the ignorant.")
- Ayah 51: قَالَ مَا خَطْبُكُنَّ إِذْ رَأَوْتُنَّ يُوسُفَ عَن نَّفْسِهِ قُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ مَا عَلِمْنَا عَلَيْهِ مِنْ () ((The King) said (to the women): "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yûsuf (Joseph)?" The women said: "Allâh forbid! No evil know we against him!" The wife of Al-'Azîz said: "Now the truth is manifest (to all), it was I who sought to seduce him, and he is surely of the truthful.")

(13) Knowledge + reasoning = goodness (العقل = الخير) / Ignorance

+ desire = evil (الجهل + الهوى = الشر)

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- This is the story of Yusuf (عليه السلام), he is granted knowledge, and he uses his mind and reasoning, he didn't use his desires when acting. Ignorance and desire leads to evil like the wife of the Aziz, the ladies, and the brothers.

(14) Dawah to Allah (ﷻ) in both good and bad times (الدعوة الى الله في السراء والضراء)

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- Yusuf (عليه السلام) was making dawah to Allah (ﷻ) both in good times and in prison.

(15) Dawah begins with what is most important then less important (يبدأ في الدعوة الأهم فالمهم)

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- Yusuf (عليه السلام) was asked while in the prison, he did not bring himself and force himself in to talk to them and give dawah. But when the opportunity came that they were asking him, then he began to spoke. This shows don't force it on anyone, the means will come to you to do dawah. If someone asks you about any matter but you know they are committing shirk, then you should delay answering their question and bring what is more important. For example, if someone is asking about shortening the prayer while travelling, but you know this person commits shirk by worshipping the graves, then you should prioritize the matter of addressing grave worship first. So when the prisoners asked Yusuf (عليه السلام) about the interpretation of their dreams, he told them about tawheed first, and then he told them the interpretation of their dreams.

(16) Whoever is in a harmful situation, then it is not wrong to seek the help of someone who has the ability to help (من وقع في مكروه لا بأس أن يستعين بمن)
(له قدرة على تخليصه)

- When you have a problem, you don't want to complain, but in order to find a solution, there is no harm in talking about it to someone who can help. There's a difference between someone complaining and another talking in order to solve a problem. Yusuf (عليه السلام) wasn't complaining about his situation but asked to clear his name with the ladies so that he leaves with honor from the prison.

(17) Sincerity in sharing knowledge (الإخلاص في التعليم)

- When Yusuf (عليه السلام) told them about the interpretation of the king's dream, he didn't expect anything from them. He didn't say now you need to take me out of prison, or I won't interpret it unless you take me out. Neither did he expect anything from the prisoners when he interpreted their dreams either. This shows complete sincerity of not wanting anything in return from the people.

(18) Yusuf's (عليه السلام) outer beauty lead him to problems and distress (جماله الظاهري --> الشدة) / His inner beauty lead him to relief and blessings (جماله الباطني --> الفرج والمنحة)

- As mentioned previously about entering and leaving the jail, subhan Allah.

(19) It's ok to tell others of the qualifications you have (لا بأس ان يخبر الانسان)

(عما عنده من العلم)

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- Yusuf (عليه السلام) didn't go and tell the king of his qualifications, rather he was asked by the king, so he told him his qualifications without boasting, and note it was about the duniya qualifications. So when asked by others, it's ok, but do not to go and tell it without being asked.

(20) It's ok to devise a plan to get the rights (الجواز استعمال الكايد للوصول الى)

(الحقوق)

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- When Yusuf (عليه السلام) devised a plan to bring back his brother to him, this does not negate tawakul in Allah (ﷻ) because he had tawakul in Allah (ﷻ) and acted.

(21) Entertaining/honoring the guests is the way of the messengers

(مشروعية الضيافة وهي من سنن المرسلين)

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- When Yusuf (عليه السلام) entertained his brothers twice.

This is merely an overview and Kallam Allah is beyond this which we can never encompass, we can never give it justice. May Allah (ﷻ) forgive us and our shortcomings and accept from all. Ameen.

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